

Oedipus at Colonus

Sophocles · about 406 B.C.E.

Francis Storr translation (1912) as edited by Standard Ebooks (not yet in the app)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

12 scene lessons, intro, seminar, test, workshop and essay day: 17 class days of 90 minutes in 4 units (5 + 5 + 5 + 2)
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–12), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Sections follow the Greek structure (prologue, parodos, episodes, stasima, exodos). Line numbers are Storr's English lines, not Greek. Lines 403–404 (a disputed speaker) are cited by number only and are never quoted. Line 99 is the corrected pack text and may be quoted. The play has no suicide-method lines. SAT Reading A/B (two 12-item tiers per scene) is in the reader app; the printed teacher editions include the two in-scene SAT-style questions per lesson, not the 288-item A/B set.

Grades: Grades 10–12 (scales to AP via rigor levels). **Units:** 4. **Class days:** 17 × 90 minutes (12 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Oedipus at Colonus suggest about refuge and hospitality?
- What does Oedipus at Colonus suggest about guilt and intent?
- What does Oedipus at Colonus suggest about curse and mercy?
- What does Oedipus at Colonus suggest about law against force?
- What does Oedipus at Colonus suggest about death and blessing?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the play in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the scene quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Writing prompt each unit (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has four rigor levels (HS Sophomore through AP); each level offers three writing options (individual analytical, individual creative, group) on one rubric; the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary (word histories where verified)	We do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Unit	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Prologue (lines 1–114) Parodos (lines 115–248) Episode 1 (lines 249–694) Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*refuge and hospitality* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) *Socratic seminar on refuge and hospitality* Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*guilt and intent* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on refuge and hospitality • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) Exodos (lines 1626–1831) *Whole-book test (90 minutes)*	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*curse and mercy* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Whole-book test and final essay
4	*Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)* *Final paper: peer review, revision and submission*	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*law against force* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework) • Final paper: peer review, revision and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Oedipus at Colonus

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Sophocles's life or times connects to refuge and hospitality in “Oedipus at Colonus”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (refuge and hospitality, guilt and intent, curse and mercy).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Sophocles (about 497/6 to 406/5 B.C.E.) was one of the three great tragic poets of Athens, with Aeschylus and Euripides. He was born at Colonus, just outside the city, served Athens as a general and a treasurer, and is said to have written more than 120 plays, of which seven survive complete. He won first prize at the City Dionysia many times and is credited with adding a third actor to the stage.

Historical and cultural context

Sophocles was born in the deme of Colonus near Athens and died about 406 B.C.E.; Oedipus at Colonus was his last play, staged after his death by his grandson in 401 B.C.E., after Athens had lost the Peloponnesian War.

Publication and reception, then and now

Oedipus at Colonus was Sophocles' last play, staged after his death by his grandson in 401 B.C.E. It is set at Colonus, the poet's birthplace near Athens. This app uses Francis Storr's 1912 translation as edited by Standard Ebooks, corrected against Storr's 1912 Loeb text.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Years after his fall, the blind exile Oedipus arrives with his daughter Antigone at a sacred grove at Colonus near Athens. An oracle once told him that he would find rest there, and that his grave would bless the land that took him in.

Main themes

- refuge and hospitality
- guilt and intent
- curse and mercy
- law against force
- death and blessing

Why it matters

The play is about how a ruined person can claim dignity, how a city treats refugees and suppliants, and how families carry old wrongs. It completes the story of Oedipus with mercy and a death that is a blessing rather than a punishment.

Spoilers · teacher only

Theseus, king of Athens, grants Oedipus protection. Creon tries to take him back by force and seizes his daughters, but Theseus rescues them. Oedipus curses his son Polyneices, then, called by the gods, walks to a secret place and passes from life in a way only Theseus sees.

Content framing, teacher guidance: Keep it brief. Have the school counselor's contact ready and follow school protocol if a student discloses risk. The note does not reveal how Oedipus's life ends.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Say: Before we start, I want to tell you about some hard parts of this play. It follows an old, blind man and his daughters at the end of a long, hard journey. It looks back on painful family events, including violence, a marriage within one family that no one knew about, and a man who hurt himself in grief, and at times characters are so full of sorrow that they say they wish they could die. Sophocles shows these as the words of people in pain, and the play answers them with friendship, loyalty and care. In real life, hurting yourself is wrong and is never the answer. If you or someone you know is having a hard time, call or text 988, or chat at 988lifeline.org, or talk to a school counselor or a trusted adult. You don't have to handle it alone. Before we open Oedipus at Colonus: which matters more, refuge and hospitality or guilt and intent? Write for five minutes.
Prompt: Before we open Oedipus at Colonus: which matters more, refuge and hospitality or guilt and intent? Write for five minutes.

8–18 min · Key terms · We do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
Key terms for Oedipus at Colonus: refuge and hospitality, guilt and intent, curse and mercy, law against force, death and blessing.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).

About the author. Sophocles (about 497/6 to 406/5 B.C.E.) was one of the three great tragic poets of Athens, with Aeschylus and Euripides. He was born at Colonus, just outside the city, served Athens as a general and a treasurer, and is said to have written more than 120 plays, of which seven survive complete. He won first prize at the City Dionysia many times and is credited with adding a third actor to the stage. The world of the book. Sophocles was born in the deme of Colonus near Athens and died about 406 B.C.E.; Oedipus at Colonus was his last play, staged after his death by his grandson in 401 B.C.E., after Athens had lost the Peloponnesian War. Publication and reception. Oedipus at Colonus was Sophocles' last play, staged after his death by his grandson in 401 B.C.E. It is set at Colonus, the poet's birthplace near Athens. This app uses Francis Storr's 1912 translation as edited by Standard Ebooks, corrected against Storr's 1912 Loeb text. How the work first appeared. Sophocles wrote his tragedies for the festivals of Dionysus at Athens, including the City Dionysia, and is credited with adding a third actor to the stage. Oedipus at Colonus was brought out after his death, in 401 B.C.E., by his grandson (Jebb, Introduction, § 18). The play itself is written for a speaking chorus of Colonus elders, who enter and remain as a character in the action. Later influence. In The Birth of Tragedy, section 9, Nietzsche reads this play as the place where a "supermundane cheerfulness" descends, and where the hero, in a "purely passive attitude," "attains his highest activity" beyond life, after earlier conscious striving had led only to passivity (Haussmann translation, 1910). Related works. The three Theban plays were not written in the order of their story. In the story, Oedipus the King comes first, then Oedipus at Colonus, then Antigone; Antigone was written first, and Oedipus at Colonus last (Jebb, Introduction, § 18).

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.

First, meaning. I read "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" slowly and put it in my own words: A blind, aging father asks his daughter what land and what city they have reached. He does not know where he is, and he has to ask. Next, craft. I notice the opening is a question, not a command: the man who once answered the Sphinx now depends on Antigone for the simple fact of place. The strongest word is "blind": "old blind sire" tells us his condition before we hear his name, and it explains why the daughter, not the king, must see the road. Then, effect. What do lines 1–2 reveal about the beggar at the sacred grove? My answer: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The first thing we learn is dependence and exile: the sacred grove is still only a place they have reached, and he cannot see it.

> *Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached* *(Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" slowly and put it in my own words: A blind, aging father asks his daughter what land and what city they have reached. He does not know where he is, and he has to ask. Next, craft. I notice the opening is a question, not a command: the man who once answered the Sphinx now depends on Antigone for the simple fact of place. The strongest word is "blind": "old blind sire" tells us his condition before we hear his name, and it explains why the daughter, not the king, must see the road. Then, effect. What do lines 1–2 reveal about the beggar at the sacred grove? My answer: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The first thing we learn is dependence and exile: the sacred grove is still only a place they have reached, and he cannot see it.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Years after his fall, the blind exile Oedipus arrives with his daughter Antigone at a sacred grove at Colonus near Athens. An oracle once told him that he would find rest there, and that his grave would bless the land that took him in. Themes to track: refuge and hospitality: guilt and intent: curse and mercy: law against force: death and blessing:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page, refuge and hospitality: my prediction is that the play will test this idea against a hard choice, and my question is whether anyone in it can see the whole truth before it is too late to act on it.
Task: Set up a reading journal for Oedipus at Colonus: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page, refuge and hospitality: my prediction is that the play will test this idea against a hard choice, and my question is whether anyone in it can see the whole truth before it is too late to act on it.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Oedipus at Colonus still matter? The play is about how a ruined person can claim dignity, how a city treats refugees and suppliants, and how families carry old wrongs. It completes the story of Oedipus with mercy and a death that is a blessing rather than a punishment.
Anchor question: Why might Oedipus at Colonus still be taught today?
Facilitation: The play is about how a ruined person can claim dignity, how a city treats refugees and suppliants, and how families carry old wrongs. It completes the story of Oedipus with mercy and a death that is a blessing rather than a punishment.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Sophocles was born at Colonus near Athens, and Oedipus at Colonus was staged only after his death, when Athens had lost the Peloponnesian War. Why might a play promising that Oedipus's grave will protect Athens have mattered then? Answer: Accept answers such as: a defeated Athens needed comfort and pride; the play honours the poet's home village and Theseus's Athens as a place of mercy that wins a lasting protector.
Exit ticket: Sophocles was born at Colonus near Athens, and Oedipus at Colonus was staged only after his death, when Athens had lost the Peloponnesian War. Why might a play promising that Oedipus's grave will protect Athens have mattered then?
Answer: Accept answers such as: a defeated Athens needed comfort and pride; the play honours the poet's home village and Theseus's Athens as a place of mercy that wins a lasting protector.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Prologue (lines 1–114).

Teacher notes · sources: Standard Ebooks, Sophocles, translated by Francis Storr (https://standardebooks.org/ebooks/sophocles); R. C. Jebb, Sophocles: The Plays and Fragments (Cambridge University Press), Internet Archive (https://archive.org/details/sophocles02soph_0); Friedrich Nietzsche, The Birth of Tragedy, section 9, trans. W. A. Haussmann (1910), Project Gutenberg #51356 (https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/51356)

Lesson 2: Prologue (lines 1–114)

Focus: the beggar at the sacred grove

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in "Prologue (lines 1–114)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Blind and old, Oedipus comes with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

Background: Jebb notes that the play was brought out after Sophocles' death by his grandson (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18), and that the link between Oedipus and Colonus was not Sophocles' invention (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8).

Significance: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does a community owe a stranger it fears? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: What does a community owe a stranger it fears?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The play opens with a fallen king who must ask where he is, yet already claims that this forbidden grove will be his place of rest and a blessing to those who take him in.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
7 key words in context.
Today's words: wanderer — a person who travels without a settled home; scanted — given sparingly; restricted in amount; denizens — inhabitants of a particular place; inviolable — that must not be broken, entered, or profaned; sanctuary — a holy place of refuge and protection; consecrate — set apart as sacred; dedicated to a god; wayfarer — a traveler, especially one who travels on foot.
Words: wanderer: a person who travels without a settled home · scanted: given sparingly; restricted in amount · denizens: inhabitants of a particular place · inviolable: that must not be broken, entered, or profaned · sanctuary: a holy place of refuge and protection · consecrate: set apart as sacred; dedicated to a god · wayfarer: a traveler, especially one who travels on foot

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).

Jebb notes that the play was brought out after Sophocles' death by his grandson (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18), and that the link between Oedipus and Colonus was not Sophocles' invention (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Setting: The opening is set at a sacred grove of the Eumenides near Athens. A local man tells the newcomers it is holy ground and that they must leave. Characterization: Blind and old, Oedipus has to ask where he is, yet he refuses to leave: Apollo, he says, foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out. Irony: The king who once solved riddles must now ask which city he has reached, and the forbidden grove of the Furies is the place where he claims he will find rest. He also says the blind man's words will be instinct with sight. Watch for the sacred grove and the hidden grave: The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the beggar at the sacred grove.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)

Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.

First, meaning. I read "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" slowly and put it in my own words: A blind, aging father asks his daughter what land and what city they have reached. He does not know where he is, and he has to ask. Next, craft. I notice the opening is a question, not a command: the man who once answered the Sphinx now depends on Antigone for the simple fact of place. The strongest word is "blind": "old blind sire" tells us his condition before we hear his name, and it explains why the daughter, not the king, must see the road. Then, effect. What do lines 1–2 reveal about the beggar at the sacred grove? My answer: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The first thing we learn is dependence and exile: the sacred grove is still only a place they have reached, and he cannot see it.

> *Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached* *(Prologue, lines 1–2)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" slowly and put it in my own words: A blind, aging father asks his daughter what land and what city they have reached. He does not know where he is, and he has to ask. Next, craft. I notice the opening is a question, not a command: the man who once answered the Sphinx now depends on Antigone for the simple fact of place. The strongest word is "blind": "old blind sire" tells us his condition before we hear his name, and it explains why the daughter, not the king, must see the road. Then, effect. What do lines 1–2 reveal about the beggar at the sacred grove? My answer: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The first thing we learn is dependence and exile: the sacred grove is still only a place they have reached, and he cannot see it.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Blind", "man's" and "instinct" stand out. "Blind" and "man's" name the speaker as a sightless human being, while "instinct with sight" puts seeing inside the words themselves, not in the eyes. He answers the stranger's doubt (line 73) by claiming that insight can live in a blind man's speech (Oedipus, line 74). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected student answer: The line answers the stranger's fear of a helpless trespasser: Oedipus claims that a blind guest can still speak with insight, so the grove's hosts should hear him before they drive him out.

> *The blind man's words will be instinct with sight (Prologue, line 74)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Blind", "man's" and "instinct" stand out. "Blind" and "man's" name the speaker as a sightless human being, while "instinct with sight" puts seeing inside the words themselves, not in the eyes. He answers the stranger's doubt (line 73) by claiming that insight can live in a blind man's speech (Oedipus, line 74).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected student answer: The line answers the stranger's fear of a helpless trespasser: Oedipus claims that a blind guest can still speak with insight, so the grove's hosts should hear him before they drive him out.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the beggar at the sacred grove? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–114) develops the idea of the beggar at the sacred grove. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. When the text says "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue, lines 1–2), it shows this directly. Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

Task: Annotate the scene for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the beggar at the sacred grove? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–114) develops the idea of the beggar at the sacred grove. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Access supports: Access supports (not a legal-compliance promise). These are teaching options for English learners and for students with IEP or 504 needs; they do not replace a student's plan, and using them does not by itself satisfy any legal requirement. Chunked reading: read lines 1–74 (the arrival and the stranger's question) and then lines 75–114 (the prayer), with a gist check after each stretch. Sentence frames for today's CER: Oedipus first asks "___" (lines 1–2) because ___. / In his prayer he calls himself "___" (lines 107–108), which shows ___. Graphic organizer: three columns—where they are, what the stranger warns, what Oedipus claims about the grove. Time: extended time on the quiz and on starting the writing prompt; the prompt's rigor does not change. Audio: students may hear lines 1–114 while following the printed text. For English learners, pre-teach grove, stranger, and shade from the line 107 prayer.

Exemplar: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. When the text says "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue, lines 1–2), it shows this directly. Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What does a community owe a stranger it fears? Ask: What does a community owe a stranger it fears?

Anchor question: What does a community owe a stranger it fears?

Facilitation: Ask: What does a community owe a stranger it fears?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the beggar at the sacred grove? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. ("Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached", Prologue, lines 1–2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the beggar at the sacred grove? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. ("Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached", Prologue, lines 1–2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes the beggar at the sacred grove. Key takeaway: The play opens with a fallen king who must ask where he is, yet already claims that this forbidden grove will be his place of rest and a blessing to those who take him in.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** The opening is set at a sacred grove of the Eumenides near Athens. A local man tells the newcomers it is holy ground and that they must leave.
- **Characterization:** Blind and old, Oedipus has to ask where he is, yet he refuses to leave: Apollo, he says, foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.
- **Irony:** The king who once solved riddles must now ask which city he has reached, and the forbidden grove of the Furies is the place where he claims he will find rest. He also says the blind man's words will be instinct with sight.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the beggar at the sacred grove.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the beggar at the sacred grove.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue, lines 1–2) Blind and exiled, Oedipus must ask his daughter what land they have reached, so the play opens in dependence rather than command.
- "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight" (Prologue, line 74) He answers the stranger's doubt by claiming that insight can live in a blind man's speech.
- "There," said he, "shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse" (Prologue, lines 91–93) Apollo promised him rest here as a blessing to his hosts and a curse on the land that expelled him.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest.
Evidence: "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue, lines 1–2)
Reasoning: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1–2

1 **Oedipus:** Child of an old blind sire, Antigone,
2 **Oedipus:** What region, say, whose city have we reached?

Lines 1–8

1 **Oedipus:** Child of an old blind sire, Antigone,
2 **Oedipus:** What region, say, whose city have we reached?
3 **Oedipus:** Who will provide today with scanted dole
4 **Oedipus:** This wanderer? 'Tis little that he craves,
5 **Oedipus:** And less obtains—that less enough for me;
6 **Oedipus:** For I am taught by suffering to endure,
7 **Oedipus:** And the long years that have grown old with me,
8 **Oedipus:** And last not least, by true nobility.

Lines 1–13

1 **Oedipus:** Child of an old blind sire, Antigone,
2 **Oedipus:** What region, say, whose city have we reached?
3 **Oedipus:** Who will provide today with scanted dole
4 **Oedipus:** This wanderer? 'Tis little that he craves,
5 **Oedipus:** And less obtains—that less enough for me;
6 **Oedipus:** For I am taught by suffering to endure,
7 **Oedipus:** And the long years that have grown old with me,
8 **Oedipus:** And last not least, by true nobility.

9 **Oedipus:** My daughter, if thou seest a resting place
10 **Oedipus:** On common ground or by some sacred grove,
11 **Oedipus:** Stay me and set me down. Let us discover
12 **Oedipus:** Where we have come, for strangers must inquire
13 **Oedipus:** Of denizens, and do as they are bid.

Line 2
2 **Oedipus:** What region, say, whose city have we reached?

Line 21
21 **Oedipus:** Guide these dark steps and seat me there secure.

Lines 33–34
33 **Oedipus:** O stranger, as I learn from her whose eyes
34 **Oedipus:** Must serve both her and me, that thou art here

Line 36
36 **Stranger:** First quit that seat, then question me at large:

Line 40
40 **Stranger:** Dread brood of Earth and Darkness, here abide.

Line 44
44 **Oedipus:** Then may they show their suppliant grace, for I

Line 49
49 **Stranger:** Due warrant and instruction from the State.

Lines 54–55
54 **Stranger:** Whate'er I know thou too shalt know; the place
55 **Stranger:** Is all to great Poseidon consecrate.

Line 69
69 **Stranger:** Theseus, the son of Aegeus our late king.

Line 74
74 **Oedipus:** The blind man's words will be instinct with sight.

Lines 75–114
75 **Stranger:** Heed then; I fain would see thee out of harm;
76 **Stranger:** For by thy looks, marred though they be by fate,
77 **Stranger:** I judge thee noble: tarry where thou art,
78 **Stranger:** While I go seek the burghers—those at hand,
79 **Stranger:** Not in the city. They will soon decide
80 **Stranger:** Whether thou art to rest or go thy way. Exit Stranger.
81 **Oedipus:** Tell me, my daughter, has the stranger gone?
82 **Antigone:** Yes, he has gone; now we are all alone,

Antigone: And thou may'st speak, dear father, without fear.
Oedipus: Stern-visaged queens, since coming to this land
Oedipus: First in your sanctuary I bent the knee,
Oedipus: Frown not on me or Phoebus, who, when erst
Oedipus: He told me all my miseries to come,
Oedipus: Spake of this respite after many years,
Oedipus: Some haven in a far-off land, a rest
Oedipus: Vouchsafed at last by dread divinities.
Oedipus: "There," said he, "shalt thou round thy weary life,
Oedipus: A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st,
Oedipus: But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse."
Oedipus: And of my weird he promised signs should come,
Oedipus: Earthquake, or thunderclap, or lightning flash.
Oedipus: And now I recognise as yours the sign
Oedipus: That led my wanderings to this your grove;
Oedipus: Else had I never lighted on you first,
Oedipus: A wineless man on you who loathe the grape,
Oedipus: Or set me on your seat of native rock.
Oedipus: O goddesses, fulfil Apollo's word,
Oedipus: Grant me some consummation of my life,
Oedipus: If haply I appear not all too vile,
Oedipus: A thrall to sorrow worse than any slave.
Oedipus: Hear, gentle daughters of primeval Night,
Oedipus: Hear, namesake of great Pallas; Athens, first
Oedipus: Of cities, pity this dishonoured shade,
Oedipus: The ghost of him who once was Oedipus.
Antigone: Hush! for I see some grey-beards on their way,
Antigone: Their errand to spy out our resting-place.
Oedipus: I will be mute, and thou shalt guide my steps
Oedipus: Into the covert from the public road,
Oedipus: Till I have learned their drift. A prudent man
Oedipus: Will ever shape his course by what he learns.

Lines 76–77

Stranger: For by thy looks, marred though they be by fate,
Stranger: I judge thee noble: tarry where thou art,

Lines 91–93

Oedipus: "There," said he, "shalt thou round thy weary life,
Oedipus: A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st,
Oedipus: But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse."

Lines 92–93

Oedipus: A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st,
Oedipus: But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse."

Line 93
93 **Oedipus:** But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse."

Lines 98–99
98 **Oedipus:** Else had I never lighted on you first,
99 **Oedipus:** A wineless man on you who loathe the grape,

Line 107
107 **Oedipus:** Of cities, pity this dishonoured shade,

Line 108
108 **Oedipus:** The ghost of him who once was Oedipus.

Lines 113–114
113 **Oedipus:** Till I have learned their drift. A prudent man
114 **Oedipus:** Will ever shape his course by what he learns.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
wanderer (noun)	a person who travels without a settled home	*Who will provide today with scanted dole / This wanderer? 'Tis little that he craves,*
scanted (adjective)	given sparingly; restricted in amount	*Who will provide today with scanted dole / This wanderer? 'Tis little that he craves,*
denizens (noun)	inhabitants of a particular place	*Where we have come, for strangers must inquire / Of denizens, and do as they are bid.*
inviolable (adjective)	that must not be broken, entered, or profaned	*Inviolable, untrod; goddesses, / Dread brood of Earth and Darkness, here abide.*
sanctuary (noun)	a holy place of refuge and protection	*Then may they show their suppliant grace, for I / From this your sanctuary will ne'er depart.*
consecrate (adjective)	set apart as sacred; dedicated to a god	*Whate'er I know thou too shalt know; the place / Is all to great Poseidon consecrate.*
wayfarer (noun)	a traveler, especially one who travels on foot	*Athens I recognise, but not the spot. / That much we heard from every wayfarer.*

Discussion questions

1. What does a community owe a stranger it fears?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and intent?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore:

1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Oedipus ask Antigone in lines 1–2? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Oedipus asks what region they have reached and whose city it is. In the opening lines he says, “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached?” The question is practical and helpless at once: a former king must now learn even the name of the ground under his feet, and he can learn it only through his daughter.

   Answer guidance: Oedipus asks what region they have reached and whose city it is. In the opening lines he says, “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached?” The question is practical and helpless at once: a former king must now learn even the name of the ground under his feet, and he can learn it only through his daughter.
2. According to the stranger, what god and what hero give this neighbourhood its name and worship? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The stranger says the place is consecrated to Poseidon, that Prometheus is worshipped hard by, and that the neighbouring lands take their name from the knight Colonus. “The place / Is all to great Poseidon consecrate,” he tells Oedipus, then adds that “the neighbouring lands / Claim as their chief and patron yonder knight / Colonus, and in common bear his name.” The grove of the goddesses therefore sits inside a named Attic deme, not in a blank wilderness.

   Answer guidance: The stranger says the place is consecrated to Poseidon, that Prometheus is worshipped hard by, and that the neighbouring lands take their name from the knight Colonus. “The place / Is all to great Poseidon consecrate,” he tells Oedipus, then adds that “the neighbouring lands / Claim as their chief and patron yonder knight / Colonus, and in common bear his name.” The grove of the goddesses therefore sits inside a named Attic deme, not in a blank wilderness.
3. How does the stranger first describe the ground under Oedipus's feet? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** It is inviolable and untrod

   Answer guidance: It is inviolable and untrod.
4. Of what does Oedipus say a wanderer must live today? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A scanted dole

   Answer guidance: A scanted dole.
5. What did Apollo foretell about this place? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Oedipus would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts

   Answer guidance: Oedipus would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts.
6. What blessing does Oedipus first ask of the grove's goddesses, once he knows whose ground this is? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** That they be gracious to their suppliant

   Answer guidance: That they be gracious to their suppliant.
7. What will Oedipus be to the land that cast him out? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A curse

   Answer guidance: A curse.

8. What people, according to the stranger, take their name from a horseman of this ground? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The neighbouring lands, from the knight Colonus

   Answer guidance: The neighbouring lands, from the knight Colonus.
9. What does Oedipus ask the stranger not to refuse, once he has heard the place's name? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A slight service that may avail the king much

   Answer guidance: A slight service that may avail the king much.
10. What does Oedipus say he would be, were he not received by these goddesses? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A thrall to sorrow worse than any slave

    Answer guidance: A thrall to sorrow worse than any slave.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Oedipus refuse to leave the grove once he hears it is holy ground? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He refuses because he recognises the grove as the resting place Apollo foretold. After the stranger names the "Dread brood of Earth and Darkness," Oedipus answers, "Then may they show their suppliant grace, for I / From this your sanctuary will ne'er depart." The refusal is not stubbornness for its own sake: he takes the holiness of the spot as the "watchword of my fate," the sign that his wandering has reached the haven promised him.

   Answer guidance: He refuses because he recognises the grove as the resting place Apollo foretold. After the stranger names the "Dread brood of Earth and Darkness," Oedipus answers, "Then may they show their suppliant grace, for I / From this your sanctuary will ne'er depart." The refusal is not stubbornness for its own sake: he takes the holiness of the spot as the "watchword of my fate," the sign that his wandering has reached the haven promised him.
2. Why does Oedipus want the stranger to summon Theseus, even though he is a sightless beggar? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He believes his coming can help the king, and that "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight." When the stranger asks, "How can he profit from a sightless man?" Oedipus answers with that claim, then asks that "a slight service may avail him much." The request shows that Oedipus already understands his coming as a political gift to Athens, not merely as a plea for food and rest.

   Answer guidance: He believes his coming can help the king, and that "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight." When the stranger asks, "How can he profit from a sightless man?" Oedipus answers with that claim, then asks that "a slight service may avail him much." The request shows that Oedipus already understands his coming as a political gift to Athens, not merely as a plea for food and rest.
3. What does "Prologue (lines 1–114)" suggest about the beggar at the sacred grove? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An inference that the beggar is more than helpless: he asks for little, yet he already treats this grove as the rest Apollo promised him, so weakness and authority sit side by side.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Oedipus's poverty hides a sense of purpose. He says "'Tis little that he craves, / And less obtains—that less enough for me" (lines 4–5), yet once he hears the ground is holy he announces that he "From this your sanctuary will ne'er depart" (line 45). The beggar who needs a guide also believes the gods have brought him to this exact spot.

4. Find one example of setting in "Prologue (lines 1–114)". What does it reveal about the beggar at the sacred grove that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** One concrete detail of place, such as the "Brass-footed Threshold" or the laurel, olive and nightingales, explained for what it shows: the ground he rests on is holy and guarded, so his resting place is a public matter.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The stranger tells him that "the spot / Thou treadest, the Brass-footed Threshold named, / Is Athens' bastion" (lines 57–59). The rock a blind beggar sits on is also a guard-post of the city. A plain statement would say only that he is trespassing; the setting shows that where he chooses to rest touches the safety of the whole city.

5. How does the characterization in "Prologue (lines 1–114)" shape what we understand about the beggar at the sacred grove? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** How Oedipus's words and the stranger's reaction build a double portrait: a man humbled by suffering who still speaks like a king, and whom even a hostile local judges "noble."

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Oedipus says he is "taught by suffering to endure" (line 6), but within minutes he is asking for the lord of Athens, claiming that "a slight service may avail him much" (line 72). The stranger, who wants him off the seat, still says "by thy looks, marred though they be by fate, / I judge thee noble" (lines 76–77). The characterization makes the beggar someone to be reckoned with, not only pitied.

6. In the passage that opens with "Child of an old…", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two words from lines 1–13, each with its connotation, and what the pair shows together, for example "scanted dole" (a stingy handout), "wanderer" (no home), "nobility" (rank kept in ruin) or "denizens" (locals whose rules he must obey).

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The phrase "scanted dole" (line 3) makes his food a grudging handout, so we feel how far a king has fallen. The word "nobility" (line 8) pushes back: suffering, time "And last not least, by true nobility" have taught him to endure, so he claims an inner rank that poverty cannot take. Together the words present a man who is poor in goods but not in dignity.

7. What causes the main turn in "Prologue (lines 1–114)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The turn is the stranger's news that the ground belongs to the dread goddesses. Oedipus hears it as a sign and refuses to move, so the local men must be fetched to decide.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The turn comes when the stranger says the spot belongs to the "Dread brood of Earth and Darkness" (line 40). Instead of leaving, Oedipus calls this "The watchword of my fate" (line 47). Because he will not move, the stranger goes for the local men, who "will soon decide / Whether thou art to rest or go thy way" (lines 79–80). The next scene will have to be a confrontation.

8. As the opening scene, what does "Prologue (lines 1–114)" set up that the rest of Oedipus at Colonus will need? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** What the opening plants for the whole play: Apollo's promise of rest, a blessing to the hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out (lines 91–93), the promised signs (lines 94–95), and the open question of whether this land will take him in.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The Prologue sets up the promise the rest of the play tests. Apollo said Oedipus would "round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st, / But to the land that

cast thee forth, a curse" (lines 91–93), and "promised signs should come" (line 94). From here the audience watches for two things: whether this land will receive him, and when the promised signs will appear.

9. In "Prologue (lines 1–114)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the beggar at the sacred grove, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A motive read beneath a stated claim, for example the stranger, who claims only to follow procedure but is afraid to act alone on holy ground, or Oedipus, who promises silence but is gathering information.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The stranger says only that "'tis not mine to bid thee hence without / Due warrant and instruction from the State" (lines 48–49); beneath the rule-following, he is wary of acting alone on holy ground and hands the decision up. Oedipus says he will "be mute" (line 111), but his reason is tactical: "A prudent man / Will ever shape his course by what he learns" (lines 113–114). His silence is a way of reading his judges before he speaks.

10. Go back to the bell-ringer question (What does a community owe a stranger it fears?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A revised bell-ringer answer that changes because of a specific Prologue line, such as the stranger's wish to see him "out of harm" or Oedipus's plea that Athens "pity this dishonoured shade."

    Answer guidance: Model answer: My first answer was that a community owes a stranger safety. Now I would say it owes him at least a fair hearing before it acts. Even the stranger who wants him off the holy seat says, "I fain would see thee out of harm" (line 75), and lets the local men decide instead of acting alone. Oedipus's prayer, "Athens, first / Of cities, pity this dishonoured shade" (lines 106–107), shows what he hopes that hearing will bring.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus a helpless beggar or a man still in control in the Prologue? Defend your view with evidence from this section. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A clear position weighed against the other side: helplessness (he needs Antigone to guide "these dark steps") against control (he refuses to move, asks for the king, and reads the sign for himself).

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: he is helpless in body but in control of the scene. He cannot walk alone ("Guide these dark steps and seat me there secure," line 21), yet he decides what happens next by refusing to leave the grove and asking, "Might one be sent from you to summon him?" (line 70). Counter-line: his prayer, "Grant me some consummation of my life, / If haply I appear not all too vile" (lines 102–103), shows he knows his fate still lies with others.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A stand on both halves of the reading: the reversal (the man who must ask where he is) and the forbidden grove as his rest. A careful answer notes that this translation never names the Furies or a riddle, so that part depends on outside knowledge.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: agree, with a qualification. Oedipus opens by asking, "What region, say, whose city have we reached?" (line 2), so a man famous for knowing must depend on others even for where he is. He treats the forbidden ground as his promised haven: "now I recognise as yours the sign / That led my wanderings to this your grove" (lines 96–97). The qualification is that the text calls the

goddesses “The Gracious Ones” (line 42), and the riddle belongs to the earlier story, so students should mark which part of the claim comes from outside the scene.

3. Which character in “Prologue (lines 1–114)” acts most wisely in the matter of the beggar at the sacred grove, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named standard, such as prudence (acting only on what you know), applied to two characters in the Prologue, with a line for each and a reason the other falls short.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: by the standard of prudence, the stranger acts most wisely. He warns that “The spot thou treadest on is holy ground” (line 37) but will not expel Oedipus without the State’s word. Antigone is close behind, since she scouts the land and finds “a man hard by” to ask (line 29). By the same standard Oedipus acts least wisely, staking everything on his reading of a sign. A student could argue the reverse, though, because he too waits “Till I have learned their drift” (line 113).

4. You are directing “Prologue (lines 1–114)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the beggar at the sacred grove. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two staging choices tied to particular lines, each with its effect on how the audience sees the beggar: for example his stillness on the rock, a change of light for the prayer, or Antigone guiding him into hiding.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: (1) Hold Oedipus seated and still on a central rock while the stranger stands over him on “First quit that seat, then question me at large” (line 36). The stillness makes his refusal look like a choice, not frailty. (2) After the stranger leaves, narrow the light to one warm pool and have Oedipus kneel for “Hear, gentle daughters of primeval Night” (line 105). The audience sees a ruined man addressing the powers of the place almost as an equal. Both choices let the beggar command a stage he cannot see.

5. Write your own questions about “Prologue (lines 1–114)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Three questions, each answerable from lines 1–114: one recall, one why/how and one should/what-if, not three versions of the same question.

   Answer guidance: Model set. Recall: To whom does the stranger say the grove belongs? (The “Dread brood of Earth and Darkness,” line 40.) Why/how: Why does Oedipus call the holiness of the spot “The watchword of my fate” (line 47)? (He takes it as Apollo’s promised sign.) Should/what if: Should the stranger have expelled him at once? (Answers weigh the sanctity of the ground against the stranger’s choice to wait for “Due warrant and instruction from the State,” line 49.)

6. Connect “Prologue (lines 1–114)”, with its focus on the beggar at the sacred grove, to curse and mercy: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment about curse and mercy, the theme the question names. Mercy is asked for and a curse is announced, but no one has yet granted either. A strong answer names what Sophocles must show next: the people of this place choosing mercy or refusing it.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the link is strong in words but untested in action. Mercy is asked for (“Then may they show their suppliant grace,” line 44; “pity this dishonoured shade,” line 107), and a curse is promised to “the land that cast thee forth” (line 93). But no one in the Prologue grants mercy; the stranger only postpones a decision. To strengthen the link, Sophocles would need to show the local people deciding whether to show mercy to a stranger whose name they do not yet know.

7. Is the setting in "Prologue (lines 1–114)" effective in presenting the beggar at the sacred grove, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment of the grove setting against a stated criterion (does it drive the conflict, or only decorate?), with one detail that meets the criterion and one that might miss it.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: effective, because the setting is the conflict. The beauty Antigone describes, "surely holy ground; / A wilderness of laurel, olive, vine" (lines 16–17), invites rest, while the same ground is "Inviolable, untrod" (line 39), so every detail pushes him both to stay and to leave. Counter-line: the stranger's list of Poseidon, Prometheus and the knight Colonus (lines 54–61) can read like a guidebook. A reviewer might call it heavy-handed unless the class sees how it ties the local people to their place.

8. Compare how "Prologue (lines 1–114)" treats the beggar at the sacred grove with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named comparison (a play, film or real situation of someone seeking shelter or asylum) and one thing the Prologue sees that the other misses, tied to a line.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Many modern stories about asylum seekers focus on the host country's rules. The Prologue notices something they often miss: the newcomer comes with his own sense of purpose and worth. Oedipus is a beggar, yet he insists, "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight" (line 74). He expects to give as well as receive. A strong answer names its comparison exactly and says what each one notices.

9. Predict what "Parodos (lines 115–248)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A prediction built on two clues from the end of the Prologue, the grey-beards coming "to spy out our resting-place" and the warning that the locals "will soon decide," then checked after reading.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Clue 1: Antigone sees "some grey-beards on their way, / Their errand to spy out our resting-place" (lines 109–110), so the next scene will probably open as a search. Clue 2: the stranger said they "will soon decide / Whether thou art to rest or go thy way" (lines 79–80), so it should end in a judgment on whether he may stay. A sharper prediction also asks what will happen once the locals hear the name he has not yet given them.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Prologue (lines 1–114)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the beggar at the sacred grove? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An adaptation that holds the core situation: a disgraced, dependent outsider sits on protected ground and claims a right to stay. It names two details that must survive, such as a guide who sees for him or a local who will not decide alone.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: A disgraced former official, now blind and poor, is led by his teenage daughter into a fenced memorial garden in a capital city and sits down inside it. A gardener tells him to leave. He refuses, saying he was told long ago that he would find rest here, and asks to speak to the mayor. Two things must stay: his dependence on the daughter who sees for him ("her whose eyes / Must serve both her and me," lines 33–34), and the protected status of the ground, which turns his rest into a public question.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who guides the blind Oedipus?

   A. Antigone
   B. sister Ismene
   C. King Theseus
   D. Creon of Thebes

   Key: A (Antigone)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why must Oedipus leave his seat, according to the stranger?

   A. It belongs to Creon
   B. It is holy ground
   C. It is a battlefield
   D. It is a market

   Key: B (It is holy ground)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Oedipus's claim: "The _____ of my fate."

   Key: watchword

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Oedipus's vow: "From this your _____ will ne'er depart."

   Key: sanctuary

5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Antigone first conclude about the place they stand?

   A. It is the market of Thebes
   B. It is Theseus' royal palace
   C. It is surely holy ground
   D. It is a deserted battlefield

   Key: C (It is surely holy ground)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] What is ironic about "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight"?

   A. He is not really blind, only pretending to the stranger now
   B. He is quoting Teiresias by mistake, not speaking for himself
   C. He is only joking about his lost eyes to comfort Antigone
   D. The blind man claims a kind of sight the seeing lack

   Key: D (The blind man claims a kind of sight the seeing lack)

7. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus refuse to leave the grove once the stranger names its goddesses?

   Sample answer: He refuses because he recognises the grove as the resting place Apollo foretold. After the stranger names the "Dread brood of Earth and Darkness", Oedipus answers, "Then may they show their suppliant grace, for I / From this your sanctuary will ne'er depart" (lines 44–45). The refusal is not stubbornness for its own sake: he takes the holiness of the spot as "The watchword of my fate" (line 47), the sign that his wandering has reached the haven promised him.

8. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] When the stranger says, "First quit that seat, then question me at large:" what does the sequence of those commands show?

   A. The holiness of the ground comes before any conversation

   B. The stranger is rushing Oedipus toward the city gates at once

   C. Questions about the gods are forbidden on this sacred seat

   D. Oedipus has already broken a written law of the city

   Key: A (The holiness of the ground comes before any conversation)

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] In the opening lines, Oedipus asks Antigone, "What region, say, whose city have we reached?" What does this question show about his situation at the start of the play?

   Sample answer: It shows that the former king is now dependent and lost. He must ask even the name of the ground under his feet: "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached?" (lines 1–2). The question is practical and helpless at once: he cannot see, he does not know the land, and he can learn it only through his daughter, who must "Guide these dark steps" (line 21).

10. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Trace how Oedipus moves, in this Prologue, from not knowing where he is to claiming the grove as his fated resting place. Use one early quotation and one later one.

    Sample answer: At first he can only ask, "What region, say, whose city have we reached?" (lines 1–2): he comes as a blind wanderer who does not even know the land. Once the stranger names the holy ground, he will not be moved: "From this your sanctuary will ne'er depart" (line 45), and he calls that refusal "The watchword of my fate" (line 47). The Prologue turns ignorance of place into a claim that this grove is the haven Apollo promised.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the stranger say of this spot, as to its fame?

    A. It is to fame unknown

    B. It is already famous throughout Thebes

    C. It is already mapped in a public decree

    D. It is already named in a treaty with Argos

    Key: A (It is to fame unknown)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the stranger tell Oedipus to do first, before he will answer questions at large?

    A. Name Theseus as king of Thebes this hour

    B. Quit that seat, then question him at large

    C. Send Antigone back along the public road

    D. Cut a branch from the sacred olive

    Key: B (Quit that seat, then question him at large)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Antigone's description: "A _____ of laurel, olive, vine;"

    Key: wilderness

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the stranger's account of the place: “the place / Is all to great _____ consecrate.”

    Key: Poseidon

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus ask the stranger to do about Theseus?

    A. Take the pair back to Thebes

    B. Hide him from every passer-by

    C. Send someone to summon him

    D. Crown him on the nearest rock

    Key: C (Send someone to summon him)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] The stranger says that, “by thy looks, marred though they be by fate, / I judge thee noble”. What is he doing in that judgment?

    A. He is mocking a beggar who claims a royal Theban bloodline

    B. He is repeating a command already given by the local king

    C. He is warning that the grove punishes every unknown visitor

    D. He reads dignity in Oedipus despite his ruined appearance

    Key: D (He reads dignity in Oedipus despite his ruined appearance)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus want the stranger to summon Theseus, even though he is a sightless beggar?

    Sample answer: He believes his coming can help the king, and that “The blind man’s words will be instinct with sight” (line 74). When the stranger asks, “How can he profit from a sightless man?” (line 73), Oedipus answers with that claim, having already said that “a slight service may avail him much” (line 72). The request shows that Oedipus already understands his coming as a gift to Athens, not merely as a plea for food and rest.

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] The stranger says the local people call the goddesses “The Gracious Ones, All-seeing”, though “elsewhere other names are rife”. What does this difference in naming show?

    A. The same dread goddesses are honoured here under a milder name

    B. The stranger does not know which gods inhabit this sacred grove

    C. The goddesses of this grove are unique to the city of Athens alone

    D. Oedipus has already given them a forbidden unspoken name

    Key: A (The same dread goddesses are honoured here under a milder name)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Antigone describes the grove's plants and the “warbling” of nightingales. What is the effect of this description of the grove?

    Sample answer: The description makes the grove feel sacred and alive before anyone explains its gods. “A wilderness of laurel, olive, vine” (line 17) names plants already tied to Attic religion, and “a feathered flock of nightingales / Are warbling” (lines 18–19) fills the place with song rather than threat. The beauty supports her conclusion that “where we stand is surely holy ground” (line 16), so the later warning not to sit there falls on a scene the audience has already learned to revere.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the stranger's information change what Oedipus can ask for? Use one quotation about the place and one about the city's king.

    Sample answer: At first Oedipus can only ask where they have come. The stranger gives the ground a civic identity: “the place / Is all to great Poseidon consecrate” (lines 54–55), and the neighbouring lands “Claim as their chief and patron yonder knight / Colonus” (lines 60–61). Then he names the ruler: “Theseus, the son of Aegeus our late king” (line 69). With that

knowledge Oedipus can ask that Theseus be summoned, turning a lost wanderer's question into a request to the king of Athens.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What did Apollo foretell about this place?

    A. He would close his life here as a blessing

    B. Oedipus would become king of Athens again by force

    C. Oedipus would regain his sight upon this very ground

    D. Thebes would be destroyed before the following dawn

    Key: A (He would close his life here as a blessing)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the stranger's answer: "_____, the son of Aegeus our late king."

    Key: Theseus

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's claim: "The blind man's words will be _____ with sight."

    Key: instinct

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the stranger go to the nearby burghers, not the city?

    A. They will arm him at once for a coming war on Thebes

    B. They will decide whether he may stay or must go

    C. They will claim the right to restore his vanished sight

    D. They will vote that very hour to make him a citizen

    Key: B (They will decide whether he may stay or must go)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does it suggest that Oedipus waits until the stranger has gone before he prays to the goddesses?

    A. He does not yet believe the grove is truly sacred ground

    B. He is hiding this prayer from Antigone as well as from the man

    C. The prayer is a private claim, not a speech to the stranger

    D. He has been forbidden to speak until the over-lord is present

    Key: C (The prayer is a private claim, not a speech to the stranger)

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] According to the stranger, what god and what hero give this neighbourhood its name and worship, and why does that matter to Oedipus?

    Sample answer: The stranger says the place is consecrated to Poseidon, that Prometheus is worshipped hard by, and that the neighbouring lands take their name from the knight Colonus. "the place / Is all to great Poseidon consecrate." he tells Oedipus, then adds that Prometheus "has his worship" nearby, and that the lands "Claim as their chief and patron yonder knight / Colonus, and in common bear his name" (lines 54–61). The grove therefore sits inside a named Attic deme under Athens, which is why Oedipus can treat it as a political as well as a sacred shelter.

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Oedipus says he would never have "lighted on" the goddesses first, "A wineless man on you who loathe the grape". What does that detail show?

    A. He is asking the stranger for a drink offering at once beside the rock

    B. He admits he has come only to insult the goddesses of the grove

    C. He wants the burghers to plant new vines beside the sacred rock

    D. He reads his coming without wine as a sign he belongs on this sober ground

Key: D (He reads his coming without wine as a sign he belongs on this sober ground)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In his prayer Oedipus calls himself "The ghost of him who once was Oedipus". What does this wording show about how he sees himself?

    Sample answer: The line presents him as already a shade of his former self, not as a king still in power. He asks Athens to "pity this dishonoured shade, / The ghost of him who once was Oedipus" (lines 107–108). The words "dishonoured shade" and "ghost" stress disgrace and a kind of living death, while "who once was" puts his famous name in the past. The prayer seeks pity for what remains of him, even as he still claims Apollo's promise in the same speech.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Apollo, as Oedipus quotes him, promised a double fate: "A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse." How does that prophecy define his value in this scene?

    Sample answer: The prophecy makes his death a gift to his hosts and a threat to Thebes, not a private ending only. Oedipus quotes Apollo: "shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse" (lines 91–93). In the Prologue he already uses that double value to justify staying and to offer Theseus "a slight service" (line 72). His worth, as he tells it here, begins where his wandering ends.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Using one line about Oedipus's body and one about his will, explain how the Prologue holds together his helplessness and his control.

    Sample answer: The helplessness is physical and open: he must say, "Guide these dark steps and seat me there secure" (line 21), and he lives on a "scanted dole" (line 3). The control is a refusal once he knows the ground: "From this your sanctuary will ne'er depart" (line 45). The Prologue does not choose one portrait over the other; it shows a man who must be led and seated, and who will not be moved from the place he takes to be his fated rest.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's direction to Antigone: "Into the _____ from the public road,"

    Key: covert

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete this close of Apollo's promise: "But to the land that cast thee forth, a _____."

    Key: curse

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus call himself in the prayer to Athens?

    A. The ghost of him who once was Oedipus

    B. The new-made king of Colonus

    C. A priest who serves Poseidon here

    D. A spy dispatched from a foreign court

    Key: A (The ghost of him who once was Oedipus)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone see at the end of the Prologue, and why does Oedipus go silent and step off the public road?

    Sample answer: She sees "some grey-beards on their way, / Their errand to spy out our resting-place" (lines 109–110). Oedipus answers, "I will be mute, and thou shalt guide my steps / Into the covert from the public road, / Till I have learned their drift" (lines 111–113). He hides and waits because, as he says, "A prudent man / Will ever shape his course by what he learns" (lines 113–114). The ending is cautious, not yet a confrontation: he will hear these men before he speaks again.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Oedipus closes the Prologue with "A prudent man / Will ever shape his course by what he learns." How does that line function as an ending?

    A. It admits that he already knows who the approaching men are, and why they have come

    B. It turns his hiding into a principle of waiting for knowledge before he acts

C. It cancels Apollo's promise outright and has them leave the grove by night

D. It tells Antigone to speak for him no matter what these men may say

Key: B (It turns his hiding into a principle of waiting for knowledge before he acts)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Oedipus says Apollo promised signs such as earthquake, thunder, or lightning, yet he also says he already recognises a sign that led him to this grove. What kind of recognition is this?

A. He has already felt an earthquake stirring under the native rock

B. He is waiting for thunder and lightning before he will trust the place

C. He treats his very coming as the promised sign, before any storm

D. He thinks the stranger's speech was itself a bolt sent down from Zeus

Key: C (He treats his very coming as the promised sign, before any storm)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse the wording of "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight" (line 74). What does the phrase claim, and how does its diction work?

Sample answer: The line claims a kind of insight that does not depend on physical eyes. "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight" (line 74) answers the stranger's doubt, "How can he profit from a sightless man?" (line 73). "Sightless" and "blind" name the body's lack, while "instinct with sight" puts seeing inside the words themselves, as if prophecy or knowledge lived in speech. The paradox prepares Theseus to hear a beggar as someone who can still offer a service to the city.

38. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which statement best captures how the Prologue as a whole defines Oedipus's position?

A. He has already been made a citizen and a judge of this deme Colonus

B. He has come to reclaim the throne of Thebes by open force of arms

C. He wants only food and drink and has no claim about the land's future

D. He is a dependent exile who still offers a fated gift to the city

Key: D (He is a dependent exile who still offers a fated gift to the city)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Is Oedipus a helpless beggar or a man still in control in the Prologue? Defend your view with evidence from this section.

Sample answer: He is both, and the Prologue makes the two conditions work together rather than cancel each other. He must be seated and guided—"Guide these dark steps and seat me there secure" (line 21)—and he lives on a "scanted dole" (line 3), so the beggar's need is real. Yet once he knows the ground is holy he will not be moved, he interprets Apollo's old promise without a priest to prompt him, and he already bargains with Athens: his end here will be "A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st" (line 92). Control, in this scene, is knowledge and refusal, not strength of body.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Across the Prologue, how does Sophocles link the sacred grove, Oedipus's exile, and a possible gift to Athens? Use one quotation about the ground and one about Apollo's promise.

Sample answer: The ground is first named as holy and Attic, not as empty wilderness: the stranger says "The spot thou treadest on is holy ground" (line 37) and later that the place "Is all to great Poseidon consecrate" (line 55). Oedipus then joins that sacred ground to his exile and to Athens's profit, quoting Apollo: he will be "A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse" (lines 92–93). The Prologue therefore makes shelter, holiness, and political value the same coming.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix

HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–114) develops the idea of the beggar at the sacred grove. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Prologue (lines 1–114)” could deliver about the beggar at the sacred grove. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the beggar at the sacred grove in “Prologue (lines 1–114)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to guilt and intent and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Prologue (lines 1–114) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the beggar at the sacred grove. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Prologue (lines 1–114)” could deliver about the beggar at the sacred grove. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the beggar at the sacred grove in “Prologue (lines 1–114)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to guilt and intent and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Prologue (lines 1–114) suggests about the beggar at the sacred grove. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Prologue (lines 1–114)” could deliver about the beggar at the sacred grove. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the beggar at the sacred grove in "Prologue (lines 1–114)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to guilt and intent and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses setting in Prologue (lines 1–114) to complicate the reader's understanding of the beggar at the sacred grove. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Prologue (lines 1–114)" could deliver about the beggar at the sacred grove. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the beggar at the sacred grove in "Prologue (lines 1–114)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to guilt and intent and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, What region, say, whose city have we reached? Who will provide today with scanted dole This wanderer? 'Tis little that he craves, And less obtains—that less enough for me; For I am taught by suffering to endure, And the long years that have grown old with me, And last not least, by true nobility.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "endure" most nearly mean?

   A. bear or last through hardship

   B. forget every injury at once

   C. demand a rich welcome from the city

   D. turn back toward home that same day

2. *Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, What region, say, whose city have we reached? Who will provide today with scanted dole This wanderer? 'Tis little that he craves, And less obtains—that less enough for me; For I am taught by suffering to endure, And the long years that have grown old with me, And last not least, by true nobility. My daughter, if thou seest a resting place On common ground or by some sacred grove, Stay me and set me down. Let us discover Where we have come, for strangers must inquire Of denizens, and do as they are bid.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Prologue (lines 1–114)"?

   A. A demand that Athens restore his Theban throne

   B. The beggar at the sacred grove

   C. A hymn of thanksgiving for a safe journey's end

   D. A formal trial of Antigone for trespass

SAT key: 1. A (bear or last through hardship); 2. B (The beggar at the sacred grove)

Lesson 3: Parodos (lines 115–248)

Focus: the elders' fear

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in "Parodos (lines 115–248)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

Background: The Chorus's entrance song (parodos) here is a search and a confrontation, not a hymn.

Significance: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: A name alone almost ends the welcome: the elders hunt the trespasser, and when they learn who he is they judge him by the story that arrived before he could speak.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
8 key words in context.
Today's words: perdition — ruin; in religion, eternal punishment; requites — repays, especially a wrong with a wrong; demesne — a domain or estate, especially land held as one's own; precincts — the grounds immediately around a sacred or official place; profane — showing contempt for what is sacred; unholy; pilgrimage — a long journey, especially one undertaken as a sacred duty or through hardship; hapless — unlucky; unfortunate; guile — cunning deception; sly trickery.
Words: perdition: ruin; in religion, eternal punishment · requites: repays, especially a wrong with a wrong · demesne: a domain or estate, especially land held as one's own · precincts: the grounds immediately around a sacred or official place · profane: showing contempt for what is sacred; unholy · pilgrimage: a long journey, especially one undertaken as a sacred duty or through hardship · hapless: unlucky; unfortunate · guile: cunning deception; sly trickery

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Chorus's entrance song (parodos) here is a search and a confrontation, not a hymn. A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Conflict: The elders of Colonus search the grove for the trespasser, and when they learn his name they order him out, so the scene is a clash between their fear and his claim to remain. Characterization: Antigone pleads for her father when the elders turn against him. The chorus's entrance is a search and a confrontation, not a hymn. Theme: A name alone condemns him: his story has traveled ahead of him, and the elders judge the stranger by what they have heard before they will hear him out. Watch for the sacred grove and the hidden grave: The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the elders' fear.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites" slowly and put it in my own words: The elders say heaven's justice never strikes a person who pays back a wrong with a wrong. They use that rule to justify driving him out after they promised safety. Next, craft. I notice they answer Oedipus's "How keep you then your troth?" (line 221) not by keeping the promise but by renaming the expulsion as justice. The strongest word is "requites": "ill with ill requites" turns their broken welcome into a repayment, as if his name were itself a wrong they may lawfully pay back. Then, effect. What do lines 222–223 reveal about the elders' fear? My answer: This is the elders' fear: a name alone condemns him, his story has traveled ahead of him, and they treat expulsion as just requital rather than a broken troth.

> *Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites* *(Parodos, lines 222–223)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites" slowly and put it in my own words: The elders say heaven's justice never strikes a person who pays back a wrong with a wrong. They use that rule to justify driving him out after they promised safety. Next, craft. I notice they answer Oedipus's "How keep you then your troth?" (line 221) not by keeping the promise but by renaming the expulsion as justice. The strongest word is "requites": "ill with ill requites" turns their broken welcome into a repayment, as if his name were itself a wrong they may lawfully pay back. Then, effect. What do lines 222–223 reveal about the elders' fear? My answer: This is the elders' fear: a name alone condemns him, his story has traveled ahead of him, and they treat expulsion as just requital rather than a broken troth.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Search", "scapes" and "perdition" stand out. "Search ye ne'er so well" makes the hunt exhaustive, "scapes" is the bare chance of escape, and "perdition" names ruin as what follows if a god impels. Antigone argues that a person driven by a god cannot be judged as if the ruin were freely chosen (Antigone, lines 243–244). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected student answer: Antigone asks the elders to grant refuge rather than treat her father's ruin as freely chosen sin; if a god drove him, hospitality, not expulsion, is the just response.

> *Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel* *(Parodos, lines 243–244)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Search", "scapes" and "perdition" stand out. "Search ye ne'er so well" makes the hunt exhaustive, "scapes" is the bare chance of escape, and "perdition" names ruin as what follows if a god impels. Antigone argues that a person driven by a god cannot be judged as if the ruin were freely chosen (Antigone, lines 243–244).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected student answer: Antigone asks the elders to grant refuge rather than treat her father's ruin as freely chosen sin; if a god drove him, hospitality, not expulsion, is the just response.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the elders' fear? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Parodos (lines 115–248) develops the idea of the elders' fear. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. When the text says "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos, lines 243–244), it shows this directly. The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

Task: Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the elders' fear? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Parodos (lines 115–248) develops the idea of the elders' fear. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Access supports: Access supports (not a legal-compliance promise). These are teaching options for English learners and for students with IEP or 504 needs; they do not replace a student's plan, and using them does not by itself satisfy any legal requirement. Chunked reading: read the search (lines 115–215) and then the naming and "Begone!" (lines 216–248), pausing to check why the welcome breaks. Sentence frames: The elders first promise "___," but when they hear the name they say "Begone!" (line 216) because ___. / Antigone's "search ye ne'er so well… if a god impel" (lines 243–244) asks them to ___. Graphic organizer: two columns (the elders' fear / Antigone's plea) with a quoted line in each. Time: extended time on the quiz and CER; rigor does not change. Audio: hear the parodos while following the text, and mark "Begone!" and "requites" as they come.

Exemplar: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. When the text says "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos, lines 243–244), it shows this directly. The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them? Ask: Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them?

Anchor question: Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them?

Facilitation: Ask: Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the elders' fear? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. ("Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel", Parodos, lines 243–244). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the elders' fear? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. ("Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel", Parodos, lines 243–244). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes the elders' fear. Key takeaway: A name alone almost ends the welcome: the elders hunt the trespasser, and when they learn who he is they judge him by the story that arrived before he could speak.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** The elders of Colonus search the grove for the trespasser, and when they learn his name they order him out, so the scene is a clash between their fear and his claim to remain.
- **Characterization:** Antigone pleads for her father when the elders turn against him. The chorus's entrance is a search and a confrontation, not a hymn.
- **Theme:** A name alone condemns him: his story has traveled ahead of him, and the elders judge the stranger by what they have heard before they will hear him out.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the elders' fear.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the elders' fear.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites" (Parodos, lines 222–223) The elders break their promise of safety by treating his name as a wrong they may justly repay.

- "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos, lines 243–244) Antigone argues that a person driven by a god cannot be judged as if the ruin were freely chosen.
- "Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan" (Parodos, lines 115–116) The chorus enters not with a hymn but with a hunt for the trespasser they cannot yet see.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him.
Evidence: "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos, lines 243–244)
Reasoning: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Line 115
115 **Chorus:** Ha! Where is he? Look around!

Lines 115–116
115 **Chorus:** Ha! Where is he? Look around!
116 **Chorus:** Every nook and corner scan!

Lines 115–133
115 **Chorus:** Ha! Where is he? Look around!
116 **Chorus:** Every nook and corner scan!
117 **Chorus:** He the all-presumptuous man,
118 **Chorus:** Whither vanished? search the ground!
119 **Chorus:** A wayfarer, I ween,
120 **Chorus:** A wayfarer, no countryman of ours,
121 **Chorus:** That old man must have been;
122 **Chorus:** Never had native dared to tempt the Powers,
123 **Chorus:** Or enter their demesne,
124 **Chorus:** The Maids in awe of whom each mortal cowers,
125 **Chorus:** Whose name no voice betrays nor cry,
126 **Chorus:** And as we pass them with averted eye,
127 **Chorus:** We move hushed lips in reverent piety.
128 **Chorus:** But now some godless man,
129 **Chorus:** 'Tis rumoured, here abides;
130 **Chorus:** The precincts through I scan,
131 **Chorus:** Yet wot not where he hides,
132 **Chorus:** The wretch profane!
133 **Chorus:** I search and search in vain.

Lines 119–127
119 **Chorus:** A wayfarer, I ween,
120 **Chorus:** A wayfarer, no countryman of ours,
121 **Chorus:** That old man must have been;
122 **Chorus:** Never had native dared to tempt the Powers,
123 **Chorus:** Or enter their demesne,
124 **Chorus:** The Maids in awe of whom each mortal cowers,
125 **Chorus:** Whose name no voice betrays nor cry,
126 **Chorus:** And as we pass them with averted eye,
127 **Chorus:** We move hushed lips in reverent piety.

Line 133
133 **Chorus:** I search and search in vain.

Line 135
135 **Oedipus:** Ears to the blind, they say, are eyes.

Line 137
137 **Oedipus:** Oh sirs, I am no outlaw under ban.

Line 147
147 **Chorus:** Yet add not curse to curse and wrong to wrong.

Line 152
152 **Chorus:** Bowls of spring water mingled with sweet mead.

Line 163
163 **Oedipus:** O Sirs, if I come forth at your command,

Line 164
164 **Oedipus:** Let me not suffer for my confidence.

Line 165
165 **Chorus:** Against thy will no man shall drive thee hence.

Line 188
188 **Chorus:** And sit thee crouching on the scarped edge.

Line 199
199 **Oedipus:** Forbear, nor urge me further to reveal—

Line 216
216 **Chorus:** Begone!

Lines 222–223
222 **Chorus:** Heaven's justice never smites
223 **Chorus:** Him who ill with ill requites.

Lines 234–235

234 **Antigone:** My eyes, not reft of sight,
235 **Antigone:** Plead with you as a daughter's might

Lines 243–244

243 **Antigone:** Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well,
244 **Antigone:** Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel!

Line 244

244 **Antigone:** Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel!

Line 248

248 **Chorus:** We cannot say aught other than we said.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
perdition (noun)	ruin; in religion, eternal punishment	*Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel!*
requites (verb)	repays, especially a wrong with a wrong	*Heaven's justice never smites Him who ill with ill requites.*
demesne (noun)	a domain or estate, especially land held as one's own	*Never had native dared to tempt the Powers, / Or enter their demesne,*
precincts (noun)	the grounds immediately around a sacred or official place	*'Tis rumoured, here abides; / The precincts through I scan,*
profane (adjective)	showing contempt for what is sacred; unholy	*The wretch profane! / I search and search in vain.*
pilgrimage (noun)	a long journey, especially one undertaken as a sacred duty or through hardship	*Evil, methinks, and long / Thy pilgrimage on earth.*
hapless (adjective)	unlucky; unfortunate	*The hapless Oedipus. / Art he?*
guile (noun)	cunning deception; sly trickery	*But if guile with guile contend, / Bane, not blessing, is the end.*

Discussion questions

1. Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with curse and mercy?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore:

1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Antigone ask the elders to consider in lines 243–244? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** She asks them to consider that no one escapes ruin when a god impels him. “Where will you find one, search ye ne’er so well, / Who ’scapes perdition if a god impel!” The plea does not deny that her father has done terrible things; it asks the elders to judge a man driven by a god differently from a man who chose his ruin in cold freedom.

   Answer guidance: She asks them to consider that no one escapes ruin when a god impels him. “Where will you find one, search ye ne’er so well, / Who ’scapes perdition if a god impel!” The plea does not deny that her father has done terrible things; it asks the elders to judge a man driven by a god differently from a man who chose his ruin in cold freedom.
2. What do the elders command once Oedipus names himself, and what do they tell him to do? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** They shout “Begone!” and order father and daughter out of their borders. After he says, “The hapless Oedipus,” the chorus answers, “Forth from our borders speed ye both!” and later, “Arise, begone and take thee hence straightway, / Lest on our land a heavier curse thou lay.” The command is expulsion, not a request for more explanation.

   Answer guidance: They shout “Begone!” and order father and daughter out of their borders. After he says, “The hapless Oedipus,” the chorus answers, “Forth from our borders speed ye both!” and later, “Arise, begone and take thee hence straightway, / Lest on our land a heavier curse thou lay.” The command is expulsion, not a request for more explanation.
3. When they first come on the trespasser, what do the elders demand to know before they will deal with him further? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** His name and the land of his birth

   Answer guidance: His name and the land of his birth.
4. What does Antigone remind the elders she still has, when she begins her plea? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Her eyes, not reft of sight

   Answer guidance: Her eyes, not reft of sight.
5. What do the elders say about requiting ill with ill? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Heaven's justice does not punish it

   Answer guidance: Heaven's justice does not punish it.
6. What does Oedipus say he has no longer got, when they ask him of his birth and home? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A country he can claim as his

   Answer guidance: A country he can claim as his.
7. What boon does Antigone say she craves of the elders, in the plea itself? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The nigh despaired-of boon

   Answer guidance: The nigh despaired-of boon.

8. What does the chorus say it does, while still hunting the trespasser? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** It searches and searches in vain
   Answer guidance: It searches and searches in vain.
9. What counsel does Oedipus ask of his daughter, after the elders have found them? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** What they should now pursue
   Answer guidance: What they should now pursue.
10. What does Oedipus offer to teach the elders, if they will let him speak? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The worship due to this place, as he has learned it
    Answer guidance: The worship due to this place, as he has learned it.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Chorus break its promise of safety? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Fear of pollution, once they hear his name, outweighs the promise they made while he was still an unknown wanderer. Before the revelation they had said, "Against thy will no man shall drive thee hence." After he names Laius, Labdacus, and himself, they cry "Begone!" and defend the reversal with "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites." The name, not a new deed in the grove, is what changes their mind.
   Answer guidance: Fear of pollution, once they hear his name, outweighs the promise they made while he was still an unknown wanderer. Before the revelation they had said, "Against thy will no man shall drive thee hence." After he names Laius, Labdacus, and himself, they cry "Begone!" and defend the reversal with "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites." The name, not a new deed in the grove, is what changes their mind.
2. Why does Antigone, rather than Oedipus, make the longest plea after the elders turn on him? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** She can still see, she is not the infamous name they fear, and she can appeal to their pity as a daughter. "My eyes, not reft of sight, / Plead with you as a daughter's might," she says, and she reminds them that they already knew something of "the deeds he wrought, not innocent, / But with no ill intent." The speech tries to separate the man in front of them from the story that has gone ahead of him.
   Answer guidance: She can still see, she is not the infamous name they fear, and she can appeal to their pity as a daughter. "My eyes, not reft of sight, / Plead with you as a daughter's might," she says, and she reminds them that they already knew something of "the deeds he wrought, not innocent, / But with no ill intent." The speech tries to separate the man in front of them from the story that has gone ahead of him.
3. What does "Parodos (lines 115–248)" suggest about the elders' fear? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An inference that the elders' fear is religious before it is personal: they dread the goddesses' anger at a trespass, and once they hear his name, dread of pollution outweighs pity.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Their fear starts as reverence for the goddesses, "The Maids in awe of whom each mortal cowers" (line 124), past whom they move "with averted eye" (line 126). When they hear his name, the same fear turns on him: "Lest on our land a heavier curse thou lay" (line 227). They fear what his presence may bring on the whole land, not what he might do with his hands.

4. Find one example of conflict in “Parodos (lines 115–248)”. What does it reveal about the elders' fear that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A specific clash, such as the elders’ “Begone!” against his “How keep you then your troth?”, explained for what it shows: fear is strong enough to make decent men break their word.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: When the elders cry “Begone!” (line 216), Oedipus answers, “How keep you then your troth?” (line 221). A plain statement would say only that they changed their minds. The exchange shows that they know they promised “Against thy will no man shall drive thee hence” (line 165), and that fear makes them break that promise while still claiming the gods are on their side.
5. How does the characterization in “Parodos (lines 115–248)” shape what we understand about the elders' fear? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** How the elders are drawn as pious, nervous and quick to judge (they hunt, shout, then shelter behind “the decrees of Heaven”), so their fear reads as communal panic rather than cruelty.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders enter like a search party (“Ha! Where is he? Look around!”, line 115) and call the unseen man “The wretch profane!” (line 132) before they have met him. At the end they admit pity yet hide behind piety: “as we reverence the decrees of Heaven / We cannot say aught other than we said” (lines 247–248). They are not villains; theirs is the fear of a community that believes it must protect itself from the gods.
6. In the passage that opens with “Ha!”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two words from lines 115–133 with their connotations, such as “all-presumptuous” (arrogance toward the gods), “profane” (unclean), “scan” (a hunt) or “hushed” (fearful reverence).
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The word “all-presumptuous” (line 117) accuses the stranger of arrogance toward the gods, not only of wandering into the wrong place. The word “profane” (line 132) goes further and marks him as unclean. Both words judge a man the elders have not yet seen, so the diction shows fear running ahead of knowledge.
7. What causes the main turn in “Parodos (lines 115–248)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The turn is the naming: pressed for his family, Oedipus says he is of Laius and Labdacus, and the elders reverse their promise. The effect is that Antigone must plead and the question of his staying is open again.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The turn is caused by the elders’ demand to know his family: “Say of what stock thou comest, what man’s son” (line 204). When he answers “The hapless Oedipus” (line 213), they cry “Begone!” (line 216). The promise of safety collapses, Antigone pleads, and the elders end by saying they “cannot say aught other than we said” (line 248). His fate is left for someone else to settle.
8. How does “Parodos (lines 115–248)” build on “Prologue (lines 1–114)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A cause-and-effect link: in the Prologue the stranger left to fetch the local men who would decide; the Parodos is that decision, or Oedipus’s withheld name becomes the question forced out here.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: In the Prologue the stranger went to “seek the burghers” (line 78), who “will soon decide / Whether thou art to rest or go thy way” (lines 79–80). The Parodos delivers that decision. The burghers enter searching (“I search and search in vain,” line 133) and, once they know his name, decide he must go. The Prologue’s open question becomes the Parodos’s verdict.
9. In “Parodos (lines 115–248)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the elders' fear, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the

previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A motive read beneath a claim: the elders claim divine justice, but their next line shows fear for their land; Oedipus delays his name because he knows what it will do.

Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders say they are acting justly, as if expelling him only repaid a wrong: "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites" (lines 222–223). The lines that follow show the real motive, fear for their own land (line 227). Oedipus, for his part, holds back his name ("Forbear, nor urge me further to reveal," line 199) because he knows what hearing it will do to them.

10. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in a line where the elders judge by rumour, such as the rumour they hunt or the instant "Begone!" after the name, with a sentence on what changed the student's mind.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: At first I said judging by reputation is unfair but sometimes necessary. The Parodos shows how rumour outruns evidence. The elders hunt a man because "But now some godless man, / 'Tis rumoured, here abides" (lines 128–129), and they expel Oedipus the moment he says his name, before he has done anything in their sight. Antigone's line "Knowing the deeds he wrought, not innocent, / But with no ill intent" (lines 230–231) changed my mind: judging by the name skips the question of intent.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Are the elders right to fear Oedipus? Defend your view with evidence from this section. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A position on whether the fear is justified by what is on stage (a trespass on holy ground, a name they believe polluted) against what is not (no new wrong; the plea about intent), with a counter-line.

    Answer guidance: One defensible answer: partly. They are right to guard the grove, since he sat "Within this hallowed spot" (line 149), and in their belief the goddesses punish trespass. They are wrong to fear the man himself, who tells them, "Whate'er I utter, have no fear of me" (line 215), and has harmed no one in their sight. Counter-line: in their religion a polluted man could bring "a heavier curse" on the land (line 227) whatever his intent, so their fear makes sense on its own terms.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A stand with two lines: the reversal follows the name alone (lines 213–216). A careful qualification notes that what travels ahead of him is a belief about pollution, not only gossip.

    Answer guidance: One defensible answer: largely agree. The elders promised safety (line 165) and reversed it the moment they heard "The hapless Oedipus" (line 213), crying "Begone!" (line 216). Nothing he did changed; only the name did. A qualification: what goes ahead of him is not just a story but a belief about pollution, which they defend with "Heaven's justice" (line 222). They think they are obeying the gods, not repeating gossip.

3. Which character in "Parodos (lines 115–248)" acts most wisely in the matter of the elders' fear, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named standard, such as fairness (judging deeds and intent, not names), applied to two of Oedipus, Antigone and the elders, with a line for each.

    Answer guidance: One defensible answer: by the standard of fairness, Antigone acts most wisely. She

grants that her father's deeds were "not innocent" (line 230) but insists they were done "with no ill intent" (line 231), asking the elders to judge the man and not the name. By the same standard the elders act least wisely: they break their own word, "Against thy will no man shall drive thee hence" (line 165), as soon as fear outweighs it. A student who chooses piety as the standard could rank the elders higher, since they cite "the decrees of Heaven" (line 247).

4. You are directing "Parodos (lines 115–248)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the elders' fear. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two staging choices tied to lines, such as the chorus scattering to search, a silence before the name, or a collective recoil, each with its effect on how we see the elders' fear.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: (1) Bring the elders on in scattered clusters, peering into corners on "Every nook and corner scan!" (line 116), so their fear looks like a manhunt before we see the old blind man they are hunting. (2) Hold a long silence after "Know'st one of Laius'—" (line 209), then have the whole chorus step back together on "Ha! Who!" (line 210). The physical recoil lets the audience feel how a name alone pushes people away.

5. Write your own questions about "Parodos (lines 115–248)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Three questions, each answerable from lines 115–248: one recall, one why/how and one should/what-if, different in kind.

   Answer guidance: Model set. Recall: What do the elders order once Oedipus names himself? ("Begone!", line 216.) Why/how: Why does Antigone stress that the deeds were done "with no ill intent" (line 231)? (She separates guilt from the act.) Should/what if: Should the elders have kept the promise of line 165 once they knew his name? (Answers weigh a sworn word against a community's fear.)

6. Connect "Parodos (lines 115–248)", with its focus on the elders' fear, to law against force: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment about law against force, the theme the question names. So far the elders use commands and custom, not hands, and no one has tried force; a strong answer says what Sophocles must show next.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the link is present but weak so far. The elders speak for rule and custom, "Honour whatso'er the State / Honours, all she frowns on hate" (lines 177–178), and use words, not hands, even when they cry "Begone!". No one has yet tried to take anyone by force, so law has not been tested against force. To strengthen the link, Sophocles would need to show someone choosing force where law or a sworn word should govern, and show how the land answers.

7. Is the conflict in "Parodos (lines 115–248)" effective in presenting the elders' fear, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment of the confrontation against a stated criterion (does it build tension through rhythm and reversal, or is the shouting overdone?), with one line that meets it and one that might miss it.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: effective. The broken half-lines "Know'st one of Laius'— / Ha! Who! / Seed of Labdacus— / Oh Zeus!" (lines 209–212) build tension like a cross-examination, so the reversal feels forced out of the elders rather than announced. Counter-line: the repeated "Begone!" (lines 216 and 218) could feel heavy-handed to a modern reader unless it is played as panic rather than cruelty.

8. Compare how "Parodos (lines 115–248)" treats the elders' fear with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named comparison (a text, film or event where a community judges someone by reputation) and one thing the Parodos sees that the other misses, tied to a line.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: In The Crucible, Salem condemns people largely on rumour and fear. The Parodos sees something that play leaves in the background: the accusers are frightened, and they pity the people they expel. The elders say, "Surely we pity thee and him alike" (line 245), and still send them away. Sophocles shows how decent people can do an unfair thing for what they believe is a sacred reason.
9. Predict what "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A prediction from two clues in this scene, such as the elders' pity despite their ruling and their order to speak only "where 'tis right," checked after reading.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Clue 1: the elders admit, "Surely we pity thee and him alike" (line 245), though they will not change their ruling, so Oedipus may try to turn that pity into a reversal. Clue 2: they told him, "If aught thou would'st beseech, / Speak where 'tis right" (lines 157–158), so the next scene will probably be his defence in words. A sharper prediction asks whether someone with more authority than the elders will be asked to decide.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Parodos (lines 115–248)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the elders' fear? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An adaptation that keeps the core situation: a group turns on a newcomer the moment it learns his notorious name, after promising him safety. It names two details that must stay: the broken promise and a family member pleading about intent.
    Answer guidance: Model answer: Volunteers at a small-town shelter welcome an old blind man until someone recognises his name from a decades-old scandal; within minutes they tell him to leave "for everyone's safety." His daughter stands up and argues that he did terrible things without knowing what he was doing. Two things must stay: the promise of safety given before the name was known (line 165), and the plea that separates the deed from the intent (lines 230–231).

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who pleads for Oedipus?

   A. Antigone

   B. sister Ismene

   C. King Theseus

   D. Creon of Thebes

   Key: A (Antigone)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders do when they learn who Oedipus is?

   A. Crown him as their honoured guest today

   B. Order him to leave the land at once

   C. Ignore the name he has just given them

   D. Offer him a public civic welcome now

   Key: B (Order him to leave the land at once)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Oedipus's request: “Let me not suffer for my _____.”

   Key: confidence

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Oedipus's challenge: “How keep you then your _____?”

   Key: troth

5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why do the elders fear Oedipus?

   A. He is armed when they first find him there

   B. He is a spy sent into Attica this very day

   C. His name and story are known and feared

   D. He carries a visible plague-spot even now

   Key: C (His name and story are known and feared)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] When do the elders shout “Begone”?

   A. When Antigone first takes him by the hand

   B. When he asks to sit down on the rock

   C. When he prays aloud to great Poseidon

   D. When he names himself the hapless Oedipus

   Key: D (When he names himself the hapless Oedipus)

7. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Chorus break its promise of safety once Oedipus has named himself?

   Sample answer: Fear of the name, not a new crime in the grove, is what overturns the promise. While he was still an unknown wanderer they had said, “Against thy will no man shall drive thee hence” (line 165). After he names himself “The hapless Oedipus” (line 213), they cry “Begone!” (line 216) and “Forth from our borders speed ye both!” (line 220). The reversal answers a reputation that has travelled ahead of the man, not a deed they have just watched him commit.

8. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What is Antigone's argument in lines 243–244?

   A. No one escapes ruin if a god drives him

   B. Oedipus is innocent of every charge they name

   C. The elders are being cruel for its own sake

   D. Athens must take its orders from Thebes now

   Key: A (No one escapes ruin if a god drives him)

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Antigone try to change the elders' judgment of her father's past deeds? Use one quotation from her plea.

   Sample answer: She does not claim that he is blameless; she asks them to distinguish guilt from intent. “Knowing the deeds he wrought, not innocent, / But with no ill intent” (lines 230–231), she reminds them that they already knew something of what he had done, and that the harm was not chosen as a free crime. The plea tries to separate the man before them from the story that has travelled ahead of him, and to win pity for a daughter who “pleads for him alone” (line 233).

10. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Trace how this section moves from a promised safety to an order of expulsion. Use one early quotation and one later one.

    Sample answer: The elders first bind themselves: “Against thy will no man shall drive thee hence” (line 165), a promise given before they know his name. After the naming they unsay it in action, crying “Arise, begone and take thee hence straightway, / Lest on our land a heavier curse thou lay” (lines 226–227). The parodos therefore turns a guarantee of safety into a command to leave, and the turn comes from who he is, not from a new trespass they have just discovered.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What promise do the elders give before they know who Oedipus is?

    A. No man shall drive him hence against his will

    B. He may rule as king of this local deme

    C. They will hide him from all Theban searchers

    D. They will restore his sight before the day ends

    Key: A (No man shall drive him hence against his will)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What name do the elders give the still-unseen trespasser during the hunt?

    A. A crowned guest of the city

    B. A godless man

    C. A priest of the grove already

    D. A herald sent from Theseus

    Key: B (A godless man)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the elders' direction: “And sit thee crouching on the _____ edge.”

    Key: scarped

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's cry: “Woe on my fate _____!”

    Key: unblest

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] When does Oedipus say he has no country?

    A. When they offer him a civic crown

    B. When they bring him a bowl of water

    C. When they ask his birth and home

    D. When they first call him a wayfarer

    Key: C (When they ask his birth and home)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone mainly ask the elders to grant?

    A. That Oedipus be crowned at once in the sacred grove

    B. That she be sent home at once without her father

    C. That the sacred grove itself be cut down today

    D. That father and daughter not be forced to leave

    Key: D (That father and daughter not be forced to leave)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Antigone, rather than Oedipus, make the longest plea after the elders turn on him?

    Sample answer: She can still see, she is not the infamous name they fear, and she can appeal to them as a daughter. “My

eyes, not reft of sight, / Plead with you as a daughter's might" (lines 234–235). The plea uses a visible, living bond that his name cannot offer, and it asks them to hear a child who still has sight when they will no longer hear the man they have just driven off with a word. She, not he, can still stand before them as someone other than "The hapless Oedipus".

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What do the elders say about requiting ill with ill?

    A. Heaven's justice does not punish it

    B. It offends the grove's own goddesses

    C. Only kings may repay a personal wrong

    D. It brings a sudden plague on the land

    Key: A (Heaven's justice does not punish it)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How do the elders use the lines about requiting ill with ill to defend their change of course? Quote the lines.

    Sample answer: They treat his name as a wrong they may justly repay, and so as no breach of their word. After he asks, "How keep you then your troth?" (line 221), they answer, "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites" (lines 222–223). The couplet recasts expulsion as righteous repayment rather than broken faith. They then press the command: "Arise, begone and take thee hence straightway" (line 226), as if justice, not fear alone, required him to leave.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the chorus's entrance prepare the confrontation that follows? Use one quotation from the opening search and one from later in the section.

    Sample answer: The parodos begins as a hunt, not a hymn: "Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan!" (lines 115–116). They are already calling the unseen man "godless" and "The wretch profane" (lines 128, 132) before they have heard his name. That searcher's fear makes the later cry "Begone!" (line 216) feel like the end of a chase already begun, not a sudden change of subject. The section is a confrontation from its first lines.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What do the elders still say after they pity father and daughter?

    A. They cannot take back what they have already said

    B. They will arm the whole city to drive him out

    C. They now believe he is wholly innocent after all

    D. They will make him a citizen of the deme at once

    Key: A (They cannot take back what they have already said)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's warning: "Dread my _____."

    Key: lineage

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the description of the offerings: "Bowls of spring water mingled with sweet _____."

    Key: mead

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Immediately after Oedipus says "The hapless Oedipus," what do the elders do?

    A. They offer him a seat of honour in the grove at once

    B. They cry out and order father and daughter away

    C. They send a runner to fetch the local king now

    D. They ask him to lead them in a public prayer

    Key: B (They cry out and order father and daughter away)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is Oedipus trying to do when he answers their questions about birth and home by saying he has no country?

    A. He is claiming Athens as his new and legal homeland now

    B. He is denying that he ever had any parents at all

    C. He is withholding the name that he already dreads to speak

    D. He is asking them to invent a birth-story on the spot

    Key: C (He is withholding the name that he already dreads to speak)

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Before they know his name, the elders warn, "Yet add not curse to curse and wrong to wrong." What are they asking of him, and what irony does the warning take on later in the section?

    Sample answer: At that point they still see only a tired trespasser on holy ground, and they warn him not to compound a long, hard pilgrimage by profaning the grove: "Yet add not curse to curse and wrong to wrong" (line 147). The warning is about staying where he must not stay, not yet about who he is. After he is named, they themselves add a new sentence to his exile, crying that he must leave "Lest on our land a heavier curse thou lay" (line 227). The later fear echoes their own earlier language of curse, now turned against a name rather than a foot set on hallowed ground.

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does it show that the elders can say they pity Antigone and her father and still refuse to unsay their decree?

    A. They have decided the pair are lying about all of their distress

    B. They now think the grove itself has already been wholly destroyed

    C. They are waiting only for the local king to dismiss the pair

    D. Pity does not, in this scene, outweigh their fear of Heaven's decree

    Key: D (Pity does not, in this scene, outweigh their fear of Heaven's decree)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse the wording of "My eyes, not reft of sight, / Plead with you as a daughter's might". What does Antigone claim, and how does the diction work?

    Sample answer: The lines claim that visible, living kinship can reach the elders when the father's name cannot. "My eyes, not reft of sight" (line 234) sets her looking against his blindness, as if the plea needed a body that can still be seen. "Plead with you as a daughter's might" (line 235) makes the appeal a daughter's right, not a legal argument about guilt. The diction asks them to answer a face and a bond in front of them, rather than the story they already fear.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Are the elders right to fear Oedipus in this section? Defend your view with evidence from the parodos.

    Sample answer: Their fear is understandable, but the scene shows the way it acts as unjust. They do not discover a new crime in the grove; they hear a name they already dread and revoke a promise just given. "Against thy will no man shall drive thee hence" (line 165) becomes "Forth from our borders speed ye both!" (line 220). Antigone's claim that no one "'scapes perdition if a god impel" (line 244) does not make their caution foolish, but it does show that turning him out now is a judgment of reputation rather than of what he has done before their eyes. A fair defence of the elders must admit that they pity the maiden and still will not unsay the decree.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does this section show that a name alone can condemn a person? Use one quotation from the questioning and one from what follows the naming.

    Sample answer: The elders press him for stock and father: "Say of what stock thou comest, what man's son" (line 204). He delays, saying "Dread my lineage" (line 201) and "now we are undone" (line 205), which already treats the name as a doom. When he at last says "The hapless Oedipus" (line 213), they do not ask what he has done in the grove; they cry "Begone!" (line 216). The story has travelled ahead of him, and the name is enough.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's condition: “O Sirs, if I come forth at your _____,”

    Key: command

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Antigone's plea: “Who ’scapes perdition if a god _____!”

    Key: impel

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Oedipus mean by “Ears to the blind, they say, are eyes”?

    A. He locates the approaching men by hearing, not by sight

    B. He claims that the elders have already lost their vision

    C. He is asking Antigone to stop speaking for him now

    D. He wants the chorus to close their ears to his name

    Key: A (He locates the approaching men by hearing, not by sight)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus first tell the elders, “Oh sirs, I am no outlaw under ban”, before they know who he is?

    Sample answer: He hears their dread and tries to separate himself from the crime they already imagine. They have been hunting “some godless man” and “The wretch profane” (lines 128, 132), and they cry, “O dread to see and dread to hear!” (line 136). His answer, “Oh sirs, I am no outlaw under ban” (line 137), is a bid to be heard as a tired, sightless wanderer rather than as a man already sentenced. The line shows how quickly rumour has filled the space before any name is spoken.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] The chorus enters with “Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan!” What kind of entrance is this?

    A. A formal hymn in praise of all the local gods

    B. A search for a trespasser, not a hymn of welcome

    C. A legal hearing already opened by the local king

    D. A victory-song for a battle just now completed

    Key: B (A search for a trespasser, not a hymn of welcome)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] After saying they pity father and daughter, the elders add, “We cannot say aught other than we said.” What does that close show?

    A. They have forgotten what they promised him earlier on

    B. They now intend to crown him as a local patron saint

    C. They will not unsay the decree, even while they admit pity

    D. They are asking Antigone to speak the whole decree for them

    Key: C (They will not unsay the decree, even while they admit pity)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the dialogue of the naming itself (Laius, Labdacus, Oedipus) tighten the scene? Use the exchange in your answer.

    Sample answer: The name is forced out in fragments, and the chorus's interjections do the work of recognition before the last word lands. Oedipus begins, “Know’st one of Laius’—” (line 209), and they break in “Ha! Who!” (line 210); “Seed of Labdacus” (line 211) draws “Oh Zeus!” (line 212); only then does he say “The hapless Oedipus” (line 213). Each piece of the lineage is already enough to terrify them. The shattered exchange makes the identity feel inevitable, and it leaves almost no space between recognition and “Begone!”

38. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which statement best captures how this parodos defines the conflict?

    A. The elders welcome the stranger as soon as they first learn his name

    B. Antigone turns against her father and openly takes the elders' side

    C. The scene is mainly a debate about who should hold the Theban throne

    D. A name already feared outweighs a promise the elders have just given

    Key: D (A name already feared outweighs a promise the elders have just given)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does the parodos present the elders' reversal as a necessary precaution, an injustice, or both? Defend your view with evidence from this section.

    Sample answer: The scene lets both readings stand, and it does not flinch from either. The elders have been trained to keep the grove inviolate, and after the name they fear "a heavier curse" on the land (line 227). At the same time they themselves had promised, "Against thy will no man shall drive thee hence" (line 165), and they admit pity even as they refuse to unsay the command: "Surely we pity thee and him alike", yet "We cannot say aught other than we said" (lines 245, 248). The injustice lies less in the fear than in using a name, rather than a deed done before them, to revoke a troth already given.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Across the parodos, how does Sophocles move from an unseen trespasser to a named man the city wants gone? Use one quotation from the search and one from after he is named.

    Sample answer: The opening treats him as a rumour and a hunt: "But now some godless man, / 'Tis rumoured, here abides" (lines 128–129), and they "search and search in vain" (line 133). By the end the same men are no longer searching; they know the name and want the land cleared of it, crying "Forth from our borders speed ye both!" (line 220). The movement of the section is from an unseen, unspecific pollution to a famous identity that, once spoken, is treated as already proved.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Parodos (lines 115–248) develops the idea of the elders' fear. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Parodos (lines 115–248)" could deliver about the elders' fear. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the elders' fear in "Parodos (lines 115–248)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and

explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to guilt and intent and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Parodos (lines 115–248) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the elders' fear. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Parodos (lines 115–248)" could deliver about the elders' fear. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the elders' fear in "Parodos (lines 115–248)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to guilt and intent and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Parodos (lines 115–248) suggests about the elders' fear. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Parodos (lines 115–248)" could deliver about the elders' fear. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the elders' fear in "Parodos (lines 115–248)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to guilt and intent and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses conflict in Parodos (lines 115–248) to complicate the reader's understanding of the elders' fear. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Parodos (lines 115–248)" could deliver about the elders' fear. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the elders' fear in "Parodos (lines 115–248)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to guilt and intent and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *A wayfarer, I ween, A wayfarer, no countryman of ours, That old man must have been; Never had native dared to tempt the Powers, Or enter their demesne, The Maids in awe of whom each mortal cowers, Whose name no voice betrays nor cry, And as we pass them with averted eye, We move hushed lips in reverent piety.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "demesne" most nearly mean?

   A. a public highway open to every traveller

   B. the domain or sacred precinct of the Powers

   C. a written treaty between neighbouring cities

   D. a drinking-cup used at a private feast

2. *Ha! Where is he? Look around! Every nook and corner scan! He the all-presumptuous man, Whither vanished? search the ground! A wayfarer, I ween, A wayfarer, no countryman of ours, That old man must have been; Never had native dared to tempt the Powers, Or enter their demesne, The Maids in awe of whom each mortal cowers, Whose name no voice betrays nor cry, And as we pass them with averted eye, We move hushed lips in reverent piety. But now some godless man, 'Tis rumoured, here abides; The precincts through I scan, Yet wot not where he hides, The wretch profane! I search and search in vain.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Parodos (lines 115–248)"?

   A. The elders' fear

   B. A formal welcome that settles him as a townsman at once

   C. A celebration of the grove as a public garden

   D. A messenger's account of a battle already won

SAT key: 1. B (the domain or sacred precinct of the Powers); 2. A (The elders' fear)

Lesson 4: Episode 1 (lines 249–694)

Focus: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide or self-harm (reported)): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: "What does the play show about the cost of this loss?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

Background: Greeks believed a hero's grave could protect a city. Jebb notes that in this play Oedipus insists on his moral innocence (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 3).

Significance: The outcast becomes a treasure once Athens receives him, reversing the expulsion from Thebes.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
When has your own experience helped you understand someone else? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: When has your own experience helped you understand someone else?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Ismene's news makes the outcast a prize, and Theseus, remembering his own exile, answers with a welcome that reverses the expulsion from Thebes.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)

8 key words in context.

Today's words: hospitality — welcome and care given to guests and strangers; succour — help in time of need; suppliant — a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar; scutcheon — a shield bearing a coat of arms; figuratively, a state's honor; unwitting — not knowing or intending; unaware; harbourage — shelter or lodging; a place of refuge; atonement — an act of making amends, especially to restore a right relationship with the gods; libation — a drink offering poured out in honor of a god.

Words: hospitality: welcome and care given to guests and strangers · succour: help in time of need · suppliant: a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar · scutcheon: a shield bearing a coat of arms; figuratively, a state's honor · unwitting: not knowing or intending; unaware · harbourage: shelter or lodging; a place of refuge · atonement: an act of making amends, especially to restore a right relationship with the gods · libation: a drink offering poured out in honor of a god

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).

Greeks believed a hero's grave could protect a city. Jebb notes that in this play Oedipus insists on his moral innocence (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 3). The outcast becomes a treasure once Athens receives him, reversing the expulsion from Thebes. Characterization: Oedipus defends himself as a man who struck in self-defence and without knowledge, and he answers the elders' questions about the killing and the incest. Theseus, remembering that he too was an exile, grants him protection. Theme: The outcast becomes a treasure: an oracle says that whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, and Oedipus himself says that when he ceases to be, his worth begins. Conflict: Ismene reports that the sons are fighting over Thebes and that Creon is coming for Oedipus because of the grave. Oedipus curses his sons, and the threat from Thebes is set against Theseus' grant of refuge. Watch for the sacred grove and the hidden grave: The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" slowly and put it in my own words: Oedipus asks whether he is a villain just because, when he was struck, he struck back in self-defense. Next, craft. I notice the sentence is already a defence: "Stricken, I struck the striker," three blows in one line, with the first blow not his. The strongest word is "Stricken": "Stricken" comes first, so the listener hears the blow he received before the blow he gave. Then, effect. What do lines 261–263 reveal about Oedipus's defence of himself? My answer: This is Oedipus's defence of himself: he presents himself as a man who answered force, not as someone born wicked, and the line is his claim to be heard as something other than a villain.

> *Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again (Episode 1, lines 261–263)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" slowly and put it in my own words: Oedipus asks whether he is a villain just because, when he was struck, he struck back in self-defense. Next, craft. I notice the sentence is already a defence: "Stricken, I struck the striker," three blows in one line, with the first blow not his. The strongest word is "Stricken": "Stricken" comes first, so the listener hears the blow he received before the blow he gave. Then, effect. What do lines 261–263 reveal about Oedipus's defence of himself? My answer: This is Oedipus's defence of himself: he presents himself as a man who answered force, not as someone born wicked, and the line is his claim to be heard as something other than a villain.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Cease", "worth" and "begins" stand out. "When I cease to be" names death as a stopping, and "my worth begins" turns that stopping into a start: "worth" is value to the city that will keep his grave, not comfort for himself. He recasts his death as the beginning of his civic gift (Oedipus, line 393). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected student answer: He offers Athens a gift in return for refuge: his death and grave will begin his worth to the city that takes him in, turning hospitality into a civic blessing.

> *So, when I cease to be, my worth begins (Episode 1, line 393)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Cease", "worth" and "begins" stand out. "When I cease to be" names death as a stopping, and "my worth begins" turns that stopping into a start: "worth" is value to the city that will keep his grave, not comfort for himself. He recasts his death as the beginning of his civic gift (Oedipus, line 393).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected student answer: He offers Athens a gift in return for refuge: his death and grave will begin his worth to the city that takes him in, turning hospitality into a civic blessing.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 249–694) develops the idea of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. When the text says "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1, lines 261–263), it shows this directly. Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 249–694) develops the idea of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Access supports: Access supports (not a legal-compliance promise). These are teaching options for English learners and for students with IEP or 504 needs; they do not replace a student's plan, and using them does not by itself satisfy any legal requirement. Chunked reading: Ismene's news first (through the oracle about the grave), then Theseus's welcome, with a gist check after each. Sentence frames: When Oedipus says "when I cease to be, my worth begins" (line 393), he means ___. / Theseus welcomes him because ___, which I can quote at line ___. Graphic organizer: a two-row chart (Ismene / Theseus) with news or action, a quotation, and what it changes about the beggar's standing. Time: extended time on the long episode's quiz and writing start. Audio: hear Ismene's speech and Theseus's welcome separately while following the text.

Exemplar: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. When the text says "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1, lines 261–263), it shows this directly. Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: When has your own experience helped you understand someone else? Ask: When has your own experience helped you understand someone else?

Anchor question: When has your own experience helped you understand someone else?

Facilitation: Ask: When has your own experience helped you understand someone else?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. ("Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again", Episode 1, lines 261–263). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. ("Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again", Episode 1, lines 261–263). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Key takeaway: Ismene's news makes the outcast a prize, and Theseus, remembering his own exile, answers with a welcome that reverses the expulsion from Thebes.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Oedipus defends himself as a man who struck in self-defence and without knowledge, and he answers the elders' questions about the killing and the incest. Theseus, remembering that he too was an exile, grants him protection.
- **Theme:** The outcast becomes a treasure: an oracle says that whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, and Oedipus himself says that when he ceases to be, his worth begins.
- **Conflict:** Ismene reports that the sons are fighting over Thebes and that Creon is coming for Oedipus because of the grave. Oedipus curses his sons, and the threat from Thebes is set against Theseus' grant of refuge.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1, lines 261–263) Oedipus denies that striking in self-defence, without knowledge, makes him a villain by birth.
- "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins" (Episode 1, line 393) He recasts his death as the start of his value to the city that will keep his grave.
- "The gods, who once abased, uplift thee now" (Episode 1, line 394) Ismene says the same gods who brought him low are now ready to raise him.
- "I too was reared, / Like thee, in exile, and in foreign lands / Wrestled with many perils, no man more" (Episode 1, lines 583–585) Theseus grants welcome because he too has known exile and danger in a foreign land.
- "Earth's might decays, the might of men decays, / Honour grows cold, dishonour flourishes, / There is no constancy 'twixt friend and friend, / Or city and city; be it soon or late, / Sweet turns to bitter, hate once more to love" (Episode 1, lines 632–636) Oedipus warns that power, honour, and friendship all decay, so today's ally may not stay one.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes.
Evidence: "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1, lines 261–263)
Reasoning: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 249–261

249 **Oedipus:** O what avails renown or fair repute?
250 **Oedipus:** Are they not vanity? For, look you, now
251 **Oedipus:** Athens is held of States the most devout,
252 **Oedipus:** Athens alone gives hospitality
253 **Oedipus:** And shelters the vexed stranger, so men say.
254 **Oedipus:** Have I so found it? I whom ye dislodged
255 **Oedipus:** First from my seat of rock and now would drive
256 **Oedipus:** Forth from your land, dreading my name alone;
257 **Oedipus:** For me you surely dread not, nor my deeds,
258 **Oedipus:** Deeds of a man more sinned against than sinning
259 **Oedipus:** As I might well convince you, were it meet
260 **Oedipus:** To tell my mother's story and my sire's,
261 **Oedipus:** The cause of this your fear. Yet am I then

Lines 249–268

249 **Oedipus:** O what avails renown or fair repute?
250 **Oedipus:** Are they not vanity? For, look you, now
251 **Oedipus:** Athens is held of States the most devout,
252 **Oedipus:** Athens alone gives hospitality
253 **Oedipus:** And shelters the vexed stranger, so men say.
254 **Oedipus:** Have I so found it? I whom ye dislodged
255 **Oedipus:** First from my seat of rock and now would drive
256 **Oedipus:** Forth from your land, dreading my name alone;
257 **Oedipus:** For me you surely dread not, nor my deeds,
258 **Oedipus:** Deeds of a man more sinned against than sinning
259 **Oedipus:** As I might well convince you, were it meet
260 **Oedipus:** To tell my mother's story and my sire's,
261 **Oedipus:** The cause of this your fear. Yet am I then
262 **Oedipus:** A villain born because in self-defence,
263 **Oedipus:** Stricken, I struck the striker back again?
264 **Oedipus:** E'en had I known, no villainy 'twould prove:
265 **Oedipus:** But all unwitting whither I went, I went—
266 **Oedipus:** To ruin; my destroyers knew it well,
267 **Oedipus:** Wherefore, I pray you, sirs, in Heaven's name,
268 **Oedipus:** Even as ye bade me quit my seat, defend me.

Line 258

258 **Oedipus:** Deeds of a man more sinned against than sinning

Lines 261–263

261 **Oedipus:** The cause of this your fear. Yet am I then
262 **Oedipus:** A villain born because in self-defence,
263 **Oedipus:** Stricken, I struck the striker back again?

Line 371

371 **Ismene:** Have stirred betwixt them a mad rivalry

Line 393

393 **Oedipus:** So, when I cease to be, my worth begins.

Line 394

394 **Ismene:** The gods, who once abased, uplift thee now.

Line 410

410 **Oedipus:** Then never shall they be my masters, never!

Line 413

413 **Ismene:** Thy angry wraith, when at thy tomb they stand.

Lines 468–485

468 **Chorus:** Make a libation first of water fetched
469 **Chorus:** With undefilèd hands from living spring.
470 **Oedipus:** And after I have gotten this pure draught?
471 **Chorus:** Bowls thou wilt find, the carver's handiwork;
472 **Chorus:** Crown thou the rims and both the handles crown—
473 **Oedipus:** With olive shoots or flocks of wool, or how?
474 **Chorus:** With wool from fleece of yearling freshly shorn.
475 **Oedipus:** What next? how must I end the ritual?
476 **Chorus:** Pour thy libation, turning to the dawn.
477 **Oedipus:** Pouring it from the urns whereof ye spake?
478 **Chorus:** Yea, in three streams; and be the last bowl drained
479 **Chorus:** To the last drop.
480 **Oedipus:** And wherewith shall I fill it,
481 **Oedipus:** Ere in its place I set it? This too tell.
482 **Chorus:** With water and with honey; add no wine.
483 **Oedipus:** And when the embowered earth hath drunk thereof?
484 **Chorus:** Then lay upon it thrice nine olive sprays
485 **Chorus:** With both thy hands, and offer up this prayer.

Line 482

482 **Chorus:** With water and with honey; add no wine.

Line 510

510 **Ismene:** Toil, if there be toil, is of no account. Exit Ismene.

Lines 531–532

531 **Oedipus:** An all unwitting bridegroom bound
532 **Oedipus:** An impious marriage chain;

Lines 566–567

566 **Oedipus:** I slew who else would me have slain;
567 **Oedipus:** I slew without intent,

Line 572

572 **Theseus:** Oft had I heard of thee in times gone by—

Lines 583–584

583 **Theseus:** Whereat I should recoil. I too was reared,
584 **Theseus:** Like thee, in exile, and in foreign lands

Lines 583–585

583 **Theseus:** Whereat I should recoil. I too was reared,
584 **Theseus:** Like thee, in exile, and in foreign lands
585 **Theseus:** Wrestled with many perils, no man more.

Lines 632–633

632 **Oedipus:** Earth's might decays, the might of men decays,
633 **Oedipus:** Honour grows cold, dishonour flourishes,

Lines 632–636

632 **Oedipus:** Earth's might decays, the might of men decays,
633 **Oedipus:** Honour grows cold, dishonour flourishes,
634 **Oedipus:** There is no constancy 'twixt friend and friend,
635 **Oedipus:** Or city and city; be it soon or late,
636 **Oedipus:** Sweet turns to bitter, hate once more to love.

Line 661

661 **Theseus:** But grant him the full rights of citizen;

Line 665

665 **Theseus:** Which of the two thou wilt. Thy choice is mine.

Line 670

670 **Oedipus:** Here shall I vanquish those who cast me forth.

Line 675

675 **Theseus:** An oath would be no surer than my word.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
hospitality (noun)	welcome and care given to guests and strangers	*For, look you, now Athens is held of States the most devout, Athens alone gives hospitality And shelters the vexed stranger, so men say.*
succour (noun)	help in time of need	*Wherefore no alien in adversity Shall seek in vain my succour, nor shalt thou; I know myself a mortal, and my share In what the morrow brings no more than thine.*
suppliant (noun)	a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar	*I came to you a suppliant, and you pledged Your honour; O preserve me to the end, O let not this marred visage do me wrong!*
scutcheon (noun)	a shield bearing a coat of arms; figuratively, a state's honor	*Stand then on Heaven's side and never blot / Athens' fair scutcheon by abetting wrong.*
unwitting (adjective)	not knowing or intending; unaware	*But all unwitting whither I went, I went— / To ruin; my destroyers knew it well,*
harbourage (noun)	shelter or lodging; a place of refuge	*Food and safe harbourage and filial care; / While their two brethren sacrificed their sire*
atonement (noun)	an act of making amends, especially to restore a right relationship with the gods	*First make atonement to the deities, / Whose grove by trespass thou didst first profane.*

libation (noun)	a drink offering poured out in honor of a god	*After what manner, stranger? Teach me, pray. / Make a libation first of water fetched*

Discussion questions

1. When has your own experience helped you understand someone else?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with curse and mercy?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Ismene say in line 394? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The gods who once brought him low now raise him up.
   Answer guidance: The gods who once brought him low now raise him up.
2. What does Antigone first say Ismene is riding, when she recognises her sister? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A colt of Aetna's breed
   Answer guidance: A colt of Aetna's breed.
3. What bowls does the chorus say Oedipus will find ready for the rite? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Bowls, the carver's handiwork
   Answer guidance: Bowls, the carver's handiwork.
4. How many olive sprays does the chorus tell him to lay upon the offering? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Thrice nine olive sprays
   Answer guidance: Thrice nine olive sprays.
5. What does Theseus say idle boasts of foemen often are? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Blusterers, vented in anger
   Answer guidance: Blusterers, vented in anger.
6. What does Oedipus say is enough, if Theseus will keep it? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** His plighted troth
   Answer guidance: His plighted troth.
7. What does Ismene say she came to learn, besides how her father fared? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** His lodging-place
   Answer guidance: His lodging-place.
8. On whom does Ismene say the brothers' sovereignty is now said to depend? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** On Oedipus
   Answer guidance: On Oedipus.

9. What does Ismene name as the source of the report about that sovereignty? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The envoys who returned to Thebes
   Answer guidance: The envoys who returned to Thebes.
10. What does Oedipus say the Theban feud should never do, once he has heard Ismene's news? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Be quenched by the gods
    Answer guidance: Be quenched by the gods.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins" mean? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** His value to a city will begin with his death: Ismene's report that his country will want him "alive or dead" turns the outcast into something worth possessing.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Oedipus is answering Ismene's report that his country "shall yearn in time / To have thee for their weal alive or dead" (lines 389–390). His dry reply, "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins" (line 393), means that the man everyone rejected while he lived becomes valuable at the moment of death, because whoever holds his body holds its power. The line is bitter as well as hopeful.
2. What does "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" suggest about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An inference that joins the two halves of the scene: Thebes wants Oedipus as a possession to control, while Theseus receives him as a person with rights, so possession is set against hospitality.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Thebes wants him only as an asset. Ismene says they mean "To plant thee near the Theban land, and so / Keep thee within their grasp" (lines 399–400). Theseus offers the opposite and will "grant him the full rights of citizen" (line 661). The scene suggests that the same man can be treated as property or as a guest with rights, and that this difference will decide where he ends his life.
3. Find one example of characterization in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)". What does it reveal about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A trait shown in action and what it reveals beyond a label, such as Theseus meeting the same reputation the elders feared with pity, or Oedipus praising his daughters' care while condemning his sons.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Theseus has heard the same story that frightened the elders ("Oft had I heard of thee in times gone by," line 572), but it moves him to pity, not fear: "So pitying thine estate" (line 578), he asks what Oedipus wants. The characterization shows that the difference between the elders and their king is not what they know about Oedipus but how they respond to it.
4. How does the theme in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" shape what we understand about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** How the theme of guilt and intent, argued in Oedipus's defence ("all unwitting," "without intent"), changes how we read the welcome: Theseus receives a man who has made a case that suffering and guilt differ.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The scene keeps returning to guilt and intent. Oedipus says "all unwitting whither I went, I went" (line 265) and "I slew without intent, / A wretch, but innocent / In the law's eye" (lines 567–569). Because this case is argued before Theseus enters, his welcome reads as more

than kindness: he receives a man who has argued that a terrible deed done without knowledge does not make him a villain.

5. In the passage that opens with "O what avails renown…", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two words from Oedipus's opening speech (lines 249–283) with their connotations, such as "renown," "vanity," "dislodged" or "scutcheon," showing how he turns Athens' reputation into an obligation.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The word "renown" (line 249) and the phrase "Athens' fair scutcheon" (line 275) both point to reputation: Athens is famous for sheltering strangers, and its coat of arms could be stained. By choosing honour words instead of pleas for pity, Oedipus makes driving him out a threat to the city's good name, which is harder for the elders to ignore.

6. What causes the main turn in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The turn is Ismene's news (the feud, the oracles, Creon coming), which changes Oedipus from a man asking to stay into a man with something to give and withhold. The effect: he refuses Thebes and offers himself to Athens.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The turn is Ismene's report that the oracles now make Oedipus valuable and that "Creon comes to thee—and comes anon" (line 397). It changes his stance. He refuses Thebes ("Then never shall they be my masters, never!", line 410) and offers himself to his hosts as "A great deliverer, for my foemen bane" (line 459). The likely effect is a struggle over him, with Thebes trying to reclaim what Athens now protects.

7. How does "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" build on "Parodos (lines 115–248)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A cause-and-effect link: the elders' refusal at the end of the Parodos leaves Oedipus to answer in words, and his defence persuades them to leave the decision to their king.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The Parodos ends with the elders refusing to change their ruling (lines 247–248). Episode 1 opens with his answer: "Have I so found it? I whom ye dislodged / First from my seat of rock and now would drive / Forth from your land" (lines 254–256). The argument works well enough that they agree to "leave the issue with the ruling powers" (line 286), which is why the king comes.

8. In "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A motive beneath a claim: Oedipus calls his request small (burial), but his aim is to choose where his power will rest and to defeat those who cast him out.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Oedipus says the benefit he brings comes only "When I am dead and thou hast buried me" (line 603), and Theseus calls the favour "small indeed" (line 607). His real motive shows a few lines later: "Here shall I vanquish those who cast me forth" (line 670). He wants his last resting place to be a judgment on Thebes and on his sons, not only a kindness to himself.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (When has your own experience helped you understand someone else?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A revised answer that uses Theseus's own exile as the example of experience creating understanding, and notes how it changes his response compared with the elders'.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: My first answer was about understanding a friend after the same loss. Episode 1 gives a sharper example. Theseus understands Oedipus because "I too was reared, / Like thee, in

exile" (lines 583–584), and so "no alien in adversity / Shall seek in vain my succour" (lines 586–587). The elders judged by the name; Theseus judges by shared experience, and that changes the outcome.

10. Where does conflict appear in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)", and how does it connect Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome to the larger concern with curse and mercy? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Conflict located in the scene (Oedipus against his absent sons, or Thebes against Athens over him) and tied to curse and mercy: the father curses sons who showed him none, while a stranger shows mercy.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: The sharpest conflict is between Oedipus and his absent sons. Because "one little word from them / Was all I needed, and they spoke no word" (lines 442–443), he prays, "may the gods ne'er quench their fatal feud" (line 423). That is the curse half; the mercy half comes from a stranger, as Theseus asks, "Who could reject / The proffered amity of such a friend?" (lines 654–655). The scene sets a father's curse on his kin against a stranger's mercy.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus innocent? Evaluate his argument in lines 261–263 against the play's other evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An evaluation of the self-defence argument (lines 261–263) against other evidence in the play, his "all unwitting" and "innocent / In the law's eye" and what still troubles it (he did kill; he calls his sufferings vile), with a position and a counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: One defensible answer: innocent of intent, not of the deed. His claim that he struck "in self-defence, / Stricken" (lines 262–263) is backed by "I slew who else would me have slain" (line 566) and by his acting "all unwitting" (line 265). Counter-line: he admits, "Yes, a murderer" (line 562), and that he "suffered ills most vile" (line 527). The play lets him be innocent in law and still marked by what he did.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The outcast becomes a treasure once Athens receives him, reversing the expulsion from Thebes. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A stand with two lines: support from "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins" and Theseus's grant of citizenship, with a qualification that the treasure is also a threat to his enemies.

    Answer guidance: One defensible answer: agree, with a qualification. Oedipus names the reversal himself, "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins" (line 393), and Theseus receives him with "the full rights of citizen" (line 661), the opposite of being cast out. But the treasure is not harmless: Oedipus says that if Thebes turns on Athens, his buried body will "drink their warm life-blood up" (line 643). He is a gift to his hosts and a threat to his enemies at once.

3. Which character in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" acts most wisely in the matter of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named standard applied to two characters, for example judging only on full knowledge: Theseus waits to hear everything, while Oedipus curses his sons on a report. Give a line for each.

    Answer guidance: One defensible answer: by the standard of judging only on full knowledge, Theseus acts most wisely: "Say on, I wait full knowledge ere I judge" (line 616). By the same standard Oedipus acts least wisely when he curses his sons, praying that "neither he who holds the scepter now / May keep his throne" (lines 426–427), on the strength of Ismene's report. A student could defend Oedipus by another standard, justice to a neglected father, since his sons "spoke no word" for him (line 443).

4. You are directing “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two staging choices tied to lines, such as Ismene’s entrance seen through Antigone’s uncertainty or Theseus physically closing the distance at his welcome, each with its effect.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: (1) Let Ismene be heard before she is seen. Antigone peers offstage, asking “She or a stranger? Do I wake or dream?” (line 308), so the audience shares the family’s suspense about whether this is help or danger. (2) When Theseus says “I too was reared, / Like thee, in exile” (lines 583–584), have him walk to the seated Oedipus and kneel to his level, the first character to come close instead of standing off. The welcome becomes physical, not only spoken.
5. Write your own questions about “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Three questions answerable from lines 249–694: one recall, one why/how and one should/what-if, different in kind.

   Answer guidance: Model set. Recall: What must be poured, and with what, to atone to the goddesses? (Water and honey, “add no wine,” line 482, from bowls crowned with wool, then olive sprays, lines 468–485.) Why/how: Why does Theseus pity Oedipus instead of fearing him? (He was himself an exile, lines 583–585.) Should/what if: Should Oedipus have refused the elders’ questions about his past? (Answers weigh his request, “as guest I claim / This grace” (lines 518–519), against the elders’ wish to know whom they shelter.)
6. Connect “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)”, with its focus on Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome, to law against force: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment about law against force, the question’s theme. Oedipus appeals to law and Theseus answers the threat from Thebes with a public pledge, but force is only threatened. A strong answer names what must come next.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the link is stronger than in the Parodos but still promised, not tested. Oedipus claims to stand “innocent / In the law’s eye” (lines 568–569), and Theseus answers the threat from Thebes with a pledge, “I know that none / Shall hale thee hence in my despite” (lines 685–686). No one has yet used force. To strengthen the link, Sophocles needs to show force actually tried against Athens’ word, and the land’s law answering it.
7. Is the characterization in “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)” effective in presenting Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment of the characterization against a criterion (complex or one-note?), for example Oedipus’s tenderness and bitterness in one scene, and whether Theseus is too ideal.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: effective, because Oedipus is shown with mixed qualities in one scene. He praises Antigone’s “tender ministry” (line 351) and soon after wishes his sons an unending “fatal feud” (line 423). Counter-line: Theseus may seem too ideal, generous at every turn (“Thy choice is mine,” line 665). A reviewer could call him heavy-handed, a model king rather than a person. A strong answer decides whether that idealism serves the play’s argument about hospitality.
8. Compare how “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)” treats Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses?

[DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named comparison (a story of a refugee or exile welcomed by a host) and one thing Episode 1 sees that the other misses, tied to a line.

Answer guidance: Model answer: News stories about refugees often treat the host's generosity as the whole story. Episode 1 adds a harder truth: the guest brings old family wars with him. Theseus welcomes Oedipus, but Oedipus warns that between friends and cities "Sweet turns to bitter, hate once more to love" (line 636). The play sees that hospitality may draw the host into the guest's conflicts, which the simpler story leaves out.

9. Predict what "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A prediction from two clues at the end of the episode, Theseus placing Oedipus in the elders' charge and calling the place god-chosen, about what the elders will now sing, checked after reading.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Clue 1: Theseus says, "I place him in your charge" (line 663), so the elders now have a duty to the man they tried to expel. Clue 2: he tells Oedipus, "Take heart, since Phoebus sent thee here" (line 693), presenting the place as chosen by a god. A reasonable prediction is that the elders will praise their land and why it is fit to receive him. After reading, students check whether the ode praises Colonus, Athens or Oedipus.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An adaptation that keeps the core: a rejected man learns he has become valuable to the people who rejected him, while a host offers him rights. It names two details that must stay.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: A disgraced scientist living abroad learns that his home government now wants him back, not to welcome him but to control his work, while a foreign mayor who was once a refugee offers him citizenship. Two things must stay: the home country's wish to keep him "within their grasp" (line 400) without letting him in, and the host's fellow-feeling born of his own exile (lines 583–584).

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What news does Ismene bring?

   A. The sons are fighting over Thebes and Creon is coming for Oedipus

   B. Thebes has already fallen to a foreign army from across the sea

   C. Theseus lies dead, and Athens is left without any king at all

   D. The sacred grove at Colonus has been burned down to the ground

   Key: A (The sons are fighting over Thebes and Creon is coming for Oedipus)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Theseus grant Oedipus?

   A. A throne in place of his old one

B. Protection in Athens

C. An army to march back on Thebes

D. A new name to hide his past life

Key: B (Protection in Athens)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Ismene's account of the brothers: “Have stirred betwixt them a mad _____”

Key: rivalry

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the chorus's instruction: “Make a _____ first of water fetched”

Key: libation

5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why do the Thebans now want Oedipus?

A. They want to punish him a second time in public court

B. They want to set him on the Theban throne again today

C. An oracle says whoever holds his grave will prosper

D. They need his money to pay a hired foreign army

Key: C (An oracle says whoever holds his grave will prosper)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Theseus understand Oedipus?

A. He is Oedipus's long-lost younger son

B. He is himself blind and led by a child

C. He was born and reared in Thebes himself

D. He too was raised in exile

Key: D (He too was raised in exile)

7. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does Oedipus mean by “So, when I cease to be, my worth begins”?

Sample answer: He means that his value to a city will begin at his death, in the keeping of his grave, not in the power or comfort of his remaining life. After Ismene has said that “their sovereignty depends” on him (line 392), he answers, “So, when I cease to be, my worth begins” (line 393). The line recasts the outcast as a future prize: what Thebes now wants is not the living beggar, but the power that will attach to his burial-place.

8. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Oedipus defend himself?

A. He acted in self-defence and without knowledge

B. He puts the whole blame for the past on Antigone alone

C. He denies that any killing ever took place at all

D. He says that Creon struck Laius on the public road

Key: A (He acted in self-defence and without knowledge)

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Ismene's closing word, “Toil, if there be toil, is of no account,” show about her part in the rites?

Sample answer: It shows that she treats the purification as a daughter's duty, not as a burden to be weighed. The chorus has told Oedipus to “make atonement to the deities” (line 465) whose grove he profaned, and he cannot fetch the water himself: “this frame is all too weak / To move without the help of guiding hand” (lines 502–503). Ismene goes in his place, tells Antigone to guard their father, and adds, “Toil, if there be toil, is of no account” (line 510). The line sets her labour beside the sons' earlier neglect: what might be toil is, for her, simply what a child owes.

10. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Trace how this episode moves from Oedipus's plea to the elders to Theseus's grant of protection. Use one early quotation and one later one.

    Sample answer: The episode opens with Oedipus still arguing for a hearing after the elders have tried to drive him out. He reminds them that "Athens alone gives hospitality / And shelters the vexed stranger, so men say" (lines 252–253), and he begs them, "Even as ye bade me quit my seat, defend me" (line 268). By the close, Theseus has taken the plea out of the chorus's hands and pledged the city's word: "Though I be distant, warrants thee from harm" (line 694). The movement is from a contested suppliant among frightened elders to a man under the king's protection.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who brings Oedipus the news from Thebes in this episode?

    A. Ismene
    B. Antigone
    C. Creon of Thebes
    D. King Theseus

    Key: A (Ismene)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does the chorus say Oedipus must speak the prayer of the rite?

    A. With a loud cry already heard in Thebes
    B. In whispered accents, not with lifted voice
    C. In a song already taught by Creon
    D. In silence, without any words at all

    Key: B (In whispered accents, not with lifted voice)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the oracle as Ismene reports it: "To have thee for their _____ alive or dead."

    Key: weal

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the chorus's first instruction: "First make _____ to the deities,"

    Key: atonement

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] According to Ismene, what did Oedipus's sons know and still set aside?

    A. That Theseus had already promised him a Theban throne that day
    B. That Antigone had refused to stay and help their father
    C. The oracle about him, outweighed by their greed of rule
    D. That the grove at Colonus had already been wholly destroyed

    Key: C (The oracle about him, outweighed by their greed of rule)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why, according to Ismene, will the Thebans not actually shroud Oedipus's bones in Theban dust?

    A. They have already built him a tomb in Argos
    B. Phoebus has forbidden any tomb for him at all
    C. Theseus has claimed the body as an Athenian prize
    D. Guilt of a kinsman's blood forbids that burial

    Key: D (Guilt of a kinsman's blood forbids that burial)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus refuse to be planted just outside Theban land, close at hand but not master of himself? Use Ismene's account of their intent.
    Sample answer: He sees the plan as a way to use him without restoring him. Ismene says Creon comes "To plant thee near the Theban land, and so / Keep thee within their grasp, yet not allow / Thy foot to pass beyond their boundaries" (lines 399–401). When he asks, "Mean they to shroud my bones in Theban dust?" (line 408), she answers that "guilt of kinsman's blood forbids" (line 409). He concludes, "Then never shall they be my masters, never!" (line 410). To sit just outside the border would give Thebes the benefit of his presence and deny him freedom, so he will not come.

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is the point of Theseus's claim, "I too was reared, / Like thee, in exile"?
    A. Shared exile is the ground on which he offers welcome
    B. He is proving that Oedipus was not a Theban by birth
    C. He wants Oedipus to return with him at once to Thebes
    D. He is warning that Athens also means to drive him out
    Key: A (Shared exile is the ground on which he offers welcome)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] When the elders press him about the past, what defence does Oedipus offer? Use "I slew who else would me have slain; / I slew without intent".
    Sample answer: He grants the deed and refuses the guilt of chosen murder. "I slew who else would me have slain; / I slew without intent" (lines 566–567), and he adds that he stands "A wretch, but innocent / In the law's eye" (lines 568–569). The defence has two parts: the other man would have killed him, and he did not know whom he faced. It matches his earlier claim that he struck "in self-defence" and "all unwitting" (lines 262, 265). He wants the elders to judge the act as forced and uninformed, not as malice.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Ismene's news recast the outcast as something a city might prize? Use one quotation about the oracle and one about what Oedipus offers Theseus.
    Sample answer: The news first makes his body a political stake: Ismene says of the latest oracles, "On thee, 'tis said, their sovereignty depends" (line 392). That is why Creon is coming, and why Oedipus can later offer Theseus "this woe-worn frame, / A gift not fair to look on; yet its worth / More precious far than any outward show" (lines 597–599). The same ruined body the elders feared becomes, through the oracle, a gift a king can be asked to keep.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who does the chorus announce as sovereign of Athens in this episode?
    A. Theseus, the son of Aegeus
    B. Creon, coming in haste from Thebes
    C. Polyneices, reported as still waiting in Argos
    D. A nameless guardian of the sacred close
    Key: A (Theseus, the son of Aegeus)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Ismene's line: "The gods, who once _____, uplift thee now."
    Key: abased

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Theseus's grant: "But grant him the full rights of _____,"
    Key: citizen

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Oedipus say Theseus will gain, and when will that gain appear?

    A. An immediate victory over Argos in the next battle

    B. The worth of his burial, once Theseus has buried him

    C. The Theban throne, transferred to Athens that day

    D. A cure for blindness, granted as soon as he is housed

    Key: B (The worth of his burial, once Theseus has buried him)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus pray that his sons' feud never be quenched?

    A. They tried to make him king of Colonus against his will

    B. They asked Ismene to keep the Theban throne in their name

    C. They did nothing to help him when he was banned and banished

    D. They refused to let Ismene leave Thebes in order to find him

    Key: C (They did nothing to help him when he was banned and banished)

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Oedipus mean when he tells Theseus that time can turn friendship between cities, and that his buried body will drink Theban life-blood? Quote the warning.

    Sample answer: He is explaining why Thebes's present need of him will not stay a friendly errand, and why Athens should keep him. Time, he argues, can undo a present peace and cut the "bonds of amity" (line 641) between cities that now seem friends. Then, he says, "my slumbering and buried corse / In its cold grave drink their warm life-blood up" (lines 642–643), if Zeus and Phoebus still speak true. The grave is offered as a future defence of Attica, not as a private rest only.

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] When the elders charge Oedipus with sin, he answers, "I sinnèd not." What does that reply claim?

    A. He denies that Laius ever died on the road at all that day

    B. He claims the chorus has no right to ask him any question

    C. He says Ismene, not he, should answer for the whole past

    D. He denies that the suffering came from acts done in malice

    Key: D (He denies that the suffering came from acts done in malice)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse the wording of "Earth's might decays, the might of men decays, / Honour grows cold, dishonour flourishes". What does the diction argue?

    Sample answer: The lines argue that no human power or bond stays fixed, so a present peace cannot be trusted as permanent. The doubled "decays" sets the earth and men under the same wasting, and "Honour grows cold, dishonour flourishes" (line 633) turns moral reputation into something that can reverse with time. The diction prepares the next claim: friendship and the bonds between cities will not stay constant either. It is not a general lament only; it is the reason Theseus should value a future grave that will still act when friendship has already turned.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is Oedipus innocent in the argument he offers in this episode? Evaluate his defence of the killing with evidence from more than one speech.

    Sample answer: He is arguing for a limited innocence: not that the deeds never happened, but that they were not chosen as crimes. Early he asks whether he is "A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (lines 262–263), and he adds that he went "all unwitting" (line 265). Later, under the elders' questions, he says he suffered ills "from acts in malice done" "none" (lines 527–528), and he answers the charge of sin with "I sinnèd not" (line 552). The

argument is consistent: knowledge and intent, not the bare deed, are what would make him a villain. A fair judgment can admit the horror of the facts and still see that, on the terms he has just set out before the elders, the play lets him stand as a man the law would not call guilty (lines 568–569).

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Theseus's welcome reverse the Theban rejection Ismene has just reported? Use one quotation from her news about the sons and one from Theseus's grant.
    Sample answer: Ismene's news is that the sons knew what was at stake and still chose power: "They knew it, yet the ignoble greed of rule / Outweighed all longing for their sire's return" (lines 420–421). Against that refusal, Theseus answers a stranger with a public bond: "Who could reject / The proffered amity of such a friend?" (lines 654–655). The episode therefore sets a king who remembers exile against sons who would use their father's grave without taking him home as a free man.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's warning: "There is no _____ 'twixt friend and friend,"
    Key: constancy

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Ismene's prophecy: "Thy angry _____, when at thy tomb they stand."
    Key: wraith

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Theseus mean by "An oath would be no surer than my word"?
    A. He treats his spoken pledge as already binding, without a further oath
    B. He is refusing to protect Oedipus until a formal oath is sworn first
    C. He wants Oedipus to swear first before Athens will offer any help
    D. He believes oracles are already surer than any human spoken promise

    Key: A (He treats his spoken pledge as already binding, without a further oath)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus choose to remain at the grove rather than go with Theseus? Use "Here shall I vanquish those who cast me forth".
    Sample answer: He stays because the place itself is the ground of the promised turn, not because he doubts Theseus's care. When Theseus asks if he will come, Oedipus answers, "Yea, were it lawful—but 'tis rather here—" (line 668), and then, "Here shall I vanquish those who cast me forth" (line 670). The grove is where he says the benefit will be reaped, once he is dead and buried (line 603). To leave with the king might be kindness, but it would take him from the spot where, as he tells it, the Thebans who want him can be defeated.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the force of Oedipus's phrase "a man more sinned against than sinning"?
    A. It admits that his sins were greater than any wrong he had suffered
    B. It asks the elders to weigh what was done to him above what he did
    C. It claims that no person in Thebes ever committed any sin at all
    D. It tells the chorus that only Theseus may judge a fallen king

    Key: B (It asks the elders to weigh what was done to him above what he did)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Oedipus's speech about his children, how does he contrast the daughters with the sons?
    A. The daughters fled to Argos, while the sons remained behind to nurse him
    B. The sons brought food, but the daughters tried to seize the Theban throne

C. The daughters gave care and harbourage; the sons sacrificed him for power

D. Both pairs of children, in this speech, refused him any kind of help at all

Key: C (The daughters gave care and harbourage; the sons sacrificed him for power)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse the wording of "An all unwitting bridegroom bound / An impious marriage chain". What does the diction admit, and what does it refuse?

Sample answer: The lines admit the fact of the marriage and refuse the charge of chosen impiety. "Unwitting" (line 531) restates the lack of knowledge he has already claimed for the killing, and "bridegroom bound" makes him the one tied, not the one who designed the bond. "An impious marriage chain" (line 532) does not soften the horror of the union; it names it as impious while still placing the binding outside his will. He even calls it "That was my bane" (line 533). The diction lets the elders hear the worst name for the marriage without granting that he chose it.

38. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which statement best captures how this episode recasts Oedipus's position?

A. Theseus drives him out as soon as the Theban oracle is first heard

B. Oedipus recovers his sight and returns to rule in Thebes at once

C. The sons send peaceful gifts and ask him to bless all of their rule

D. The outcast becomes a treasure a city may want to keep and protect

Key: D (The outcast becomes a treasure a city may want to keep and protect)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Sophocles set Theseus's character against the Theban sons in this episode? Use one quotation from Theseus and one from Oedipus's charge against the brothers.

Sample answer: The sons, as Oedipus tells it, heard the oracle and still chose power: they "sacrificed their sire / For lust of power and sceptred sovereignty" (lines 448–449), and they "spoke no word" when "one little word from them / Was all I needed" (lines 442–443). Theseus, who has never owed him that kinship, answers a stranger out of known hardship: "no alien in adversity / Shall seek in vain my succour, nor shalt thou" (lines 586–587). The contrast is between blood that failed and a host who knows what exile is.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How do the closing pledges of Theseus complete the thought that Oedipus's worth will be realised in what is done with his body? Use one quotation from the offer and one from the grant.

Sample answer: Oedipus says the benefit of the body he offers will come "When I am dead and thou hast buried me" (line 603): the worth is postponed until the grave is in Theseus's keeping. Theseus answers not with curiosity about the mystery but with a present personal bond: "Fear not for me; I shall not play thee false" (line 673). The close therefore keeps the future grave in view while making the living man already a protected guest of Athens.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 249–694) develops the idea of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" could deliver about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 1 (lines 249–694) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" could deliver about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 1 (lines 249–694) suggests about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" could deliver about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses characterization in Episode 1 (lines 249–694) to complicate the reader's understanding of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" could deliver about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *O what avails renown or fair repute? Are they not vanity? For, look you, now Athens is held of States the most devout, Athens alone gives hospitality And shelters the vexed stranger, so men say. Have I so found it? I whom ye dislodged First from my seat of rock and now would drive Forth from your land, dreading my name alone; For me you surely dread not, nor my deeds, Deeds of a man more sinned against than sinning As I might well convince you, were it meet To tell my mother's story and my sire's, The cause of this your fear.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "hospitality" most nearly mean?

   A. a tax levied on every stranger at the gates

   B. a military alliance against Thebes

   C. welcome and shelter offered to a guest

   D. a private bargain to buy a seat of rock

2. *O what avails renown or fair repute? Are they not vanity? For, look you, now Athens is held of States the most devout, Athens alone gives hospitality And shelters the vexed stranger, so men say. Have I so found it? I whom ye dislodged First from my seat of rock and now would drive Forth from your land, dreading my name alone; For me you surely dread not, nor my deeds, Deeds of a man more sinned against than sinning As I might well convince you, were it meet To tell my mother's story and my sire's, The cause of this your fear. Yet am I then A villain born because in self-defence, Stricken, I struck the striker back again? E'en had I known, no villainy 'twould prove: But all unwitting whither I went, I went— To ruin; my destroyers knew it well, Wherefore, I pray you, sirs, in Heaven's name, Even as ye bade me quit my seat, defend me.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)"?

   A. The elders' fear

   B. A decision to send Oedipus back to Thebes under guard

   C. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome

   D. The beggar at the sacred grove

SAT key: 1. C (welcome and shelter offered to a guest); 2. C (Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome)

Lesson 5: Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)

Focus: the Colonus ode

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

Background: Jebb links the play's Colonus setting to local legend (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). Sophocles was himself from Colonus.

Significance: The undying olive stands for a city that endures.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The ode praises Colonus itself—nightingale, olive, and sea-gift—as the goodliest rest for a worn stranger, and as a city worth defending.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
8 key words in context.
Today's words: olive — a tree sacred to Athena; a symbol of peace and endurance; steed — a horse, especially a spirited one; pleasance — a pleasure-garden; a pleasant enclosed ground; quire — a choir; a company of singers; bower — a leafy shelter or shady retreat; glistening — shining with a sparkling or reflected light; unpruned — not trimmed or cut back; brine — the sea; salt water.
Words: olive: a tree sacred to Athena; a symbol of peace and endurance · steed: a horse, especially a spirited one · pleasance: a pleasure-garden; a pleasant enclosed ground · quire: a choir; a company of singers · bower: a leafy shelter or shady retreat · glistening: shining with a sparkling or reflected light · unpruned: not trimmed or cut back · brine: the sea; salt water

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Jebb links the play's Colonus setting to local legend (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). Sophocles was himself from Colonus. The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Imagery: The ode fills Colonus with particular images: the clear-voiced nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's grey-leaved olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar. Setting: The elders name the place itself: a steed-famed land, Colonus' glistening soil, and the haunt of the nightingale, the poet's own deme near Athens. Tone / mood: The song is one of praise and proud protection: the olive is a terror to a foeman's spear, and the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends the plant that feeds the city's boys. Watch for the sacred grove and the hidden grave: The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the Colonus ode.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening..." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders greet the worn stranger by praising the land itself: a country famous for horses, the goodliest of lands, Colonus with glistening soil. Next, craft. I notice the ode speaks to him ("Thou hast come... O stranger worn with toil") and then lifts the eye to the ground under his feet. The strongest word is "glistening": "glistening" makes the soil shine, a visual welcome after the fear and argument of the earlier scenes. Then, effect. What do lines 695–698 reveal about the Colonus ode? My answer: The Colonus ode reveals a land of light on the ground: this praise of Colonus is a song about a place that can receive a worn stranger, not a song about battle.

> *Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil (Stasimon 1, lines 695–698)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening…" slowly and put it in my own words: The elders greet the worn stranger by praising the land itself: a country famous for horses, the goodliest of lands, Colonus with glistening soil. Next, craft. I notice the ode speaks to him ("Thou hast come… O stranger worn with toil") and then lifts the eye to the ground under his feet. The strongest word is "glistening": "glistening" makes the soil shine, a visual welcome after the fear and argument of the earlier scenes. Then, effect. What do lines 695–698 reveal about the Colonus ode? My answer: The Colonus ode reveals a land of light on the ground: this praise of Colonus is a song about a place that can receive a worn stranger, not a song about battle.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Unpruned", "unclaimed" and "withering" stand out. "Unpruned" and "unclaimed" make the olive self-nurtured, belonging to no foreign soil, and "nor youth nor withering age destroys" says time itself cannot kill it. Athena's olive stands for a city that endures and terrifies its enemies (Chorus, lines 720–728). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected student answer: The ode welcomes the worn stranger to a land whose olive the goddess herself defends; Colonus's hospitality is imagined as a rooted, protected home, not a temporary courtesy.

> *And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, / Self-nurtured year by year; / 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys; / Nor youth nor withering age destroys / The plant that the Olive Planter tends / And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends (Stasimon 1, lines 720–728)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Unpruned", "unclaimed" and "withering" stand out. "Unpruned" and "unclaimed" make the olive self-nurtured, belonging to no foreign soil, and "nor youth nor withering age destroys" says time itself cannot kill it. Athena's olive stands for a city that endures and terrifies its enemies (Chorus, lines 720–728).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected student answer: The ode welcomes the worn stranger to a land whose olive the goddess herself defends; Colonus's hospitality is imagined as a rooted, protected home, not a temporary courtesy.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for imagery, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Colonus ode? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) develops the idea of the Colonus ode. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. When the text says "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1, lines 695–698), it shows this directly. The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Colonus ode? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) develops the idea of the Colonus ode. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Access supports: Access supports (not a legal-compliance promise). These are teaching options for English learners and for students with IEP or 504 needs; they do not replace a student's plan, and using them does not by itself satisfy any legal requirement. Chunked reading: read the opening welcome to the worn stranger (lines 695–719), then the olive and Poseidon gifts (lines 720–739), and name one image from each stanza. Sentence frames: The ode calls Colonus "___" (lines 695–698), which makes the land seem ___. / The olive is "unpruned" and "unclaimed" (lines 720–723), which suggests ___. Graphic organizer: a four-row image list (nightingale, soil, olive, sea-gift) with the line and what it praises. Time: extended time on the short-ode quiz and CER. Audio: hear the ode twice; students may whisper the olive stanza (lines 720–728) with the printed words.

Exemplar: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. When the text says "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1, lines 695–698), it shows this directly. The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home? Ask: What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home?

Anchor question: What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home?

Facilitation: Ask: What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Colonus ode? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. ("Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil", Stasimon 1, lines 695–698). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Colonus ode? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. ("Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil", Stasimon 1, lines 695–698). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the Colonus ode. Key takeaway: The ode praises Colonus itself—nightingale, olive, and sea-gift—as the goodliest rest for a worn stranger, and as a city worth defending.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The ode fills Colonus with particular images: the clear-voiced nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's grey-leaved olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.
- **Setting:** The elders name the place itself: a steed-famed land, Colonus' glistening soil, and the haunt of the nightingale, the poet's own deme near Athens.
- **Tone / mood:** The song is one of praise and proud protection: the olive is a terror to a foeman's spear, and the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends the plant that feeds the city's boys.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the Colonus ode.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the Colonus ode.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1, lines 695–698) The elders praise Colonus itself as the goodliest rest for a worn stranger.

- "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, / Self-nurtured year by year; / 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys; / Nor youth nor withering age destroys / The plant that the Olive Planter tends / And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends" (Stasimon 1, lines 720–728) Athena's self-nurtured olive stands for a city that endures and terrifies its enemies.
- "Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among" (Stasimon 1, lines 699–700) The ode locates the grove as the nightingale's haunt, a living image of the poet's own deme.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The undying olive stands for a city that endures.
Evidence: "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1, lines 695–698)
Reasoning: The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Line 695

695 **Chorus:** Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest,

Lines 695–698

695 **Chorus:** Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest,
696 **Chorus:** O stranger worn with toil,
697 **Chorus:** To a land of all lands the goodliest
698 **Chorus:** Colonus' glistening soil.

Lines 695–708

695 **Chorus:** Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest,
696 **Chorus:** O stranger worn with toil,
697 **Chorus:** To a land of all lands the goodliest
698 **Chorus:** Colonus' glistening soil.
699 **Chorus:** 'Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale,
700 **Chorus:** Who hid in her bower, among
701 **Chorus:** The wine-dark ivy that wreathes the vale,
702 **Chorus:** Trilleth her ceaseless song;
703 **Chorus:** And she loves, where the clustering berries nod
704 **Chorus:** O'er a sunless, windless glade,
705 **Chorus:** The spot by no mortal footstep trod,
706 **Chorus:** The pleasance kept for the Bacchic god,
707 **Chorus:** Where he holds each night his revels wild
708 **Chorus:** With the nymphs who fostered the lusty child.

Lines 695–739

695 **Chorus:** Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest,

Chorus: O stranger worn with toil,
Chorus: To a land of all lands the goodliest
Chorus: Colonus' glistening soil.
Chorus: 'Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale,
Chorus: Who hid in her bower, among
Chorus: The wine-dark ivy that wreathes the vale,
Chorus: Trilleth her ceaseless song;
Chorus: And she loves, where the clustering berries nod
Chorus: O'er a sunless, windless glade,
Chorus: The spot by no mortal footstep trod,
Chorus: The pleasance kept for the Bacchic god,
Chorus: Where he holds each night his revels wild
Chorus: With the nymphs who fostered the lusty child.
Chorus: And fed each morn by the pearly dew
Chorus: The starred narcissi shine,
Chorus: And a wreath with the crocus' golden hue
Chorus: For the Mother and Daughter twine.
Chorus: And never the sleepless fountains cease
Chorus: That feed Cephisus' stream,
Chorus: But they swell earth's bosom with quick increase,
Chorus: And their wave hath a crystal gleam.
Chorus: And the Muses' quire will never disdain
Chorus: To visit this heaven-favoured plain,
Chorus: Nor the Cyprian queen of the golden rein.
Chorus: And here there grows, unpruned, untamed,
Chorus: Terror to foemen's spear,
Chorus: A tree in Asian soil unnamed,
Chorus: By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed,
Chorus: Self-nurtured year by year;
Chorus: 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys;
Chorus: Nor youth nor withering age destroys
Chorus: The plant that the Olive Planter tends
Chorus: And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends.
Chorus: Yet another gift, of all gifts the most
Chorus: Prized by our fatherland, we boast—
Chorus: The might of the horse, the might of the sea;
Chorus: Our fame, Poseidon, we owe to thee,
Chorus: Son of Kronos, our king divine,
Chorus: Who in these highways first didst fit
Chorus: For the mouth of horses the iron bit;
Chorus: Thou too hast taught us to fashion meet
Chorus: For the arm of the rower the oar-blade fleet,
Chorus: Swift as the Nereids' hundred feet
Chorus: As they dance along the brine.

Line 696
696 **Chorus:** O stranger worn with toil,

Line 697
697 **Chorus:** To a land of all lands the goodliest

Lines 699–700
699 **Chorus:** 'Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale,
700 **Chorus:** Who hid in her bower, among

Line 714
714 **Chorus:** That feed Cephisus' stream,

Line 719
719 **Chorus:** Nor the Cyprian queen of the golden rein.

Lines 720–728
720 **Chorus:** And here there grows, unpruned, untamed,
721 **Chorus:** Terror to foemen's spear,
722 **Chorus:** A tree in Asian soil unnamed,
723 **Chorus:** By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed,
724 **Chorus:** Self-nurtured year by year;
725 **Chorus:** 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys;
726 **Chorus:** Nor youth nor withering age destroys
727 **Chorus:** The plant that the Olive Planter tends
728 **Chorus:** And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends.

Line 725
725 **Chorus:** 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys;

Line 731
731 **Chorus:** The might of the horse, the might of the sea;

Line 732
732 **Chorus:** Our fame, Poseidon, we owe to thee,

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
olive (noun)	a tree sacred to Athena; a symbol of peace and endurance	*Self-nurtured year by year; / 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys;*
steed (noun)	a horse, especially a spirited one	*Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil,*
pleasance (noun)	a pleasure-garden; a pleasant enclosed ground	*The spot by no mortal footstep trod, / The pleasance kept for the Bacchic god,*

quire (noun)	a choir; a company of singers	*And the Muses' quire will never disdain / To visit this heaven-favoured plain,*
bower (noun)	a leafy shelter or shady retreat	*'Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among*
glistening (adjective)	shining with a sparkling or reflected light	*To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil.*
unpruned (adjective)	not trimmed or cut back	*And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear,*
brine (noun)	the sea; salt water	*Swift as the Nereids' hundred feet / As they dance along the brine.*

Discussion questions

1. What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with law against force?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What wreath does the ode say is twined for the Mother and Daughter? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A crocus wreath. The ode names the flower as the wreath twined for the Mother and Daughter on this favoured ground, so the land's praise includes a rite of Demeter and Persephone, not only a boast of trees and horses.
   Answer guidance: A crocus wreath. The ode names the flower as the wreath twined for the Mother and Daughter on this favoured ground, so the land's praise includes a rite of Demeter and Persephone, not only a boast of trees and horses.
2. What does the wine-dark ivy do, in the ode's picture of the vale? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** It wreathes the vale
   Answer guidance: It wreathes the vale.
3. How does the ode describe the glade where the clustering berries nod? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Sunless and windless
   Answer guidance: Sunless and windless.
4. What does the ode say of mortal footstep in this favoured spot? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** No mortal footstep has trod it
   Answer guidance: No mortal footstep has trod it.

5. For whom, according to the ode, is this pleasance kept? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The Bacchic god
   Answer guidance: The Bacchic god.
6. Who, in the ode, fostered the lusty child at those night revels? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The nymphs
   Answer guidance: The nymphs.
7. What does the ode call this land, of all lands? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The goodliest
   Answer guidance: The goodliest.
8. What does the Olive Planter do, in the ode's account of the tree? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He tends the plant
   Answer guidance: He tends the plant.
9. What did Poseidon first fit, in these highways, for the mouths of horses? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The iron bit
   Answer guidance: The iron bit.
10. What has he taught this people to fashion for the rower's arm? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The oar-blade fleet
    Answer guidance: The oar-blade fleet.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why place a hymn of praise right after Theseus' welcome? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** It celebrates the land that has just taken the stranger in: the ode turns Theseus's private pledge into the community's public praise, addressed to the guest.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Theseus has just promised protection, and the elders who once cried "Begone!" now speak to Oedipus directly: "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil" (lines 695–696). Placing the hymn here shows the community accepting what its king decided, and tells the stranger what kind of place has received him.
2. What does "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" suggest about the Colonus ode? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The undying olive stands for a city that renews itself and cannot be cut down by age or by its enemies, so it can shelter a guest.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The olive is the ode's image of endurance: "Nor youth nor withering age destroys / The plant that the Olive Planter tends" (lines 726–727). The ode suggests that Athens, like its olive, renews itself and cannot be cut down by age or enemies, which is why it can safely shelter an old man whom Thebes wants back.
3. Find one example of imagery in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)". What does it reveal about the Colonus ode that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** One image (the nightingale in the ivy, the sleepless fountains, the olive, Poseidon's bit and oar) and what it shows beyond a plain statement: a land that keeps renewing itself.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: "And never the sleepless fountains cease / That feed Cephisus' stream" (lines 713–714). The never-failing springs make the land itself seem alive and generous, always giving. A

plain statement that Colonus is fertile would not carry that sense of a place that keeps renewing itself, which is exactly what a worn-out stranger lacks.

4. How does the setting in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" shape what we understand about the Colonus ode? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** How the ode's setting, a plain favoured by the Muses and the goddess of love and kept by gods, presents Colonus as divinely loved, so that rest here means divine favour, not just shelter.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The ode says "the Muses' quire will never disdain / To visit this heaven-favoured plain" (lines 717–718). The setting is not just pleasant; it is visited and loved by gods. That shapes the welcome: a stranger resting here rests under divine favour, which answers the elders' earlier fear that his presence would offend the powers of the place.
5. In the passage that opens with "Thou hast come to…", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two words from the opening lines with their connotations, such as "steed-famed" (a heroic reputation), "worn" (exhaustion), "goodliest" or "glistening," showing a welcome that pairs the land's glory with the stranger's need.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The word "steed-famed" (line 695) gives the land a heroic reputation, while "worn" (line 696) names the stranger's exhaustion. The pairing makes the land's fame and the stranger's need fit together: a famous place offers rest to a tired man.
6. What causes the main turn in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The ode's turn from natural beauty (song, water, flowers) to civic strength (the olive feared by enemies, Poseidon's horse and oar), and its effect: the welcome becomes a promise that this land can defend its guest.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The turn comes at "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear" (lines 720–721). Until then the ode praises song, water and flowers; from here it praises strength, ending with "The might of the horse, the might of the sea" (line 731). The effect is to remind the audience, just after a threat from Thebes has been announced, that this land can fight for its guest.
7. How does "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" build on "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A causal link: Oedipus's warning in Episode 1 that all strength decays is answered by an olive that age cannot destroy, sung now because Theseus has pledged protection.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: In Episode 1 Oedipus warned that "Earth's might decays, the might of men decays" (line 632). The ode answers with an olive that "Nor youth nor withering age destroys" (line 726). Because Theseus has just pledged protection, the elders now sing of a place whose strength does not decay. The fear in Episode 1 produces this hopeful reply.
8. In "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the Colonus ode, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A motive inferred from the elders' praise: they claim to welcome the stranger, but most of the ode praises their own land, suggesting civic pride and a wish to make up for their first hostility.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders claim simply to welcome the stranger ("Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest," line 695), but the ode spends far more lines on Colonus than on him, ending with "Our fame, Poseidon, we owe to thee" (line 732). A fair inference is that civic pride, and a wish to

repair their first hostility, drive the song: by praising the land, they show the stranger what his hosts are worth.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A revised answer that compares the student's list with what the elders actually choose (birds, river, sacred flowers, the olive, horses and ships), noting that the ode praises strength as well as beauty.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: My first list was things I like about home: food, friends, a park. The ode made me add what protects a home. The elders praise "the clear-voiced nightingale" (line 699) but also the olive that is "Terror to foemen's spear" (line 721) and the oar their people learned to make (lines 736–737). A home worth praising both comforts and defends.
10. Where does tone / mood appear in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)", and how does it connect the Colonus ode to the larger concern with law against force? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Where the mood shifts from serene to proud and martial, and how that connects to law against force: the strength the ode praises is controlled strength (the bit that tames horses), not raiding.
    Answer guidance: Model answer: The mood is peaceful through the glade and fountains, then turns proud and martial with the olive that is "Terror to foemen's spear" (line 721). Even the strength the ode praises is ordered strength: Poseidon "first didst fit / For the mouth of horses the iron bit" (lines 734–735), taming force rather than letting it loose. That connects to law against force: Athens is pictured as a power that controls its own strength.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the ode about Oedipus, Athens, or both? Defend your reading. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A defended reading: mainly the land, but framed as an address to the stranger, with everything praised answering his need (rest, endurance, protection), plus a counter-reading.
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: both, but Athens is the subject and Oedipus is the audience. Only the opening speaks to him ("O stranger worn with toil," line 696); the rest praises the land. Yet everything praised answers his need: rest after toil, an olive that age cannot destroy for an old man, and a power that can protect a guest. Counter-line: a reader could argue that it is purely civic pride, since Oedipus is never named and the closing lines belong to Poseidon (lines 729–739).
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The undying olive stands for a city that endures. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A stand on the reading with two lines from the olive stanza (lines 720–728), perhaps qualifying that the olive is also a weapon and a gift defended by a goddess.
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: agree, and extend it. The olive is "Self-nurtured year by year" (line 724), so it does stand for endurance. But it is also "Terror to foemen's spear" (line 721), and "the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends" it (line 728). The city endures because its people and its goddess defend it, not only because it is old.
3. No character acts in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)"; the elders sing. Which gift or image the ode praises seems wisest to value most, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named

standard applied to two things the ode praises, for example what best serves a stranger who needs rest and safety: the olive against the night revels. Give lines.

Answer guidance: One defensible answer: by the standard of what best serves a worn stranger, the olive is the wisest thing to value, since it "feeds our boys" (line 725) and age cannot destroy it. The least, by that standard, is the night revel of "the Bacchic god" (line 706), which delights but protects no one. A student using beauty as the standard could rank the nightingale's "ceaseless song" (line 702) first instead.

4. You are directing "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the Colonus ode. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two staging choices tied to lines, such as the chorus turning from Oedipus to the audience or a change of rhythm at the olive or the oar, each with its effect.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: (1) On the opening lines (lines 695–696), have the elders face Oedipus, then slowly turn outward to the audience, so the welcome becomes the city praising itself. (2) At "The might of the horse, the might of the sea" (line 731), shift the music to a stronger beat and let the dancers mime rowing through the last lines. The audience feels the land's power right after its gentleness.

5. Write your own questions about "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Three questions answerable from lines 695–739: one recall, one why/how and one should/what-if, different in kind.

   Answer guidance: Model set. Recall: Which river do the sleepless fountains feed? (The Cephisus, line 714.) Why/how: Why does the ode end with Poseidon's gifts of horse and oar rather than with the grove? (It moves from beauty to the city's strength.) Should/what if: If you were Oedipus, should this ode reassure you? (Answers weigh the strength promised here against the elders' earlier fear.)

6. Connect "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)", with its focus on the Colonus ode, to death and blessing: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment about death and blessing, the question's theme. The ode itself is full of life, not death, so the link is weak here; a strong answer notes that Oedipus has already tied his blessing to his death and says what must come next.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the link is weak inside the ode, and the contrast matters. The ode is full of life: fountains that "swell earth's bosom with quick increase" (line 715). But Oedipus has already said his benefit comes "When I am dead and thou hast buried me" (line 603). Sophocles would need to show how that promised blessing after death joins this land of living blessings.

7. Is the imagery in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" effective in presenting the Colonus ode, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment of the imagery against a stated criterion (does it do dramatic work or only decorate?), with a line that meets the criterion and one that might miss it.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: effective, because the images are chosen for this stranger. Rest, shade and endless water, "O'er a sunless, windless glade" (line 704), offer a weary wanderer what he lacks. Counter-line: the ode's many gods and myths, such as "the Cyprian queen of the golden rein" (line 719) or the Nereids' "hundred feet" (line 738), may read like a catalogue. That could feel heavy-handed unless the class sees it as a hometown hymn by a poet born at Colonus.

8. Compare how "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" treats the Colonus ode with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic

circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named comparison (a song, poem or speech praising a home or nation) and one thing the ode sees that the other misses, tied to a line.

Answer guidance: Model answer: Compare "America the Beautiful," which praises a land's beauty and plenty. The ode sees something the anthem leaves implicit: praise of home is offered to a stranger, as a promise of what the home will give him ("Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest," line 695). It ties a land's worth to how it treats someone who is not its own.

9. Predict what "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A prediction from two clues, the olive feared by enemies and the earlier report that Creon is coming, about a coming test of the land's strength, checked after reading.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Clue 1: the ode stresses defence, with the olive as "Terror to foemen's spear" (line 721). Clue 2: Ismene reported that "Creon comes to thee—and comes anon" (line 397). A reasonable prediction is that Creon will come and the land the elders just praised will have to show whether it can protect its guest. After reading, students judge whether the praise held up.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the Colonus ode? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An adaptation that keeps the core: a community praises its home to a newcomer it has just accepted, moving from comfort to strength. It names two details that must stay.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: At a coastal town's welcome evening, a choir sings to a newly settled exile about its lighthouse, orchards and fishing fleet. Two things must stay: the direct address to the newcomer ("O stranger worn with toil," line 696), and the turn from gentle beauty to the town's strength (lines 720–721), so the praise is also a promise of protection.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to the opening strophe, what does the nightingale do from a bower among the ivy?

   A. Trilleth her ceaseless song

   B. Warns the city of a Theban raid

   C. Leads the worn stranger back to the road

   D. Keeps silent until a king has spoken

   Key: A (Trilleth her ceaseless song)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is Colonus called in line 695?

   A. A land of plague and famine

   B. A steed-famed land

C. A barren rock without a stream

D. A city already wasted by war

Key: B (A steed-famed land)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: “The starred _____ shine,”

   Key: narcissi

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: “And here there grows, _____, untamed,”

   Key: unpruned

5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.9] What gifts does the chorus say it owes to Poseidon?

   A. A new Theban throne prepared for the worn stranger alone

   B. The laurel crown reserved for the Delphic god Apollo now

   C. Horsemanship and seafaring, which the ode credits to him

   D. The power to call a wasting plague down on any named foe

   Key: C (Horsemanship and seafaring, which the ode credits to him)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] In the opening lines, how is the visitor described?

   A. A king returning home in a public triumph

   B. A herald sent in haste from Theban Creon now

   C. A god walking the sacred grove in human disguise

   D. A worn stranger who has come here for rest

   Key: D (A worn stranger who has come here for rest)

7. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does the chorus mean by calling this “a land of all lands the goodliest”? Use the lines that name the soil.

   Sample answer: The elders are not making a general compliment only; they name the very ground of their own deme as the best of lands. After the address to the visitor, they add, “To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus’ glistening soil” (lines 697–698). “Goodliest” ranks Colonus above other places, and “glistening soil” makes the boast local and visible: the praise is of this shining earth, not of a distant city in the abstract.

8. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What does the olive stand for when the ode calls it a “Terror to foemen’s spear”?

   A. It presents the tree as a living defence of the city

   B. It claims the sacred tree is cut to make enemy spears

   C. It says the city's foes come just to harvest the fruit

   D. It warns that the holy grove will be felled in a siege

   Key: A (It presents the tree as a living defence of the city)

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] How do the images of the iron bit and the oar-blade work together in the closing stanza? Quote both.

   Sample answer: They pair land-power and sea-power as one civic gift, both taught by the same god. Poseidon, the chorus says, first fitted “For the mouth of horses the iron bit” (line 735) and also taught them to fashion “For the arm of the rower the oar-blade fleet” (line 737). The bit tames the horse on the road; the oar-blade drives the ship. Set side by side, they turn horsemanship and rowing into a single boast: Athens is strong inland and on the water.

10. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] How does this ode recast the tired visitor as a man being welcomed into a proud land? Use one early quotation and one later one.

    Sample answer: The song begins not with a threat but with rest already offered: “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land

for rest, / O stranger worn with toil" (lines 695–696). The visitor is seen as worn, and the land as a place that can receive him. The later praise of tree, horse, and sea then shows what kind of land is offering that rest: one that boasts gifts "Prized by our fatherland" (line 730) and a plant no age destroys. The ode therefore turns the stranger's weariness into the opening of a hymn of civic pride.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What tree does the ode celebrate?

    A. The olive

    B. The oak

    C. The laurel

    D. The cypress

    Key: A (The olive)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What is the tone of the ode?

    A. Fearful and uncertain

    B. Proud and loving

    C. Angry at the worn stranger

    D. Mocking of the city's gods

    Key: B (Proud and loving)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "That feed _____' stream,"

    Key: Cephisus

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "By Pelops' Dorian isle _____,"

    Key: unclaimed

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What do the sleepless fountains do for the land, according to the ode?

    A. They dry the fields so the olive can grow

    B. They wash the stranger's past from memory

    C. They keep the soil fertile without ceasing

    D. They mark a hard border with the Theban plain

    Key: C (They keep the soil fertile without ceasing)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Who is "the Cyprian queen of the golden rein" in this ode?

    A. Hera, queen of the Argive sky and marriage

    B. Artemis, huntress of the sunless windless glade

    C. Athena, already praised as the city's own defender

    D. Aphrodite, who also visits this favoured plain

    Key: D (Aphrodite, who also visits this favoured plain)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the chorus claim about the fountains and the land's increase? Quote the lines about the wave.

    Sample answer: The ode presents the water as endlessly at work, not as a brief spring rain. After the fountains that do not cease, the chorus says, "But they swell earth's bosom with quick increase, / And their wave hath a crystal gleam" (lines 715–716). "swell earth's bosom" and "quick increase" make the land's fertility a living, repeated action, and the "crystal gleam" keeps the image bright and clean. The praise is that this ground is continually fed, and therefore fit to be called favoured.

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the claim that the tree is unnamed in Asian soil and not claimed by Pelops' Dorian isle emphasize?

    A. It treats the olive as uniquely Attic, not Asian or Dorian

    B. The chorus admits the tree was first grown in Asian gardens

    C. The olive, in this song, belongs equally to every Greek city

    D. The tree will soon be sent abroad as a gift from Athens

    Key: A (It treats the olive as uniquely Attic, not Asian or Dorian)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the nightingale passage present the grove as a place set apart? Use the lines about the bird's haunt and the ivy.

    Sample answer: It makes the grove a hidden, sounding refuge rather than a public road. The chorus says Colonus is "the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among / The wine-dark ivy that wreathes the vale, / Trilleth her ceaseless song" (lines 699–702). "hid in her bower" and the "wine-dark ivy" shut the scene in, and the "ceaseless song" gives it a life that does not depend on human traffic. The bird's shelter becomes an image of a sacred close, loved and withdrawn, before the ode ever names the olive or the sea.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the mention of the Muses help complete the ode's praise of the place? Use the line about the plain they visit.

    Sample answer: The Muses' visit raises Colonus from a pretty landscape to a place the arts themselves will not refuse. The chorus says their quire will not disdain "To visit this heaven-favoured plain" (line 718). "heaven-favoured" already marks the ground as chosen, and the Muses' willingness to come confirms that the favour is not only of river and tree but of song. The ode thus claims that the same land which offers the worn stranger rest is also a plain worthy of divine and artistic company.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who defends the olive, according to the ode?

    A. The Grey-eyed Goddess (Athena)

    B. Zeus alone, without any care from Athena

    C. Apollo, speaking from the Delphic hearth

    D. Creon, acting as guardian of Theban land

    Key: A (The Grey-eyed Goddess (Athena))

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Nor youth nor _____ age destroys"

    Key: withering

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Son of _____, our king divine,"

    Key: Kronos

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does "Self-nurtured year by year" make the olive stand for?

    A. The city's boys must replant the same tree again each spring

    B. It renews itself in this soil without being imported or forced

    C. The tree was brought from Asia in this very same generation

    D. Theseus planted it on the very day he welcomed the stranger

    Key: B (It renews itself in this soil without being imported or forced)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this ode, the Mother and Daughter for whom a crocus wreath is twined are:

    A. Athena and her companion Artemis

    B. Antigone and Ismene, the stranger's daughters

C. Demeter and Persephone

D. The nymphs who fostered the Bacchic child

Key: C (Demeter and Persephone)

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What is the force of the chorus's address, “Our fame, Poseidon, we owe to thee”? Quote the line and explain the claim.

Sample answer: The line makes Athens' name a debt to one god, not a vague civic boast. After the chorus has named a further gift its fatherland prizes most, it turns to the god himself: “Our fame, Poseidon, we owe to thee” (line 732). “Fame” is public reputation, and “we owe” makes it a gift received rather than a prize merely taken. The force of the address is to root horsemanship and seafaring in divine teaching, so the land's pride is also piety.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse the wording of “’Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys”. What does the diction argue?

Sample answer: The line turns a tree into a civic nurse. “Grey-leaved” keeps the plant particular and visible, not a generic symbol, and “feeds our boys” makes its work domestic and generational: the olive does not only stand as an emblem, it nourishes the city's children. The wording therefore argues that Athens' endurance is lived in ordinary care, the same plant later said to be defended by the goddess. Beauty and utility are bound in one tree.

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What contrast does the ode draw when it says that neither youth nor age destroys the plant?

A. The tree lives only while the city's boys are young

B. Old age is about to bring the grove down

C. The stranger's youth will be restored by the fruit

D. The tree outlasts the span of a human life

Key: D (The tree outlasts the span of a human life)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the olive stanza turn a tree into an image of a city that endures? Use the line about Asian soil.

Sample answer: The chorus first isolates the tree from other lands, then gives it a life that does not wear out. It is “A tree in Asian soil unnamed” (line 722), and it is not claimed by Pelops' Dorian isle either: the point is that this plant belongs here. That uniqueness is then joined to a strength no season of life can ruin, and to a goddess who defends it. The olive thus stands for a city whose life is native, fed, and guarded, not borrowed or briefly held.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How do the closing gifts named after the olive complete the ode's portrait of the fatherland? Quote the lines about the gift the land boasts.

Sample answer: After the olive has been praised as a defended, self-nurtured tree, the chorus adds a further civic boast: “Yet another gift, of all gifts the most / Prized by our fatherland, we boast—” (lines 729–730). The “most prized” gift is the double might of horse and sea, owed to Poseidon. Olive, bit, and oar therefore sit in one catalogue: a land that feeds its boys, terrifies a foe, and is skilled on road and water. The ode's welcome of the worn stranger is backed by this full portrait of a country worth resting in.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “And the Muses’ _____ will never disdain”

Key: quire

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Swift as the _____’ hundred feet”

Key: Nereids

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the phrase “heaven-favoured plain” add to the visit of the Muses?

A. It presents the place as chosen and honoured by the gods

B. It means the favoured plain is empty of every mortal voice

C. It claims Colonus has already taken the old place of Delphi

D. It warns that the gods are now about to leave the whole land

Key: A (It presents the place as chosen and honoured by the gods)

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the pairing of the tree's wild growth with its feeding of the city's boys make the olive stand for?

A. The chorus wants the sacred grove cut back and formally trained

B. The tree's strength is native and wild, yet it still nourishes the city

C. The olive is treated as too wild to be of any civic use at all

D. A king must first tame the wild tree before it can feed anyone

Key: B (The tree's strength is native and wild, yet it still nourishes the city)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the yearly, self-nurtured life of the olive work in that stanza?

A. It means the city's boys must plant a new tree every single year

B. It admits the sacred tree was imported from the Dorian isle

C. It stresses a continuous, native life that no other land is said to claim

D. It refers to the nightingale's yearly return in early spring

Key: C (It stresses a continuous, native life that no other land is said to claim)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of repeating “The might of the horse, the might of the sea”?

A. The chorus shows it cannot decide which of the gifts matters more now

B. The line reduces Poseidon to being no more than a god of horses

C. The stanza prepares a confession that Athens has no real sea fleet

D. The repeated word might balances two powers as one boast of the land

Key: D (The repeated word might balances two powers as one boast of the land)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How do the lines about an untrodden spot and the Bacchic pleasance set the grove apart? Quote both.

Sample answer: They place the grove outside ordinary human traffic and inside a god's keeping. The chorus loves “The spot by no mortal footstep trod, / The pleasance kept for the Bacchic god” (lines 705–706), where he holds revels with the nymphs who fostered him. “no mortal footstep” withdraws the place from common use, and “kept for the Bacchic god” assigns it a divine owner. The grove is not merely pretty countryside; it is a reserved, holy pleasance, which makes the later civic boasts of olive and sea grow out of sacred ground.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is the ode about Oedipus, Athens, or both? Defend your reading.

Sample answer: It is about both, but it spends its lyrical force on Athens while still addressing the man who has just been received. The song opens by telling a worn stranger that he has come here for rest, so Oedipus is the occasion of the hymn. What the chorus then unfolds, however, is the land itself: river, goddess, olive, horse, and sea. Even the plant “that the Olive Planter tends” (line 727) is praised as a civic and divine care, not as a private comfort for the guest. The ode therefore uses the stranger's arrival to praise the city that can shelter him, and it cannot be reduced to either portrait alone.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the catalogue of Poseidon's gifts complete the thought that this is a land worth boasting of? Use the closing image of the dance on the brine.

Sample answer: The last gift is not another tree but motion on the water, taught by the same god who gave the bit. After the fatherland has boasted of horse and sea, the chorus says Poseidon taught them the oar-blade, "Swift as the Nereids' hundred feet / As they dance along the brine" (lines 738–739). The Nereids' dance makes seafaring graceful as well as strong, a finish in motion rather than in a still grove. The ode thus ends by joining sacred place, enduring tree, and skilled movement, so the welcome offered to the worn stranger is the welcome of a complete, favoured land.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Stasimon 1 give lyric substance to the hospitality already granted? Use one quotation from the olive's defence and one from the land's daily feeding.
Sample answer: Theseus has already pledged protection; the ode then shows, in images, why this ground can bear that pledge. The tree is not left to chance: "And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends" (line 728). Just before the olive stanza, the land itself is said to be "fed each morn by the pearly dew" (line 709). Defence and daily feeding together make rest more than a courteous word: the stranger is welcomed into a place the ode presents as both guarded and continually renewed.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) develops the idea of the Colonus ode. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" could deliver about the Colonus ode. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Colonus ode in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the Colonus ode. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" could deliver about the Colonus ode. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Colonus ode in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) suggests about the Colonus ode. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" could deliver about the Colonus ode. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Colonus ode in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses imagery in Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) to complicate the reader's understanding of the Colonus ode. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" could deliver about the Colonus ode. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Colonus ode in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, O stranger worn with toil, To a land of all lands the goodliest Colonus' glistening soil. 'Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, Who hid in her bower, among The wine-dark ivy that wreathes the vale, Trilleth her ceaseless song; And she loves, where the clustering berries nod O'er a sunless, windless glade, The spot by no mortal footstep trod, The pleasance kept for the Bacchic god, Where he holds each night his revels wild With the nymphs who fostered the lusty child.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "glistening" most nearly mean?

   A. barren and dried by drought
   B. hidden under a long darkness
   C. ploughed up for a new road
   D. shining or gleaming

2. *Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, O stranger worn with toil, To a land of all lands the goodliest Colonus' glistening soil. 'Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, Who hid in her bower, among The wine-dark ivy that wreathes the vale, Trilleth her ceaseless song; And she loves, where the clustering berries nod O'er a sunless, windless glade, The spot by no mortal footstep trod, The pleasance kept for the Bacchic god, Where he holds each night his revels wild With the nymphs who fostered the lusty child.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)"?

   A. A lament that Colonus has no gods and no trees
   B. The beggar at the sacred grove
   C. A plan for Theseus to abandon the grove
   D. The Colonus ode

SAT key: 1. D (shining or gleaming); 2. D (The Colonus ode)

Lesson 6: Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)

Focus: Creon seizes the daughters

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

Background: Slavery was legal in ancient Greece; Creon and Theseus use "slave" as an insult (lines 869, 963). Owning a person is wrong, and slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022, Executive summary).

Significance: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957).

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Smooth words give way to force: Creon seizes the daughters, and Theseus answers that Athens is a state that asks a warranty of law for every action.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
8 key words in context.
Today's words: freebooter — a pirate or plunderer; minions — followers who obey a leader without question; ravisher — (archaic) one who carries off or assaults a woman by force; warranty — a formal guarantee; an authorization that makes an action lawful; sojourner — a person who stays temporarily in a place that is not home; insolence — rude and arrogant disrespect; adjure — to charge someone solemnly, as if under oath, to do something; kindred — relatives; people related by blood or family.
Words: freebooter: a pirate or plunderer · minions: followers who obey a leader without question · ravisher: (archaic) one who carries off or assaults a woman by force · warranty: a formal guarantee; an authorization that makes an action lawful · sojourner: a person who stays temporarily in a place that is not home · insolence: rude and arrogant disrespect · adjure: to charge someone solemnly, as if under oath, to do something · kindred: relatives; people related by blood or family

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Slavery was legal in ancient Greece; Creon and Theseus use "slave" as an insult (lines 869, 963). Owning a person is wrong, and slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022, Executive summary). The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Conflict: After smooth words fail, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus rebukes him for breaking Athenian law and sends men to rescue the girls. Characterization: Creon begins with persuasion and turns to force, insisting he is not a slave; Oedipus answers that he met his father unknowingly; Theseus speaks as the defender of a state that asks a warranty of law for every action. Theme: The scene sets the rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state that champions right, while Oedipus again claims that an all-unconscious hand cannot be blamed as if it had known what it did. Watch for the sacred grove and the hidden grave: The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: Creon seizes the daughters.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content" slowly and put it in my own words: Oedipus tells Creon his words are wasted and bids him go; whatever happens, he says a person who lives content does not live badly. Next, craft. I notice he answers a threat with a dismissal and a proverb, as if contentment were a kind of armor in a scene already tense with force. The strongest word is "content": "lives withal content" is his claim to a life that force cannot redefine, even while Creon is still before him. Then, effect. What do lines 816–818 reveal about how Oedipus answers Creon? My answer: He tries to end the exchange by sending Creon away and claiming a contented lot. The question of law and force in this scene will have to be answered by more than this refusal.

> *Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content (Episode 2, lines 816–818)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content" slowly and put it in my own words: Oedipus tells Creon his words are wasted and bids him go; whatever happens, he says a person who lives content does not live badly. Next, craft. I notice he answers a threat with a dismissal and a proverb, as if contentment were a kind of armor in a scene already tense with force. The strongest word is "content": "lives withal content" is his claim to a life that force cannot redefine, even while Creon is still before him. Then, effect. What do lines 816–818 reveal about how Oedipus answers Creon? My answer: He tries to end the exchange by sending Creon away and claiming a contented lot. The question of law and force in this scene will have to be answered by more than this refusal.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Command", "minions" and "slave" stand out. "Command your minions" tells Theseus to give orders only to his own servants, and "I am not your slave" refuses Athenian authority in one insult. Creon rejects the host city's command and will not be treated as its slave (Creon, line 869). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected student answer: Creon refuses the host city's authority and will not be treated as its slave; the line shows the seizure of the daughters as a rejection of Athenian hospitality and law.

> *Command your minions; I am not your slave (Episode 2, line 869)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Command", "minions" and "slave" stand out. "Command your minions" tells Theseus to give orders only to his own servants, and "I am not your slave" refuses Athenian authority in one insult. Creon rejects the host city's command and will not be treated as its slave (Creon, line 869).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected student answer: Creon refuses the host city's authority and will not be treated as its slave; the line shows the seizure of the daughters as a rejection of Athenian hospitality and law.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Creon seizes the daughters? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) develops the idea of Creon seizes the daughters. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). When the text says "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou thoughtest this a city without men, / Or manned by slaves, and me a thing of naught" (Episode 2, lines 956–963), it shows this directly. Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

Task: Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Creon seizes the daughters? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) develops the idea of Creon seizes the daughters. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Access supports: Access supports (not a legal-compliance promise). These are teaching options for English learners and for students with IEP or 504 needs; they do not replace a student's plan, and using them does not by itself satisfy any legal requirement. Chunked reading: Creon's opening words, then the seizure, then Theseus's answer (lines 947–958), with a gist check at each turn. Sentence frames: Creon says "Command your minions; I am not your slave" (line 869), which shows ___. / Theseus answers with "the laws to which himself appealed… shall adjudicate" (lines 951–952) because ___. Graphic organizer: a three-column law-against-force chart (Creon's words, the daughters, Theseus's ruling) with a quotation in each column. Time: extended time on this long episode's quiz and writing start. Audio: hear the Theseus speech (lines 947–958) while following the printed text.

Exemplar: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). When the text says "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou thoughtest this a city without men, / Or manned by slaves, and me a thing of naught" (Episode 2, lines 956–963), it shows this directly. Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you? Ask: How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you?
Anchor question: How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you?
Facilitation: Ask: How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Creon seizes the daughters? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). ("Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land", Episode 2, lines 956–963). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Creon seizes the daughters? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). ("Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land", Episode 2, lines 956–963). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes Creon seizes the daughters. Key takeaway: Smooth words give way to force: Creon seizes the daughters, and Theseus answers that Athens is a state that asks a warranty of law for every action.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** After smooth words fail, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus rebukes him for breaking Athenian law and sends men to rescue the girls.
- **Characterization:** Creon begins with persuasion and turns to force, insisting he is not a slave; Oedipus answers that he met his father unknowingly; Theseus speaks as the defender of a state that asks a warranty of law for every action.
- **Theme:** The scene sets the rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state that champions right, while Oedipus again claims that an all-unconscious hand cannot be blamed as if it had known what it did.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** Creon seizes the daughters.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: Creon seizes the daughters.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content" (Episode 2, lines 816–818) Oedipus refuses Creon's suit and claims that a contented life is not a failed one.
- "Command your minions; I am not your slave" (Episode 2, line 869) Creon rejects Athenian authority and insists he will not be commanded as a slave.
- "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou thoughtest this a city without men, / Or manned by slaves, and me a thing of naught" (Episode 2, lines 956–963) Theseus rebukes Creon for treating Athens like a lawless city he can plunder at will.
- "Anger has no old age but only death; / The dead alone can feel no touch of spite" (Episode 2, lines 1001–1002) Creon claims anger has no old age, so an old man can still nurse spite until death.
- "And if / When born to misery, as born I was, / I met my sire, not knowing whom I met / Or what I did, and slew him, how canst thou / With justice blame the all-unconscious hand" (Episode 2, lines 1019–1023) Oedipus argues that an unconscious hand cannot justly be blamed as if it had known the deed.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957).
Evidence: "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou thoughtest this a city without men, / Or manned by slaves, and me a thing of naught" (Episode 2, lines 956–963)
Reasoning: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 747–758

747 **Creon:** Burghers, my noble friends, ye take alarm
748 **Creon:** At my approach (I read it in your eyes),
749 **Creon:** Fear nothing and refrain from angry words.
750 **Creon:** I come with no ill purpose; I am old,
751 **Creon:** And know the city whither I am come,
752 **Creon:** Without a peer amongst the powers of Greece.
753 **Creon:** It was by reason of my years that I
754 **Creon:** Was chosen to persuade your guest and bring

755 **Creon:** Him back to Thebes; not the delegate
756 **Creon:** Of one man, but commissioned by the State,
757 **Creon:** Since of all Thebans I have most bewailed,
758 **Creon:** Being his kinsman, his most grievous woes.

Lines 747–778

747 **Creon:** Burghers, my noble friends, ye take alarm
748 **Creon:** At my approach (I read it in your eyes),
749 **Creon:** Fear nothing and refrain from angry words.
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754 **Creon:** Was chosen to persuade your guest and bring
755 **Creon:** Him back to Thebes; not the delegate
756 **Creon:** Of one man, but commissioned by the State,
757 **Creon:** Since of all Thebans I have most bewailed,
758 **Creon:** Being his kinsman, his most grievous woes.
759 **Creon:** O listen to me, luckless Oedipus,
760 **Creon:** Come home! The whole Cadmeian people claim
761 **Creon:** With right to have thee back, I most of all,
762 **Creon:** For most of all (else were I vile indeed)
763 **Creon:** I mourn for thy misfortunes, seeing thee
764 **Creon:** An aged outcast, wandering on and on,
765 **Creon:** A beggar with one handmaid for thy stay.
766 **Creon:** Ah! who had e'er imagined she could fall
767 **Creon:** To such a depth of misery as this,
768 **Creon:** To tend in penury thy stricken frame,
769 **Creon:** A virgin ripe for wedlock, but unwed,
770 **Creon:** A prey for any wanton ravisher?
771 **Creon:** Seems it not cruel this reproach I cast
772 **Creon:** On thee and on myself and all the race?
773 **Creon:** Aye, but an open shame cannot be hid.
774 **Creon:** Hide it, O hide it, Oedipus, thou canst.
775 **Creon:** O, by our fathers' gods, consent I pray;
776 **Creon:** Come back to Thebes, come to thy father's home,
777 **Creon:** Bid Athens, as is meet, a fond farewell;
778 **Creon:** Thebes thy old foster-mother claims thee first.

Line 750

750 **Creon:** I come with no ill purpose; I am old,

Lines 792–793

792 **Oedipus:** Thou seek'st to part us, wrapping in soft words
793 **Oedipus:** Hard thoughts. And yet what pleasure canst thou find

Line 801
801 **Oedipus:** Fair in appearance, but when tested false.

Lines 816–818
816 **Oedipus:** Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone,
817 **Oedipus:** And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot,
818 **Oedipus:** He lives not ill who lives withal content.

Line 860
860 **Creon:** I take but what is mine.

Line 869
869 **Creon:** Command your minions; I am not your slave.

Line 928
928 **Chorus:** Men of Athens, arm ye, arm!

Line 932
932 **Theseus:** From the altar of Poseidon, lord of your Colonus? Say!

Line 949
949 **Theseus:** Justly provoked, have play, he had not 'scaped

Lines 951–952
951 **Theseus:** But now the laws to which himself appealed,
952 **Theseus:** These and none other shall adjudicate.

Lines 956–958
956 **Theseus:** And thine own race and country. Having come
957 **Theseus:** Unto a State that champions right and asks
958 **Theseus:** For every action warranty of law,

Lines 956–963
956 **Theseus:** And thine own race and country. Having come
957 **Theseus:** Unto a State that champions right and asks
958 **Theseus:** For every action warranty of law,
959 **Theseus:** Thou hast set aside the custom of the land,
960 **Theseus:** And like some freebooter art carrying off
961 **Theseus:** What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth
962 **Theseus:** Thou thoughtest this a city without men,
963 **Theseus:** Or manned by slaves, and me a thing of naught.

Line 973
973 **Theseus:** I should behave as fits an outlander

Lines 993–996
993 **Creon:** For on her native hill of Ares here

994 **Creon:** (I knew your far-famed Areopagus)
995 **Creon:** Sits Justice, and permits not vagrant folk
996 **Creon:** To stay within your borders. In that faith

Lines 1001–1002
1001 **Creon:** Anger has no old age but only death;
1002 **Creon:** The dead alone can feel no touch of spite.

Lines 1019–1023
1019 **Oedipus:** Conceivèd in no mother's womb? And if
1020 **Oedipus:** When born to misery, as born I was,
1021 **Oedipus:** I met my sire, not knowing whom I met
1022 **Oedipus:** Or what I did, and slew him, how canst thou
1023 **Oedipus:** With justice blame the all-unconscious hand?

Line 1075
1075 **Theseus:** Hath ta'en the fowler in the toils he spread;

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
freebooter (noun)	a pirate or plunderer	*Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off*
minions (noun)	followers who obey a leader without question	*Command your minions; I am not your slave.*
ravisher (noun)	(archaic) one who carries off or assaults a woman by force	*Ah! who had e'er imagined she could fall To such a depth of misery as this, To tend in penury thy stricken frame, A virgin ripe for wedlock, but unwed, A prey for any wanton ravisher?*
warranty (noun)	a formal guarantee; an authorization that makes an action lawful	*Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law,*
sojourner (noun)	a person who stays temporarily in a place that is not home	*And not by choice a sojourner; so much / I tell thee home and what I say, I mean.*
insolence (noun)	rude and arrogant disrespect	*Insolence! / Insolence that thou must bear.*
adjure (verb)	to charge someone solemnly, as if under oath, to do something	*I turn, adjure them and invoke their aid / To champion my cause, that thou mayest learn*
kindred (noun)	relatives; people related by blood or family	*These ties of kindred were by thee ignored; / And now again when thou behold'st this State*

Discussion questions

1. How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.

3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with death and blessing?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Theseus say Athens asks of every action, in lines 956–958? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He says Athens is "a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law." The line is the standard he holds Creon to: having entered such a city, Creon has "set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter" carried off what he pleased. The demand is not courtesy; it is the legal condition on which a stranger may act inside Athens.
   Answer guidance: He says Athens is "a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law." The line is the standard he holds Creon to: having entered such a city, Creon has "set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter" carried off what he pleased. The demand is not courtesy; it is the legal condition on which a stranger may act inside Athens.
2. What does Creon reveal he has already done before he has Antigone seized on stage? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He tells Oedipus that "One of thy daughters is already seized, / The other I will carry off anon." Ismene is already in his men's hands, offstage, and the visible struggle over Antigone is only "prelude to thy woes." The revelation shows that the turn from persuasion to force began before this confrontation, not in a sudden moment of anger alone.
   Answer guidance: He tells Oedipus that "One of thy daughters is already seized, / The other I will carry off anon." Ismene is already in his men's hands, offstage, and the visible struggle over Antigone is only "prelude to thy woes." The revelation shows that the turn from persuasion to force began before this confrontation, not in a sudden moment of anger alone.
3. What does Oedipus bid Creon do, speaking in the burghers' name? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Depart
   Answer guidance: Depart.
4. What far-famed court does Creon say he knew, when he excuses the seizure? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The Areopagus
   Answer guidance: The Areopagus.
5. What does Theseus say shall adjudicate, as to the laws Creon himself appealed to? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** These and none other shall adjudicate
   Answer guidance: These and none other shall adjudicate.
6. Where does Theseus say this villainy was not learnt? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Not from Thebes
   Answer guidance: Not from Thebes.
7. What does Theseus ask as he first hurries in, before he has heard the tale? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** On

what errand he has hurried hither, without stop or stay

Answer guidance: On what errand he has hurried hither, without stop or stay.

8. What does Creon say shall curb his will, though he is old? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Nothing shall curb his will

   Answer guidance: Nothing shall curb his will.

9. What does the chorus shout when Antigone is seized? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Quick, unhand her

   Answer guidance: Quick, unhand her.

10. What blessing does Oedipus speak upon Theseus, once the pursuit is set on foot? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Heaven bless thee, Theseus, for thy nobleness

    Answer guidance: Heaven bless thee, Theseus, for thy nobleness.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Creon pretend friendship at first? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He hopes to persuade Oedipus to return before he has to use force, and he wants the chorus to see him as a kinsman, not a raider. He arrives saying, "I come with no ill purpose; I am old," claims he was "chosen to persuade your guest and bring / Him back to Thebes," and appeals to pity for Antigone's hardship. Only after Oedipus refuses—"leave me here; whate'er may be my lot"—does he show that a daughter is already seized. The courtesy is a tactic, not a change of aim.

   Answer guidance: He hopes to persuade Oedipus to return before he has to use force, and he wants the chorus to see him as a kinsman, not a raider. He arrives saying, "I come with no ill purpose; I am old," claims he was "chosen to persuade your guest and bring / Him back to Thebes," and appeals to pity for Antigone's hardship. Only after Oedipus refuses—"leave me here; whate'er may be my lot"—does he show that a daughter is already seized. The courtesy is a tactic, not a change of aim.

2. Why does Theseus refuse to let his just anger decide Creon's punishment on the spot? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He will use the same laws Creon himself appealed to, not a private revenge. "But now the laws to which himself appealed, / These and none other shall adjudicate," he says, and he will not let Creon leave "till thou hast fetched / The maidens and produced them in my sight." The choice keeps Athens from becoming the lawless city Creon has treated it as, even while Theseus admits that his rage was "Justly provoked" (line 949).

   Answer guidance: He will use the same laws Creon himself appealed to, not a private revenge. "But now the laws to which himself appealed, / These and none other shall adjudicate," he says, and he will not let Creon leave "till thou hast fetched / The maidens and produced them in my sight." The choice keeps Athens from becoming the lawless city Creon has treated it as, even while Theseus admits that his rage was "Justly provoked" (line 949).

3. What does "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" suggest about Creon seizes the daughters? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An inference that Creon's persuasion was cover for force: when words fail he takes hostages, which shows that Thebes wants control of Oedipus, not his welfare.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals, "One of thy daughters is already seized, / The other I will carry off anon" (lines 840–841). The seizure was planned before the

persuasion ended, so the kind words were never the real plan. He treats the daughters as leverage, "those two crutches" (line 883), because what he wants is control of Oedipus himself.

4. Find one example of conflict in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)". What does it reveal about Creon seizes the daughters that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A specific clash, such as the rapid "wrong" / "right" exchange, explained for what it shows: Creon claims a right over his kin while using force.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: In the exchange "Sir, thou dost wrong. / Nay, right. / How right? / I take but what is mine." (lines 857–860), Creon claims ownership of Antigone as her kinsman while his men drag her away. The conflict shows him dressing force in the language of rights, which a plain statement about a kidnapping would miss.

5. How does the characterization in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" shape what we understand about Creon seizes the daughters? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** How Creon is drawn as smooth, then menacing, and Theseus as angry but restrained, so the seizure reads as a clash between two kinds of power.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Creon opens gently ("I come with no ill purpose; I am old," line 750) and ends with "Nothing shall curb my will" (line 913). Oedipus names the pattern: "wrapping in soft words / Hard thoughts" (lines 792–793). Theseus admits his rage was "Justly provoked" (line 949) yet holds it back. The characterization makes the seizure a test of two kinds of power: a ruler who restrains himself and an envoy who does not.

6. In the passage that opens with "Burghers, my noble friends…", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two words from Creon's opening speech (lines 747–778) with their connotations, such as "noble friends," "kinsman," "foster-mother" or "Hide it," showing flattery and family language used to persuade.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Creon calls the elders "my noble friends" (line 747) and Thebes Oedipus's "old foster-mother" (line 778). Both are warm words of friendship and family. They flatter the hosts and make leaving Athens sound like going home to a mother, hiding Thebes' plan to keep him outside its borders.

7. What causes the main turn in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The turn comes when persuasion fails: Oedipus exposes Creon's real purpose and Creon reveals the seizure. The effect is open force, the elders' call to arms, and Theseus's arrival.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The turn is caused by Oedipus exposing Creon's aim: "Thou art come to take me, not to take me home, / But plant me on thy borders" (lines 803–804). With persuasion gone, Creon turns to force and reveals that a daughter is already taken (line 840). The effect is open conflict that the elders cannot stop, so they call for help ("Men of Athens, arm ye, arm!", line 928) and Theseus must answer.

8. How does "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" build on "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A cause-and-effect link: the ode praised Athens as able to defend its guest, and Antigone's first line calls on the land to make that praise good, so Episode 2 tests the ode.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The ode ended by praising Athens' strength. Antigone's first words turn the praise into a challenge: "O land extolled above all lands, 'tis now / For thee to make these glorious

titles good" (lines 740–741). The ode sets up the test: having boasted, the land must now prove it can defend its guest against Creon.

9. In "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about Creon seizes the daughters, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Creon claims grief and kinship, but his motive is political control of Oedipus; even his appeal to Athens' court is an excuse after the force.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Creon claims to come from grief: "of all Thebans I have most bewailed, / Being his kinsman, his most grievous woes" (lines 757–758). His actions show another motive: he has already taken one daughter and threatens to "Carry off this man" (line 897). Afterwards he says he trusted Athens' court, which "permits not vagrant folk / To stay within your borders" (lines 995–996). He reaches for any argument that excuses getting Oedipus back under Thebes' control.
10. Go back to the bell-ringer question (How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A revised answer that uses Oedipus's test of Creon, a favour offered only when it serves the giver, or the gap between Creon's tears and his seizure.
    Answer guidance: Model answer: I first said you can tell by tone of voice. Oedipus gives a better test: timing. A favour offered after it was refused when you needed it is "Fair in appearance, but when tested false" (line 801). Creon offered a home only once Oedipus became useful, and when refused he turned to force. Care that becomes force when it is declined was control all along.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does intent decide guilt? Evaluate Oedipus' argument in lines 1019–1023, using evidence from this scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An evaluation of Oedipus's argument that he cannot be blamed for killing a father he did not know, weighed against other evidence in the play (he calls the acts horrors; he must live with them), with a position and a counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: intent decides moral guilt, but not every consequence. Oedipus says he "met my sire, not knowing whom I met / Or what I did" (lines 1021–1022) and asks how Creon can "blame the all-unconscious hand" (line 1023). His example of a man turning on an attacker (lines 1040–1045) is persuasive. Counter-line: he still calls the acts "deeds of horror" (line 1008) and has lived with them, so the play separates blame from suffering rather than erasing the deed.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A stand with two lines: Theseus hands Creon to the laws he appealed to and condemns him for setting aside custom; a qualification that Theseus also uses force, but lawful force.
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: agree, with a qualification. Theseus will not punish Creon in rage; he condemns him for having "set aside the custom of the land" (line 959) and acting "like some freebooter" (line 960). The qualification is that Theseus also uses force, sending "foot and horse" after the captors (line 943). The scene does not oppose law to all force; it opposes lawful force to lawless seizure.
3. Which character in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" acts most wisely in the matter of Creon seizes the daughters, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think

alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named standard, such as restraint under provocation, applied to Theseus and Creon (or the elders), with a line for each.

Answer guidance: One defensible answer: by the standard of restraint, Theseus acts most wisely. His rage was "Justly provoked" (line 949), but he hands Creon to the law and first sends men after the maidens: "Quick, as I bid" (line 947). By the same standard Creon acts least wisely, boasting "Nothing shall curb my will" (line 913) in a foreign city. A student could also rank the elders highly for standing up to Creon unarmed: "Restore the maidens, else thou goest not" (line 893).

4. You are directing "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Creon seizes the daughters. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two staging choices tied to lines, such as father and daughter reaching for each other, Theseus's entrance cutting through the noise, or Oedipus's curse, each with its effect.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: (1) On "Thy hands, my child! / They will not let me, father" (lines 879–880), keep Oedipus and Antigone reaching toward each other with a guard's arm between them, a gap of a few feet the blind man cannot cross. The audience feels the cruelty without seeing violence. (2) Let Theseus enter at a run and stop the noise with one line, "Why this outcry? What is forward?" (line 931), standing still while everyone else moves. His calm shows the authority that will judge the seizure.

5. Write your own questions about "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Three questions answerable from lines 740–1091: one recall, one why/how and one should/what-if, different in kind.

   Answer guidance: Model set. Recall: Where was Theseus when the outcry called him? (At the altar of Poseidon, line 932.) Why/how: How does Creon justify the seizure? (He takes "what is mine," line 860, and later cites Athens' court, lines 993–996.) Should/what if: Should Theseus have punished Creon on the spot? (Answers weigh his justified anger, line 949, against his choice of law, lines 951–952.)

6. Connect "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)", with its focus on Creon seizes the daughters, to refuge and hospitality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment about refuge and hospitality, the question's theme. Creon violates both by seizing suppliants and guests of Athens, and Theseus defends them. A strong answer says what must still be proved.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the link is strong. Creon's crime is a crime against hospitality: Theseus accuses him of "Haling by force their suppliants, poor maids" (line 968), and Oedipus says Athens is "the land whence thou wast fain to steal / Their aged suppliant" (lines 1057–1058). But the link is still a promise. Theseus swears that "nothing save my death / Will stay my purpose to restore the maids" (lines 1088–1089). To strengthen it, Sophocles must show whether the host can keep that oath.

7. Is the conflict in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" effective in presenting Creon seizes the daughters, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment against a stated criterion, such as whether the conflict develops through argument as well as action, with one line that meets it and one that might miss it.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: effective, because the conflict is fought with arguments as well as hands. After the seizure comes a real trial of words: Oedipus asks whether Creon, if attacked, "Would'st thou, O man of justice, first inquire / If the assassin was perchance thy sire" (lines 1041–1042). Counter-

line: the quick insults “Insolence! / Insolence that thou must bear” (lines 925–926) may feel melodramatic. A reviewer could call that stretch heavy-handed, though it shows how fast order collapses.

8. Compare how “Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)” treats Creon seizes the daughters with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named comparison (a story of a government or family forcing an exile home) and one thing the episode sees that the other misses, tied to a line.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: News stories about governments demanding that exiles be handed back usually frame it as politics. Episode 2 sees the personal cruelty inside the politics: Creon calls Antigone and Ismene “those two crutches” (line 883), using the daughters a blind father leans on as leverage. The play shows how a political claim can be enforced by attacking the most private bonds.

9. Predict what “Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A prediction from two clues, Theseus’s riders sent after the captors and his oath to bring back the maids, about what the elders will sing while they wait, checked after reading.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Clue 1: Theseus has sent riders “To where the paths that packmen use diverge” (line 944), so a chase is under way offstage. Clue 2: he swears that nothing but his death will stop him (lines 1088–1089). Left behind with Oedipus, the elders will probably imagine the chase and pray for its outcome. After reading, students check whether the ode stays hopeful or turns to fear.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Creon seizes the daughters? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An adaptation that keeps the core: a powerful relative uses friendly persuasion, then force against dependants, to reclaim someone protected elsewhere, and a host answers with law. It names two details that must stay.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: A wealthy uncle visits a shelter, all concern and tears, to bring his estranged blind brother home. Refused, he has his men put the brother’s two caregivers into a car, and the shelter director calls the police and detains the uncle until they are brought back. Two things must stay: the switch from “soft words” (line 792) to force, and the host’s insistence that the law, not revenge, will judge (lines 951–952).

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who does Antigone first announce is approaching?

   A. Creon, coming with his company

   B. Theseus, riding back with armed horsemen

   C. A herald sent from Argos with a truce

   D. A priest assigned to tend the holy grove

Key: A (Creon, coming with his company)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus say of a man who lives withal content, when Creon urges a return to Thebes?

   A. He will be king of Thebes again this day

   B. He lives not ill who lives withal content

   C. He must pay a tribute already named by Creon

   D. He has already asked Theseus to send him home

   Key: B (He lives not ill who lives withal content)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Creon's line: “Command your _____; I am not your slave.”

   Key: minions

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Theseus's command: “Command my _____ leave the sacrifice”

   Key: liegemen

5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Creon first describe his errand to the elders?

   A. As a private visit of simple old friendship

   B. As a direct order issued by King Theseus

   C. As persuasion, commissioned by Thebes

   D. As a rite required to cleanse the holy grove

   Key: C (As persuasion, commissioned by Thebes)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What has already happened when Creon first boasts of his power over Oedipus?

   A. Theseus has already had Creon bound in chains

   B. The chorus has already fled and left the grove

   C. Oedipus has already been carried from the sanctuary

   D. One daughter is already in his men's hands

   Key: D (One daughter is already in his men's hands)

7. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus say Creon is “wrapping in soft words / Hard thoughts”? Use that wording.

   Sample answer: He means that the courtesy of the embassy hides a harsh purpose. After Creon has urged him to come home, Oedipus answers that Creon would “part us, wrapping in soft words / Hard thoughts” (lines 792–793). The “soft words” are the promises of kinship and Thebes; the “Hard thoughts” are the real plan, which is not a free homecoming. The line teaches students to hear the gap between the tone of the plea and the use Creon means to make of him.

8. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What does Creon mean by calling the two daughters the crutches that served Oedipus?

   A. They were his support in wandering, and Creon means to take that support away

   B. They have already been named joint rulers of Athens in Theseus's stead

   C. They are to serve from now on as priestesses assigned to the holy grove

   D. They will be sent as formal envoys to argue his case at Thebes

   Key: A (They were his support in wandering, and Creon means to take that support away)

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] How does Oedipus expose Creon's tongue as a tool of advantage rather than of right? Use the “front of brass” lines.

    Sample answer: He treats Creon's speech as a practised cover, not as justice. He opens, “O front of brass, thy subtle tongue would twist / To thy advantage every plea of right” (lines 779–780). “front of brass” makes the face itself a hard mask, and “twist / To thy advantage every plea of right” accuses Creon of turning legal or kinship claims into profit. The analysis is that the embassy's language of right is already, in Oedipus's hearing, a weapon.

10. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] How does this episode move from Creon's offer of a homecoming to Theseus's appeal to law? Use one quotation from Oedipus's refusal and one from Theseus's judgment.

    Sample answer: The episode begins with an offer that Oedipus names as a false taking, not a return: “Thou art come to take me, not to take me home, / But plant me on thy borders” (lines 803–804). After Creon turns from words to force, Theseus will not settle the wrong by private rage; “the laws to which himself appealed, / These and none other shall adjudicate” (lines 951–952). The movement is from a disguised embassy to a public legal answer: Athens will judge the seizure by law, not by impulse.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Why does Theseus rebuke Creon?

    A. He broke the law of Athens by using force

    B. He arrived later than he had promised Theseus

    C. He insulted Ismene's travel-worn clothing

    D. He refused to join the sacrifice at the altars

    Key: A (He broke the law of Athens by using force)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Theseus command his men to do as soon as he hears of the seizure?

    A. Burn the Theban tents along the whole border road

    B. Leave the sacrifice and hurry after the maidens

    C. Arrest Oedipus on a public charge of trespass here

    D. Hand Creon a rich tribute taken from the sacred grove

    Key: B (Leave the sacrifice and hurry after the maidens)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Theseus's line: “For every action _____ of law,”

    Key: warranty

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “And not by choice a _____; so much”

    Key: sojourner

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Until when does Theseus say Creon may not leave Attica?

    A. Until Oedipus agrees at last to travel home with him

    B. Until the chorus has sung Creon all the way out of the grove

    C. Until the maidens are fetched and produced in his sight

    D. Until Apollo sends a second and final sign to Athens

    Key: C (Until the maidens are fetched and produced in his sight)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Oedipus answer the charge of pollution?

    A. He says Creon alone is guilty of the past

    B. He admits that he planned the deed in full

    C. He says his mother gave him a direct order

D. He acted without knowing what he did

Key: D (He acted without knowing what he did)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Theseus refuse to let his just anger decide Creon's punishment on the spot? Quote his reason.
Sample answer: He admits that anger would have been fair, and then sets it aside for law. “As for this stranger, had I let my rage, / Justly provoked, have play, he had not ’scaped” (lines 948–949). The next move is the point: the very laws Creon appealed to will judge the case, rather than Theseus's personal wrath. Theseus will not become, in his own person, the kind of force he is condemning. The maidens must be restored, and the offence judged by the custom of the land.

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the force of Theseus comparing Creon to a plunderer who carries off what he likes?
A. It presents the seizure as lawless theft, not a lawful embassy
B. It praises Creon as a soldier doing no more than ordinary duty
C. It treats the violent act as a completed sacred rite of Thebes
D. It describes a fair and honoured exchange of guests between cities

Key: A (It presents the seizure as lawless theft, not a lawful embassy)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How do Antigone's words as she is taken make the violence plain? Use her cry and “Haled along by force”.
Sample answer: They turn the seizure from a claim of right into a physical wrong the audience can hear. Antigone cries, “Ah, woe is me, they drag me hence, O friends” (line 876), and when her father asks where she is, she answers, “Haled along by force” (line 878). “drag me hence” and “by force” leave no room for Creon's language of persuasion or ownership. The lines make the violence visible just when the chorus and, soon after, Theseus must answer it as a breach of the city's law.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Theseus's naming of Athens as a state that “champions right” answer Creon's use of force? Quote that line.
Sample answer: He defines the city not by might alone but by a public standard Creon has broken. “Unto a State that champions right and asks” (line 957) is followed by the demand that every action have the warranty of law. The point is not that Athens is merely stronger than Thebes in this grove, but that a guest-city which claims to champion right cannot let a stranger be despoiled by force. Theseus's rebuke therefore turns the seizure into a test of what kind of state Athens is.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Theseus call Creon's behaviour?
A. Like a freebooter carrying off plunder
B. Like a king's ordinary and lawful duty
C. Like a priest completing a required rite
D. Like a fair exchange of honoured guests

Key: A (Like a freebooter carrying off plunder)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's line: “But I _____ wed, unwilling speak.”
Key: unwitting

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Theseus's line: “_____ and uncorrected at my hands.”
Key: Scathless

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus say Creon has really come to do, rather than take him home?
A. To set him on the Theban throne again that very same day
B. To plant him on Thebes's borders, not to restore him as a free man

C. To ask Theseus for a formal military alliance against Argos

D. To offer him a lasting house inside the walls of Thebes

Key: B (To plant him on Thebes's borders, not to restore him as a free man)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Theseus promise Oedipus before leaving with Creon?

A. That he will send Oedipus back to Thebes at once that day

B. That he will leave Creon to be judged by the chorus alone now

C. That he will not abandon his purpose to restore the maidens

D. That he will hide the daughters in a place no citizen may name

Key: C (That he will not abandon his purpose to restore the maidens)

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the force of Oedipus's verdict, "Fair in appearance, but when tested false"? Quote the surrounding offer.

Sample answer: He judges Creon's boon as a thing that looks like grace and is not. After imagining a favour granted too late, he says, "Yet such the boon thou profferest now to me, / Fair in appearance, but when tested false" (lines 800–801). "Fair in appearance" names the polish of the plea; "when tested false" insists that the test is the real intent, which is to plant him on a border, not to take him home. The line is a standard for the whole embassy: sound must be tried against use.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What standard of conduct does Theseus say he would follow even on Theban soil? Quote the lines about violence and sanction.

Sample answer: He claims that even with a just claim he would not take his own by force without the city's leave. "Would never wrest by violence my own / Without the sanction of your State or King" (lines 971–972). The contrast is exact: Creon, on Attic ground, has already carried off suppliant maids. Theseus uses a hypothetical of his own restraint to expose Creon's act as a breach of the custom that should bind an outlander among a foreign folk, not as a private quarrel only.

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] After persuasion fails, what does Creon's turn to force show about his embassy?

A. He is surprised by his own men and tries at once to stop the whole seizure

B. He waits for Theseus's formal leave before anyone is taken from the grove

C. He offers himself as a willing hostage until the women can be fully heard

D. He was prepared to take the women if words did not suffice, and he claims them as his

Key: D (He was prepared to take the women if words did not suffice, and he claims them as his)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does intent decide guilt in the argument Oedipus makes in this scene? Evaluate his defence with evidence from more than one line.

Sample answer: Oedipus argues for a limited innocence: the deeds happened, but they were not chosen as crimes. He says he is "No willing sinner" (line 1010), and of the killing he asks how Creon can "With justice blame the all-unconscious hand?" (line 1023), since he "met my sire, not knowing whom I met / Or what I did" (lines 1021–1022). The argument is consistent with his earlier self-defence: knowledge and intent, not the bare fact, are what would make him the villain Creon wants Athens to see. A fair reading can admit the horror of the past and still hear that, on his terms, the unconscious hand is not the same as a planned crime.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Theseus's closing promise complete his legal rebuke of the seizure? Use the lines about his purpose to restore the maids.

Sample answer: The rebuke has already bound Creon to fetch the maidens and face the law; the close makes that restoration Theseus's own charge. He tells Oedipus to stay, "assured that nothing save my death / Will stay my purpose to restore the maids" (lines 1088–1089). The promise keeps the outcome still ahead of us, but it joins the king's person to the

standard he has named: a state that will not let force finish what persuasion began. Law is not only a speech against a freebooter; it is a purpose Theseus will not drop.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Theseus's line: "Without _____ or accomplices;"
Key: abettors

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Theseus's line: "I should behave as fits an _____"
Key: outlander

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Theseus mean by saying that a single man does not prevail against the State?

A. A private captor, even a prince, cannot overrule the city's law
B. Oedipus must now be sent away from Athens as a public burden
C. The chorus, not Theseus, will decide what is next done with Creon
D. Thebes has already legally claimed both daughters as its very own

Key: A (A private captor, even a prince, cannot overrule the city's law)

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus reject Creon's appeal to kinship as a reason to go back?

A. Oedipus has already accepted a Theban throne offered by his own sons
B. Creon ignored him in exile and now wants him as a tool, not as a free kinsman
C. Theseus has already forbidden any mention of Thebes inside the grove
D. Creon has brought the two sons themselves to plead the case in person

Key: B (Creon ignored him in exile and now wants him as a tool, not as a free kinsman)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does Theseus's image of a fowler taken in the toils he spread work as a warning to Creon?

A. It praises Creon as a skilled hunter already owed a lawful prize
B. It means Oedipus should leave the grove and hunt Creon down himself
C. It turns the captor into the one who will be caught by the plot he laid
D. It predicts that the daughters will choose to go of their own free will now

Key: C (It turns the captor into the one who will be caught by the plot he laid)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is Creon doing when he recites Oedipus's past before the Athenians?

A. He is openly confessing that Thebes was wholly wrong to drive Oedipus out
B. He is asking the chorus to judge only Creon's own earlier public crimes
C. He is offering a formal legal pardon if Oedipus will name both of his sons
D. He is trying to make the city reject the suppliant as polluted, so the seizure will seem justified

Key: D (He is trying to make the city reject the suppliant as polluted, so the seizure will seem justified)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does Theseus's metaphor of the fowler complete the turn from debate to pursuit? Quote "Hath ta'en the fowler in the toils he spread".
Sample answer: It pictures Creon's plot as a snare that will close on the man who set it. After saying "Enough of words" because the captors are already speeding (line 1065), Theseus orders Creon to lead the way: "the captor's caught, and fate / Hath ta'en the fowler in the toils he spread" (lines 1074–1075). The fowler is the hunter of birds; the toils are his own nets.

The metaphor makes the coming pursuit a reversal, not a second crime: the law of the state is imagined as catching the seizer in the device by which he seized.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Oedipus distinguish his past from Creon's present speech about it? Use evidence that keeps the focus on knowledge and intent.
Sample answer: He does not deny the facts; he denies that he chose them, and he accuses Creon of choosing the smear. Of his mother he says, "she was my mother; / I knew it not, nor she" (lines 1030–1031). Against Creon he adds, "Wittingly thou aspersest her and me" (line 1034). The contrast is between an unwilled past and a knowing present: Creon uses the story as a weapon before Athens, whereas Oedipus's claim is that he and his mother acted without that knowledge. The passage should be read as an argument about intent, not as an invitation to linger on the details.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Theseus separate Creon's violence from Thebes itself while still condemning the act? Use one quotation about Thebes and one about force against suppliants.
Sample answer: He will not let the crime be called Theban policy, and he will not soften the crime. "Yet not from Thebes this villainy was learnt; / Thebes is not wont to breed unrighteous sons" (lines 964–965). The same speech then names what Creon has in fact done: "Haling by force their suppliants, poor maids" (line 968). The distinction matters: Athens can rebuke a man for robbing a host-city and the gods without declaring war on a whole people. Force against suppliants is the wrong; Thebes is not made to stand in for that wrong.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How do the closing commands after "Enough of words" complete the episode's answer to the seizure? Use that cue and Theseus's claim about one man and the State.
Sample answer: The debate has defined the standard; the close turns it into action still in motion, not a finished rescue. "Enough of words; the captors speed amain, / While we the victims stand debating here" (lines 1065–1066). Theseus then goes with Creon and warns, "One man doth not prevail against the State" (line 1082). The seizure began as a private show of power in the grove; it ends, for this episode, with the city moving to recover the maidens and with the king's refusal to let one captor outtalk or outrun the law. The restoration itself remains a purpose, not yet a reported fact.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) develops the idea of Creon seizes the daughters. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" could deliver about Creon seizes the daughters. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Creon seizes the daughters in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of Creon seizes the daughters. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" could deliver about Creon seizes the daughters. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Creon seizes the daughters in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) suggests about Creon seizes the daughters. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" could deliver about Creon seizes the daughters. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Creon seizes the daughters in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses conflict in Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) to complicate the reader's understanding of Creon seizes the daughters. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" could deliver about Creon seizes the daughters. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Creon seizes the daughters in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)": each member takes one passage, quotes it,

and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Burghers, my noble friends, ye take alarm At my approach (I read it in your eyes), Fear nothing and refrain from angry words. I come with no ill purpose; I am old, And know the city whither I am come, Without a peer amongst the powers of Greece. It was by reason of my years that I Was chosen to persuade your guest and bring Him back to Thebes; not the delegate Of one man, but commissioned by the State, Since of all Thebans I have most bewailed, Being his kinsman, his most grievous woes.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "refrain" most nearly mean?

   A. hold back or keep from

   B. repeat more loudly

   C. write down for the record

   D. translate into another tongue

2. *Burghers, my noble friends, ye take alarm At my approach (I read it in your eyes), Fear nothing and refrain from angry words. I come with no ill purpose; I am old, And know the city whither I am come, Without a peer amongst the powers of Greece. It was by reason of my years that I Was chosen to persuade your guest and bring Him back to Thebes; not the delegate Of one man, but commissioned by the State, Since of all Thebans I have most bewailed, Being his kinsman, his most grievous woes. O listen to me, luckless Oedipus, Come home! The whole Cadmeian people claim With right to have thee back, I most of all, For most of all (else were I vile indeed) I mourn for thy misfortunes, seeing thee An aged outcast, wandering on and on, A beggar with one handmaid for thy stay. Ah! who had e'er imagined she could fall To such a depth of misery as this, To tend in penury thy stricken frame, A virgin ripe for wedlock, but unwed, A prey for any wanton ravisher? Seems it not cruel this reproach I cast On thee and on myself and all the race? Aye, but an open shame cannot be hid. Hide it, O hide it, Oedipus, thou canst. O, by our fathers' gods, consent I pray; Come back to Thebes, come to thy father's home, Bid Athens, as is meet, a fond farewell; Thebes thy old foster-mother claims thee first.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)"?

   A. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome

   B. Theseus agreeing that Creon may take the girls without trial

   C. Creon seizes the daughters

   D. A peaceful embassy that ends in a signed treaty

SAT key: 1. A (hold back or keep from); 2. C (Creon seizes the daughters)

Lesson 7: Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)

Focus: the rescue imagined

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

Background: The ode names Athenian holy places, such as the shore of the Eleusinian rites, to set the rescue in Athens' own landscape.

Significance: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The elders imagine the rescue they cannot join, asking for a dove's vantage as Theseus meets the robber band and brings the captives home.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
7 key words in context.
Today's words: acolytes — assistants in religious rites; fray — a fight or battle; mystic — relating to secret religious rites; known only to the initiated; secrecy — the state of being kept hidden or private; scaur — a steep rock face or cliff; presage — a sign or feeling that something, often something bad, is about to happen; dappled — marked with patches or spots of different color or shade.
Words: acolytes: assistants in religious rites · fray: a fight or battle · mystic: relating to secret religious rites; known only to the initiated · secrecy: the state of being kept hidden or private · scaur: a steep rock face or cliff · presage: a sign or feeling that something, often something bad, is about to happen · dappled: marked with patches or spots of different color or shade

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The ode names Athenian holy places, such as the shore of the Eleusinian rites, to set the rescue in Athens' own landscape. They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Imagery: The elders picture the chase as if they could see it: Theseus meeting the robber band, the captive maidens, and the wish for the wings of a dove to gaze on the fray from the clouds above. Tone / mood: The ode is urgent prayer and longing, not report: they call on Zeus and Athena for victory while the rescue is still happening out of their sight. Structure: The action of the rescue is off stage. The chorus holds the interval by imagining the battle, seeing it in their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Watch for the sacred grove and the hidden grave: The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the rescue imagined.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and..." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders imagine they might, by chance, see Theseus, their bold captain, meet the robber band before those men flee, and rescue the two captive girls. Next, craft. I notice the grammar stays in hope: "might chance behold," "Ere they have fled," and "Rescue" is the object of a wish, not a report that the fight is over. The strongest word is "chance": "might chance" keeps the meeting possible, not finished; the boldness is pictured, not yet witnessed. Then, effect. What do lines 1106–1111 reveal about the rescue imagined? My answer: They imagine the rescue with their minds, still from the grove: confidence in Theseus, and the fact that, for now, they can only sing what they cannot watch.

> *There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain* *(Stasimon 2, lines 1106–1111)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and…" slowly and put it in my own words: The elders imagine they might, by chance, see Theseus, their bold captain, meet the robber band before those men flee, and rescue the two captive girls. Next, craft. I notice the grammar stays in hope: "might chance behold," "Ere they have fled," and "Rescue" is the object of a wish, not a report that the fight is over. The strongest word is "chance": "might chance" keeps the meeting possible, not finished; the boldness is pictured, not yet witnessed. Then, effect. What do lines 1106–1111 reveal about the rescue imagined? My answer: They imagine the rescue with their minds, still from the grove: confidence in Theseus, and the fact that, for now, they can only sing what they cannot watch.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Wings", "upwards" and "clouds" stand out. "O for the wings, the wings of a dove" is a wish, not a fact; "upwards" and "from the clouds above" place the elders at a safe height from which to "gaze on the fray." They wish for a dove's wings so they could watch the fight they cannot join (Chorus, lines 1134–1137). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected student answer: The chorus, having granted refuge, now longs only to watch from safety as Theseus fights to keep that promise; hospitality has become a battle they hope to see won.

> *O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above (Stasimon 2, lines 1134–1137)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Wings", "upwards" and "clouds" stand out. "O for the wings, the wings of a dove" is a wish, not a fact; "upwards" and "from the clouds above" place the elders at a safe height from which to "gaze on the fray." They wish for a dove's wings so they could watch the fight they cannot join (Chorus, lines 1134–1137).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected student answer: The chorus, having granted refuge, now longs only to watch from safety as Theseus fights to keep that promise; hospitality has become a battle they hope to see won.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for imagery, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the rescue imagined? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) develops the idea of the rescue imagined. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. When the text says "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain" (Stasimon 2, lines 1106–1111), it shows this directly. The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the rescue imagined? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) develops the idea of the rescue imagined. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Access supports: Access supports (not a legal-compliance promise). These are teaching options for English learners and for students with IEP or 504 needs; they do not replace a student's plan, and using them does not by itself satisfy any legal requirement. Chunked reading: the wish to "behold the fray" (lines 1095–1111) first, then the dove-wish (lines 1134–1137), and mark every verb of hoping, not reporting. Sentence frames: "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold" (lines 1106–1107) is a wish, not a report, because the words "___" show ___. / "O for the wings, the wings of a dove" (line 1134) places the elders ___. Graphic organizer: two columns (what they imagine / what they can actually see from the grove) with quoted lines. Time: extended time on the quiz and CER. Audio: hear the stasimon twice and raise a hand at each "might" or "chance."

Exemplar: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. When the text says "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain" (Stasimon 2, lines 1106–1111), it shows this directly. The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control? Ask: What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control?

Anchor question: What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control?

Facilitation: Ask: What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the rescue imagined? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. ("There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main", Stasimon 2, lines 1106–1111). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the rescue imagined? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. ("There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main", Stasimon 2, lines 1106–1111). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the rescue imagined. Key takeaway: The elders imagine the rescue they cannot join, asking for a dove's vantage as Theseus meets the robber band and brings the captives home.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The elders picture the chase as if they could see it: Theseus meeting the robber band, the captive maidens, and the wish for the wings of a dove to gaze on the fray from the clouds above.
- **Tone / mood:** The ode is urgent prayer and longing, not report: they call on Zeus and Athena for victory while the rescue is still happening out of their sight.
- **Structure:** The action of the rescue is off stage. The chorus holds the interval by imagining the battle, seeing it in their minds, like the blind Oedipus.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the rescue imagined.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the rescue imagined.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain" (Stasimon 2, lines 1106–1111) The chorus longs to see Theseus overtake the abductors before the captured maidens are gone.

- "O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above" (Stasimon 2, lines 1134–1137) They wish for a dove's wings so they could watch the fight from safety above the fray.
- "O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay" (Stasimon 2, lines 1092–1093) The song turns on the hope that the fleeing raiders will at last be forced to stand.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus.
Evidence: "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain" (Stasimon 2, lines 1106–1111)
Reasoning: The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1092–1093
1092 **Chorus:** O when the flying foe,
1093 **Chorus:** Turning at last to bay,

Lines 1092–1105
1092 **Chorus:** O when the flying foe,
1093 **Chorus:** Turning at last to bay,
1094 **Chorus:** Soon will give blow for blow.
1095 **Chorus:** Might I behold the fray;
1096 **Chorus:** Hear the loud battle roar,
1097 **Chorus:** Swell, on the Pythian shore,
1098 **Chorus:** Or by the torch-lit bay,
1099 **Chorus:** Where the dread Queen and Maid
1100 **Chorus:** Cherish the mystic rites,
1101 **Chorus:** Rites they to none betray,
1102 **Chorus:** Ere on his lips is laid
1103 **Chorus:** Secrecy's golden key
1104 **Chorus:** By their own acolytes,
1105 **Chorus:** Priestly Eumolpidae.

Lines 1092–1111
1092 **Chorus:** O when the flying foe,
1093 **Chorus:** Turning at last to bay,
1094 **Chorus:** Soon will give blow for blow.
1095 **Chorus:** Might I behold the fray;
1096 **Chorus:** Hear the loud battle roar,
1097 **Chorus:** Swell, on the Pythian shore,
1098 **Chorus:** Or by the torch-lit bay,
1099 **Chorus:** Where the dread Queen and Maid
1100 **Chorus:** Cherish the mystic rites,

1101 **Chorus:** Rites they to none betray,
1102 **Chorus:** Ere on his lips is laid
1103 **Chorus:** Secrecy's golden key
1104 **Chorus:** By their own acolytes,
1105 **Chorus:** Priestly Eumolpidae.
1106 **Chorus:** There I might chance behold
1107 **Chorus:** Theseus our captain bold
1108 **Chorus:** Meet with the robber band,
1109 **Chorus:** Ere they have fled the land,
1110 **Chorus:** Rescue by might and main
1111 **Chorus:** Maidens, the captives twain.

Lines 1092–1152

1092 **Chorus:** O when the flying foe,
1093 **Chorus:** Turning at last to bay,
1094 **Chorus:** Soon will give blow for blow.
1095 **Chorus:** Might I behold the fray;
1096 **Chorus:** Hear the loud battle roar,
1097 **Chorus:** Swell, on the Pythian shore,
1098 **Chorus:** Or by the torch-lit bay,
1099 **Chorus:** Where the dread Queen and Maid
1100 **Chorus:** Cherish the mystic rites,
1101 **Chorus:** Rites they to none betray,
1102 **Chorus:** Ere on his lips is laid
1103 **Chorus:** Secrecy's golden key
1104 **Chorus:** By their own acolytes,
1105 **Chorus:** Priestly Eumolpidae.
1106 **Chorus:** There I might chance behold
1107 **Chorus:** Theseus our captain bold
1108 **Chorus:** Meet with the robber band,
1109 **Chorus:** Ere they have fled the land,
1110 **Chorus:** Rescue by might and main
1111 **Chorus:** Maidens, the captives twain.
1112 **Chorus:** Haply on swiftest steed,
1113 **Chorus:** Or in the flying car,
1114 **Chorus:** Now they approach the glen,
1115 **Chorus:** West of white Oea's scaur.
1116 **Chorus:** They will be vanquishèd:
1117 **Chorus:** Dread are our warriors, dread
1118 **Chorus:** Theseus our chieftain's men.
1119 **Chorus:** Flashes each bridle bright,
1120 **Chorus:** Charges each gallant knight,
1121 **Chorus:** All that our Queen adore,
1122 **Chorus:** Pallas their patron, or

1123 **Chorus:** Him whose wide floods enring
1124 **Chorus:** Earth, the great Ocean-king
1125 **Chorus:** Whom Rhea bore.
1126 **Chorus:** Fight they or now prepare
1127 **Chorus:** To fight? a vision rare
1128 **Chorus:** Tells me that soon again
1129 **Chorus:** I shall behold the twain
1130 **Chorus:** Maidens so ill bestead,
1131 **Chorus:** By their kin buffeted.
1132 **Chorus:** Today, today Zeus worketh some great thing
1133 **Chorus:** This day shall victory bring.
1134 **Chorus:** O for the wings, the wings of a dove,
1135 **Chorus:** To be borne with the speed of the gale,
1136 **Chorus:** Up and still upwards to sail
1137 **Chorus:** And gaze on the fray from the clouds above.
1138 **Chorus:** All-seeing Zeus, O lord of heaven,
1139 **Chorus:** To our guardian host be given
1140 **Chorus:** Might triumphant to surprise
1141 **Chorus:** Flying foes and win their prize.
1142 **Chorus:** Hear us, Zeus, and hear us, child
1143 **Chorus:** Of Zeus, Athenè undefiled,
1144 **Chorus:** Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear,
1145 **Chorus:** Huntress, sister of Apollo,
1146 **Chorus:** Who the dappled swift-foot deer
1147 **Chorus:** O'er the wooded glade dost follow;
1148 **Chorus:** Help with your two-fold power
1149 **Chorus:** Athens in danger's hour!
1150 **Chorus:** O wayfarer, thou wilt not have to tax
1151 **Chorus:** The friends who watch for thee with false presage,
1152 **Chorus:** For lo, an escort with the maids draws near.

Line 1095
1095 **Chorus:** Might I behold the fray;

Lines 1106–1111
1106 **Chorus:** There I might chance behold
1107 **Chorus:** Theseus our captain bold
1108 **Chorus:** Meet with the robber band,
1109 **Chorus:** Ere they have fled the land,
1110 **Chorus:** Rescue by might and main
1111 **Chorus:** Maidens, the captives twain.

Lines 1120–1121
1120 **Chorus:** Charges each gallant knight,
1121 **Chorus:** All that our Queen adore,

Lines 1123–1125

1123 **Chorus:** Him whose wide floods enring
1124 **Chorus:** Earth, the great Ocean-king
1125 **Chorus:** Whom Rhea bore.

Lines 1126–1127

1126 **Chorus:** Fight they or now prepare
1127 **Chorus:** To fight? a vision rare

Line 1132

1132 **Chorus:** Today, today Zeus worketh some great thing

Line 1133

1133 **Chorus:** This day shall victory bring.

Line 1134

1134 **Chorus:** O for the wings, the wings of a dove,

Lines 1134–1137

1134 **Chorus:** O for the wings, the wings of a dove,
1135 **Chorus:** To be borne with the speed of the gale,
1136 **Chorus:** Up and still upwards to sail
1137 **Chorus:** And gaze on the fray from the clouds above.

Line 1135

1135 **Chorus:** To be borne with the speed of the gale,

Lines 1138–1147

1138 **Chorus:** All-seeing Zeus, O lord of heaven,
1139 **Chorus:** To our guardian host be given
1140 **Chorus:** Might triumphant to surprise
1141 **Chorus:** Flying foes and win their prize.
1142 **Chorus:** Hear us, Zeus, and hear us, child
1143 **Chorus:** Of Zeus, Athenè undefiled,
1144 **Chorus:** Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear,
1145 **Chorus:** Huntress, sister of Apollo,
1146 **Chorus:** Who the dappled swift-foot deer
1147 **Chorus:** O'er the wooded glade dost follow;

Line 1151

1151 **Chorus:** The friends who watch for thee with false presage,

Line 1152

1152 **Chorus:** For lo, an escort with the maids draws near.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
acolytes (noun)	assistants in religious rites	*Secrecy's golden key / By their own acolytes,*
fray (noun)	a fight or battle	*O for the wings, the wings of a dove, To be borne with the speed of the gale, Up and still upwards to sail And gaze on the fray from the clouds above.*
mystic (adjective)	relating to secret religious rites; known only to the initiated	*Cherish the mystic rites, / Rites they to none betray,*
secrecy (noun)	the state of being kept hidden or private	*Secrecy's golden key / By their own acolytes,*
scaur (noun)	a steep rock face or cliff	*Now they approach the glen, / West of white Oea's scaur.*
presage (noun)	a sign or feeling that something, often something bad, is about to happen	*O wayfarer, thou wilt not have to tax / The friends who watch for thee with false presage,*
dappled (adjective)	marked with patches or spots of different color or shade	*Who the dappled swift-foot deer / O'er the wooded glade dost follow;*

Discussion questions

1. What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with refuge and hospitality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What bird do the elders wish to be like? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A dove.
   Answer guidance: A dove.
2. What priestly house does the ode name as laying secrecy's key on the rites' lips? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The Eumolpidae
   Answer guidance: The Eumolpidae.
3. What deer does the ode say the huntress follows through the wooded glade? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The dappled swift-foot deer
   Answer guidance: The dappled swift-foot deer.

4. What power does the chorus ask the paired gods to lend Athens, in danger's hour? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Their two-fold power
   Answer guidance: Their two-fold power.
5. How, besides on a swift steed, does the ode imagine the captors approaching the glen? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** In the flying car
   Answer guidance: In the flying car.
6. What does the ode say Zeus worketh, on this very day? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Some great thing
   Answer guidance: Some great thing.
7. Where does the chorus wish to gaze on the fray, once borne upward? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** From the clouds above
   Answer guidance: From the clouds above.
8. What does the flying foe do, in the ode's opening picture, before blows are exchanged? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Turns at last to bay
   Answer guidance: Turns at last to bay.
9. What does the chorus wish it might behold, besides hearing the battle roar? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The fray itself
   Answer guidance: The fray itself.
10. To whom, besides Zeus, does the chorus cry 'hear us' in the later strophe? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The child of Zeus
    Answer guidance: The child of Zeus.

Inferential / analytical

1. How is the ode like Oedipus' blindness? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The elders must imagine a battle they cannot see, as Oedipus must "see" through others: they rely on inner vision.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders cannot see the battle; they can only wish, "Might I behold the fray" (line 1095), and picture it, much as blind Oedipus must picture what others tell him. Their "vision rare" (line 1127) is inner sight, the kind Oedipus claimed when he said a blind man's words would be "instinct with sight" (line 74).
2. What does "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" suggest about the rescue imagined? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An inference that the elders imagine the rescue as already won with the gods' help: hope becomes confidence, which shows their new loyalty to the guest.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders move from wishing to seeing to near certainty: "Today, today Zeus worketh some great thing / This day shall victory bring" (lines 1132–1133). The ode suggests that the rescue, still unseen, is already won in their faith, and that the elders who once wanted the stranger gone now pray for his daughters to be brought back to him.

3. Find one example of imagery in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)". What does it reveal about the rescue imagined that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** One image, such as the torch-lit bay of the mysteries, the flashing bridles or the dove's wings, explained for what it reveals beyond a plain statement.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders picture the chase passing "the torch-lit bay, / Where the dread Queen and Maid / Cherish the mystic rites" (lines 1098–1100), the holy shore of the Eleusinian mysteries. The image shows that the captors are fleeing across Athens' holiest ground, so the seizure is an offence against sacred land, and the rescue becomes a defence of the holy places as well as of two girls.

4. How does the tone / mood in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" shape what we understand about the rescue imagined? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** How the mood moves from restless questions to confidence, prayer and relief, so the audience lives through the suspense of waiting.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The ode begins restless and full of questions ("Fight they or now prepare / To fight?", lines 1126–1127), rises to confidence ("This day shall victory bring," line 1133) and settles into prayer (lines 1138–1149). The shifting mood lets the audience live through the suspense of waiting, so the sighting at line 1152 lands as relief.

5. In the passage that opens with "O when the flying…", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two words from lines 1092–1111 with their connotations, such as "flying foe," "robber band," "captives" or "captain bold," showing how the elders frame Creon's men as fleeing thieves.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders call Creon's men "the robber band" (line 1108) and the daughters "the captives twain" (line 1111). "Robber" turns a ruler's guards into common thieves, and "captives" stresses that the girls were taken against their will. The diction judges the seizure as a crime, not as politics.

6. What causes the main turn in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The ode's turn from imagining the fight to prayer, and finally to the sighting of the escort, and its effect: the play moves from danger back toward reunion.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The ode turns from picturing the fight to prayer: "All-seeing Zeus, O lord of heaven, / To our guardian host be given / Might triumphant" (lines 1138–1140). Its last line turns again, this time into news: "For lo, an escort with the maids draws near" (line 1152). The effect is to carry the audience from fear to certainty and to bring the action back on stage.

7. How does "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" build on "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A causal link: Theseus left to follow the captors, so the chase happens offstage and the elders, left behind, must imagine it.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Episode 2 ended with Theseus leaving because "the captors speed amain, / While we the victims stand debating here" (lines 1065–1066). Because the chase happens offstage, the elders can only imagine it: "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band" (lines 1106–1108). The departure in Episode 2 causes the ode's way of seeing.

8. In "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the rescue imagined, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An inference about the elders' motive: they claim

to want only to watch, but their prayers show fear for Athens and a wish that their word to the guest prove true.

Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders say they only want to watch, from above: "And gaze on the fray from the clouds above" (line 1137). Their prayers show deeper motives. They fear for the city, and at the end they turn to the guest and promise that their watch for him was not in vain (lines 1150–1151). They care that the word they gave him proves true.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A revised answer based on what the elders actually do while waiting (imagine, pray, encourage one another), with a line.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: My first answer was distraction. The ode suggests something better: shared imagination and prayer. The elders picture the fight in detail and then hand it to the gods: "Hear us, Zeus, and hear us, child / Of Zeus, Athenè undefiled" (lines 1142–1143). Waiting together and naming what they hope for keeps them from despair.

10. Where does structure appear in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)", and how does it connect the rescue imagined to the larger concern with refuge and hospitality? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Where the ode's structure (imagined chase, then certainty, then prayer, then the escort sighted) appears, and how it connects to refuge and hospitality: the song ends by reassuring the guest that his hosts kept faith.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: The ode is built as a journey: from the battle the elders imagine (lines 1092–1131), to confident prayer (lines 1132–1149), to the sight of the escort (line 1152). Its last lines turn to the guest himself: "O wayfarer, thou wilt not have to tax / The friends who watch for thee with false presage" (lines 1150–1151). The structure ends on hospitality kept: the hosts' promise, once in doubt, is about to be proved.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the ode make Theseus a hero? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A defended view: the ode pictures Theseus as heroic and backed by the gods, but it is imagined by people who cannot see, so a counterpoint about praise before the fact belongs here.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: yes, in the elders' imagination. They call him "Theseus our captain bold" (line 1107) and his men "Dread" (line 1117), and they pray that his host be given "Might triumphant" (line 1140). Counter-line: everything is imagined. At this point the heroism is hoped for, not seen, so the ode makes Theseus a hero only if the next scene confirms it.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A stand with two lines: the elders imagine what they cannot see, but unlike Oedipus they long for physical sight.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: partly agree. They do see with the mind: "a vision rare / Tells me that soon again / I shall behold the twain" (lines 1127–1129). But unlike Oedipus, who trusts inner sight, they long for real sight and wish "To be borne with the speed of the gale" (line 1135) so they could watch. Their mental vision is a substitute they would gladly trade, not a deeper kind of seeing.

3. No one acts in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)"; the elders imagine others acting. Whose conduct in the imagined rescue does the ode present as wisest, and whose as least wise? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named standard applied to two figures the ode imagines (Theseus and his riders, the fleeing "robber band," or the elders themselves), with lines.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: by the standard of courage in a just cause, the ode presents Theseus and his riders as wisest, charging to bring back "Maidens, the captives twain" (line 1111). The "flying foe" (line 1092) are least wise: they have carried off suppliants from a protected land and must at last turn "to bay" (line 1093). A student could argue that the elders show a different wisdom: they know they cannot fight, and they turn to prayer (lines 1138–1149).

4. You are directing "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the rescue imagined. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two staging choices tied to lines, such as the chorus sweeping across the stage as riders or turning as one when the escort is sighted, each with its effect.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: (1) For "Haply on swiftest steed, / Or in the flying car" (lines 1112–1113), split the chorus into two groups that sweep across the stage, as if the elders' imagination were drawing the chase in front of us. (2) On "For lo, an escort with the maids draws near" (line 1152), have the chorus freeze and turn together toward the entrance while Oedipus, who cannot see, turns a beat late. The audience sees the relief and the blind man's dependence at once.

5. Write your own questions about "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Three questions answerable from lines 1092–1152: one recall, one why/how and one should/what-if, different in kind.

   Answer guidance: Model set. Recall: Which gods do the elders call on at the end? (Zeus, Athena, Apollo and Artemis, lines 1138–1147.) Why/how: Why do the elders wish for a dove's wings (line 1134)? (To see a fight they cannot watch.) Should/what if: Should the elders have followed Theseus instead of staying? (Answers weigh their age against their duty to guard the guest.)

6. Connect "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)", with its focus on the rescue imagined, to guilt and intent: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment about guilt and intent, the question's theme. The ode does not argue Oedipus's guilt; it judges the captors by their acts and intent, so the link is indirect. A strong answer says what must come next.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the link is indirect. The ode does not return to Oedipus's own guilt; it judges the seizure by its intent, calling the captors "the robber band" (line 1108) and the girls "Maidens so ill bestead, / By their kin buffeted" (lines 1130–1131). That phrase blames kin who meant harm, the reverse of Oedipus, who harmed kin without knowing. To strengthen the link, Sophocles would need a scene where guilt and intent are argued again in person.

7. Is the imagery in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" effective in presenting the rescue imagined, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment of the imagery against a stated criterion (does it make an offstage battle visible, or pile up names?), with one line that meets it and one passage that might miss it.

Answer guidance: One defensible answer: effective, because the images let the audience see an offstage battle: "Flashes each bridle bright, / Charges each gallant knight" (lines 1119–1120) puts the charge in front of us. Counter-line: the long list of holy places and rites (lines 1097–1105) may feel like a catalogue to modern readers. A reviewer might call it heavy-handed unless the class sees these as the sacred sites of Athens' own land.

8. Compare how "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" treats the rescue imagined with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named comparison (people waiting for news of a rescue, in a story, film or real event) and one thing the ode sees that the other misses, tied to a line.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Compare a family in a film listening to a rescue on the radio. The ode sees what such scenes often miss: waiting can be an act of loyalty and faith, not only nerves. The elders turn their fear into a prayer for the whole city, "Help with your two-fold power / Athens in danger's hour!" (lines 1148–1149), so their waiting becomes part of keeping faith with their guest.

9. Predict what "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A prediction from two clues, the escort sighted with the maids and the elders' confidence in Theseus, about the next scene, checked after reading.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Clue 1: "For lo, an escort with the maids draws near" (line 1152), so the next scene will almost certainly open with a reunion. Clue 2: the elders prayed that Theseus's men be given "Might triumphant" (line 1140), so Theseus will probably come back the victor and Oedipus will owe him thanks. A sharper prediction asks how Oedipus can repay a debt this large.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the rescue imagined? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An adaptation that keeps the core: people who cannot act wait for news of a rescue, imagining it and praying, and end by reassuring the person they protect. It names two details that must stay.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: Neighbours gather in a kitchen while police chase a car that took two girls from a shelter. They picture the chase street by street, pray, and finally see headlights bringing the girls back. Two things must stay: the group's imagined view of an action it cannot see ("Might I behold the fray," line 1095), and its reassurance to the girls' blind father that it kept faith with him (lines 1150–1151).

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders imagine?

   A. The chase and rescue of the daughters

   B. A wedding feast held inside the grove

C. A funeral already held for Oedipus himself

D. A formal trial of Creon before the chorus

Key: A (The chase and rescue of the daughters)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom do the elders picture rescuing the maidens?

   A. Creon

   B. Theseus

   C. Ismene

   D. The robber band

   Key: B (Theseus)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "West of white Oea's _____."

   Key: scaur

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "Flashes each _____ bright,"

   Key: bridle

5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What do the elders wish for in lines 1134–1137?

   A. A sword to join the fight themselves

   B. A ship to carry Oedipus from Athens

   C. Wings to watch the battle from above

   D. A new king to replace Theseus at once

   Key: C (Wings to watch the battle from above)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Where do the elders first imagine they might chance to behold the meeting?

   A. Inside the very walls of Thebes itself

   B. At Oedipus's still unnamed future resting-place

   C. On the long road back toward the Argive camp

   D. On the Pythian shore or by the torch-lit bay

   Key: D (On the Pythian shore or by the torch-lit bay)

7. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Why do the elders long to "behold the fray"? Use that wording.

   Sample answer: They are still in the grove, and the fight they hope for is happening out of their sight. The ode opens with a wish, "Might I behold the fray" (line 1095), not with a report that the battle has already been won. The longing shows both eagerness and distance: they want to see blow given for blow, yet they can only imagine the roar on the Pythian shore or the torch-lit bay. The line makes the stasimon a song of looking, not a messenger's account.

8. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What does the opening picture of a flying foe brought finally to stand suggest?

   A. The fleeing captors will be forced to stand and fight

   B. The Theban men have already sailed safely out of Attica

   C. The maidens have already chosen to go of their own free will

   D. The chorus means that the chase will not come to blows at all

   Key: A (The fleeing captors will be forced to stand and fight)

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] How does the wish for "the wings, the wings of a dove" work in the ode? Use the line about gazing from the clouds.

   Sample answer: It turns longing into a picture of height and speed, not into a claim that the elders can actually go. They cry, "O for the wings, the wings of a dove" (line 1134), and they want to "gaze on the fray from the clouds above" (line 1137). The repeated "wings" and the upward sail lift them, in imagination, over a fight they cannot see from the grove. The image keeps the rescue still offstage: what they ask for is a view, not a sword in their own hands.

10. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Why is the ode placed here? Use the closing line about the escort.

    Sample answer: It covers the time while the pursuit is still happening out of sight, and then it turns, at the last, toward a sign that help is near. Through most of the song the elders only imagine and pray; they have not yet watched the meeting they long to behold. The close changes the tense of hope: "For lo, an escort with the maids draws near" (line 1152). The ode therefore both fills the offstage interval and, without narrating the reunion itself, lets the hoped-for rescue begin to come into view.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What is the mood of the ode?

    A. Eager and anxious
    B. Bored and already indifferent
    C. Bitter toward Theseus and Athens
    D. Comic at the expense of the maidens

    Key: A (Eager and anxious)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Besides Zeus, whom do the elders name in the closing prayer for help?

    A. Creon, the robber band, and the whole Theban State
    B. Athenè, Apollo, and the Huntress, sister of Apollo
    C. Ismene, Antigone, and the watching wayfarer alone
    D. The Eumolpidae only, without naming any Olympian god

    Key: B (Athenè, Apollo, and the Huntress, sister of Apollo)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "They will be _____:"

    Key: vanquishèd

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Maidens so ill _____,"

    Key: bestead

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the chorus say a vision tells them they shall soon do?

    A. See Oedipus crowned again in Thebes
    B. Watch Creon take Theseus as a captive
    C. Behold the two maidens again
    D. Follow the daughters back toward Thebes in haste

    Key: C (Behold the two maidens again)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why do the elders mention the torch-lit bay and the priestly Eumolpidae?

    A. To announce that the mystic rites have already been betrayed
    B. To claim that Theseus has already reached the Theban gates

C. To replace the rescue with a new festival at Colonus

D. To set the hoped-for meeting in Athens' own sacred landscape

Key: D (To set the hoped-for meeting in Athens' own sacred landscape)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How is the ode like Oedipus's blindness? Use one quotation about a vision of beholding.

    Sample answer: The elders, like Oedipus, must see what they cannot look at with their own eyes. They say that "a vision rare / Tells me that soon again / I shall behold the twain" (lines 1127–1129): the sight is told by a vision, and the beholding is still "soon", not already in their hands. The song therefore does with lyric vision what the blind man does with inner sight: it pictures a rescue still offstage. The likeness is in the mode of seeing, not in a claim that the meeting has already been won and told.

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of the questions "Fight they or now prepare / To fight?"

    A. They keep the action offstage and uncertain, a hope rather than a report

    B. They prove that the battle has already ended in a Theban victory now

    C. They tell the audience that Theseus has refused to leave the altar yet

    D. They turn the whole ode into a comic delay before a wedding song

    Key: A (They keep the action offstage and uncertain, a hope rather than a report)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the wording of "Charges each gallant knight, / All that our Queen adore" build confidence? Quote it.

    Sample answer: The lines turn the unseen chase into a bright, loyal charge under a goddess's care. "Charges each gallant knight, / All that our Queen adore" (lines 1120–1121) makes every rider both brave and devoted: they charge, and they belong to the Queen they adore, Pallas. The present tense "Charges" is visionary, not a messenger's past tense, and it supports the hope that the flying foe will be stopped by men who ride in the city's service. Confidence is built by motion and piety together, still as a picture in the mind.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the closing prayer complete the imagined chase? Use the lines that call on Zeus, Athenè, Apollo, and the Huntress.

    Sample answer: After picturing horse and chase, the elders turn the vision into a petition. They cry, "Hear us, Zeus, and hear us, child / Of Zeus, Athenè undefiled," and they add, "Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear, / Huntress, sister of Apollo" (lines 1142–1145). The stacked "Hear" gathers the city's gods while the fight is still unseen. The chase is no longer only a scene they wish to watch; it is handed to the gods they name. Hope becomes prayer, still before the escort is seen.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who is "Him whose wide floods enring / Earth, the great Ocean-king / Whom Rhea bore"?

    A. Poseidon, the sea-god, son of Rhea

    B. Apollo, the hunter named later in the prayer

    C. Theseus, already called the captain of the host

    D. Zeus alone, with no other god beside him

    Key: A (Poseidon, the sea-god, son of Rhea)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "By their kin _____."

    Key: buffeted

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "To be borne with the speed of the _____,"

    Key: gale

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the chorus add by saying the captured maidens have been struck and driven by their own family?

    A. A foreign army from Argos has already claimed them

    B. Their own kinsman has struck them; the captors are family

    C. The chorus itself has driven the daughters from the grove

    D. The maidens have struck Theseus's men in the glen

    Key: B (Their own kinsman has struck them; the captors are family)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What change occurs in the closing address to the wayfarer?

    A. The chorus announces that the daughters have already been led back to Thebes

    B. Oedipus is told that his death has already come in the grove

    C. Hope begins to be confirmed: an escort with the maids is said to draw near

    D. Theseus is said to have kept the resting-place hidden from them all

    Key: C (Hope begins to be confirmed: an escort with the maids is said to draw near)

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the force of "Today, today Zeus worketh some great thing"? Quote the paired line about victory.

    Sample answer: The doubled "Today" presses the hoped-for rescue into the present, as if the god were already at work, though the elders have not yet seen the fight. "Today, today Zeus worketh some great thing / This day shall victory bring" (lines 1132–1133). "Worketh" and "shall" together hold present act and still-future result: they do not narrate a victory already won, but they stake this very day on one. The force of the cry is urgency and faith, the mood of a prayer spoken while the chase is still elsewhere.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How do "Secrecy's golden key" and the mystic rites belong in an ode about a chase? Quote the lines about the key.

    Sample answer: They plant the imagined meeting in a holy Attic landscape, not on a nameless road. After the torch-lit bay where the Queen and Maid cherish rites betrayed to none, the chorus says that "Secrecy's golden key" is laid on the worshipper's lips "By their own acolytes, / Priestly Eumolpidae" (lines 1103–1105). The secrecy of Eleusis does not hide the rescue from us; it marks the ground as Athens' own, a place of guarded rites beside which Theseus might meet the robber band. Geography here is religious, and that makes the hoped-for recovery a defence of sacred land as well as of two captives.

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the catalogue of Pallas and the Ocean-king add to the picture of the riders?

    A. It replaces Theseus with Poseidon as the one and only rescuer in the ode

    B. It proves that the mystic rites have already been fully told to Thebes

    C. It means the chase will be fought at sea, and not at all on land

    D. It sets the horsemen under Athens' own divine patrons, not under a nameless luck

    Key: D (It sets the horsemen under Athens' own divine patrons, not under a nameless luck)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Does the ode make Theseus a hero? Defend your view. Use the lines about the dread warriors and his men.

    Sample answer: It makes him a hero by association with a force the song calls formidable, not by narrating a victory already won. "Dread are our warriors, dread / Theseus our chieftain's men" (lines 1117–1118) places Theseus as "chieftain" over men who are twice called "dread". That is a heroic style of naming, but it appears in a vision of what should happen offstage, while the elders still ask whether the fight has even begun. The ode heroizes Theseus as Athens' captain in hope; it does not yet give us the reunion as a completed fact.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the ode move from imagined sight to a civic prayer to Zeus? Use the lines that ask might for the guardian host.

    Sample answer: The inward sight comes first, and the prayer follows as its public form. After the chorus has spoken of a rare vision that it shall soon behold the two maidens, it turns outward: "All-seeing Zeus, O lord of heaven, / To our guardian host be given / Might triumphant to surprise / Flying foes and win their prize" (lines 1138–1141). The seeing they longed for becomes a request that the city's host be given might. The movement is from private seeing-with-the-mind to a petition on behalf of Athens, keeping the rescue in the realm of hope until the very end of the song.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Of Zeus, Athenè _____,"

    Key: undefiled

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "The friends who watch for thee with false _____,"

    Key: presage

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this ode, the dread Queen and Maid of the torch-lit bay are best identified as:

    A. Demeter and Persephone, whose mystic rites belong to Eleusis
    B. Athenè and Artemis, who are later named in the closing prayer
    C. Antigone and Ismene, already safe and waiting inside the grove
    D. The nymphs who once fostered the robber band back in Thebes

    Key: A (Demeter and Persephone, whose mystic rites belong to Eleusis)

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the closing address claim about the friends who have been watching?

    A. They have already failed, and the maidens will not be seen again at all
    B. Their hope will not prove a false sign, because an escort with the maids is drawing near
    C. They must now keep Oedipus's resting-place hidden from everyone there
    D. They should send the wayfarer back to Thebes before nightfall comes

    Key: B (Their hope will not prove a false sign, because an escort with the maids is drawing near)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of stacking "Hear us" and "Hear" as the elders name one god after another?

    A. The repetition shows that the chorus no longer expects any god to listen now
    B. The lines reduce the ode to a roll of Theban gods only, with no Attic names left
    C. The repeated call makes the prayer urgent and gathers the city's gods into one appeal
    D. The syntax proves the battle is already over and needs no further help at all

    Key: C (The repeated call makes the prayer urgent and gathers the city's gods into one appeal)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is the effect of setting the mystic rites beside the hoped-for clash with the robber band?

    A. The chorus admits the rites have already been told to Creon's men
    B. The ode replaces the rescue with a hidden burial already performed
    C. The mystic rites are used to forbid Theseus from leaving the shore
    D. The chase is imagined on holy Attic ground, defending sacred land and captives

    Key: D (The chase is imagined on holy Attic ground, defending sacred land and captives)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse the wording of "O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay". What do the key words suggest?

    Sample answer: "Flying" and "Turning at last to bay" together make a hunt, not a finished victory. The foe is first seen in flight, then imagined as finally brought to stand, as a hunted creature is brought to bay. The opening "O when" keeps even that turn in the future, a time the elders have not yet reached with their eyes. The diction therefore starts the ode in motion and uncertainty: pursuit is underway, contact is longed for, and the song will have to imagine the rest, including the captain who may meet the robber band before the foe can flee the land.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the hymn turn a private longing to see the fight into a civic prayer for Athens? Use the plea that ends the invocation.

    Sample answer: The wish for a dove's wings and a view from the clouds is first a personal hunger to see. The invocation then names Zeus, Athenè, Apollo, and the Huntress, and it closes by asking them to "Help with your two-fold power / Athens in danger's hour!" (lines 1148–1149). "two-fold power" binds the brother and sister gods to the city's need, and "danger's hour" makes the offstage chase a public emergency, not only Oedipus's private loss. The lyric thus carries the elders from a wish to watch to a prayer that Athens itself be helped, while the escort is still, at most, about to come into sight.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How do the diction and syntax of the wish to behold Theseus meeting the robber band shape the ode's hope? Use the 'captain bold' passage without treating the rescue as already complete.

    Sample answer: The grammar stays in the realm of chance and prevention, even as the epithets are heroic. After "There I might chance behold", the elders name "Theseus our captain bold" and imagine him meeting the robber band "Ere they have fled the land", to "Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain" (lines 1106–1111). "might chance" and "Ere" are the hinges: the boldness is pictured, the flight of the captors is still possible, and rescue is the object of the sentence, not its accomplished result. The syntax lets the audience feel both confidence in Theseus and the fact that, for now, the chorus can only sing the meeting it cannot yet report.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the Eleusinian geography frame the imagined rescue? Use the lines about the torch-lit bay and the rites.

    Sample answer: The ode does not imagine a fight in empty country; it names a holy shore. The battle-roar may swell "by the torch-lit bay, / Where the dread Queen and Maid / Cherish the mystic rites, / Rites they to none betray" (lines 1098–1101). Torchlight, the Queen and Maid, and rites they betray to none all point to Eleusis, Athens' own landscape of guarded worship. To hope to behold Theseus there is to hope that the recovery of the captives will take place under the city's gods and in its sacred places, so the stasimon binds the offstage chase to the religious ground the first Colonus ode had already praised.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) develops the idea of the rescue imagined. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual

evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" could deliver about the rescue imagined. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the rescue imagined in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the rescue imagined. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" could deliver about the rescue imagined. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the rescue imagined in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) suggests about the rescue imagined. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" could deliver about the rescue imagined. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the rescue imagined in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses imagery in Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) to complicate the reader's understanding of the rescue imagined. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" could deliver about the rescue imagined. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the rescue imagined in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *O when the flying foe, Turning at last to bay, Soon will give blow for blow. Might I behold the fray; Hear the loud battle roar, Swell, on the Pythian shore, Or by the torch-lit bay, Where the dread Queen and Maid Cherish the mystic rites, Rites they to none betray, Ere on his lips is laid Secrecy's golden key By their own acolytes, Priestly Eumolpidae.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "fray" most nearly mean?

   A. a quiet council held after dusk

   B. a feast prepared for the Queen and Maid

   C. a fight or battle

   D. a hymn sung by the acolytes alone

2. *O when the flying foe, Turning at last to bay, Soon will give blow for blow. Might I behold the fray; Hear the loud battle roar, Swell, on the Pythian shore, Or by the torch-lit bay, Where the dread Queen and Maid Cherish the mystic rites, Rites they to none betray, Ere on his lips is laid Secrecy's golden key By their own acolytes, Priestly Eumolpidae. There I might chance behold Theseus our captain bold Meet with the robber band, Ere they have fled the land, Rescue by might and main Maidens, the captives twain.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)"?

   A. The rescue imagined

   B. The beggar at the sacred grove

   C. The elders' fear

   D. The rites at the torch-lit bay

SAT key: 1. C (a fight or battle); 2. A (The rescue imagined)

Lesson 8: Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)

Focus: the daughters return; a suppliant son

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

Background: A suppliant at an altar was under the god's protection and could not be harmed.

Significance: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The daughters return under Theseus's protection, and a suppliant son is already at the gate; the host must now weigh a new claim on the man he has sworn to guard.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
8 key words in context.
Today's words: asylum — a place of safety and refuge; calamity — a disaster causing great distress; impious — lacking respect for the gods or for duty; wayfaring — traveling from place to place, especially on foot; petitioner — a person who formally asks for a favor, right, or hearing; perforce — by necessity; unavoidably; nurslings — young children in someone's care; reverence — deep respect, especially for what is sacred.
Words: asylum: a place of safety and refuge · calamity: a disaster causing great distress · impious: lacking respect for the gods or for duty · wayfaring: traveling from place to place, especially on foot · petitioner: a person who formally asks for a favor, right, or hearing · perforce: by necessity; unavoidably · nurslings: young children in someone's care · reverence: deep respect, especially for what is sacred

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
A suppliant at an altar was under the god's protection and could not be harmed. Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Characterization: Oedipus thanks Theseus for the rescue but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Antigone, not her father, is the one who persuades him to listen to a suppliant son. Conflict: Theseus reports that Polyneices has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar. Oedipus refuses to see him, and Antigone has to argue him into granting a hearing. Theme: Refuge now includes a suppliant kinsman: Oedipus says that only those who have known calamity can share it, and Antigone asks him, as a father, not to pay a son's outrages in kind. Watch for the sacred grove and the hidden grave: The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the daughters return; a suppliant son.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" slowly and put it in my own words: He says that only people who have known calamity can share it with someone else. Next, craft. I notice how short the sentence is, and that "known" comes before "share": experience is the price of sympathy. The strongest word is "calamity": "calamity" names shared suffering as knowledge, the ground on which Oedipus can speak to Theseus and to his returned daughters. Then, effect. What do lines 1195–1196 reveal about who can share suffering? My answer: After the daughters' return, this is a line about who can share suffering: only those who have known calamity can share it; mercy here is imagined as something learned through pain, not as a formal speech.

> *They only who have known calamity / Can share it* *(Episode 3, lines 1195–1196)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" slowly and put it in my own words: He says that only people who have known calamity can share it with someone else. Next, craft. I notice how short the sentence is, and that "known" comes before "share": experience is the price of sympathy. The strongest word is "calamity": "calamity" names shared suffering as knowledge, the ground on which Oedipus can speak to Theseus and to his returned daughters. Then, effect. What do lines 1195–1196 reveal about who can share suffering? My answer: After the daughters' return, this is a line about who can share suffering: only those who have known calamity can share it; mercy here is imagined as something learned through pain, not as a formal speech.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Heeds", "matters" and "great" stand out. "A wise man heeds" makes attention a ruler's duty, and "all matters great or small" refuses to rank the report as too slight to weigh. Theseus treats even a small report as a matter a careful ruler must consider (Theseus, line 1210). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected student answer: Theseus, the host, treats even a small report as a ruler's duty; careful attention is how Athens keeps its promise to the returned daughters and to the suppliant who will arrive.

> *A wise man heeds all matters great or small (Episode 3, line 1210)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Heeds", "matters" and "great" stand out. "A wise man heeds" makes attention a ruler's duty, and "all matters great or small" refuses to rank the report as too slight to weigh. Theseus treats even a small report as a matter a careful ruler must consider (Theseus, line 1210).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected student answer: Theseus, the host, treats even a small report as a ruler's duty; careful attention is how Athens keeps its promise to the returned daughters and to the suppliant who will arrive.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the daughters return; a suppliant son? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) develops the idea of the daughters return; a suppliant son. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. When the text says "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" (Episode 3, lines 1195–1196), it shows this directly. Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the daughters return; a suppliant son? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) develops the idea of the daughters return; a suppliant son. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Access supports: Access supports (not a legal-compliance promise). These are teaching options for English learners and for students with IEP or 504 needs; they do not replace a student's plan, and using them does not by itself satisfy any legal requirement. Chunked reading: the daughters' return and the embrace (lines 1153–1172) first, then the news of a suppliant at the altar, with a gist check after each. Sentence frames: When Oedipus says "I have my darlings" and "Death were not wholly bitter with you near" (lines 1169–1170), he is saying ___. / Theseus "heeds all matters great or small" (line 1210), which shows a host who ___. Graphic organizer: a two-row chart (daughters return / a suppliant son) with a quotation and what new claim each places on Theseus. Time: extended time on the quiz and writing start. Audio: hear the reunion speech while following the text.

Exemplar: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. When the text says "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" (Episode 3, lines 1195–1196), it shows this directly. Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible? Ask: Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible?

Anchor question: Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible?

Facilitation: Ask: Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the daughters return; a suppliant son? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. ("They only who have known calamity / Can share it", Episode 3, lines 1195–1196). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the daughters return; a suppliant son? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. ("They only who have known calamity / Can share it", Episode 3, lines 1195–1196). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the daughters return; a suppliant son. Key takeaway: The daughters return under Theseus's protection, and a suppliant son is already at the gate; the host must now weigh a new claim on the man he has sworn to guard.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Oedipus thanks Theseus for the rescue but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Antigone, not her father, is the one who persuades him to listen to a suppliant son.
- **Conflict:** Theseus reports that Polyneices has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar. Oedipus refuses to see him, and Antigone has to argue him into granting a hearing.
- **Theme:** Refuge now includes a suppliant kinsman: Oedipus says that only those who have known calamity can share it, and Antigone asks him, as a father, not to pay a son's outrages in kind.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the daughters return; a suppliant son.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the daughters return; a suppliant son.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" (Episode 3, lines 1195–1196) Oedipus claims that only those who have suffered can truly share another person's pain.
- "A wise man heeds all matters great or small" (Episode 3, line 1210) Theseus treats even a small report as a matter a careful ruler must weigh.

- "Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son's most impious outrages" (Episode 3, lines 1248–1249) Antigone tells her father he cannot repay a son's outrage in the same coin.
- "Look thou to the past, forget the present, think / On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee; / Thence wilt thou draw this lesson without fail, / Of evil passion evil is the end" (Episode 3, lines 1254–1257) She asks him to remember the grief of his own parents and learn that passion ends in ruin.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone.
Evidence: "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" (Episode 3, lines 1195–1196)
Reasoning: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1153–1172

1153 **Oedipus:** Where, where? what sayest thou?
1154 **Antigone:** O father, father,
1155 **Antigone:** Would that some god might grant thee eyes to see
1156 **Antigone:** This best of men who brings us back again.
1157 **Oedipus:** My child! and are ye back indeed!
1158 **Antigone:** Yes, saved
1159 **Antigone:** By Theseus and his gallant followers.
1160 **Oedipus:** Come to your father's arms, O let me feel
1161 **Oedipus:** A child's embrace I never hoped for more.
1162 **Antigone:** Thou askest what is doubly sweet to give.
1163 **Oedipus:** Where are ye then?
1164 **Antigone:** We come together both.
1165 **Oedipus:** My precious nurslings!
1166 **Antigone:** Fathers aye were fond.
1167 **Oedipus:** Props of my age!
1168 **Antigone:** So sorrow sorrow props.
1169 **Oedipus:** I have my darlings, and if death should come,
1170 **Oedipus:** Death were not wholly bitter with you near.
1171 **Oedipus:** Cling to me, press me close on either side,
1172 **Oedipus:** There rest ye from your dreary wayfaring.

Lines 1160–1170

1160 **Oedipus:** Come to your father's arms, O let me feel
1161 **Oedipus:** A child's embrace I never hoped for more.
1162 **Antigone:** Thou askest what is doubly sweet to give.
1163 **Oedipus:** Where are ye then?
1164 **Antigone:** We come together both.
1165 **Oedipus:** My precious nurslings!

1166 **Antigone:** Fathers aye were fond.
1167 **Oedipus:** Props of my age!
1168 **Antigone:** So sorrow sorrow props.
1169 **Oedipus:** I have my darlings, and if death should come,
1170 **Oedipus:** Death were not wholly bitter with you near.

Line 1170
1170 **Oedipus:** Death were not wholly bitter with you near.

Lines 1195–1196
1195 **Oedipus:** They only who have known calamity
1196 **Oedipus:** Can share it. Let me greet thee where thou art,

Line 1198
1198 **Theseus:** I marvel not if thou hast dallied long

Line 1201
1201 **Theseus:** I would be famous more by deeds than words.

Line 1210
1210 **Theseus:** A wise man heeds all matters great or small.

Lines 1214–1216
1214 **Theseus:** But of thy kin, hath taken sanctuary
1215 **Theseus:** Beside the altar of Poseidon, where
1216 **Theseus:** I was at sacrifice when called away.

Lines 1236–1237
1236 **Oedipus:** That voice, O king, grates on a father's ears;
1237 **Oedipus:** I have come to loathe it. Force me not to yield.

Line 1238
1238 **Theseus:** But he hath found asylum. O beware,

Lines 1238–1253
1238 **Theseus:** But he hath found asylum. O beware,
1239 **Theseus:** And fail not in due reverence to the god.
1240 **Antigone:** O heed me, father, though I am young in years.
1241 **Antigone:** Let the prince have his will and pay withal
1242 **Antigone:** What in his eyes is service to the god;
1243 **Antigone:** For our sake also let our brother come.
1244 **Antigone:** If what he urges tend not to thy good
1245 **Antigone:** He cannot surely wrest perforce thy will.
1246 **Antigone:** To hear him then, what harm? By open words
1247 **Antigone:** A scheme of villainy is soon bewrayed.
1248 **Antigone:** Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay

1249 **Antigone:** In kind a son's most impious outrages.
1250 **Antigone:** O listen to him; other men like thee
1251 **Antigone:** Have thankless children and are choleric,
1252 **Antigone:** But yielding to persuasion's gentle spell
1253 **Antigone:** They let their savage mood be exorcised.

Line 1247
1247 **Antigone:** A scheme of villainy is soon bewrayed.

Lines 1248–1249
1248 **Antigone:** Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay
1249 **Antigone:** In kind a son's most impious outrages.

Line 1253
1253 **Antigone:** They let their savage mood be exorcised.

Lines 1254–1257
1254 **Antigone:** Look thou to the past, forget the present, think
1255 **Antigone:** On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee;
1256 **Antigone:** Thence wilt thou draw this lesson without fail,
1257 **Antigone:** Of evil passion evil is the end.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
asylum (noun)	a place of safety and refuge	*But he hath found asylum. O beware, / And fail not in due reverence to the god.*
calamity (noun)	a disaster causing great distress	*They only who have known calamity Can share it.*
impious (adjective)	lacking respect for the gods or for duty	*Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay In kind a son's most impious outrages.*
wayfaring (noun)	traveling from place to place, especially on foot	*Cling to me, press me close on either side, / There rest ye from your dreary wayfaring.*
petitioner (noun)	a person who formally asks for a favor, right, or hearing	*I marvel who is this petitioner. / Think if there be not any of thy kin*
perforce (adverb)	by necessity; unavoidably	*He cannot surely wrest perforce thy will. / To hear him then, what harm? By open words*
nurslings (noun)	young children in someone's care	*My precious nurslings! / Fathers aye were fond.*
reverence (noun)	deep respect, especially for what is sacred	*But he hath found asylum. O beware, / And fail not in due reverence to the god.*

Discussion questions

1. Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible?

2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and intent?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Who can share calamity, according to Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Only those who have known it.
   Answer guidance: Only those who have known it.
2. What does Oedipus tell the daughters to do, after the first greeting of their return? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Rest from their dreary wayfaring
   Answer guidance: Rest from their dreary wayfaring.
3. What greeting does Oedipus ask leave to give Theseus, if he is permitted? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** To kiss his cheek
   Answer guidance: To kiss his cheek.
4. Where does Oedipus say he will greet Theseus, since he will not touch him? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Where Theseus already stands
   Answer guidance: Where Theseus already stands.
5. What does Antigone call her father's sightless eyes, in her plea? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Stern monitors
   Answer guidance: Stern monitors.
6. What does Antigone ask, as to the prince's will, when she pleads for a hearing? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** That they let the prince have his will
   Answer guidance: That they let the prince have his will.
7. What is Oedipus's first word to Theseus, when he hears there is a suppliant? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Dear friend, forbear, I pray
   Answer guidance: Dear friend, forbear, I pray.
8. How does Oedipus describe the children, just returned, as having been given over? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Given o'er for lost
   Answer guidance: Given o'er for lost.
9. What, besides the land, does Oedipus bless with his thanks after the rescue? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Theseus himself, for fear of heaven
   Answer guidance: Theseus himself, for fear of heaven.

10. What does Oedipus say he cannot find, when he first gropes for the returned daughters? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The dear faces he longs to touch

    Answer guidance: The dear faces he longs to touch.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Antigone remind her father of his own past? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** To show where anger leads: Antigone points her father to the evil his own parents' passions brought him, so that he will not repeat that pattern with his son.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Antigone tells him to "think / On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee" (lines 1254–1255), because that past teaches "Of evil passion evil is the end" (line 1257). She uses his own suffering as the strongest argument she has: a man who was harmed by his parents' passions should not let his own anger rule how he treats his child.
2. What does "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" suggest about the daughters return; a suppliant son? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Antigone is the voice of mercy: in this scene she persuades her father to hear the son he loathes.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The scene suggests that mercy has to be argued for, even by those who receive it. Antigone, just rescued herself, pleads "For our sake also let our brother come" (line 1243), and Oedipus yields only reluctantly: "Grievous to me, my child, the boon ye win / By pleading" (lines 1263–1264). The daughter who was just saved by a stranger's kindness now asks her father to show his own kin a little of it.
3. Find one example of characterization in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)". What does it reveal about the daughters return; a suppliant son that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** One trait shown in action, such as Oedipus pulling back from touching Theseus because he thinks himself tainted, or Theseus refusing to boast, and what it reveals beyond a label.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Oedipus asks to kiss Theseus's cheek, then stops himself: "Can I wish that thou should'st touch / One fallen like me to utter wretchedness" (lines 1191–1192). Gratitude and shame show in the same gesture. A plain statement that Oedipus is grateful would miss how deeply he still sees himself as polluted, even in his best moment.
4. How does the conflict in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" shape what we understand about the daughters return; a suppliant son? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The conflict between a father's loathing and the sacred duty to a suppliant (and the daughter's plea), and how it frames the coming meeting as a test of whether Oedipus can hear his son.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The conflict is between Oedipus's loathing, "That voice, O king, grates on a father's ears" (line 1236), and the god's claim, since the son "hath found asylum" (line 1238). Oedipus himself just received sanctuary as a suppliant; now his son asks for the same. The conflict makes the coming meeting a test of whether Oedipus will honour for his son the custom that protected him.
5. In the passage that opens with "Where, where?", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two words from the reunion (lines 1153–1172) with their connotations, such as "nurslings," "Props," "darlings" or "wayfaring," showing a father's dependence and tenderness.

Answer guidance: Model answer: The words “nurslings” (line 1165) and “Props” (line 1167) carry the scene. “Nurslings” makes the daughters little children he has cared for, while “Props” makes them the supports he leans on. Antigone answers “So sorrow sorrow props” (line 1168). The words show that care in this family runs both ways and grew out of shared suffering.

6. What causes the main turn in “Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The turn is Theseus’s news of a suppliant at Poseidon’s altar, which turns joy into dread; its likely effect is a hard meeting between father and son that Oedipus agrees to only because his daughter pleads.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The turn is Theseus’s report that “a man, no countryman of thine, / But of thy kin, hath taken sanctuary” (lines 1213–1214). The joy of the reunion drains at once, and Oedipus begs, “Dear friend, forbear, I pray” (line 1226). Because Antigone pleads, he agrees to hear the man, so the next scene will bring father and son face to face, with Oedipus’s hostility already clear.
7. How does “Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)” build on “Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A cause-and-effect link: the ode imagined Theseus winning the daughters back, and this episode confirms it, so Oedipus now owes Theseus everything, which is why he cannot easily refuse Theseus’s request.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The ode ended with “an escort with the maids draws near” (line 1152). Episode 3 confirms what the elders imagined: Theseus has “brought thee back the maids / Alive and nothing harmed” (lines 1203–1204). Oedipus’s debt, “For all I have I owe to thee alone” (line 1188), makes it hard to refuse when Theseus asks him to respect the suppliant at the altar.
8. In “Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the daughters return; a suppliant son, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A motive behind a claim: Oedipus says he does not know who the suppliant is, then guesses at once and calls him “hateful,” which shows old anger that has been waiting.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Oedipus first claims, “Of what thou askest I myself know naught” (line 1212), and wonders, “I marvel who is this petitioner” (line 1223). But at the word “Argos” he knows at once: “My son, O king, my hateful son” (line 1232). The speed of the guess and the word “hateful” show anger that has been waiting; his neutral questions were never really neutral.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A revised answer to the bell-ringer (forgive and still hold responsible) that uses Antigone’s argument: hearing someone is not excusing them, since a bad plan shows itself in open words.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: I first said forgiveness means letting go of blame. Antigone separates the two. She asks her father only to listen: “If what he urges tend not to thy good / He cannot surely wrest perforce thy will” (lines 1244–1245), and “By open words / A scheme of villainy is soon bewrayed” (lines 1246–1247). You can hear someone and still hold them responsible; listening is not excusing.
10. Where does theme appear in “Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)”, and how does it connect the daughters return; a suppliant son to the larger concern with guilt and intent? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Where guilt and intent appear: Oedipus calls himself “Corrupt and tainted” though he has argued he acted unknowingly, and he holds his son guilty for deliberate neglect.
    Answer guidance: Model answer: Oedipus still calls himself “Corrupt and tainted with a thousand ills”

(line 1193), so he has not shaken off the stain even after arguing that he acted without knowing. Antigone, though, treats the son's wrongs as chosen and still calls them "a son's most impious outrages" (line 1249). The scene sets unknowing guilt, which Oedipus carries, against deliberate wrongdoing, which he will not forgive.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Antigone right that a father cannot repay a son in kind? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An evaluation of Antigone's claim (lines 1248–1249) as a principle, with a position and a counterpoint (justice may require consequences; the son's wrongs were deliberate).
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: mostly right. She argues, "Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son's most impious outrages" (lines 1248–1249): a parent who answers cruelty with cruelty repeats it, and she points to where "evil passion" ends (line 1257). Counter-line: she does not deny the son's guilt, calling his deeds "impious outrages" herself, and Oedipus could reply that some harm must have consequences even within a family.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A stand with two lines from Episode 3, with a qualification that her mercy is practical and conditional (hear him; you need not grant his suit), not unconditional forgiveness.
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: agree, with a qualification. She is the voice of mercy: "O listen to him; other men like thee / Have thankless children" (lines 1250–1251), and she asks him to let "their savage mood be exorcised" (line 1253). But her mercy is practical. She asks only for a hearing and admits her father need not grant what his son wants (lines 1244–1245). Mercy here means openness, not unconditional pardon.
3. Which character in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" acts most wisely in the matter of the daughters return; a suppliant son, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named standard applied to two characters, for example judging by what is owed to a suppliant: Theseus and Antigone honour it, while Oedipus at first refuses. Give a line for each.
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: by the standard of respect for the sacred rights of a suppliant, Theseus acts most wisely. He warns, "O beware, / And fail not in due reverence to the god" (lines 1238–1239). By the same standard, Oedipus at first acts least wisely: "I have come to loathe it. Force me not to yield" (line 1237). A student could rank Antigone highest instead, since she persuades without commanding.
4. You are directing "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the daughters return; a suppliant son. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two staging choices tied to lines, such as the daughters pressing close on either side of their father, or Oedipus stopping his hand short of Theseus's face, each with its effect.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: (1) On "Cling to me, press me close on either side" (line 1171), let the daughters kneel on either side of the seated Oedipus, so he is literally held up by his "Props" and the picture matches the words. (2) On "Oh no, I would not let thee if thou would'st" (line 1194), have Oedipus reach

toward Theseus's face, then pull his hand back before touching it. The audience sees gratitude stopped by shame.

5. Write your own questions about "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Three questions answerable from lines 1153–1269: one recall, one why/how and one should/what-if, different in kind.

   Answer guidance: Model set. Recall: Where has the suppliant taken refuge? (At Poseidon's altar, lines 1214–1216.) Why/how: Why does Theseus not describe the fight himself? (He would rather be known by deeds than words, line 1201.) Should/what if: Should Oedipus have refused to hear his son? (Answers weigh his anger, lines 1236–1237, against the suppliant's rights and Antigone's plea, lines 1238–1253.)

6. Connect "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)", with its focus on the daughters return; a suppliant son, to curse and mercy: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment about curse and mercy, the question's theme. The link is strong in prospect: Antigone pleads for mercy toward a son Oedipus loathes, but his response is not yet heard. A strong answer says what must come next.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the link is strong but still unresolved. The scene sets the daughter's plea for mercy, "yielding to persuasion's gentle spell" (line 1252), against her father's loathing of the son whose voice "grates on a father's ears" (line 1236). Oedipus yields only grudgingly (lines 1263–1264). To strengthen the link, Sophocles must show whether the hearing Antigone won leads to mercy or to something harder.

7. Is the characterization in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" effective in presenting the daughters return; a suppliant son, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment against a stated criterion (does the characterization show mixed feelings, or one note?), with a line that meets it and one that might miss it.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: effective, because Oedipus is shown with mixed feelings in quick succession. He is overjoyed ("Death were not wholly bitter with you near," line 1170), humbled before Theseus (lines 1191–1194), then bitter toward his son (line 1232). Counter-line: Theseus's modesty, "I would be famous more by deeds than words" (line 1201), is admirable but very tidy, and a reviewer might find him too perfect to be fully human.

8. Compare how "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" treats the daughters return; a suppliant son with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named comparison (a story of a family reunion followed by an unwelcome relative's return, or the prodigal son) and one thing Episode 3 sees that the other misses, tied to a line.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The parable of the prodigal son shows a father running to welcome a son who has wronged him. Episode 3 sees what that story leaves out: a father may not want to welcome the son at all, and a sibling may have to argue him into even hearing it. Here it is the daughter, not the father, who pleads, "For our sake also let our brother come" (line 1243). The play treats mercy as something that may need persuading, not instinct.

9. Predict what "Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the

class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A prediction from two clues, Oedipus's loathing of his son and his request that no one be allowed to dispose of him, about the mood the elders will sing next, checked after reading.

Answer guidance: Model answer: Clue 1: Oedipus agrees to hear his son only grudgingly and calls him "my hateful son" (line 1232). Clue 2: he asks that none "have power to dispose of me" (line 1266), as if he expects pressure. Before the meeting, the elders will probably reflect on the troubles of a long life and an old man's burdens, so the ode may be dark rather than hopeful. After reading, students check whether the ode matched that mood.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the daughters return; a suppliant son? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An adaptation that keeps the core: a newly reunited family learns that an estranged son wants to speak with his father, and a daughter persuades the father to listen. It names two details that must stay.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: A father has just been reunited with the daughters who care for him when a nurse says his estranged son is waiting in the hospital chapel, asking to see him. The father refuses until one daughter persuades him. Two things must stay: the son asking from a protected place ("he hath found asylum," line 1238), and the daughter's argument that hearing him costs nothing, since "By open words / A scheme of villainy is soon bewrayed" (lines 1246–1247).

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why will Oedipus not touch Theseus?

    A. He believes he is still polluted

    B. He is still too angry with Theseus to greet him

    C. He cannot find Theseus after the fight ends

    D. Theseus forbids any greeting from a guest

    Key: A (He believes he is still polluted)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who brings the daughters back to Oedipus, according to Antigone?

    A. Creon and a band of Theban men

    B. Theseus and his gallant followers

    C. Ismene acting by herself alone

    D. The chorus coming from the grove

    Key: B (Theseus and his gallant followers)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "My converse somewhat long and _____."

    Key: tedious

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: “I marvel not if thou hast _____ long”

   Key: dallied

5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Who is the suppliant at Poseidon's altar?

   A. Creon

   B. Ismene

   C. Polyneices

   D. A priest of Poseidon

   Key: C (Polyneices)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Theseus say it would be a waste of words to do?

   A. Ask Oedipus for any further counsel

   B. Swear a new oath after the rescue

   C. Send the daughters back to Creon at once

   D. Boast of how the fight was won

   Key: D (Boast of how the fight was won)

7. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] How does Antigone’s reply “So sorrow sorrow props” change the meaning of “Props of my age”? Quote both.

   Sample answer: Oedipus praises the girls as supports of his old age, and Antigone turns the praise into a harder truth. He says, “Props of my age!” and she answers, “So sorrow sorrow props.” (lines 1167–1168). The verb “props” is kept, but the props are no longer only children holding up a father; sorrow itself is what holds sorrow up. The line keeps the joy of the reunion and still names the grief that has not left them.

8. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What assurance does Theseus give as he goes out?

   A. Oedipus's life is safe while any god saves Theseus

   B. The suppliant will be arrested before he can speak

   C. The daughters must leave Attica before nightfall

   D. Oedipus's resting-place will be shown to every guest

   Key: A (Oedipus's life is safe while any god saves Theseus)

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does the first reunion show that both daughters have returned? Use Oedipus’s request and Antigone’s answer about coming.

   Sample answer: The old man has to find them by touch, and he needs to be told that he has not been given only one child. He says, “Come to your father’s arms, O let me feel / A child’s embrace I never hoped for more.” (lines 1160–1161), and then he asks where they are. Antigone answers, “We come together both.” (line 1164). The scene makes the rescue complete in the body: both sisters are present, and he can hold them.

10. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How do gratitude and a sense of pollution sit together when Oedipus addresses Theseus? Use the lines in which he asks for a hand and then takes the wish back.

    Sample answer: He wants to honor Theseus and, in the same breath, he will not let the king come too near. He asks, “Give me thy hand, O Prince, that I may touch it, / And if thou wilt permit me, kiss thy cheek.” (lines 1189–1190), then checks himself: “Oh no, I would not let thee if thou would’st.” (line 1194). Thanks and self-reproach stand side by side: he owes Theseus everything, yet he still treats himself as a man too fallen to touch.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who persuades Oedipus to listen?

    A. Antigone

    B. Ismene

C. The Chorus

D. Creon

Key: A (Antigone)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Oedipus first respond?

A. He embraces him at once with joy

B. He refuses to see him

C. He sends him money for the journey

D. He curses Theseus for bringing the news

Key: B (He refuses to see him)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Corrupt and _____ with a thousand ills?"

Key: tainted

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "I marvel who is this _____."

Key: petitioner

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone ask her father to allow?

A. That Creon be invited back into the grove

B. That Theseus hand the daughters over to Argos

C. That their brother may come and be heard

D. That Oedipus leave Attica before the suppliant speaks

Key: C (That their brother may come and be heard)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does Theseus tell Oedipus to beware and not fail in due reverence?

A. The chorus has already promised the man a crown

B. The daughters have already sworn to follow him home

C. The man has brought a Theban army to the shore

D. The man has found asylum at the god's altar

Key: D (The man has found asylum at the god's altar)

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Oedipus mean by "They only who have known calamity / Can share it"? Quote the lines.

Sample answer: He is explaining why he will greet Theseus from where he stands, instead of taking the king's hand. "They only who have known calamity / Can share it." (lines 1195–1196). Shared suffering, not a royal courtesy, is the ground on which he thinks a person may come near his ills. The saying lets him praise Theseus and still keep a distance he believes is safer for the king.

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Who does Antigone say should tell the tale of their ventures, and why?

A. Theseus, from his own lips, so her part may be brief

B. Ismene, because she saw more of the fight than anyone

C. The chorus, because only the elders may speak of war

D. Creon, if he will confess the seizure in public

Key: A (Theseus, from his own lips, so her part may be brief)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Theseus refuse jealousy after the reunion? Use the line about fame by deeds.

    Sample answer: He will not treat the daughters' talk as a slight to himself. He says he marvels not that Oedipus has preferred their speech, and he adds, "I would be famous more by deeds than words." (line 1201). The line turns his quietness into a rule of character: the rescue he has already performed should speak for him. He claims credit by what he has done, not by competing for Oedipus's first greeting.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Antigone join service to the god with a family plea? Use the lines in which she asks that their brother come.

    Sample answer: She does not ask her father to forget the god, and she does not ask only for a private favor. She says, "Let the prince have his will and pay withal / What in his eyes is service to the god; / For our sake also let our brother come." (lines 1241–1243). Reverence and kinship are argued together: yielding would honor Theseus's duty at the altar and would also let the sisters hear their brother. The appeal is pious and personal at once, still a request that he be heard, not a claim that he has already won his suit.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What proof of the oath does Theseus say Oedipus has already had?

    A. He has brought the maids back alive and nothing harmed
    B. He has already named the resting-place before the chorus
    C. He has sent Creon home with gifts from Athens
    D. He has promised the daughters a safe escort out of Attica

    Key: A (He has brought the maids back alive and nothing harmed)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "On my way _____, I fain would have"

    Key: hitherward

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "A scheme of villainy is soon _____."

    Key: bewrayed

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What tells Oedipus who the suppliant is?

    A. A messenger's report that Creon has come back again
    B. Theseus's hint that a kinsman at Argos might claim this boon
    C. The chorus naming the man as a priest of Poseidon
    D. Antigone's claim that Ismene is waiting at the altar

    Key: B (Theseus's hint that a kinsman at Argos might claim this boon)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] When Oedipus yields, what does he beg Theseus to prevent?

    A. That the daughters be sent ahead to meet the suppliant
    B. That the altar of Poseidon be taken down at once
    C. That anyone should have power to dispose of him
    D. That Theseus publish the resting-place to every guest

    Key: C (That anyone should have power to dispose of him)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How should we read Oedipus's words about death in the reunion? Use the lines about his darlings being near.

    Sample answer: The lines belong to the joy of having the girls again. He says, "I have my darlings, and if death should come, / Death were not wholly bitter with you near." (lines 1169–1170). The "if" keeps death as a possibility, and the comfort is their presence after a rescue he had not dared to hope for. The speech is a measure of restored love.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Oedipus praise in Theseus and in Athens when he gives thanks? Use the lines about fear of heaven and truthful lips.

    Sample answer: He treats the rescue as a moral fact about the city, not only as a private favor. He says, “The gods deal with thee after my desire, / With thee and with this land! for fear of heaven / I found above all peoples most with you, / And righteousness and lips that cannot lie.” (lines 1183–1186). “fear of heaven,” “righteousness,” and “lips that cannot lie” are the terms of his gratitude. Theseus is honored as the man who enacted those civic virtues when he brought the daughters back.

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Theseus treat Oedipus's long converse with the children?

    A. He rebukes Oedipus for ignoring a king in the grove

    B. He leaves at once and will not hear any later counsel

    C. He demands that the daughters be silent before he speaks

    D. He is not jealous and will not take offense at the delay

    Key: D (He is not jealous and will not take offense at the delay)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is Antigone right that a father cannot repay a son in kind? Defend your view. Use her lines about impious outrages.

    Sample answer: She is right that a father’s office is not a license to copy a son’s injuries, even if the injuries are real. She says, “Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son’s most impious outrages.” (lines 1248–1249). The “therefore” makes fatherhood itself the limit: hearing the man would not cancel what he has done, and it would not require Oedipus to grant the suit. Her claim is a moral restraint, not a verdict that the son is already cleared or already cursed.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Oedipus move from not knowing the petitioner to naming him? Use the lines in which he says Theseus's words have told him, and the name he then gives.

    Sample answer: The recognition is inferred, not announced by a messenger with a proper name. After Theseus mentions kin at Argos, Oedipus says, “Thy words have told me who the suppliant is.” (line 1230). He then names him by relation, not by a formal introduction: “My son, O king, my hateful son, whose words / Of all men’s most would jar upon my ears.” (lines 1232–1233). The scene shows him reading a hint and feeling the old wound; it does not yet stage the son’s plea or any later doom.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Have thankless children and are _____,”

    Key: choleric

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “They let their savage mood be _____.”

    Key: exorcised

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is the matter Theseus calls slight, yet worthy of thought?

    A. A man of Oedipus's kin has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar

    B. A new war has already broken out inside the grove

    C. The daughters have refused to stay in Attica any longer

    D. The chorus has asked to hear the tale of the fight again

    Key: A (A man of Oedipus's kin has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What lesson does Antigone draw from the past?

    A. Revenge is the only duty a father has left

    B. Of evil passion evil is the end

    C. The gods do not care how parents treat their sons

D. Sons should be refused a hearing in every case

Key: B (Of evil passion evil is the end)

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus greet Theseus from where he stands, rather than take his hand?

    A. Theseus has already refused to come within reach of him

    B. The daughters have asked him not to thank the king at all

    C. He will not let Theseus touch one fallen to wretchedness and many ills

    D. He means to save his greeting until the suppliant has spoken

    Key: C (He will not let Theseus touch one fallen to wretchedness and many ills)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of Theseus reporting the sanctuary before the suppliant is named as a son?

    A. The report proves that the altar has already been torn down by force

    B. The speech replaces the reunion with a hidden burial already performed

    C. The king uses the rite to forbid Oedipus from remaining in the land

    D. The news arrives first as a sacred obligation, and only then as a family blow

    Key: D (The news arrives first as a sacred obligation, and only then as a family blow)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Antigone's opening wish about eyes frame the reunion? Use the lines that name the man who brings them back.

    Sample answer: She begins with the one thing the reunion cannot give him: sight of the rescuer. "Would that some god might grant thee eyes to see / This best of men who brings us back again." (lines 1155–1156). The wish makes Theseus visible in praise while reminding us that Oedipus must receive the return by hearing and touch. The daughters are present, the saviour is praised, and the father's blindness remains; joy is real, and it is still incomplete.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Antigone use her father's "ever-sightless orbs" to complete her plea that he hear the suppliant? Quote the lines.

    Sample answer: She turns his blindness into a reminder, not into a spectacle of how the injury was done. She says, "Thou hast, alas, to prick thy memory, / Stern monitors, these ever-sightless orbs." (lines 1258–1259). The orbs, called "Stern monitors," recall the woe she has just asked him to remember, so that he will not answer passion with passion. The lines complete her case for yielding and hearing the man; they recall the wound as a reminder, not as a spectacle.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Antigone turn family memory into a warning about passion? Use the lines that end in her lesson.

    Sample answer: She asks him to look backward, not in order to reopen the old story for its own sake, but to draw a rule from it. "Look thou to the past, forget the present, think / On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee; / Thence wilt thou draw this lesson without fail, / Of evil passion evil is the end." (lines 1254–1257). The "woe" is named as the parents' story, without further detail, and the lesson is ethical: passion breeds a bad end. She wants that warning to govern how he meets his son, not to settle the later quarrel in advance.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How do reverence for a suppliant and the safety of Oedipus meet at the close? Use Theseus's warning about asylum and his last assurance.

    Sample answer: Theseus will not let piety toward the altar cancel the protection he has already sworn. He warns, "But he hath found asylum. O beware, / And fail not in due reverence to the god." (lines 1238–1239), so the petitioner cannot simply be refused as an ordinary visitor. Yet when Oedipus yields, Theseus also pledges, "Thy life is safe while any god saves mine." (line 1269). Hearing the man and guarding Oedipus are held together: the god is honored, and the king's own life is named as the measure of the old man's safety.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) develops the idea of the daughters return; a suppliant son. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" could deliver about the daughters return; a suppliant son. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the daughters return; a suppliant son in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the daughters return; a suppliant son. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" could deliver about the daughters return; a suppliant son. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the daughters return; a suppliant son in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) suggests about the daughters return; a suppliant son. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" could deliver about the daughters return; a suppliant son. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the daughters return; a suppliant son in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses characterization in Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) to complicate the reader's understanding of the daughters return; a suppliant son. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" could deliver about the daughters return; a suppliant son. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the daughters return; a suppliant son in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Come to your father's arms, O let me feel A child's embrace I never hoped for more. Thou askest what is doubly sweet to give. Where are ye then? We come together both. My precious nurslings! Fathers aye were fond. Props of my age! So sorrow sorrow props. I have my darlings, and if death should come, Death were not wholly bitter with you near.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "nurslings" most nearly mean?

   A. hired soldiers sent to guard the road
   B. the children he has reared
   C. strangers waiting at the grove
   D. messengers from the city gates

2. *Where, where? what sayest thou? O father, father, Would that some god might grant thee eyes to see This best of men who brings us back again. My child! and are ye back indeed! Yes, saved By Theseus and his gallant followers. Come to your father's arms, O let me feel A child's embrace I never hoped for more. Thou askest what is doubly sweet to give. Where are ye then? We come together both. My precious nurslings! Fathers aye were fond. Props of my age! So sorrow sorrow props. I have my darlings, and if death should come, Death were not wholly bitter with you near. Cling to me, press me close on either side, There rest ye from your dreary wayfaring.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)"?

   A. A formal exile of the daughters from Athens
   B. Creon seizes the daughters
   C. The beggar at the sacred grove
   D. The daughters return; a suppliant son

SAT key: 1. B (the children he has reared); 2. D (The daughters return; a suppliant son)

Lesson 9: Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)

Focus: "Not to be born"

Objective: Students will analyze how theme develops in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: “What does this passage make us notice?”

Teacher only · spoilers

The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

Background: The ode is sung by old men in grief.

Significance: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, sung as old men’s grief and already set beside a scene of love.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does the scene in which the daughters were restored already sit beside this ode? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: How does the scene in which the daughters were restored already sit beside this ode?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The ode’s hardest line, “not to be born,” is grief and old age speaking; the elders then turn to their guest, a headland lashed from every side, who suffers as they do and still stands.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
8 key words in context.
Today's words: headland — a high point of land jutting into the sea; sedition — speech or action that stirs rebellion against authority; dirge — a mournful song or hymn for the dead; knell — the sound of a bell rung slowly to mark a death or funeral; carnage — widespread killing; great slaughter; giddy — thoughtlessly reckless; wight — a person (an archaic or literary word); coils — windings or entanglements, here the troubles that wrap around a life.
Words: headland: a high point of land jutting into the sea · sedition: speech or action that stirs rebellion against authority · dirge: a mournful song or hymn for the dead · knell: the sound of a bell rung slowly to mark a death or funeral · carnage: widespread killing; great slaughter · giddy: thoughtlessly reckless · wight: a person (an archaic or literary word) · coils: windings or entanglements, here the troubles that wrap around a life

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The ode is sung by old men in grief. The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, sung as old men's grief and already set beside a scene of love. Theme: The elders say that not to be born at all is best, and next best, once born, is to go back quickly — a judgment on long life and the troubles that come with it. Imagery: They compare Oedipus to a headland on an iron-bound shore, lashed by the wintry blast and by storms from sunset, from the east, and from the noonday glow. Tone / mood: The ode is a lament sung by old men, heavy with weariness of long life and with pity for the guest who has known the same ills. Watch for the sacred grove and the hidden grave: The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: "Not to be born".

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way" slowly and put it in my own words: The chorus ranks two fates: never to be born is best, and the next best, once born, is to go back the way you came, with as little delay as possible. Next, craft. I notice the wording itself ranks and rushes: "far best" lifts the first claim, "Next best" and "least delay" hurry a life already begun toward "the backward way." The strongest word is "backward": "the backward way" turns dying into a retracing of birth, a path walked quickly, in the voice of old men singing about long life and pain. Then, effect. What do lines 1284–1287 reveal about "Not to be born"? My answer: These four lines reveal the claim that it is best not to be born, and they belong to the elders' grief. The scene just before, in which the daughters were restored, already stands beside this song as a picture of love and care.

> *Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way (Stasimon 3, lines 1284–1287)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way" slowly and put it in my own words: The chorus ranks two fates: never to be born is best, and the next best, once born, is to go back the way you came, with as little delay as possible. Next, craft. I notice the wording itself ranks and rushes: "far best" lifts the first claim, "Next best" and "least delay" hurry a life already begun toward "the backward way." The strongest word is "backward": "the backward way" turns dying into a retracing of birth, a path walked quickly, in the voice of old men singing about long life and pain. Then, effect. What do lines 1284–1287 reveal about "Not to be born"? My answer: These four lines reveal the claim that it is best not to be born, and they belong to the elders' grief. The scene just before, in which the daughters were restored, already stands beside this song as a picture of love and care.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Headland", "misfortune's" and "o'erborne" stand out. "E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore" makes him a place that takes the weather and still stands; "misfortune's whelming tide" and "o'erborne" name the blows from every side, not a collapse. The ode likens their guest to a headland beaten from every quarter of the sky (Chorus, lines 1298–1306).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected student answer: After "not to be born," the elders turn the storm-beaten headland image on their guest; refuge does not erase his buffeting, and they finally name his suffering as their own to witness.

> *Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune's whelming tide, / By every wind of heaven o'erborne / Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, / Some from the noonday glow (Stasimon 3, lines 1298–1306)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Headland", "misfortune's" and "o'erborne" stand out. "E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore" makes him a place that takes the weather and still stands; "misfortune's whelming tide" and "o'erborne" name the blows from every side, not a collapse. The ode likens their guest to a headland beaten from every quarter of the sky (Chorus, lines 1298–1306).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected student answer: After "not to be born," the elders turn the storm-beaten headland image on their guest; refuge does not erase his buffeting, and they finally name his suffering as their own to witness.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for theme, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about "Not to be born"? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) develops the idea of "Not to be born". Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, sung as old men's grief and already set beside a scene of love. When the text says "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune's whelming tide, / By every wind of heaven o'erborne / Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, / Some from the noonday glow" (Stasimon 3, lines 1298–1306), it shows this directly. The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

Task: Annotate the scene for theme, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about "Not to be born"? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) develops the idea of "Not to be born". Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Access supports: Access supports (not a legal-compliance promise). These are teaching options for English learners and for students with IEP or 504 needs; they do not replace a student's plan, and using them does not by itself satisfy any legal requirement. Chunked reading: the "not to be born" stanza (lines 1284–1287) first, then the headland image (lines 1298–1307), and set both beside "Death were not wholly bitter with you near" (line 1170) from the scene just before. Sentence frames: "Far best" and "the backward way" (lines 1284–1287) mean the elders are saying ___. / The headland "on an iron-bound shore" (line 1300) treats Oedipus as ___, not as already gone. Graphic organizer: two stanzas, three columns (quotation, speaker, what the wording does). Time: extended time on the quiz and CER. Audio: hear the four lines twice, then the headland, while following the printed text.

Exemplar: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, sung as old men's grief and already set beside a scene of love. When the text says "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune's whelming tide, / By every wind of heaven o'erborne / Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, / Some from the noonday glow" (Stasimon 3, lines 1298–1306), it shows this directly. The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How does the scene in which the daughters were restored already sit beside this ode? Ask: How does the scene in which the daughters were restored already sit beside this ode?

Anchor question: How does the scene in which the daughters were restored already sit beside this ode?

Facilitation: Ask: How does the scene in which the daughters were restored already sit beside this ode?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about "Not to be born"? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, sung as old men's grief and already set beside a scene of love. ("Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar", Stasimon 3, lines 1298–1306). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about "Not to be born"? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, sung as old men's grief and already set beside a scene of love. ("Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar", Stasimon 3, lines 1298–1306). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how theme shapes "Not to be born". Key takeaway: The ode's hardest line, "not to be born," is grief and old age speaking; the elders then turn to their guest, a headland lashed from every side, who suffers as they do and still stands.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Theme:** The elders say that not to be born at all is best, and next best, once born, is to go back quickly — a judgment on long life and the troubles that come with it.
- **Imagery:** They compare Oedipus to a headland on an iron-bound shore, lashed by the wintry blast and by storms from sunset, from the east, and from the noonday glow.
- **Tone / mood:** The ode is a lament sung by old men, heavy with weariness of long life and with pity for the guest who has known the same ills.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** "Not to be born".

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: "Not to be born".

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way" (Stasimon 3, lines 1284–1287) The ode says it is best not to be born at all, and next best to die quickly once born.
- "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune's whelming tide, / By every wind of heaven o'erborne / Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, / Some from the noonday glow" (Stasimon 3, lines 1298–1306) It likens their guest to a headland beaten by storms from every quarter of the sky.
- "Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span" (Stasimon 3, lines 1270–1271) The song warns that craving more life than the common span only multiplies misery.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, sung as old men's grief and already set beside a scene of love.
Evidence: "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune's whelming tide, / By every wind of heaven o'erborne / Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, / Some from the noonday glow" (Stasimon 3, lines 1298–1306)
Reasoning: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1270–1271
1270 **Chorus:** Who craves excess of days,
1271 **Chorus:** Scorning the common span

Lines 1270–1283
1270 **Chorus:** Who craves excess of days,
1271 **Chorus:** Scorning the common span
1272 **Chorus:** Of life, I judge that man
1273 **Chorus:** A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways.
1274 **Chorus:** For the long years heap up a grievous load,
1275 **Chorus:** Scant pleasures, heavier pains,
1276 **Chorus:** Till not one joy remains
1277 **Chorus:** For him who lingers on life's weary road
1278 **Chorus:** And come it slow or fast,
1279 **Chorus:** One doom of fate
1280 **Chorus:** Doth all await,
1281 **Chorus:** For dance and marriage bell,
1282 **Chorus:** The dirge and funeral knell.
1283 **Chorus:** Death the deliverer freeth all at last.

Lines 1270–1297

1270 **Chorus:** Who craves excess of days,
1271 **Chorus:** Scorning the common span
1272 **Chorus:** Of life, I judge that man
1273 **Chorus:** A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways.
1274 **Chorus:** For the long years heap up a grievous load,
1275 **Chorus:** Scant pleasures, heavier pains,
1276 **Chorus:** Till not one joy remains
1277 **Chorus:** For him who lingers on life's weary road
1278 **Chorus:** And come it slow or fast,
1279 **Chorus:** One doom of fate
1280 **Chorus:** Doth all await,
1281 **Chorus:** For dance and marriage bell,
1282 **Chorus:** The dirge and funeral knell.
1283 **Chorus:** Death the deliverer freeth all at last.
1284 **Chorus:** Not to be born at all
1285 **Chorus:** Is best, far best that can befall,
1286 **Chorus:** Next best, when born, with least delay
1287 **Chorus:** To trace the backward way.
1288 **Chorus:** For when youth passes with its giddy train,
1289 **Chorus:** Troubles on troubles follow, toils on toils,
1290 **Chorus:** Pain, pain for ever pain;
1291 **Chorus:** And none escapes life's coils.
1292 **Chorus:** Envy, sedition, strife,
1293 **Chorus:** Carnage and war, make up the tale of life.
1294 **Chorus:** Last comes the worst and most abhorred stage
1295 **Chorus:** Of unregarded age,
1296 **Chorus:** Joyless, companionless and slow,
1297 **Chorus:** Of woes the crowning woe.

Lines 1270–1307

1270 **Chorus:** Who craves excess of days,
1271 **Chorus:** Scorning the common span
1272 **Chorus:** Of life, I judge that man
1273 **Chorus:** A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways.
1274 **Chorus:** For the long years heap up a grievous load,
1275 **Chorus:** Scant pleasures, heavier pains,
1276 **Chorus:** Till not one joy remains
1277 **Chorus:** For him who lingers on life's weary road
1278 **Chorus:** And come it slow or fast,
1279 **Chorus:** One doom of fate
1280 **Chorus:** Doth all await,
1281 **Chorus:** For dance and marriage bell,
1282 **Chorus:** The dirge and funeral knell.

1283 **Chorus:** Death the deliverer freeth all at last.
1284 **Chorus:** Not to be born at all
1285 **Chorus:** Is best, far best that can befall,
1286 **Chorus:** Next best, when born, with least delay
1287 **Chorus:** To trace the backward way.
1288 **Chorus:** For when youth passes with its giddy train,
1289 **Chorus:** Troubles on troubles follow, toils on toils,
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1294 **Chorus:** Last comes the worst and most abhorred stage
1295 **Chorus:** Of unregarded age,
1296 **Chorus:** Joyless, companionless and slow,
1297 **Chorus:** Of woes the crowning woe.
1298 **Chorus:** Such ills not I alone,
1299 **Chorus:** He too our guest hath known,
1300 **Chorus:** E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore,
1301 **Chorus:** Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar,
1302 **Chorus:** So is he buffeted on every side
1303 **Chorus:** By drear misfortune's whelming tide,
1304 **Chorus:** By every wind of heaven o'erborne
1305 **Chorus:** Some from the sunset, some from orient morn,
1306 **Chorus:** Some from the noonday glow.
1307 **Chorus:** Some from Rhipean gloom of everlasting snow.

Line 1272
1272 **Chorus:** Of life, I judge that man

Line 1273
1273 **Chorus:** A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways.

Lines 1278–1280
1278 **Chorus:** And come it slow or fast,
1279 **Chorus:** One doom of fate
1280 **Chorus:** Doth all await,

Line 1283
1283 **Chorus:** Death the deliverer freeth all at last.

Lines 1284–1285
1284 **Chorus:** Not to be born at all
1285 **Chorus:** Is best, far best that can befall,

Lines 1284–1287
1284 **Chorus:** Not to be born at all

1285 **Chorus:** Is best, far best that can befall,
1286 **Chorus:** Next best, when born, with least delay
1287 **Chorus:** To trace the backward way.

Lines 1298–1306
1298 **Chorus:** Such ills not I alone,
1299 **Chorus:** He too our guest hath known,
1300 **Chorus:** E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore,
1301 **Chorus:** Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar,
1302 **Chorus:** So is he buffeted on every side
1303 **Chorus:** By drear misfortune's whelming tide,
1304 **Chorus:** By every wind of heaven o'erborne
1305 **Chorus:** Some from the sunset, some from orient morn,
1306 **Chorus:** Some from the noonday glow.

Lines 1298–1307
1298 **Chorus:** Such ills not I alone,
1299 **Chorus:** He too our guest hath known,
1300 **Chorus:** E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore,
1301 **Chorus:** Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar,
1302 **Chorus:** So is he buffeted on every side
1303 **Chorus:** By drear misfortune's whelming tide,
1304 **Chorus:** By every wind of heaven o'erborne
1305 **Chorus:** Some from the sunset, some from orient morn,
1306 **Chorus:** Some from the noonday glow.
1307 **Chorus:** Some from Rhipean gloom of everlasting snow.

Lines 1300–1302
1300 **Chorus:** E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore,
1301 **Chorus:** Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar,
1302 **Chorus:** So is he buffeted on every side

Line 1301
1301 **Chorus:** Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar,

Line 1302
1302 **Chorus:** So is he buffeted on every side

Line 1305
1305 **Chorus:** Some from the sunset, some from orient morn,

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
headland (noun)	a high point of land jutting into the sea	*He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore,*

sedition (noun)	speech or action that stirs rebellion against authority	*Envy, sedition, strife, Carnage and war, make up the tale of life.*
dirge (noun)	a mournful song or hymn for the dead	*For dance and marriage bell, / The dirge and funeral knell.*
knell (noun)	the sound of a bell rung slowly to mark a death or funeral	*For dance and marriage bell, / The dirge and funeral knell.*
carnage (noun)	widespread killing; great slaughter	*Envy, sedition, strife, / Carnage and war, make up the tale of life.*
giddy (adjective)	thoughtlessly reckless	*Of life, I judge that man / A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways.*
wight (noun)	a person (an archaic or literary word)	*Of life, I judge that man / A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways.*
coils (noun)	windings or entanglements, here the troubles that wrap around a life	*Pain, pain for ever pain; / And none escapes life's coils.*

Discussion questions

1. How does the scene in which the daughters were restored already sit beside this ode?
2. Where does theme appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with curse and mercy?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What two kinds of rite does the ode pair as waiting under one doom of fate? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The dance and marriage bell, together with the dirge and funeral knell. The ode says that, come it slow or fast, one doom of fate awaits all, and it sets those festive and funeral sounds side by side as a common bound.
   Answer guidance: The dance and marriage bell, together with the dirge and funeral knell. The ode says that, come it slow or fast, one doom of fate awaits all, and it sets those festive and funeral sounds side by side as a common bound.
2. What does the ode say remains, for him who lingers on life's weary road? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Not one joy remains
   Answer guidance: Not one joy remains.
3. What repeated word does the ode use, after youth has passed, to name the cost of living on? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Pain, said more than once
   Answer guidance: Pain, said more than once.

4. What does the chorus say of these ills, as to who has known them, besides themselves? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** They are not the chorus's lot alone
   Answer guidance: They are not the chorus's lot alone.
5. What does the ode say one doom of fate does, come it slow or fast? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** It awaits all
   Answer guidance: It awaits all.
6. What train does the ode say passes with youth, before later troubles are listed? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A giddy train
   Answer guidance: A giddy train.
7. After the list of public troubles, what does the ode say they make up? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The tale of life
   Answer guidance: The tale of life.
8. What does the ode say comes last, after the public troubles have been named? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The worst and most abhorred stage of life
   Answer guidance: The worst and most abhorred stage of life.
9. What does the closing image say he is, as the winds beat upon him? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Buffeted on every side
   Answer guidance: Buffeted on every side.
10. What does the ode say happens to youth, before the later troubles are listed? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Youth passes
    Answer guidance: Youth passes.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why compare Oedipus to a headland rather than a ship? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A headland stays where it is while storms break on it from every side: the image grants his suffering and also his endurance, as a ship's wreck would not.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: A ship can be wrecked and sink; a headland stays where it is. The elders picture their guest "as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar" (lines 1300–1301). The image grants that he is "buffeted on every side" (line 1302), but it also makes him something the storms cannot carry away. The comparison holds both his suffering and his endurance.
2. What does "Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)" suggest about "Not to be born"? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, spoken as old men's grief and already set beside a scene of love: the ode voices that grief while the scene before it showed love that makes life worth living.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The ode suggests how old age and long suffering can make life itself look like a burden: "Not to be born at all / Is best" (lines 1284–1285). Just before the ode, Oedipus held his daughters and said, "Death were not wholly bitter with you near" (line 1170). The ode is one voice of sorrow inside a play that keeps showing care and companionship.

3. Find one example of theme in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”. What does it reveal about "Not to be born" that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A theme example, such as the loneliness of old age (“companionless”), explained for what it reveals: the elders’ despair is about loneliness as much as length of life, which the daughters’ presence answers.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The ode’s worst stage of life is “unregarded age, / Joyless, companionless and slow” (lines 1295–1296). The word “companionless” shows that the elders fear being alone and unregarded, not simply growing old. A plain statement that life is hard would miss this, and the scene just before it answers the fear: Oedipus is old and blind but not companionless.
4. How does the imagery in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” shape what we understand about "Not to be born"? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The imagery of a road, a load and storms from every direction, which makes long life a weight and a battering, and the headland image that turns the battering into endurance.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The images make long life a weight and a battering: “the long years heap up a grievous load” (line 1274), and storms come “Some from the sunset, some from orient morn” (line 1305). They shape our sense of Oedipus as a man struck from every side. The headland image at the end adds endurance: what is battered from every side still stands.
5. In the passage that opens with “Who craves excess of…”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two words from the opening (lines 1270–1277) with their connotations, such as “craves,” “excess,” “giddy wight” or “weary road,” showing the elders judging the wish for long life as folly.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The word “craves” (line 1270) makes the wish for long life sound like hunger or greed, and “giddy wight” (line 1273) calls such a person a dizzy fool. Together they judge the desire for more years as foolish appetite. The elders speak as old men disillusioned with what age brings.
6. What causes the main turn in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The turn is from general truths about life to “our guest,” and its effect is to tie the ode’s grief to Oedipus as he faces the hearing he dreads.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The ode turns at “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known” (lines 1298–1299). Before this the elders speak of everyone’s life; after it they speak of Oedipus. The effect is to bring the sorrow back to the man on stage just before he must face the son he called “hateful” (line 1232), so the audience expects pain rather than comfort.
7. How does “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” build on “Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A causal link: Episode 3 ends with Oedipus reluctantly agreeing to hear his son, so the elders, waiting, reflect on the troubles that pile up in a long life.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Episode 3 ends with Oedipus yielding only grudgingly, “Grievous to me, my child, the boon ye win / By pleading” (lines 1263–1264). The ode reflects that grief: “Troubles on troubles follow, toils on toils” (line 1289). One more trouble is coming to an old man who already has many, and that makes the elders think about the burdens of a long life.
8. In “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about "Not to be born", as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A motive inferred from the ode: the elders speak

in general truths, but the line "Such ills not I alone" shows they are describing their own old age as well as the guest's.

Answer guidance: Model answer: The ode sounds like a general rule about life, but "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known" (lines 1298–1299) admits that the elders are also speaking of themselves. Their motive is personal: old men expressing their own weariness and finding in their guest a companion in suffering. That makes the ode sympathy, not cold philosophy.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (How does the scene in which the daughters were restored already sit beside this ode?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A revised answer to the bell-ringer (how the scene in which the daughters were restored already sits beside this ode), using the daughters' care or the headland's endurance as the counter-evidence.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: I first said the earlier scene does not sit beside this song. Now I see that it does: Oedipus said, "Death were not wholly bitter with you near" (line 1170), because his daughters were with him. The ode's worst fear is age "Joyless, companionless and slow" (line 1296), and Oedipus is not companionless. The earlier scene answers the ode with love rather than argument.

10. Where does tone / mood appear in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)", and how does it connect "Not to be born" to the larger concern with curse and mercy? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Where the tone shifts from bitter judgment to pity for the guest, and how that connects to curse and mercy: the ode feels for a man buffeted on every side just before he is asked to show mercy to his son.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: The tone moves from bitter judgment ("A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways," line 1273) to pity for the guest, "So is he buffeted on every side" (line 1302). That pity matters for curse and mercy. The elders show mercy to Oedipus just before he is asked to show it to his son, which leaves the audience asking whether a man so battered can give what the elders give him.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Open question: does the play agree with this ode? Defend any position with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A defended position: the play does not simply agree; it frames the ode as old men's grief and answers it with care, endurance and the gods' concern. A counterpoint notes how much suffering the play does show.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the play understands the ode but does not simply rest in it, even in this section. The ode says "Death the deliverer freeth all at last" (line 1283), but the same day's evidence gives Oedipus his daughters' love, "I have my darlings" (line 1169), and the elders themselves picture him as a headland that endures (line 1300). Counter-line: the play does show suffering on every side (lines 1302–1307), so the ode's sorrow is earned, even if it is not the only word this section gives us.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, set beside a scene of love that came just before it. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A stand with two lines, qualifying the claim by pointing out that at this point the play's counterweight is the love shown in the scene before the ode, not an ending we have not yet read.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: agree, with a qualification. The despair is strong: "Not to be born at all / Is best" (lines 1284–1285). But the frame is already there: the ode ends by comparing Oedipus to a headland that stands against the storm (lines 1300–1302), and the scene before it showed love (line

1170). The counterweight at this point is that earlier scene and the headland, not a later act we have not yet read.

3. No character acts in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”; the elders reflect. Which attitude toward a long life does the ode present as wisest, and which as least wise? Judge them by a standard you name, and say whether you accept it. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named standard applied to two attitudes the ode describes, for example the man who craves endless years against acceptance of the common span, with lines and a counter-view from the daughters' care.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: by the ode's own standard, accepting the ordinary span of life, the man who “craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span” (lines 1270–1271) is least wise, and the wise attitude is acceptance that “One doom of fate / Doth all await” (lines 1279–1280). A student could challenge the standard: Oedipus's wish to live near his daughters (line 1170) seems wiser than the ode's weariness.

4. You are directing “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of "Not to be born". [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two staging choices tied to lines, such as the chorus turning toward Oedipus at “He too our guest hath known” or sound effects of wind and sea for the headland, each with its effect.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: (1) Sing the opening lines (lines 1270–1297) facing the audience, as general reflection, then have the elders turn toward Oedipus at “He too our guest hath known” (line 1299), so the sorrow lands on him. (2) Under the headland image (lines 1300–1307), bring in the sound of wind and surf from different sides while Oedipus sits upright and still. The audience sees him battered but standing.

5. Write your own questions about “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Three questions answerable from lines 1270–1307: one recall, one why/how and one should/what-if, different in kind.

   Answer guidance: Model set. Recall: To what does the ode compare Oedipus? (A headland on a storm-beaten shore, lines 1300–1302.) Why/how: Why does the ode call the worst stage “unregarded age” (line 1295)? (Being old and ignored is worse than being old.) Should/what if: Should the elders have sung this ode in front of their suffering guest? (Answers weigh honesty and sympathy against comfort.)

6. Connect “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”, with its focus on "Not to be born", to law against force: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment about law against force, the question's theme. The link is weak here; the ode names “Envy, sedition, strife” and war as life's troubles but proposes no law. A strong answer says what must come next.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the link is weak in this ode. It lists “Envy, sedition, strife, / Carnage and war” (lines 1292–1293) as the stuff of life but offers no law against them, only endurance. The theme is waiting: Oedipus has agreed to hear a son who came as a suppliant under the god's protection. To strengthen the link, Sophocles must show whether custom and law can govern that hearing, or whether strife wins again.

7. Is the theme in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” effective in presenting "Not to be born", or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that

matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment against a stated criterion (honest grief or heavy pessimism?), with a line that meets the criterion and one that might miss it, mindful that this is grief and age speaking in a song.

Answer guidance: One defensible answer: effective, because the grief is concrete and tied to a person, ending with the headland (lines 1300–1307), not an abstract sermon. Counter-line: the run "Pain, pain for ever pain" (line 1290) and the piled-up list of troubles may feel heavy-handed to a modern reader. A fair review notes that the ode is grief and old age speaking, and the play sets other voices against it.

8. Compare how "Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)" treats "Not to be born" with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named comparison (another text about the burdens of old age or a lament) and one thing the ode sees that the other misses, tied to a line.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Compare Dylan Thomas's villanelle that urges his dying father to fight against death. The ode sees a different side of age: weariness and loneliness, "Joyless, companionless and slow" (line 1296). It sees that what makes old age hardest is being "unregarded" (line 1295). That is why the daughters' care in the play matters so much.

9. Predict what "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A prediction from two clues, the ode's list of "sedition, strife" and war and Oedipus's grudging promise to hear his son, about the meeting with the son, checked after reading.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Clue 1: the ode names "Envy, sedition, strife, / Carnage and war" (lines 1292–1293) as the tale of life. Clue 2: Oedipus agreed to hear his son only grudgingly, calling him "my hateful son" (line 1232). A reasonable prediction is that the son will come asking for something tied to strife, and that his father will not receive him kindly. After reading, students check how far the ode's dark mood prepared for the scene.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about "Not to be born"? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An adaptation that keeps the core: old people reflect bitterly on the burdens of long life, then turn their pity on a friend who has suffered more. It names two details that must stay, framing it as grief.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: In a care-home lounge, residents talk bitterly about how long life has brought more losses than joys, then one nods toward a blind newcomer and says he has had it worse than any of them, though he is still standing. Two things must stay: the turn from the elders' own sorrow to the guest, "He too our guest hath known" (line 1299), and the image of endurance at the end (lines 1300–1302), so it reads as grief and sympathy.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who sings this ode?

   A. The elders of Colonus

   B. Antigone by herself

   C. Oedipus to the king

   D. Theseus from the altar

   Key: A (The elders of Colonus)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To what is Oedipus compared?

   A. A tree swept away in a sudden winter flood

   B. A headland battered by storms from every side

   C. A hunted bull running through the sacred grove

   D. A ship already safe inside the quiet harbour

   Key: B (A headland battered by storms from every side)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "E'en as some _____ on an iron-bound shore,"

   Key: headland

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "_____ by the wintry blasts and surge's roar,"

   Key: Lashed

5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What stage of life does the ode call the worst?

   A. Childhood in the house

   B. Youth with its giddy train

   C. Unregarded age

   D. The hour of a marriage bell

   Key: C (Unregarded age)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which troubles does the ode list?

   A. Feasts, dances, and easy rewards of fame

   B. Wealth, honour, and a quiet old age

   C. Love, friendship, and the care of children

   D. Envy, sedition, strife, carnage and war

   Key: D (Envy, sedition, strife, carnage and war)

7. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What do "the long years" do, according to the chorus? Use the lines about a grievous load and a weary road.

   Sample answer: The singers picture long life as a burden that grows heavier, not as a prize. They say, "For the long years heap up a grievous load, / Scant pleasures, heavier pains, / Till not one joy remains / For him who lingers on life's weary road" (lines 1274–1277). Pleasure shrinks, pain grows, and joy runs out for the one who lingers. This is the chorus of old men describing a weary road in song.

8. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] From which directions do the winds strike the imagined headland?

   A. From every side: sunset, morning, noon, and the north

   B. From the harbour of Athens only, in a single gust

   C. From Thebes alone, as a sign the guest must return

D. From underground, as if the shore itself were sinking

Key: A (From every side: sunset, morning, noon, and the north)

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] How do the images of "dance and marriage bell" and "The dirge and funeral knell" work together? Quote both.

   Sample answer: The chorus sets a scene of celebration beside a scene of mourning, then binds them under one fate. "For dance and marriage bell, / The dirge and funeral knell." (lines 1281–1282) names both kinds of music, and the lines just before say that one doom awaits all, whether it comes slow or fast. Joyful rites and funeral rites are placed in the same song. The point is the chorus's dark view of time, spoken in grief.

10. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] How does the ode turn from a general lament to Oedipus himself? Use the line "Such ills not I alone".

    Sample answer: After listing the troubles of a long life, the singers refuse to treat those troubles as only their own. "Such ills not I alone," they say (line 1298), and they add that their guest has known them too. The ode then pictures him as a shore beaten by weather from every side. The turn matters: the lament becomes a portrait of the man they have just received, while the song remains a cry of old age.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In what mood do the elders of Colonus sing this ode?

    A. In grief, as aged men lamenting a long and burdened life

    B. In triumph, celebrating a Theban victory already won

    C. In comic relief after the curse upon the sons

    D. In a festive wedding hymn for the daughters

    Key: A (In grief, as aged men lamenting a long and burdened life)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the chorus call the man who craves excess of days?

    A. A hero already sure of a quiet and easy end

    B. A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways

    C. A king who has earned a still longer life here

    D. A boy who has not yet learned to hope at all

    Key: B (A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "He too our _____ hath known,"

    Key: guest

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "By drear misfortune's _____ tide,"

    Key: whelming

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why is a headland a fitting image for the guest in this ode?

    A. He is pictured as sailing safely out of Attica before night comes

    B. He is pictured as already buried on a hidden northern shore

    C. He stands fixed and is beaten from every side, not sunk

    D. He is pictured as leading the whole chorus back home to Thebes

    Key: C (He stands fixed and is beaten from every side, not sunk)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Who, besides the singers, has known the ills the ode describes?

    A. Theseus, whom they name as a fellow singer of the ode

    B. Creon, whom they name as a welcome friend in the grove

C. Polyneices, whom they name as already gone from the land

D. Oedipus, the man the singers include with themselves

Key: D (Oedipus, the man the singers include with themselves)

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What judgment opens the ode? Use the lines about craving excess of days and walking in folly's ways.

Sample answer: The chorus begins by judging the wish for too long a life. "Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span" (lines 1270–1271) names that craving, and the sentence ends, "A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways." (line 1273). The man who wants more days than the common span is called giddy and foolish. This is an old men's judgment inside a lament, and it should be read as grief speaking in song about a long life.

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What happens, in the ode's account, when youth has passed?

A. Troubles and toils follow, and none escapes life's coils

B. A quiet harbour opens and every last pain is lifted

C. The guest is told to return at once toward Thebes

D. The chorus breaks off and refuses to name any of the pain

Key: A (Troubles and toils follow, and none escapes life's coils)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the ode describe life after youth? Use the lines about a giddy train and life's coils.

Sample answer: Once youth is gone, the song sees no easy remainder, only a tightening sequence of hardships. "For when youth passes with its giddy train, / Troubles on troubles follow, toils on toils, / Pain, pain for ever pain; / And none escapes life's coils." (lines 1288–1291). The repeated "troubles," "toils," and "pain" make the years after youth sound crowded and inescapable. Again this is the chorus picturing a bitter pattern in grief, not a command about what a person should do.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the ode name old age just before it turns to the guest? Use the lines about an unregarded stage and a crowning woe.

Sample answer: The last general stage in the song is not childhood or youth, but an old age the chorus calls unseen and joyless. "Last comes the worst and most abhorred stage / Of unregarded age, / Joyless, companionless and slow, / Of woes the crowning woe." (lines 1294–1297). "Unregarded," "joyless," and "companionless" make that stage sound abandoned. The lines belong to a lament by old men; they describe a fear of being left alone.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What judgment does the chorus pass on the man who wants more than a common span of life?

A. It judges that craving as giddy folly, scorning a common span

B. It praises him as the wisest and kindest guest in all Attica

C. It names him already sure of an honoured, quiet, famous grave

D. It asks Theseus to grant him twice the whole span of years

Key: A (It judges that craving as giddy folly, scorning a common span)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "By every wind of heaven _____"

Key: o'erborne

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Some from the sunset, some from _____ morn,"

Key: orient

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why compare Oedipus to a headland rather than to a ship?

A. A headland can raise its anchor and leave the rocky shore at will

B. A headland stands fixed and is beaten, but is not pictured as sunk

C. A ship would hide the guest's true name from every beating wind

D. A ship would mean the daughters had already sailed for home at once

Key: B (A headland stands fixed and is beaten, but is not pictured as sunk)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the claim that these ills are 'not I alone' add to the ode?

A. The elders deny that Oedipus has suffered any hardship at all in this song

B. The elders announce that the son has already been cursed in this very hour

C. The elders include themselves, then turn those ills toward their guest

D. The elders ask to keep the resting-place hidden from every later visitor

Key: C (The elders include themselves, then turn those ills toward their guest)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How should we read the personification “Death the deliverer freeth all at last”? Quote the line and explain its place in the song.

Sample answer: The line gives Death a title and a verb, as if Death were a figure who sets people free. “Death the deliverer freeth all at last.” (line 1283). In the ode it follows the marriage bell and the funeral knell, so it sums up the chorus’s weary view that one fate comes to all. It should be read as grief and old age speaking in a song. The play has already shown the daughters’ care in the scene before this song; that care is part of the larger context in which this lament is heard.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the line “So is he buffeted on every side” do in the closing image? Quote it.

Sample answer: It applies the storm to the man himself, after the chorus has named a headland and the weather that beats a shore. “So is he buffeted on every side” (line 1302) makes Oedipus the rock that takes the blows. He is not pictured as already gone, and he is not pictured as choosing the storm; he is pictured as standing while trouble comes from every quarter. The image is sympathy for a guest who has suffered, spoken in the same song of grief, not a verdict that his story is finished.

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In the ode's sequence, what makes unregarded age the worst stage?

A. It is called the only stage that still increases every lasting joy

B. It is called a return of childhood, free of every heavy burden

C. It is called the hour when the guest is sent back toward Thebes

D. It is called joyless, companionless and slow, the crowning woe

Key: D (It is called joyless, companionless and slow, the crowning woe)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the wording of the ode's darkest claim about birth and a 'backward way' reveal about the elders' perspective? Quote the four lines.

Sample answer: The wording itself ranks two states and makes the second a motion backward. “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way.” (Chorus, lines 1284–1287). “Far best” raises never-being-born above every other fate, and “next best” plus “least delay” rush a life that has already begun toward “the backward way,” a phrase that turns dying into a retracing of the path of birth. The lines belong to old men singing in grief about long life and pain. The immediately earlier scene, in which the daughters were restored to their father, already stands beside this song as a picture of love and care.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Does the ode speak in a private voice, or does it also judge a kind of life? Use the chorus's act of judging.

Sample answer: It does both: the singers speak as particular old men, and they also pass a judgment on craving too many days. They say, "Of life, I judge that man" (line 1272), which makes the opening a verdict as well as a moan. That verdict still belongs inside a lyric lament; it tells us how these elders, in this grief, see a long life. The later turn to "our guest" keeps the judgment attached to a real sufferer standing among them.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Some from the _____ glow."
    Key: noonday

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Some from _____ gloom of everlasting snow."
    Key: Rhipean

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of naming winds from sunset, morning, noon, and Rhipean snow?
    A. The blows seem to come from every quarter of the sky at once
    B. The weather is limited to a single mild breeze from the west
    C. The image proves that the guest has already left the shore
    D. The directions tell the daughters to sail home before night
    Key: A (The blows seem to come from every quarter of the sky at once)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How should the line that names Death as a deliverer be understood in this ode?
    A. As a stage direction telling the guest to leave the grove at once
    B. As personification inside a lament by aged singers
    C. As a promise that Oedipus has already been taken from the sacred grove
    D. As a joke meant to cancel the rest of the song
    Key: B (As personification inside a lament by aged singers)

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the chorus mean by saying that none escapes life's coils?
    A. The guest has already slipped the coils and left the land for good now
    B. Only the sons of Oedipus are said to escape every last kind of pain
    C. After youth, the ode sees troubles tightening around every life it names
    D. The coils are a legal bond Theseus can unfasten at will this very hour
    Key: C (After youth, the ode sees troubles tightening around every life it names)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of calling the last stage 'unregarded age'?
    A. It pictures that last stage as the one crowds come to honour and to praise
    B. It pictures that last stage as a quiet prize already claimed in full by him
    C. It pictures that last stage as a return to Thebes under a son's close protection
    D. It pictures that last stage as ignored and joyless, the crowning woe in the song
    Key: D (It pictures that last stage as ignored and joyless, the crowning woe in the song)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What is the force of "And come it slow or fast, / One doom of fate / Doth all await"? Quote the lines.
    Sample answer: The lines make speed irrelevant: whether the end is delayed or sudden, the same fate is said to wait for everyone. "And come it slow or fast, / One doom of fate / Doth all await," (lines 1278–1280). Coming just after the weary

road, they widen the lament from the man who lingers to all who live. The claim is absolute inside the song, and that is why it must be read as the chorus's grief.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How do the listed troubles shape "the tale of life" in this ode? Use the lines that name them.

    Sample answer: The chorus does not describe life as a mix of goods and harms; it composes a tale out of civic and violent ills. "Envy, sedition, strife, / Carnage and war, make up the tale of life." (lines 1292–1293). Envy and sedition belong to the city, carnage and war to bloodshed, and the verb "make up" leaves little room in the tale for anything else. The catalogue is the darkness of the song, a view from old men in grief, not a complete map of the play.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the closing weather image treat Oedipus: as already destroyed, or as still standing under the blows? Defend your view from the end of the ode, without quoting a fill line.

    Sample answer: He is treated as still standing. The chorus first says that these ills are not theirs alone, then likens their guest to a headland on a hard shore, and finally says he is beaten from every side by winds off sunset, morning, noon, and the Rhipean north (Chorus, lines 1298–1307). A headland takes the weather and remains a headland; the song does not show him sinking or already gone. The image is a figure for endurance under misfortune, spoken in sympathy, and it should not be turned into a claim that his end has already come.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the ode move from the elders' first-person verdict on long life ("I judge", line 1272) to their guest (line 1299)? Trace the turn and explain what it changes in the song.

    Sample answer: The ode opens as the elders' own verdict: "Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span / Of life, I judge that man / A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways." (lines 1270–1273). The stanzas that follow keep the voice of old men weighing long life, from a grievous load to an unregarded age, "Of woes the crowning woe." (line 1297). Then the speaker who judged includes himself and turns outward: "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known," (lines 1298–1299). The closing headland, "Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar," (line 1301), makes the guest the figure of those ills. The turn changes the song from a general verdict into recognition of one man who has suffered them and still stands.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) develops the idea of "Not to be born". Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)" could deliver about "Not to be born". Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for "Not to be born" in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of "Not to be born". Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” could deliver about "Not to be born". Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for "Not to be born" in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) suggests about "Not to be born". Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's theme and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” could deliver about "Not to be born". Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for "Not to be born" in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses theme in Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) to complicate the reader's understanding of "Not to be born". Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” could deliver about "Not to be born". Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for "Not to be born" in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and

explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Who craves excess of days, Scorning the common span Of life, I judge that man A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways. For the long years heap up a grievous load, Scant pleasures, heavier pains, Till not one joy remains For him who lingers on life's weary road And come it slow or fast, One doom of fate Doth all await, For dance and marriage bell, The dirge and funeral knell. Death the deliverer freeth all at last.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "span" most nearly mean?

   A. a bridge built over a river

   B. a sudden burst of music

   C. the ordinary allotted length of life

   D. a hidden store of gold

2. *Who craves excess of days, Scorning the common span Of life, I judge that man A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways. For the long years heap up a grievous load, Scant pleasures, heavier pains, Till not one joy remains For him who lingers on life's weary road And come it slow or fast, One doom of fate Doth all await, For dance and marriage bell, The dirge and funeral knell. Death the deliverer freeth all at last. Not to be born at all Is best, far best that can befall, Next best, when born, with least delay To trace the backward way. For when youth passes with its giddy train, Troubles on troubles follow, toils on toils, Pain, pain for ever pain; And none escapes life's coils. Envy, sedition, strife, Carnage and war, make up the tale of life. Last comes the worst and most abhorred stage Of unregarded age, Joyless, companionless and slow, Of woes the crowning woe.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)"?

   A. Creon seizes the daughters

   B. The Colonus ode

   C. A victory song celebrating a long life without pain

   D. "Not to be born"

SAT key: 1. C (the ordinary allotted length of life); 2. D ("Not to be born")

Lesson 10: Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)

Focus: Polyneices and the father's curse

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in “Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: “What does this passage make us notice?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

Background: Oedipus' praise of his daughters as "men / Not women" (lines 1419–1420) reflects the gender stereotypes of his time; teach them as such.

Significance: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Polyneices comes as a suppliant and leaves under a father’s curse; the scene tests whether a son who failed his father in exile can still claim blessing for a war on Thebes.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
7 key words in context.
Today's words: abhorred — hated; regarded with disgust; co-partner — one who shares equally in something; enmity — deep-seated hatred or hostility; prophecy — a declaration of what will happen, believed to come from a god; remit — to withdraw or cancel (anger or a penalty); kinsman — a male relative; oracles — messages or answers believed to come from a god, often through a shrine.
Words: abhorred: hated; regarded with disgust · co-partner: one who shares equally in something · enmity: deep-seated hatred or hostility · prophecy: a declaration of what will happen, believed to come from a god · remit: to withdraw or cancel (anger or a penalty) · kinsman: a male relative · oracles: messages or answers believed to come from a god, often through a shrine

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Oedipus' praise of his daughters as "men / Not women" (lines 1419–1420) reflects the gender stereotypes of his time; teach them as such. The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Conflict: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him, saying the brothers will die by each other's hands, and Antigone cannot turn Polyneices back. Characterization: Polyneices invokes Mercy as the partner of Zeus's throne, then speaks as a general who reports successes and conceals mishaps. Oedipus answers by praising his daughters' service and disowning his sons. Foreshadowing: After the curse, Polyneices asks his sisters to bury him if it comes true, which sets up Antigone: the family's past is made into its future. Watch for the sacred grove and the hidden grave: The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: Polyneices and the father's curse.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart..." slowly and put it in my own words: Polyneices asks that Mercy, who sits beside Zeus, also sit on the throne of his father's heart. Next, craft. I notice he argues from a god's court to a father's: Mercy is "co-partner" of Zeus's throne, and so should be "enthroned" in Oedipus. The strongest word is "enthroned": "enthroned" makes mercy a royal power he wants seated in his father, the same kind of power he hopes will bless his cause. Then, effect. What do lines 1324–1327 reveal about Polyneices' plea? My answer: This is Polyneices' plea: he asks for mercy as a partner of rule. The line shows what Polyneices wants from the father he now faces, before that father answers him.

> *But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise (Episode 4, lines 1324–1327)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart…" slowly and put it in my own words: Polyneices asks that Mercy, who sits beside Zeus, also sit on the throne of his father's heart. Next, craft. I notice he argues from a god's court to a father's: Mercy is "co-partner" of Zeus's throne, and so should be "enthroned" in Oedipus. The strongest word is "enthroned": "enthroned" makes mercy a royal power he wants seated in his father, the same kind of power he hopes will bless his cause. Then, effect. What do lines 1324–1327 reveal about Polyneices' plea? My answer: This is Polyneices' plea: he asks for mercy as a partner of rule. The line shows what Polyneices wants from the father he now faces, before that father answers him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Preserve", "service" and "bastards" stand out. "They tend me, they preserve me" names the daughters' care as what has kept him alive; "true service to their sire" honours that care; "But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine" disowns the sons who failed it. Oedipus praises his daughters' service and disowns his sons (Oedipus, lines 1419–1421). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected student answer: He contrasts the daughters who have preserved him in exile with the sons who now seek his blessing; the curse falls because they failed the care that kinship and hospitality required.

> *They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine (Episode 4, lines 1419–1421)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Preserve", "service" and "bastards" stand out. "They tend me, they preserve me" names the daughters' care as what has kept him alive; "true service to their sire" honours that care; "But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine" disowns the sons who failed it. Oedipus praises his daughters' service and disowns his sons (Oedipus, lines 1419–1421).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected student answer: He contrasts the daughters who have preserved him in exile with the sons who now seek his blessing; the curse falls because they failed the care that kinship and hospitality required.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Polyneices and the father's curse? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) develops the idea of Polyneices and the father's curse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. When the text says "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise" (Episode 4, lines 1324–1327), it shows this directly. Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

Task: Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Polyneices and the father's curse? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) develops the idea of Polyneices and the father's curse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Access supports: Access supports (not a legal-compliance promise). These are teaching options for English learners and for students with IEP or 504 needs; they do not replace a student's plan, and using them does not by itself satisfy any legal requirement. Chunked reading: Polyneices' plea (the Mercy speech at lines 1324–1327) first, then Oedipus's answer and the curse, with a gist check after each. Sentence frames: Polyneices asks that Mercy sit "enthroned / In thy heart" (lines 1326–1327) because ___. / Oedipus says "They tend me, they preserve me" and "ye are bastards, and no sons of mine" (lines 1419–1421), which shows ___. Graphic organizer: a two-column plea-and-answer chart with a located quotation on each side. Time: extended time on the quiz and writing start. Audio: hear the Mercy speech and the 1419–1421 judgement separately, following the printed text.

Exemplar: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. When the text says "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise" (Episode 4, lines 1324–1327), it shows this directly. Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail? Ask: Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail?

Anchor question: Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail?

Facilitation: Ask: Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Polyneices and the father's curse? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. ("But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise", Episode 4, lines 1324–1327). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Polyneices and the father's curse? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. ("But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise", Episode 4, lines 1324–1327). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes Polyneices and the father's curse. Key takeaway: Polyneices comes as a suppliant and leaves under a father's curse; the scene tests whether a son who failed his father in exile can still claim blessing for a war on Thebes.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him, saying the brothers will die by each other's hands, and Antigone cannot turn Polyneices back.
- **Characterization:** Polyneices invokes Mercy as the partner of Zeus's throne, then speaks as a general who reports successes and conceals mishaps. Oedipus answers by praising his daughters' service and disowning his sons.
- **Foreshadowing:** After the curse, Polyneices asks his sisters to bury him if it comes true, which sets up Antigone: the family's past is made into its future.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** Polyneices and the father's curse.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: Polyneices and the father's curse.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise" (Episode 4, lines 1324–1327) Polyneices begs his father to let Mercy sit beside justice, as it does beside Zeus.
- "They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine" (Episode 4, lines 1419–1421) Oedipus praises his daughters' service and disowns his sons as no true children of his.
- "I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports successes and conceals mishaps" (Episode 4, lines 1479–1480) Polyneices will report only success and hide the curse from the allies who follow him.
- "Misguided youth, thy purpose then stands fast" (Episode 4, line 1481) Antigone sees that her brother's warlike purpose is unchanged and names it misguided.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone.
Evidence: "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise" (Episode 4, lines 1324–1327)
Reasoning: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1313–1320

Polyneices: Ah me, my sisters, shall I first lament
Polyneices: My own afflictions, or my aged sire's,
Polyneices: Whom here I find a castaway, with you,
Polyneices: In a strange land, an ancient beggar clad
Polyneices: In antic tatters, marring all his frame,
Polyneices: While o'er the sightless orbs his unkempt locks
Polyneices: Float in the breeze; and, as it were to match,
Polyneices: He bears a wallet against hunger's pinch.

Lines 1313–1328

Polyneices: Ah me, my sisters, shall I first lament
Polyneices: My own afflictions, or my aged sire's,
Polyneices: Whom here I find a castaway, with you,
Polyneices: In a strange land, an ancient beggar clad
Polyneices: In antic tatters, marring all his frame,
Polyneices: While o'er the sightless orbs his unkempt locks
Polyneices: Float in the breeze; and, as it were to match,
Polyneices: He bears a wallet against hunger's pinch.
Polyneices: All this too late I learn, wretch that I am,
Polyneices: Alas! I own it, and am proved most vile

1323 **Polyneices:** In my neglect of thee: I scorn myself.
1324 **Polyneices:** But as almighty Zeus in all he doth
1325 **Polyneices:** Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne,
1326 **Polyneices:** Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned
1327 **Polyneices:** In thy heart likewise. For transgressions past
1328 **Polyneices:** May be amended, cannot be made worse.

Line 1323
1323 **Polyneices:** In my neglect of thee: I scorn myself.

Lines 1324–1327
1324 **Polyneices:** But as almighty Zeus in all he doth
1325 **Polyneices:** Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne,
1326 **Polyneices:** Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned
1327 **Polyneices:** In thy heart likewise. For transgressions past

Lines 1357–1358
1357 **Polyneices:** I came to Argos in the Dorian land
1358 **Polyneices:** And took the king Adrastus' child to wife,

Line 1368
1368 **Polyneices:** Beleaguer all the plain that circles Thebes.

Line 1392
1392 **Polyneices:** As pensioners, while he, the lord of Thebes,

Lines 1401–1402
1401 **Oedipus:** Nay, worthy seniors, but for Theseus' sake
1402 **Oedipus:** Who sent him hither to have word of me.

Lines 1419–1420
1419 **Oedipus:** They tend me, they preserve me, they are men
1420 **Oedipus:** Not women in true service to their sire;

Lines 1419–1421
1419 **Oedipus:** They tend me, they preserve me, they are men
1420 **Oedipus:** Not women in true service to their sire;
1421 **Oedipus:** But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine.

Line 1438
1438 **Oedipus:** This curse I leave thee as my last bequest:—

Lines 1479–1480
1479 **Polyneices:** I shall not tell it; a good general
1480 **Polyneices:** Reports successes and conceals mishaps.

Line 1480

1480 **Polyneices:** Reports successes and conceals mishaps.

Line 1481

1481 **Antigone:** Misguided youth, thy purpose then stands fast!

Line 1485

1485 **Polyneices:** Make your path bright if ye fulfill my hest

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
abhorred (noun)	hated; regarded with disgust	*Primeval Justice sits enthroned with Zeus. / Begone, abhorred, disowned, no son of mine,*
co-partner (noun)	one who shares equally in something	*But as almighty Zeus in all he doth Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned In thy heart likewise.*
enmity (noun)	deep-seated hatred or hostility	*To mortal enmity. Go now proclaim / What thou hast heard to the Cadmeians all,*
prophecy (noun)	a declaration of what will happen, believed to come from a god	*Hearing his prophecy, to follow thee? / I shall not tell it; a good general*
remit (verb)	to withdraw or cancel (anger or a penalty)	*We all adjure thee to remit thy wrath / And favour one who seeks a just revenge*
kinsman (noun)	a male relative	*But by a kinsman's hand to die and slay / Him who expelled thee. So I pray and call*
oracles (noun)	messages or answers believed to come from a god, often through a shrine	*For victory, if oracles speak true, / Will fall to those who have thee for ally.*

Discussion questions

1. Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with law against force?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Polyneices promise his father if the war at Thebes succeeds? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** To establish him at home again. After

asking pardon and aid, he offers this return as the reward of victory, a promise spoken in the plea, not a report that the city has already been taken.

Answer guidance: To establish him at home again. After asking pardon and aid, he offers this return as the reward of victory, a promise spoken in the plea, not a report that the city has already been taken.

2. What does Polyneices say his father bears against hunger's pinch? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A wallet

   Answer guidance: A wallet.

3. What does Polyneices say of his own neglect, when he first faces his father? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He scorns himself

   Answer guidance: He scorns himself.

4. Whose child does Polyneices say he took to wife, in Argos? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The child of King Adrastus

   Answer guidance: The child of King Adrastus.

5. How does Oedipus name the garb that Polyneices weeps to look upon? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** This beggar's garb

   Answer guidance: This beggar's garb.

6. What does Oedipus say he is forced to beg, through this son, in a strange land? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** His bread

   Answer guidance: His bread.

7. What hope does Polyneices say is baffled, once the curse has been spoken? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** His journey and his hopes

   Answer guidance: His journey and his hopes.

8. What does Polyneices tell the sisters they shall not see again, as he leaves? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** His living face

   Answer guidance: His living face.

9. What does Polyneices say of the sisters, in the eyes of all, as he parts? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** They are blameless

   Answer guidance: They are blameless.

10. Who sent Hippomedon to the war, according to Polyneices' roll of captains? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** His sire Talaos

    Answer guidance: His sire Talaos.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is Polyneices' plea for mercy unsuccessful? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** His father cannot forgive his abandonment; the curse is already set. Polyneices also asks for help in a war against his own city, so his plea for mercy is bound to a request for an ally.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Polyneices admits, “I own it, and am proved most vile / In my neglect of thee” (lines 1322–1323), but his plea is tied to a war: he wants his father’s favour because “victory, if oracles speak true, / Will fall to those who have thee for ally” (lines 1386–1387). Oedipus hears a son who

came only when he needed him, and answers with the curse he "lately launched against you twain" (line 1428).

2. What does "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" suggest about Polyneices and the father's curse? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The curse makes a family's past its future: the father's curse decides how the sons will die, and Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The scene suggests that a family's past wrongs shape its future. Oedipus curses his son "by a kinsman's hand to die and slay / Him who expelled thee" (lines 1441–1442), and Polyneices goes knowingly toward that end, asking his sisters, "grant me burial and due funeral rites" (line 1461). A request made in this scene reaches beyond the play into the sisters' future.
3. Find one example of conflict in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)". What does it reveal about Polyneices and the father's curse that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A specific clash, such as Antigone's attempt to turn her brother back, explained for what it reveals: Polyneices chooses ruin rather than shame, so the curse works through his own choice.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Antigone begs, "Turn back thy host to Argos with all speed, / And ruin not thyself and Thebes as well" (lines 1466–1467), and he answers, "'Tis shame to live in exile" (line 1472). The clash shows that the curse works through his own pride: he hears the prophecy and still says, "but I must not yield" (line 1476). A plain statement that he is cursed would miss that he walks into it.
4. How does the characterization in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" shape what we understand about Polyneices and the father's curse? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** How Polyneices is drawn as both sincere and self-serving (tears and confession, then a request for an ally), and Oedipus as justly wronged but terrible in anger, so neither is simply right.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Polyneices weeps and confesses, "I scorn myself" (line 1323), yet his speech quickly becomes a recruiting appeal for a war on his own city (lines 1365–1387). Oedipus has a real grievance, "Didst thou not drive me, thine own father, out" (line 1408), but answers with a terrible curse. Neither is drawn as simply right, so the audience has to weigh a son's late remorse against a father's justified anger.
5. In the passage that opens with "Ah me, my sisters…", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two words from the opening of Polyneices' speech (lines 1313–1323) with their connotations, such as "castaway," "antic tatters," "too late" or "vile," showing pity, shame and self-accusation.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Polyneices calls his father "a castaway" (line 1315) clothed in "antic tatters" (line 1317). The words picture a shipwrecked man in ragged clothes, a shocking sight for a former king. Then he says, "All this too late I learn" (line 1321), which admits his neglect. The diction mixes pity with shame, which is what makes his plea sound sincere.
6. What causes the main turn in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The turn is Oedipus breaking his silence, for Theseus's sake, with a curse instead of a reply; the effect is that Polyneices goes to a war he now believes he will lose.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The turn comes when Oedipus breaks his silence, "for Theseus' sake / Who sent him hither" (lines 1401–1402), with "An answer that will bring him little joy" (line 1405), and then lays his curse on his son. The likely effect follows at once: Polyneices leaves knowing his march leads "to ruin" (line 1484), but he refuses to turn back.

7. How does "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" build on "Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A cause-and-effect link: the ode's list of strife and war, and the old man buffeted on every side, are given a face here in a son who wants his blind father's help for a war against his own city.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Stasimon 3 named "Envy, sedition, strife, / Carnage and war" (lines 1292–1293) as the tale of life. Episode 4 makes that list concrete: Polyneices comes from a war of brothers, with an army that will "Beleaguer all the plain that circles Thebes" (line 1368). The ode's gloom prepares the audience for a scene in which family strife becomes open war.
8. In "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about Polyneices and the father's curse, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Polyneices claims to come in sorrow and pity, but his motive is to recruit his father as an ally; even his promise to bring his father home serves his own claim to the throne.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Polyneices claims pity for his father, but his own words reveal the motive: "victory, if oracles speak true, / Will fall to those who have thee for ally" (lines 1386–1387). Even his offer, "And bring thee home again and stablish thee, / And stablish, having cast him out, myself" (lines 1395–1396), ends with his own throne. His remorse may be real, but it comes when he needs something.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A revised answer to the bell-ringer (why people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail), using Polyneices' appeal to shame and his reasoning about leadership.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: I first said people are stubborn. Polyneices gives more specific reasons. One is shame: "'Tis shame to live in exile" (line 1472). The other is his position as a leader: "How could I lead again / An army that had seen their leader quail?" (lines 1468–1469). People keep going when turning back would cost them their pride and their place.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)", and how does it connect Polyneices and the father's curse to the larger concern with law against force? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Where foreshadowing appears (the curse on the brothers, the burial request) and how it connects to law against force: Polyneices brings force against his city, and Oedipus answers with a curse grounded in "laws eterne."
    Answer guidance: Model answer: Oedipus foretells, "That city thou canst never storm, but first / Shalt fall, thou and thy brother, blood-imbrued" (lines 1426–1427), and Polyneices' plea for burial (line 1461) points beyond the play. This connects to law against force: Polyneices brings armed force against his own city, and Oedipus answers by appealing to "laws eterne" (line 1434) and "Primeval Justice" (line 1435), claiming his curse is stronger than force.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus just or cruel to Polyneices? Defend your view with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An evaluation with evidence for justice (the son's neglect; the daughters' care) and cruelty (a curse of mutual killing on his sons), weighed to a position, with a counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: just in grievance, cruel in punishment. The grievance is real:

"thou didst thrust me out" (line 1414), and "had not these my daughters tended me / I had been dead" (lines 1417–1418). But the curse, that both sons fall "blood-imbrued" (line 1427), goes far beyond answering one son's neglect. Counter-line: Oedipus claims he only names what "just Heaven" already watches (line 1422), so the punishment may not be his alone.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A stand with two lines from the scene: the curse turns the family's past into its future, and the burial request reaches beyond the play; a qualification that Polyneices also chooses his path.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: agree, with a qualification. The curse lays the past on the future: "by a kinsman's hand to die and slay / Him who expelled thee" (lines 1441–1442), and the burial request, "grant me burial and due funeral rites" (line 1461), points beyond the play. But Polyneices also chooses: "The road I choose" (line 1482). The past shapes his future only because he refuses to turn back.

3. Which character in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" acts most wisely in the matter of Polyneices and the father's curse, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named standard applied to two characters, for example care for the whole family: Antigone tries to save her brother and Thebes, while Polyneices chooses pride. Give a line for each.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: by the standard of care for the whole family, Antigone acts most wisely, pleading, "ruin not thyself and Thebes as well" (line 1467) and asking "What profit from thy country's ruin comes?" (line 1471). By the same standard Polyneices acts least wisely, admitting that the road he chooses "Leads me to ruin" (line 1484). A student could choose Oedipus as least wise instead, for answering remorse with a curse on both his sons.

4. You are directing "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Polyneices and the father's curse. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two staging choices tied to lines, such as Oedipus's long silence while his son pleads, or the farewell between brother and sister, each with its effect.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: (1) Through "Why silent? Father, speak, nor turn away" (line 1329), keep Oedipus turned away and utterly still while Polyneices moves around him trying to catch his face. The silence becomes the father's first answer. (2) On "Ye ne'er shall see my living face again" (line 1488), let Polyneices take his sisters' hands, then pull free and leave without looking back. The audience feels both his love and his doom.

5. Write your own questions about "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Three questions answerable from lines 1308–1501: one recall, one why/how and one should/what-if, different in kind.

   Answer guidance: Model set. Recall: Where does Polyneices say he has been living and gathering allies? (Argos, where he married the king's daughter, lines 1357–1358.) Why/how: Why does Oedipus speak to his son at all? (Only for Theseus's sake, lines 1401–1402.) Should/what if: Should Polyneices have told his allies about the curse? (He says a general "Reports successes and conceals mishaps," line 1480; answers weigh honesty against his duty as a leader.)

6. Connect "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)", with its focus on Polyneices and the father's curse, to death and blessing: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment about death and blessing, the question's theme. Oedipus can bless and curse with his death in view; here he curses his son, while his blessing is reserved for those who cared for him. A strong answer says what must come next.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the link is strong but one-sided. In this scene Oedipus's power is a curse, calling on "the ancestral gloom of Tartarus / To snatch thee hence" (lines 1443–1444), while Polyneices, facing death, can only pray that his sisters "may escape all ill" (line 1500). The blessing Oedipus promised Athens (lines 92–93) has not yet been shown. To strengthen the link, Sophocles must show how his death becomes a blessing for those who received him.

7. Is the conflict in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" effective in presenting Polyneices and the father's curse, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment against a stated criterion (is the conflict balanced, letting both sides speak?), with a line that meets it and one passage that might miss it.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: effective, because both sides make real arguments. Polyneices admits his guilt ("I scorn myself," line 1323), and Oedipus answers with a real grievance (lines 1406–1418). Counter-line: the long list of the seven captains (lines 1369–1381) may feel heavy-handed or slow to a modern audience. A reviewer could cut it, though it shows how large the war Polyneices brings really is.

8. Compare how "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" treats Polyneices and the father's curse with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named comparison (another story of a parent who refuses a child's plea, or of brothers at war) and one thing the episode sees that the other misses, tied to a line.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Compare the parable of the prodigal son, where the father forgives at once. Episode 4 sees what happens when the child's remorse comes with a demand and arrives too late: "All this too late I learn" (line 1321). It also shows a sister trying to stop the damage, "Turn back thy host to Argos" (line 1466). The play sees that forgiveness can fail, and that the cost then falls on the whole family.

9. Predict what "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A prediction from two clues, Oedipus's promise from Phoebus that signs would mark his end and the scene's turn toward death, about what the next scene will bring, checked after reading.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Clue 1: in the Prologue Oedipus said he was promised signs of his end, "Earthquake, or thunderclap, or lightning flash" (line 95). Clue 2: this scene is full of farewells and death, "Ye ne'er shall see my living face again" (line 1488). A reasonable prediction is that the promised sign will come and Oedipus will prepare for his own end, and perhaps send for Theseus. After reading, students check how the sign arrived.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Polyneices and the father's curse? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An adaptation that keeps the core: an estranged son comes to ask a wronged parent for support in a fight against his brother, is refused with a terrible judgment, and asks his sister for one last favour. It names two details that must stay.

Answer guidance: Model answer: A son who ignored his father for years arrives at the shelter where his sisters care for him, asking for his public endorsement in a ruinous lawsuit against his brother. The father refuses and disowns both sons, and the son asks his sister to stand by him if he loses everything. Two things must stay: the remorse that comes only with a request (lines 1386–1387), and the sister's plea to turn back (lines 1466–1467).

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Polyneices ask of his father?

   A. Pardon and help in his war on Thebes

   B. A permanent place to live in Athens now

   C. Antigone's hand in a new marriage pact

   D. Money for the journey back toward Argos

   Key: A (Pardon and help in his war on Thebes)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Oedipus answer?

   A. He blesses him

   B. He curses him

   C. He joins his army

   D. He sends Theseus

   Key: B (He curses him)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "Because by right of _____"

   Key: primogeniture

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "As _____, while he, the lord of Thebes,"

   Key: pensioners

5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] What does Polyneices ask his sisters?

   A. To come at once and fight at Argos

   B. To strike Creon down in the grove

   C. To bury him if the curse comes true

   D. To forget him and leave him unnamed

   Key: C (To bury him if the curse comes true)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why will Polyneices not tell his army of the curse?

   A. He has already forgotten every last word of the curse

   B. He does not believe a father's curse can ever stand

   C. Theseus forbade him to speak of it at all in the grove

   D. A good general reports successes and conceals mishaps

Key: D (A good general reports successes and conceals mishaps)

7. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Polyneices first meet his father's silence? Use the lines about a word and mute disdain.
   Sample answer: He treats the silence as a refusal, and he begs for any answer at all. “Why silent? Father, speak, nor turn away, / Hast thou no word, wilt thou dismiss me then / In mute disdain, nor tell me why thou art wrath?” (lines 1329–1331). “mute disdain” names the wound: not a debate, but no word. The plea has begun, and already the son feels himself turned away, before the later speech of the curse is spoken.

8. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Who, according to Oedipus, is the reason he will speak to Polyneices at all?
   A. Theseus, who sent the young man to have word of him
   B. Creon, who still waits with a Theban escort
   C. The chorus, who have already blessed the young man's war
   D. Ismene, who has asked him to join the sevenfold host

   Key: A (Theseus, who sent the young man to have word of him)

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Polyneices justify hiding the curse from his allies? Quote his lines about a good general.
   Sample answer: He answers Antigone’s fear that no one will follow him if they hear the prophecy by turning the curse into a report he will not give. “I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports successes and conceals mishaps.” (lines 1479–1480). Successes may be told; a mishap, in his rule, must be hidden. The lines show him choosing the march over frankness, not denying that the curse was spoken.

10. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How do Antigone's plea and Polyneices's refusal close the meeting? Use her request that he turn the host back, and his reply about yielding.
    Sample answer: She asks him to save himself and the city, and he will not step off the road he has chosen. “Turn back thy host to Argos with all speed, / And ruin not thyself and Thebes as well.” (lines 1466–1467). He later answers the warning of mutual slaughter, “Aye, so he wishes:—but I must not yield.” (line 1476). The scene ends with a sister pleading and a brother refusing, still inside this meeting, before any later sign of Oedipus’s own end.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which play continues this story?
    A. Antigone
    B. Oedipus Rex
    C. Medea
    D. The Odyssey

    Key: A (Antigone)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Whom does Polyneices name as the younger brother who ousted him from the throne?
    A. Eteoclus
    B. Eteocles
    C. Capaneus
    D. Adrastus

    Key: B (Eteocles)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “_____ all the plain that circles Thebes.”
    Key: Beleaguer

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "We all _____ thee to remit thy wrath"

    Key: adjure

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus say he will give Polyneices any answer?

    A. Because the chorus has already promised him a sure victory now

    B. Because he means to join the war on Thebes himself at once

    C. For Theseus' sake, not from any love of the speaker

    D. Because Creon has asked him to bless the seven spears now

    Key: C (For Theseus' sake, not from any love of the speaker)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does Oedipus say will happen to Polyneices and his brother before Thebes can be stormed?

    A. They shall take the city and rule it side by side

    B. They shall be welcomed home by Theseus in Athens

    C. They shall see Oedipus already laid in a public tomb

    D. They shall fall, the two of them, blood-imbrued

    Key: D (They shall fall, the two of them, blood-imbrued)

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Polyneices try to move his father after owning his neglect? Use the lines that set Mercy beside Zeus.

    Sample answer: He turns from self-blame to a theological appeal: if Zeus keeps Mercy as a partner, a father should do the same. "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise." (lines 1324–1327). "Co-partner" and "sit enthroned" ask that Mercy be given a place, not that the past be called harmless. The appeal is earnest, and the later answer will show that it does not win the pardon he wants.

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone urge Polyneices to do with his army?

    A. Turn the host back to Argos, and not ruin himself and Thebes

    B. Lead the seven spears against Athens before nightfall comes on

    C. Leave the sisters as hostages with Creon's men in the grove

    D. Ask Theseus to march as a captain of the whole Argive host

    Key: A (Turn the host back to Argos, and not ruin himself and Thebes)

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What contrast does Oedipus draw between his daughters' care and his son's aid? Use the lines about being tended, and about aid from the son.

    Sample answer: He says that the girls have kept him alive, and that the son now standing before him did not. "And had not these my daughters tended me / I had been dead for aught of aid from thee." (lines 1417–1418). The contrast is about care already given or withheld in his exile. It prepares his charge that the daughters have done a son's part, while this petitioner did not.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Is Oedipus just or cruel in the answer he finally gives? Defend one view with the lines in which he charges Polyneices with driving him out.

    Sample answer: A just reading can hold both the wound and the harshness: he answers a real injury, and he answers it without mercy. He asks whether, when Polyneices held the sovereignty, "Didst thou not drive me, thine own father, out, / An exile, cityless," and he says, "I shall think of thee / As of my murderer; thou didst thrust me out." (lines 1408–1409, 1413–1414). The charge is grounded in the exile he has suffered; the cruelty, if one finds it, is that the speech leaves no room for the pardon the son had asked. Either view has to sit with those lines, not with later events this scene does not show.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What place does Polyneices say Mercy holds beside Zeus?

    A. Mercy is called co-partner of Zeus's throne

    B. Mercy is called a servant banished from the sky

    C. Mercy is called a Theban law Creon already keeps

    D. Mercy is called a gift Theseus can sell for gold

    Key: A (Mercy is called co-partner of Zeus's throne)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "An exile, _____, and make me wear"

    Key: cityless

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "'Tis thou hast made me _____ with woe,"

    Key: conversant

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Polyneices' plea for mercy fail to move Oedipus?

    A. Theseus has already forbidden any son to speak in the sacred grove

    B. Oedipus charges him with exile and will not remit his wrath

    C. The chorus has already sent the young man back toward Argos

    D. Oedipus has already left the grove and will not return at all

    Key: B (Oedipus charges him with exile and will not remit his wrath)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Polyneices treat the prophecy of mutual slaughter?

    A. He dismisses his army at once and returns in haste toward Argos

    B. He asks Theseus to hide the sisters before the coming fight

    C. He will not yield to it, and he will not tell it to his allies

    D. He laughs and says the prophecy has already failed for good

    Key: C (He will not yield to it, and he will not tell it to his allies)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How should we read Oedipus's praise of his daughters as "men / Not women in true service"? Quote the lines and attend to what the play actually honours.

    Sample answer: The wording uses the gender stereotypes of its time, and it should be taught as such, not as a rule about men and women. "They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine." (lines 1419–1421). What the speech actually honours is the daughters' steadfast care, set against the sons' failure to tend him. The comparison is a period way of praising that service, and the sting is aimed at the sons who, in his view, have not done a child's duty.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Oedipus rank his curse against Polyneices's claims? Use the lines about a throne, a suppliance, and Primeval Justice.

    Sample answer: He sets the curse above the son's political and religious pleas, and he does so by appealing to Justice beside Zeus. "Therefore my curse is stronger than thy "throne," / Thy "suppliance," if by right of laws eterne / Primeval Justice sits enthroned with Zeus." (lines 1433–1435). The quoted "throne" and "suppliance" are the son's own claims, named in order to be overborne. The argument is that an older justice than kingship or a suppliant's pose stands with the father's word.

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What distinction must a reader keep between Eteocles and Eteoclus in this episode?

    A. Eteoclus is the younger brother who holds Thebes; Eteocles is a seer with a lightning lance

    B. The two names belong to one and the same Theban prince in this scene

    C. The two names belong to daughters still waiting inside the sacred grove

    D. Eteocles is the younger brother who holds Thebes; Eteoclus is an Argive captain among the seven

Key: D (Eteocles is the younger brother who holds Thebes; Eteoclus is an Argive captain among the seven)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How should the last bequest of the curse be read? Use the lines about not winning the land and a kinsman's hand, and say what they do and do not show.
Sample answer: They foretell a mutual killing in the war, and they do not show that killing on stage. After leaving the curse as a last gift, Oedipus says the son is "Never to win by arms thy native land, / No, nor return to Argos in the Vale, / But by a kinsman's hand to die and slay / Him who expelled thee." (lines 1439–1442). The lines are a father's curse, taught in context as a prophecy of the feud. The play has not yet moved to any later sign of Oedipus's own end.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why will Polyneices not turn the army back? Use his answers about a leader who quails and about a younger brother's flouts.
Sample answer: He gives two reasons, pride of command and pride of birth, and neither is a claim that the curse is false. "That cannot be. How could I lead again / An army that had seen their leader quail?" (lines 1468–1469). He adds, "'Tis shame to live in exile, and shall I / The elder bear a younger brother's flouts?" (lines 1472–1473). To turn back would, in his eyes, be to flinch before his men and to go on bearing Eteocles's insults. The refusal is a character's choice inside the play.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "This curse I leave thee as my last _____:—"
Key: bequest

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Make your path bright if ye fulfill my _____"
Key: hest

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Polyneices mean when he says he must meet his doom mute?
A. He dares not whisper the curse to his allies or turn them back
B. He has already forgotten the words his father spoke to him here
C. He intends to let Theseus announce the curse in Thebes itself
D. He believes the chorus will speak the whole curse for him now
Key: A (He dares not whisper the curse to his allies or turn them back)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Polyneices's burial request look forward without narrating the later action of this play?
A. It tells us that the sisters have already gone home and buried him there
B. It asks the sisters, if they reach Thebes, to grant him funeral rites
C. It reveals that Theseus will keep a tomb hidden from every later visitor
D. It announces that Oedipus has already been taken from the sacred grove
Key: B (It asks the sisters, if they reach Thebes, to grant him funeral rites)

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What contrast does Oedipus draw between his daughters and his sons in the curse speech?
A. The sons have fed him in exile; he says the daughters refused all aid to him there
B. The daughters have joined the seven; he says the sons stayed behind in Athens
C. The daughters have tended and preserved him; he says the sons are no sons of his
D. The sons have already buried him; he says the daughters came far too late
Key: C (The daughters have tended and preserved him; he says the sons are no sons of his)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of Antigone's exclamation that his purpose stands fast, once he has excused his silence to the army?
A. She praises him as a general who has already won the whole city

B. She withdraws her plea and asks him to march at once against Athens

C. She tells the chorus that the curse has already failed for good now

D. She names the choice as fixed and misguided after his excuse

Key: D (She names the choice as fixed and misguided after his excuse)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Antigone try to break the silence before the long speech? Use the lines about large discourse and a tongue-tied mouth.
Sample answer: She will not let the meeting end in a wordless rebuff; she tells her brother to speak the errand himself. "Tell him thyself, unhappy one, thine errand; / For large discourse may send a thrill of joy, / Or stir a chord of wrath or tenderness, / And to the tongue-tied somehow give a tongue." (lines 1336–1339). Speech, in her counsel, might still move a stubborn listener. The advice is structural as well as kind: it opens the way for the plea, and for the harsh answer that will follow.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Antigone name the risk in her father's prophecy? Quote the lines about prophecies and mutual slaughter.
Sample answer: She puts the coming fight in the terms of the curse, and she still treats it as a future that might be refused. "Wilt thou then bring to pass his prophecies / Who threatens mutual slaughter to you both?" (lines 1474–1475). "bring to pass" makes the brothers' choice part of the danger, and "threatens" keeps the slaughter in the realm of a foretold, not a shown, event. The play does not stage that killing here; her question is a last attempt to turn him aside.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the curse make a family's past into its future? Use the lines in which Oedipus speaks of a curse lately launched and now invoked.
Sample answer: He treats the old wrath as still living, and he calls it up again to work in the war the son has just described. "Such curse I lately launched against you twain, / Such curse I now invoke to fight for me," (lines 1428–1429). "Lately" and "now" bind a past sentence to a present fight: the exile the father has suffered is to be answered by a future fall of both brothers. The speech is a prophecy spoken in anger, taught in context, and it is not yet any later sign of Oedipus's own end.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Polyneices take his leave? Use the lines about the road he chooses and a long farewell, and say how those lines should be read.
Sample answer: He goes as a man who expects ruin and still refuses to be stayed. "The road I choose, / Dogged by my sire and his avenging spirit, / Leads me to ruin;" and he adds, "Now let me go, farewell, a long farewell! / Ye ne'er shall see my living face again." (lines 1482–1484, 1487–1488). The speech belongs to this character in this play, a choice Antigone has already begged him not to make. He exits still alive, and the killing the curse foretold remains ahead of the action we have here.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) develops the idea of Polyneices and the father's curse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces

of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" could deliver about Polyneices and the father's curse. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Polyneices and the father's curse in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of Polyneices and the father's curse. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" could deliver about Polyneices and the father's curse. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Polyneices and the father's curse in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) suggests about Polyneices and the father's curse. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" could deliver about Polyneices and the father's curse. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Polyneices and the father's curse in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses conflict in Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) to complicate the reader's understanding of Polyneices

and the father's curse. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" could deliver about Polyneices and the father's curse. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Polyneices and the father's curse in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Ah me, my sisters, shall I first lament My own afflictions, or my aged sire's, Whom here I find a castaway, with you, In a strange land, an ancient beggar clad In antic tatters, marring all his frame, While o'er the sightless orbs his unkempt locks Float in the breeze; and, as it were to match, He bears a wallet against hunger's pinch.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "castaway" most nearly mean?

   A. a person abandoned and thrown off

   B. a newly crowned king at home

   C. a hired guide on a public road

   D. a priest of the grove's own rites

2. *Ah me, my sisters, shall I first lament My own afflictions, or my aged sire's, Whom here I find a castaway, with you, In a strange land, an ancient beggar clad In antic tatters, marring all his frame, While o'er the sightless orbs his unkempt locks Float in the breeze; and, as it were to match, He bears a wallet against hunger's pinch. All this too late I learn, wretch that I am, Alas! I own it, and am proved most vile In my neglect of thee: I scorn myself. But as almighty Zeus in all he doth Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned In thy heart likewise. For transgressions past May be amended, cannot be made worse.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)"?

   A. The rescue imagined

   B. The Colonus ode

   C. Polyneices and the father's curse

   D. The son's inventory of his father's beggar tatters

SAT key: 1. A (a person abandoned and thrown off); 2. C (Polyneices and the father's curse)

Lesson 11: Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)

Focus: the summons

Objective: Students will analyze how plot develops in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

Background: Compare Oedipus Rex, where the seeing king could not see the truth; here the blind man leads.

Significance: Oedipus recognises the peals as the gods' appointed warning and sends for Theseus while he can still speak the charge.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does it mean to face the end of something calmly? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: What does it mean to face the end of something calmly?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The thunder is a summons, not only a terror: Oedipus, long led by others, now leads Theseus and his children toward the secret end the god has named.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
7 key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: Hades — the Greek underworld and its god; palpable — able to be touched or felt; sepulcher — a tomb or burial place; inviolate — kept sacred and unbroken; solemn — formal, serious, and ceremonial; mischance — bad luck; an unlucky accident; peal — a loud ringing, especially of thunder or bells. "palpable": Origin: Middle French palpable; earlier Latin palpābilis.
Words: Hades: the Greek underworld and its god · palpable: able to be touched or felt · sepulcher: a tomb or burial place · inviolate: kept sacred and unbroken · solemn: formal, serious, and ceremonial · mischance: bad luck; an unlucky accident · peal: a loud ringing, especially of thunder or bells

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Compare Oedipus Rex, where the seeing king could not see the truth; here the blind man leads. Oedipus recognises the peals as the gods' appointed warning and sends for Theseus while he can still speak the charge. Plot: Thunder sounds, and Oedipus knows his end has come. He calls for Theseus, leads the others without a guide toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens. Irony: The man who has had to be led now leads the seeing: 'Strange that I whom ye have led so long should lead you now.' He also takes leave of light, which is no light to him. Characterization: Oedipus meets the summons calmly and in knowledge: he feels the last of the light, knows the way without a guide, and entrusts the secret of his grave to Theseus alone. Watch for the sacred grove and the hidden grave: The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the summons.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" slowly and put it in my own words: The chorus says Time, whose eye never sleeps, watches what is written above, throwing down the great and raising those of low estate. Next, craft. I notice the pair "Overthrowing" and "Raising": the same watching eye does both, and the thunder of this scene is already the sign they are trying to read. The strongest word is "Overthrowing": "Overthrowing now the great" names a reversal already in motion, the pressure of the summons on a man who was both king and beggar. Then, effect. What do lines 1508–1511 reveal about the summons? My answer: These lines reveal the summons: the song first names the power that watches and reverses fortunes, and the thunder is a summons they have to interpret, not only a noise to fear.

> *Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate (Thunder scene, lines 1508–1511)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" slowly and put it in my own words: The chorus says Time, whose eye never sleeps, watches what is written above, throwing down the great and raising those of low estate. Next, craft. I notice the pair "Overthrowing" and "Raising": the same watching eye does both, and the thunder of this scene is already the sign they are trying to read. The strongest word is "Overthrowing": "Overthrowing now the great" names a reversal already in motion, the pressure of the summons on a man who was both king and beggar. Then, effect. What do lines 1508–1511 reveal about the summons? My answer: These lines reveal the summons: the song first names the power that watches and reverses fortunes, and the thunder is a summons they have to interpret, not only a noise to fear.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Strange", "led" and "lead" stand out. "Strange that I" marks the reversal as surprising; "Whom ye have led so long" looks back at years of being guided; "should lead you now" turns the verb around. The blind man who has been led so long now leads his guides (Oedipus, lines 1592–1593). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected student answer: The guest who has been led now leads his hosts toward the place of his death; the summons completes Athens's hospitality by letting him go, under Theseus's protection, to the end Apollo promised.

> *Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now (Thunder scene, lines 1592–1593)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Strange", "led" and "lead" stand out. "Strange that I" marks the reversal as surprising; "Whom ye have led so long" looks back at years of being guided; "should lead you now" turns the verb around. The blind man who has been led so long now leads his guides (Oedipus, lines 1592–1593).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected student answer: The guest who has been led now leads his hosts toward the place of his death; the summons completes Athens's hospitality by letting him go, under Theseus's protection, to the end Apollo promised.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for plot, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the summons? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) develops the idea of the summons. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The blind man leads the seeing. When the text says "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene, lines 1508–1511), it shows this directly. Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

Task: Annotate the scene for plot, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the summons? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) develops the idea of the summons. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Access supports: Access supports (not a legal-compliance promise). These are teaching options for English learners and for students with IEP or 504 needs; they do not replace a student's plan, and using them does not by itself satisfy any legal requirement. Chunked reading: the thunder and the chorus on Time (lines 1508–1511) first, then Oedipus leading Those who had led him (lines 1592–1593), with a gist check after each. Sentence frames: "Time with never sleeping eye… Overthrowing now the great" (lines 1508–1510) suggests ___. / "Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now" (lines 1592–1593) is surprising because ___. Graphic organizer: a two-row summons chart (what the thunder means / who leads whom) with quotations. Time: extended time on the quiz and CER. Audio: hear the Time stanza and the "lead you now" lines while following the text.

Exemplar: The blind man leads the seeing. When the text says "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene, lines 1508–1511), it shows this directly. Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What does it mean to face the end of something calmly? Ask: What does it mean to face the end of something calmly?

Anchor question: What does it mean to face the end of something calmly?

Facilitation: Ask: What does it mean to face the end of something calmly?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the summons? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The blind man leads the seeing. ("Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate", Thunder scene, lines 1508–1511). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the summons? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The blind man leads the seeing. ("Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate", Thunder scene, lines 1508–1511). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes the summons. Key takeaway: The thunder is a summons, not only a terror: Oedipus, long led by others, now leads Theseus and his children toward the secret end the god has named.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Thunder sounds, and Oedipus knows his end has come. He calls for Theseus, leads the others without a guide toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.
- **Irony:** The man who has had to be led now leads the seeing: 'Strange that I whom ye have led so long should lead you now.' He also takes leave of light, which is no light to him.
- **Characterization:** Oedipus meets the summons calmly and in knowledge: he feels the last of the light, knows the way without a guide, and entrusts the secret of his grave to Theseus alone.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the summons.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the summons.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene, lines 1508–1511) The chorus says time topples the great and raises the low, watching what is already written.

- "Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now" (Thunder scene, lines 1592–1593) The blind man who has been led now leads his guides, as the end of his life approaches.
- "O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades" (Thunder scene, lines 1599–1602) He bids farewell to a light he can feel but cannot see, standing at the edge of Hades.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The blind man leads the seeing.
Evidence: "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene, lines 1508–1511)
Reasoning: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1502–1517

1502 **Chorus:** Ills on ills! no pause or rest!
1503 **Chorus:** Come they from our sightless guest?
1504 **Chorus:** Or haply now we see fulfilled
1505 **Chorus:** What fate long time hath willed?
1506 **Chorus:** For ne'er have I proved vain
1507 **Chorus:** Aught that the heavenly powers ordain.
1508 **Chorus:** Time with never sleeping eye
1509 **Chorus:** Watches what is writ on high,
1510 **Chorus:** Overthrowing now the great,
1511 **Chorus:** Raising now from low estate.
1512 **Chorus:** Hark! How the thunder rumbles! Zeus defend us!
1513 **Oedipus:** Children, my children! will no messenger
1514 **Oedipus:** Go summon hither Theseus my best friend?
1515 **Antigone:** And wherefore, father, dost thou summon him?
1516 **Oedipus:** This winged thunder of the god must bear me
1517 **Oedipus:** Anon to Hades. Send and tarry not.

Lines 1508–1511

1508 **Chorus:** Time with never sleeping eye
1509 **Chorus:** Watches what is writ on high,
1510 **Chorus:** Overthrowing now the great,
1511 **Chorus:** Raising now from low estate.

Lines 1513–1517

1513 **Oedipus:** Children, my children! will no messenger
1514 **Oedipus:** Go summon hither Theseus my best friend?
1515 **Antigone:** And wherefore, father, dost thou summon him?

1516 **Oedipus:** This winged thunder of the god must bear me
1517 **Oedipus:** Anon to Hades. Send and tarry not.

Lines 1516–1517
1516 **Oedipus:** This winged thunder of the god must bear me
1517 **Oedipus:** Anon to Hades. Send and tarry not.

Line 1518
1518 **Chorus:** Hark! with louder, nearer roar

Line 1558
1558 **Oedipus:** My life hath turned the scale. I would do all

Line 1575
1575 **Oedipus:** Better than native shields and near allies.

Line 1579
1579 **Oedipus:** To my own children, though I love them dearly,

Lines 1580–1582
1580 **Oedipus:** Can I reveal what thou must guard alone,
1581 **Oedipus:** And whisper to thy chosen heir alone,
1582 **Oedipus:** So to be handed down from heir to heir.

Line 1583
1583 **Oedipus:** Thus shalt thou hold this land inviolate

Lines 1592–1593
1592 **Oedipus:** Follow me, daughters, this way. Strange that I
1593 **Oedipus:** Whom ye have led so long should lead you now.

Lines 1594–1595
1594 **Oedipus:** Oh, touch me not, but let me all alone
1595 **Oedipus:** Find out the sepulcher that destiny

Lines 1599–1602
1599 **Oedipus:** O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile,
1600 **Oedipus:** Now the last time I feel thee palpable,
1601 **Oedipus:** For I am drawing near the final gloom
1602 **Oedipus:** Of Hades. Blessing on thee, dearest friend,

Line 1600
1600 **Oedipus:** Now the last time I feel thee palpable,

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
Hades (noun)	the Greek underworld and its god	*This winged thunder of the god must bear me Anon to Hades.*	
palpable (adjective)	able to be touched or felt	*O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, Now the last time I feel thee palpable, For I am drawing near the final gloom Of Hades.*	"palpable": Origin: Middle French palpable; earlier Latin palpābilis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/palpable#Etymology)
sepulcher (noun)	a tomb or burial place	*Find out the sepulcher that destiny / Appoints me in this land. Hither, this way,*	
inviolate (adjective)	kept sacred and unbroken	*Thus shalt thou hold this land inviolate / From the dread Dragon's brood. The justest State*	
solemn (adjective)	formal, serious, and ceremonial	*What solemn charge would'st thou impress on him? / For all his benefits I would perform*	
mischance (noun)	bad luck; an unlucky accident	*Of arrowy hail? a storm so fierce as this / Would warrant all surmises of mischance.*	
peal (noun)	a loud ringing, especially of thunder or bells	*This thunder, peal on peal, this lightning hurled / Flash upon flash, from the unconquered hand.*	

Discussion questions

1. What does it mean to face the end of something calmly?
2. Where does plot appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with death and blessing?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Oedipus say in lines 1592–1593? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Those who led him so long are now led by him.
   Answer guidance: Those who led him so long are now led by him.

2. What does the chorus say the bolt of Zeus does, as the din begins? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** It descends once more
   Answer guidance: It descends once more.
3. What does the chorus say the peals do, as they continue around the grove? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** They peal yet louder all around
   Answer guidance: They peal yet louder all around.
4. What vow does the chorus say is being paid in the far glade? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The vow he pays in the far glade
   Answer guidance: The vow he pays in the far glade.
5. What does Oedipus say he is drawing near, as he waits for the king? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The final gloom
   Answer guidance: The final gloom.
6. What does Oedipus first ask, of Theseus, when the peals have been read as a sign? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Whether the prince is coming, and will come in time
   Answer guidance: Whether the prince is coming, and will come in time.
7. What does Oedipus say the king already knows, even as he would still speak on? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The king already knows, yet he would still admonish him
   Answer guidance: The king already knows, yet he would still admonish him.
8. What does Oedipus call out for, at the first peal, before the king has come? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A messenger
   Answer guidance: A messenger.
9. To whom does Oedipus first cry, when the appointed warnings begin? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** His children
   Answer guidance: His children.
10. What does Oedipus say he promised Theseus and his line, to be kept before the end? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** What he promised him and his, to be spoken before the end
    Answer guidance: What he promised him and his, to be spoken before the end.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Oedipus no longer need a guide? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He is led by the god, and his inner sight now guides him: the blind man who was led all play becomes the leader of the sighted.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: Oedipus says, “Myself anon without a guiding hand / Will take thee to the spot where I must end” (lines 1570–1571), and he names the god who leads him: “For this way Hermes leads, the spirit guide” (line 1597). The reversal is striking: “Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now” (lines 1592–1593). The blind man is guided by the gods, so he no longer needs a human guide.

2. What does "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" suggest about the summons? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Oedipus recognises the peals as the gods' appointed warning and sends for Theseus while he can still speak the charge.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Oedipus reads the peals as the sign he was promised: "The gods themselves are heralds of my fate; / Of their appointed warnings nothing fails" (lines 1561–1562). His first thought is not fear but his promise to his host: he asks whether Theseus will "Find me yet living and my senses clear" (line 1539). The scene suggests that he meets the summons calmly and as a man keeping faith.

3. Find one example of plot in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)". What does it reveal about the summons that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A plot example, such as the blind man leading the sighted, explained for what it reveals: the summons gives Oedipus authority and certainty he has lacked all play.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The blind man now leads: "Follow me, daughters, this way" (line 1592). This plot reversal shows more than a plain statement could. All play Oedipus has been led, seated, moved and argued over; the summons gives him the certainty and authority to lead the people who have guided him.

4. How does the irony in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" shape what we understand about the summons? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The irony that the sightless man is the only one who understands the signs and leads the way, while the sighted elders and Theseus are afraid or uncertain.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The irony is that the blind man sees most clearly. The elders are terrified, "My spirit quails and cowers" (line 1520), and Theseus is unsure whether this is "a thunderbolt of Zeus or sleet / Of arrowy hail" (lines 1552–1553), but Oedipus says, "I know full well" (line 1528). The irony shows that in this play understanding comes from the gods, not from the eyes.

5. In the passage that opens with "Ills on ills!", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two words from the elders' opening (lines 1502–1511) with their connotations, such as "Ills on ills," "sightless guest," "never sleeping eye" or "Overthrowing," showing fear and a sense of fate at work.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders cry "Ills on ills!" (line 1502), which piles one trouble on another, and picture "Time with never sleeping eye" (line 1508), a watcher that never rests. The words show fear, but also a sense that the gods are at work: time is overthrowing the great and "Raising now from low estate" (line 1511), which may describe the guest himself.

6. What causes the main turn in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The turn is the arrival of the god's sign, which changes Oedipus from a man who stays to a man who leads; the effect is that he prepares to keep his promise and walk toward his end.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The turn is the arrival of the sign itself, the peals that Oedipus reads as the god calling him: "This winged thunder of the god must bear me / Anon to Hades" (lines 1516–1517). Its effect is immediate: Oedipus sends for Theseus to keep his promise, then sets out to lead the way to the place where he "must end" (line 1571).

7. How does "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" build on "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A causal link: having cursed his son and kept nothing back from Thebes, Oedipus now

gives everything to Athens, and the elders' sense of "Ills on ills" follows straight from the curse they have just heard.

Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders begin, "Ills on ills! no pause or rest! / Come they from our sightless guest?" (lines 1502–1503), because they have just heard him curse his son. Episode 4 showed what Oedipus withholds from those who wronged him; this scene shows what he gives to those who sheltered him, "a treasure age cannot corrupt" (line 1569).

8. In "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the summons, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A motive behind his words: Oedipus could keep his last moments for his daughters, but he wants Theseus first, which shows that keeping his promise to his host matters most to him.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Oedipus loves his daughters, "though I love them dearly" (line 1579), yet his urgent concern is Theseus: "Is the prince coming?" (line 1538). His motive is to keep his word: "I would do all / I promised thee and thine before I die" (lines 1558–1559). Paying his debt to his host matters more to him than a private farewell.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (What does it mean to face the end of something calmly?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A revised answer to the bell-ringer (facing the end calmly), using Oedipus's certainty and his care for others as he goes, set against the elders' fear.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: I first said facing the end calmly means not caring. Oedipus shows the opposite. He is calm because he is sure, "I know full well" (line 1528), and he spends his last strength on others, blessing his host: "Blessing on thee, dearest friend, / On thee and on thy land and followers!" (lines 1602–1603). Calm here comes from purpose and gratitude, not indifference.

10. Where does characterization appear in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)", and how does it connect the summons to the larger concern with death and blessing? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Where characterization connects the summons to death and blessing: Oedipus, at the edge of death, becomes a giver of blessing, a protector of Athens and a leader.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: Facing death, Oedipus is no longer a beggar asking for help but a giver: he will "Unfold a treasure age cannot corrupt" (line 1569), a secret that will "ever serve thee for defense" (line 1574). The characterization ties his death to blessing, which matches the promise in the Prologue that he would be "A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st" (line 92).

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Open question: is Oedipus' passing a reward, a mystery, or both? Defend any position. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A defended position: a reward (honoured by the gods, a blessing for Athens) and a mystery (kept secret, without witnesses), with a counterpoint, based only on what the scene shows before the end is reported.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: both, as far as this scene shows. It feels like a reward because the gods themselves call him, "The gods themselves are heralds of my fate" (line 1561), and his grave will protect Athens. It is also a mystery: "those dread mysteries speech may not profane" (line 1576) will be known only to Theseus. Counter-line: a reader could argue that it is simply a death, and that the play hides it in religious awe. A strong answer explains why secrecy matters.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Oedipus recognises the peals as the gods' appointed warning and sends for Theseus while he can still speak the charge. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A stand with two lines from the scene, with a qualification that his calm is not only acceptance but authority: he gives orders and a charge, not only a farewell.
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: agree, and extend it. He recognises the warning, "Of their appointed warnings nothing fails" (line 1562), and sends for Theseus at once (lines 1513–1514). But he does more than speak a charge. He takes command and leads the way: "Let us set forth nor longer hesitate" (line 1591). The scene shows his authority as well as his acceptance.
3. Which character in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" acts most wisely in the matter of the summons, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named standard applied to two characters, for example meeting the god's sign with understanding rather than fear, comparing Oedipus and the elders (or Theseus), with lines.
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: by the standard of meeting the god's sign with understanding, Oedipus acts most wisely: "I know full well" (line 1528). By the same standard the elders act least wisely, crying "Dread powers of air! Save, Zeus, O save!" (line 1524). A student could defend the elders: their fear is honest, and they pray for grace even toward "a man of sin" (line 1535). Theseus could also be ranked high, since he trusts a proven prophet (lines 1566–1567).
4. You are directing "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the summons. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two staging choices tied to lines, such as the blind man walking unaided as the others follow, or a light cue for "O light, no light to me," each with its effect.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: (1) On "Follow me, daughters, this way" (line 1592), let Oedipus stand and walk steadily without a hand on him while Antigone and Ismene follow, reversing every earlier entrance. (2) On "O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile" (line 1599), let a single shaft of light fall on his face, then fade as he leaves. The audience sees him lead with certainty and feels the solemn farewell.
5. Write your own questions about "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Three questions answerable from lines 1502–1605: one recall, one why/how and one should/what-if, different in kind.
   Answer guidance: Model set. Recall: Who alone may know the spot? (Theseus, who will pass it on only to his chosen heir, lines 1580–1582.) Why/how: Why must the place be kept secret? (It will defend Athens better than "native shields and near allies," line 1575.) Should/what if: Should Oedipus have told his daughters the secret? (Answers weigh his love for them, line 1579, against his promise to Athens.)
6. Connect "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)", with its focus on the summons, to refuge and hospitality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment about refuge and hospitality, the question's theme. The link is strong: the guest repays his host with a gift that will protect the city; a strong answer says what must still be shown.
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the link is strong. Hospitality comes back as a gift: the elders call it "Thy due guerdon" for the host (line 1549), and Oedipus says the secret will "serve thee for defense /

Better than native shields and near allies" (lines 1574–1575). The guest who came asking for refuge leaves his host a protection. To strengthen the link, Sophocles must show whether the promised blessing is fulfilled and how Athens keeps faith with its guest at the end.

7. Is the plot in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" effective in presenting the summons, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment against a stated criterion (does the plot build suspense and meaning, or does the repetition of peals feel mechanical?), with a line that meets it and one that might miss it.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: effective, because each peal raises the pressure. The elders' terror builds ("Hark! with louder, nearer roar," line 1518), while Oedipus asks whether Theseus will find him "living and my senses clear" (line 1539), which creates a race against time. Counter-line: a modern reader may find the repeated cries to Zeus and the warning about the "dread Dragon's brood" (line 1584) heavy-handed. A strong answer judges whether the repetition builds dread or slows the scene.

8. Compare how "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" treats the summons with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named comparison (another text or film where a dying person passes on a secret or blessing, or is called by a sign) and one thing the scene sees that the other misses, tied to a line.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Compare scenes in films where a dying mentor passes on a secret to a student. This scene sees something those often miss: the secret is a gift to a whole city, not only to one person, and it must be passed "from heir to heir" (line 1582) and kept quiet to keep its power. It also shows the giver as a man who was once rejected, so the gift becomes a reversal of his whole story.

9. Predict what "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A prediction from two clues, Oedipus leading the way to his appointed place and his blessing on Theseus, about what the elders will sing while they wait, checked after reading.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Clue 1: Oedipus leaves saying he draws "near the final gloom / Of Hades" (lines 1601–1602). Clue 2: he blesses Theseus and his land (lines 1602–1603). The elders, left behind, will probably pray for him as he goes toward the end, and perhaps ask the powers of the dead to treat him gently. After reading, students check how the elders' attitude to their guest has changed.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the summons? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An adaptation that keeps the core: a dying, once-rejected guest recognises the sign he was promised, calls for his host and leads him to a secret that will protect the host's community. It names two details that must stay.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: An old refugee, once refused everywhere, hears the storm he was told would mark his last day and calls for the mayor who took him in. He leads the mayor alone to a place only the mayor may know and gives him what will protect the town. Two things must stay: the blind man leading the sighted (lines 1592–1593), and the secret handed only to the host (lines 1580–1582).

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What signals Oedipus' end?
   A. The peals and flashes he reads as the gods' appointed warnings
   B. An earthquake that has already opened a grave in the grove
   C. A runner who has already arrived with news from a distant city
   D. A dream he reports after waking beside the altar of the grove

   Key: A (The peals and flashes he reads as the gods' appointed warnings)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Oedipus call for?
   A. Creon
   B. Theseus
   C. Polyneices
   D. Teiresias

   Key: B (Theseus)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "What doth the lightning-flash _____?"
   Key: portend
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "Thy due _____. Haste, O King!"
   Key: guerdon
5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does Time do, according to the Chorus?
   A. Stands still and leaves every fortune unchanged
   B. Favors only kings and forgets everyone else
   C. Overthrows the great and raises the low
   D. Erases the past so that no old deed can matter

   Key: C (Overthrows the great and raises the low)
6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus want the prince found while he is still "living" and his "senses clear"?
   A. So the chorus can finish the sacrifice before night comes on now
   B. So Antigone can ask him to turn back from the path at once
   C. So Creon can be invited to share the gift he means to leave here
   D. So the charge can be given while he can still speak it plainly

   Key: D (So the charge can be given while he can still speak it plainly)
7. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] How does the chorus first meet the sudden ills? Use the opening questions and the claim about heavenly powers, before the first peal is named.
   Sample answer: They ask whether the ills come from their sightless guest, or whether a long-willed fate is now being fulfilled, and they swear that the heavenly powers have never ordained anything in vain. "Ills on ills! no pause or rest! / Come they from our sightless guest?" (lines 1502–1503). "Or haply now we see fulfilled / What fate long time hath willed? / For ne'er have I proved vain / Aught that the heavenly powers ordain." (lines 1504–1507). The ode is already reading the storm as something appointed, not as a random noise, before anyone names the peal itself.

8. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does the chorus ask of Zeus when the peals grow louder, if they have looked on a man of sin with pity?

   A. Grace, not anger, for having looked with a pitying eye

   B. A swift bolt to drive the stranger from the grove at once

   C. A clear sign that the prince should refuse to come at all

   D. A promise that no later warning will fall upon the land

   Key: A (Grace, not anger, for having looked with a pitying eye)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] What does Oedipus say in lines 1592–1593, and why does that wording matter in this scene?

   Sample answer: He tells the daughters to follow, and he names the strange turn in their long journey: the man they have led will now lead them. “Follow me, daughters, this way. Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now.” (lines 1592–1593). “Strange” keeps the reversal in view without treating it as a trick: the same people are present, but the direction of guidance has changed, here, as they set out toward the place he must find.

10. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] How should we read Oedipus's last blessing on Theseus and the land? Use the close of the scene, and say what those lines do and do not settle.

    Sample answer: He blesses his friend, the land, and its followers, and he asks that they think of him, when he is dead, for their welfare. “Blessing on thee, dearest friend, / On thee and on thy land and followers! / Live prosperous and in your happy state / Still for your welfare think on me, the dead.” (lines 1602–1605). The speech is a blessing and a charge for the city's good, spoken as he sets out; it does not tell us that the end has already been accomplished, or by what later means it will be told, and it should not be read as a wish to make death a goal. The written exit names Theseus, Antigone, and Ismene; by the sense of the preceding command, he is the one who leads the way.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What ironic reversal is strange about Oedipus in this scene?

    A. The blind man leads the others

    B. He claims that his eyes have been fully restored

    C. He sits down and will not take another step

    D. He asks the chorus to carry him home at once

    Key: A (The blind man leads the others)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Whom does Oedipus name as the spirit guide along the way he takes?

    A. Creon

    B. Hermes

    C. Poseidon

    D. Apollo

    Key: B (Hermes)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Daughters, upon me the _____ end”

    Key: predestined

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Would warrant all surmises of _____.”

    Key: mischance

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus say he would perform the promise made when he first received Theseus's benefits?

    A. He wants the chorus to take the prince's place at the altar

B. He hopes the daughters will be sent away before the prince arrives

C. He means to keep, now, the pledge given when he was first received

D. He means to ask the prince to march at once against a neighbouring city

Key: C (He means to keep, now, the pledge given when he was first received)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Theseus first try to account for the general din as he arrives?

A. A quarrel already settled between the daughters in the grove

B. A runner already sent from a neighbouring city with fresh terms

C. A sacrifice the chorus has already finished without him

D. A thunderbolt of Zeus or a sleet of arrowy hail

Key: D (A thunderbolt of Zeus or a sleet of arrowy hail)

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How do the gods' warnings and Theseus's trust work together once the prince has come? Use his question about their will and his answer that he must believe Oedipus.

Sample answer: Theseus asks how the gods signify their will, and Oedipus points to the peals and the lightning already in the air. “How sayest thou they signify their will?” (line 1563). “This thunder, peal on peal, this lightning hurled” (line 1564). Theseus does not invent a reading of his own; he accepts the reading because he has found Oedipus a true prophet before. “I must believe thee, having found thee oft / A prophet true; then speak what must be done.” (lines 1566–1567). Trust here follows a record of truthfulness, and it opens the way for the charge that must still be spoken.

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus refuse to reveal even to his own children, though he loves them dearly?

A. What Theseus must guard and whisper to his chosen heir alone

B. The names of the seven captains already waiting in the field

C. A plan to send the daughters home before the prince can speak

D. The words of a prayer the chorus has already finished at the altar

Key: A (What Theseus must guard and whisper to his chosen heir alone)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus no longer need a guide?

Sample answer: He is not asking to be led by a human hand now; he says the god within him goads him on, and he names a divine guide on the way he takes. “But to the spot—the god within me goads— / Let us set forth nor longer hesitate.” (lines 1590–1591). “For this way Hermes leads, the spirit guide, / And Persephassa, empress of the dead.” (lines 1597–1598). The point is not that he has recovered ordinary sight, or that he is inventing a path for its own sake; he is answering a summons already signalled, and he chooses only the way to the place appointed in this land.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the chorus's fear of the storm with Oedipus's reading of the same signs. Use their terror at the flare and his claim that there is no turning from what has come.

Sample answer: The elders quail, their hair bristles, and they cry to the powers of air to save them; for them the flare is a terror whose issue is grave. “My spirit quails and cowers: my hair / Bristles for fear. Again that flare!” (lines 1520–1521). “Ever it points to issues grave. / Dread powers of air! Save, Zeus, O save!” (lines 1523–1524). Oedipus does not share that panic. After the same signs, he tells the daughters that what was appointed has come, and that there is no turning from it. “Has come; no turning from it any more.” (line 1526). The scene holds both responses at once: fear in the chorus, and a settled reading in the man who takes the signs as a summons.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What will protect Athens, according to Oedipus?

    A. The secret of his resting place, passed to Theseus' heir

    B. A new stone wall built around the grove and the whole town

    C. A sworn alliance with a neighbouring army for the coming year

    D. A newly founded temple raised in the city's marketplace

    Key: A (The secret of his resting place, passed to Theseus' heir)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "The gods themselves are _____ of my fate;"

    Key: heralds

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Thus shalt thou hold this land _____"

    Key: inviolate

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus mean by "My life hath turned the scale"?

    A. He has already left the grove and will not be found again

    B. The appointed moment has arrived, and he means to act now

    C. He has decided to refuse the prince any further gift or word

    D. He believes the chorus can finish the matter without him

    Key: B (The appointed moment has arrived, and he means to act now)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus say "Oh, touch me not, but let me all alone / Find out the sepulcher"?

    A. He wants the daughters to go back and wait beside the altar alone now

    B. He has already asked the chorus to hide the place from Theseus himself

    C. He must find the place destiny appoints, going without a leading hand

    D. He means to let the prince choose the place and mark it with a new wall

    Key: C (He must find the place destiny appoints, going without a leading hand)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does Oedipus's language about light he can feel but cannot see shape the close of the scene? Use the address to the light and the lines about the final gloom.

    Sample answer: He greets a light that is no light to him now, yet was once his, and he says this is the last time he can feel it, as he draws near the gloom of Hades. "O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile," (line 1599). "For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades." (lines 1601–1602). The wording holds a last sense of the world he cannot see: "no light to me" and "mine erewhile" together. It is the speech of a man answering a summons already given, a last address to daylight, and it stops short of any later report of how that end will be told.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What charge does Oedipus lay on Theseus about the mysteries, and who may not hear them? Use the lines about speech that may not profane them and about the chosen heir.

    Sample answer: The mysteries are not to be spoken as common news. Theseus himself must gather them there alone, and he must not reveal them to subjects or even to Oedipus's children, though they are dearly loved; the charge is to be whispered to a chosen heir and handed down from heir to heir. "But those dread mysteries speech may not profane / Thyself shalt gather coming there alone;" (lines 1576–1577). "Since not to any of thy subjects, nor / To my own children, though I love them dearly, / Can I reveal what thou must guard alone, / And whisper to thy chosen heir alone, / So to be handed down from heir to heir." (lines 1578–1582). The exclusion of the children is part of the charge in this scene; it is not yet a later refusal at a grave, and it should be taught as a trust placed on the king.

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Which literary element describes the turn by which the man long led now leads the seeing?

    A. Comedy

    B. Pathos

    C. Allegory

    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is Oedipus's acceptance of the summons best read as the keeping of a promise, a surrender to the gods, or both? Defend your view from his words about the scale and about the god that goads him.

    Sample answer: Both are present, and they should be held together. He tells Theseus that his life has turned the scale, and that he would do all he promised him and his before he dies; that is a promise kept at the appointed time. “I would do all / I promised thee and thine before I die.” (lines 1558–1559). A few lines later he adds that the god within him goads him toward the spot, and he asks that they set forth without delay. The scene presents a god-sent summons that he accepts, and a human pledge he still means to perform; he chooses the path he is to take, not the fact that the end has come.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the chorus try to call Theseus from sacrifice to the guest? Use the lines about the altar, the far glade, and the offering the guest would bring.

    Sample answer: They call the king away from a vow already under way, and they tell him why he must come. “Hither haste, my son, arise, / Altar leave and sacrifice, / If haply to Poseidon now / In the far glade thou pay’st thy vow.” (lines 1543–1546). The guest, they say, would bring an offering for the king and for his folk. “For our guest to thee would bring / And thy folk an offering,” (lines 1547–1548). The song treats the interruption as urgent and due: Poseidon's rite is not denied, but the king is needed in the grove, and the guest's gift is named as the reason to hurry.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Flash upon flash, from the _____ hand.”

    Key: unconquered

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Now the last time I feel thee _____,”

    Key: palpable

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Whom does Oedipus name as empress of the dead in this scene?

    A. Persephassa

    B. Lord Poseidon

    C. Queen Antigone

    D. King Aegeus

    Key: A (Persephassa)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus offer this state as a treasure age cannot corrupt?

    A. A store of arms already gathered for the prince's men in the sacred grove

    B. A gift for Athens that he will unfold at the spot, to be guarded alone

    C. A written treaty already sealed with a neighbouring city's king

    D. A new rite the chorus has already promised to sing each coming year

    Key: B (A gift for Athens that he will unfold at the spot, to be guarded alone)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Oedipus's warning about the dread Dragon's brood and wanton neighbours function in the charge to Theseus?

    A. It tells us that a neighbouring army has already entered the grove this very hour

    B. It asks Theseus to march at once and burn the fields beyond the far border

    C. It ties the just city's safety to the charge Theseus must keep, against future wrong

    D. It claims that the daughters must be sent away before any gift can be given now

    Key: C (It ties the just city's safety to the charge Theseus must keep, against future wrong)

36. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Theseus's mind about the din change after he has heard Oedipus?

    A. He first dismisses the noise, then orders the chorus to leave the grove at once now

    B. He first blames the daughters, then asks the chorus to finish the vow for him here

    C. He first names a neighbouring city, then refuses to hear another word at all

    D. He first treats the din as a storm, then, trusting a true prophet, asks what must be done

    Key: D (He first treats the din as a storm, then, trusting a true prophet, asks what must be done)

37. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How do Antigone's questions organize the scene before Theseus arrives? Use her questions about why he is summoned, what sign convinces her father, and what solemn charge he would impress.

    Sample answer: Each question pulls a next fact into the open and keeps the audience with her. She first asks why Theseus is wanted at all; her father answers that the winged peal must bear him to Hades, and that they must send without delay. "And wherefore, father, dost thou summon him?" (line 1515). She then asks what sign convinces him, and later what solemn charge he would impress on the prince. "How knowest thou? What sign convinces thee?" (line 1527). "What solemn charge would'st thou impress on him?" (line 1540). The questions do not invent the summons; they pace it, so that the need for Theseus, the ground of certainty, and the promised charge are named before the king himself is on stage.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze "This winged thunder of the god must bear me / Anon to Hades". What does Oedipus claim, and how should those words be taught?

    Sample answer: He claims that the peal is the god's, that it has wings, and that it must carry him soon to Hades; the next words tell them to send and not delay. "This winged thunder of the god must bear me / Anon to Hades. Send and tarry not." (lines 1516–1517). "Winged" and "must bear me" make the sign an escort, and "Anon" marks the time as near. The lines should be taught as a god-sent summons, accepted in this scene: a natural end named by the man it concerns. They also explain, in the same breath, why Theseus must be called at once.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] How does the scene reverse the long pattern of Oedipus being led, and what does that reversal ask us to understand about the summons? Use the lines in which he says he will go without a guiding hand.

    Sample answer: For much of the play other people have had to lead him; here he says he will take Theseus to the spot himself, without a guiding hand. "Myself anon without a guiding hand / Will take thee to the spot where I must end." (lines 1570–1571). The reversal is not a recovery of ordinary eyesight, and it is not a boast that he has chosen the fact of the end. It shows that the summons gives him a path he can walk, and a charge he can place in Theseus's keeping, at the place appointed in this land. He leads because he is being led by the sign and by the god, and the seeing king must now follow the blind man who knows the way.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What is the effect of closing the scene with a blessing on Theseus, the land, and its followers, together with the request that they think of him for their welfare? Attend also to what the exit does and does not tell us.

Sample answer: The last words are not a lament and not a report of an accomplished end; they are a blessing and a civic charge. He blesses his dearest friend, the land, and its followers, and he asks that, in their prosperity, they still think of him, when he is dead, for their welfare. That turn toward the city's good matches the gift he has just placed in Theseus's care. The written exit names Theseus followed by Antigone and Ismene; by the sense of his own command to follow, he leads them as they go. The scene stops there. It does not describe a later report of the end, and it does not tell us what will later be refused or where the daughters will next be sent.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) develops the idea of the summons. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" could deliver about the summons. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the summons in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of the summons. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" could deliver about the summons. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the summons in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) suggests about the summons. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's plot and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" could deliver about the summons. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the summons in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses plot in Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) to complicate the reader's understanding of the summons. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" could deliver about the summons. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the summons in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Children, my children! will no messenger Go summon hither Theseus my best friend? And wherefore, father, dost thou summon him? This winged thunder of the god must bear me Anon to Hades. Send and tarry not.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "Anon" most nearly mean?

   A. never, if the prayer is refused
   B. only in a distant age already past
   C. by some other road than this
   D. soon or shortly

2. *Ills on ills! no pause or rest! Come they from our sightless guest? Or haply now we see fulfilled What fate long time hath willed? For ne'er have I proved vain Aught that the heavenly powers ordain. Time with never sleeping eye Watches what is writ on high, Overthrowing now the great, Raising now from low estate. Hark! How the thunder rumbles! Zeus defend us! Children, my children! will no messenger Go summon hither Theseus my best friend? And wherefore, father, dost thou summon him? This winged thunder of the god must bear me Anon to Hades. Send and tarry not.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)"?

   A. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome
   B. Polyneices and the father's curse
   C. The chorus asking whether old fate is now fulfilled
   D. The summons

SAT key: 1. D (soon or shortly); 2. D (The summons)

Lesson 12: Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)

Focus: the elders' prayer for his peace

Objective: Students will analyze how the elders change from the Parodos to this ode by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least two quotations—one from the Parodos and one from this ode (Stasimon 4)—and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.

Background: The ode names figures of the Greek underworld, such as its queen and its watch-dog (lines 1616–1617).

Significance: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How have the elders changed since the Parodos? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: How have the elders changed since the Parodos?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The same elders who once drove him away now pray that Justice bless a man wrongfully oppressed in life, and that his going be gentle, tearless, and without pain.

8–15 min · Vocabulary · We do (7 min)
7 key words in context.
Today's words: Stygian — of the river Styx; dark and gloomy; Tartarus — in Greek myth, the deepest part of the underworld; Aidoneus — a name of Hades, the god of the underworld; infernal — belonging to the underworld; gnarling — snarling or growling; cavernous — vast and deeply hollow; scathless — unharmed; without injury.
Words: Stygian: of the river Styx; dark and gloomy · Tartarus: in Greek myth, the deepest part of the underworld · Aidoneus: a name of Hades, the god of the underworld · infernal: belonging to the underworld · gnarling: snarling or growling · cavernous: vast and deeply hollow · scathless: unharmed; without injury

15–20 min · Context and read-aloud · I do (5 min)

Say that the ode is short, read it aloud twice, and frame the prayer.

Tell the class plainly: this is the shortest section of the play, a 20-line ode of about a hundred words, so today we read it closely and then write. Read all 20 lines aloud twice, in two voices (one for lines 1606–1615, one for lines 1616–1625). Then frame it: Oedipus has just left the stage, leading Theseus and his daughters toward the place where he must end, and the elders who stayed behind can follow him only in prayer. They call on the powers below, the unseen goddess, Aidoneus (another name for Hades) and the watch-dog at the gates, and ask one thing for their guest: that his going be gentle.

20–30 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (10 min)

Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.

First, meaning. I read "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain" slowly and put it in my own words: The elders ask the god of the dead to send this stranger down gently, without tears and without pain. Next, craft. I notice the contrast the elders build: soft words, "gentle," "tearless" and "without pain," set against the names of the place below, "all-shrouding" and "Stygian." The strongest word is "tearless": it asks for an end without grief or struggle, the opposite of the life of weeping and wandering already shown in the play. Then, effect. In lines 1610–1613, what gentle wish do the elders make, and for whom? My answer: The elders' prayer is not for victory or for themselves but for the guest they once tried to drive out: the hard place below is named in full, "all-shrouding" and "Stygian," and against it they set one gentle wish.

> *By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain* (Stasimon 4, lines 1610–1613)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain" slowly and put it in my own words: The elders ask the god of the dead to send this stranger down gently, without tears and without pain. Next, craft. I notice the contrast the elders build: soft words, "gentle," "tearless" and "without pain," set against the names of the place below, "all-shrouding" and "Stygian." The strongest word is "tearless": it asks for an end without grief or struggle, the opposite of the life of weeping and wandering already shown in the play. Then, effect. In lines 1610–1613, what gentle wish do the elders make, and for whom? My answer: The elders' prayer is not for victory or for themselves but for the guest they once tried to drive out: the hard place below is named in full, "all-shrouding" and "Stygian," and against it they set one gentle wish.

30–40 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Wrongfully", "oppressed" and "Justice blessed" stand out. "Wrongfully" judges his suffering undeserved; "oppressed" makes him someone things were done to, not their author; and "Justice blessed" asks the powers below to reverse that sentence now that his life is ending. Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected student answer: The hosts who once cried "Begone!" (line 216) now speak for their guest before the gods below. Their last act of hospitality is to plead his case: they ask that the man "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (lines 1614–1615).

> *Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed (Stasimon 4, lines 1614–1615)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Wrongfully", "oppressed" and "Justice blessed" stand out. "Wrongfully" judges his suffering undeserved; "oppressed" makes him someone things were done to, not their author; and "Justice blessed" asks the powers below to reverse that sentence now that his life is ending.
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected student answer: The hosts who once cried "Begone!" (line 216) now speak for their guest before the gods below. Their last act of hospitality is to plead his case: they ask that the man "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (lines 1614–1615).

40–70 min · Writing block: teacher model and drafting · You do (30 min)

A 5-minute teacher model, then 25 minutes of drafting one body paragraph toward the final paper.

Writing block (30 minutes). For 5 minutes, model one body paragraph aloud: put "Begone!" (line 216) and lines 1614–1615 on the board and build the exemplar below from them, naming the claim, each quotation and the reasoning as you go. Then students draft for 25 minutes: one body paragraph toward final-paper Prompt 4 (curse and mercy), or toward Prompt 1 (refuge and hospitality), tracing the elders from line 216 to lines 1614–1615. Each paragraph needs a claim, two located quotations (one from the Parodos, one from this ode) and a sentence of reasoning that says what changed. The access supports below stay available.

Task: Draft one body paragraph toward final-paper Prompt 4 (curse and mercy), or Prompt 1 (refuge and hospitality): how have the elders changed from the Parodos (line 216) to this ode (lines 1614–1615)? Make a claim, quote one line from each ode with its line number, and explain what changed and why it matters.

Access supports: Access supports (not a legal-compliance promise). These are teaching options for English learners and for students with IEP or 504 needs; they do not replace a student's plan, and using them does not by itself satisfy any legal requirement. Chunked reading: read the 20-line ode in two voices (lines 1606–1615, then 1616–1625), and put the Parodos "Begone!" (line 216) beside "Wrongfully in life oppressed… Justice blessed" (lines 1614–1615) before drafting. Sentence frames for today's body paragraph: In the Parodos the elders say "___" (line ___), but in this ode they pray "___" (lines ___). / What changed is ___. Graphic organizer: two rows (Parodos / this ode), three columns (quotation, line, what it shows about the elders). Time: extended time on the 25-minute draft toward Prompt 4 or Prompt 1; the task and its rigor do not change. Audio: hear the ode twice while following the text. This lesson's writing needs one located quotation from the Parodos and one from this ode.

Exemplar: In the Parodos the elders answer the name of Oedipus with "Begone!" (line 216) and defend their broken promise with "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites" (lines 222–223). In Stasimon 4 the same voices ask the powers below that a man "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (lines 1614–1615). Justice was first their reason to expel him; now it is the power they call on to bless him. Their mercy is not a denial of his sorrow: they ask the god below to "Speed this stranger to the gloom" (line 1611) gently, and they rest their plea on a new judgment that his suffering was undeserved.

70–80 min · Pair feedback · We do (10 min)

Partners check each other's drafts against a three-point checklist, then share one strong claim with the class.

Pair feedback (10 minutes). Partners swap drafts and check three things: a clear claim, two located quotations that match the text, and one counter-line the writer should answer. For the counter-line, use classroom questions #21 and #22: does the elders' change speak for the whole play, and is their prayer for peace alone or for justice too? Take two claims to the class and ask which quotation does the most work.

Anchor question: How have the elders changed since the Parodos, and does their change speak for the play?

Facilitation: Partners check: a clear claim; two located quotations that match the text; one counter-line to answer. · Counter-lines from classroom questions #21 and #22: does the chorus speak for the play, and do the elders pray for peace alone or for justice too (lines 1614–1615)? · Share two claims with the class and ask which quotation does the most work.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the elders' prayer for his peace? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. ("By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain", Stasimon 4, lines 1610–1613). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the elders' prayer for his peace? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. ("By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain", Stasimon 4, lines 1610–1613). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we read the shortest section of the play and wrote toward the final paper. Next lesson: the Exodos. The elders have prayed for their guest; read to find out what is reported about him, and whether their prayer seems answered.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Allusion:** The prayer turns to the powers of the underworld named in this ode: the all-shrouding Stygian plain, the dread invisible goddess, and the underworld's queen and watch-dog.
- **Tone / mood:** The elders ask for a gentle, tearless doom, that the stranger may enter the gloom without pain.
- **Theme:** They now ask that he, wrongfully oppressed in life, be blessed by Justice. The same elders who first drove him away pray for his peace.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** The elders who once cried "Begone!" now speak for their guest before the powers below; their last act of hospitality is a prayer that he be received gently and judged justly.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** Oedipus has gone toward the place that only Theseus may know; the elders cannot follow him there, so they follow him in prayer, asking the powers below to let him pass unharmed.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain" (Stasimon 4, lines 1610–1613) The chorus prays that he may enter the underworld without pain, under a tearless doom.
- "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (Stasimon 4, lines 1614–1615) They ask that Justice bless in death the man who was oppressed while he lived.
- "If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, invisible" (Stasimon 4, lines 1606–1607) The prayer reaches toward the unseen goddess of the dead, if the dead can hear.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace.
Evidence: "Begone! … By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain" (Parodos, line 216, and Stasimon 4, lines 1610–1613)
Reasoning: In the Parodos the same elders cried "Begone!" (line 216) and tried to drive him out; in this ode they ask the powers below to let him pass gently and without pain.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Line 216
216 **Chorus:** Begone!

Lines 1426–1427
1426 **Oedipus:** That city thou canst never storm, but first
1427 **Oedipus:** Shalt fall, thou and thy brother, blood-imbrued.

Lines 1606–1607
1606 **Chorus:** If mortal prayers are heard in hell,
1607 **Chorus:** Hear, Goddess dread, invisible!

Lines 1606–1615
1606 **Chorus:** If mortal prayers are heard in hell,
1607 **Chorus:** Hear, Goddess dread, invisible!
1608 **Chorus:** Monarch of the regions drear,
1609 **Chorus:** Aidoneus, hear, O hear!
1610 **Chorus:** By a gentle, tearless doom
1611 **Chorus:** Speed this stranger to the gloom,
1612 **Chorus:** Let him enter without pain
1613 **Chorus:** The all-shrouding Stygian plain.
1614 **Chorus:** Wrongfully in life oppressed,
1615 **Chorus:** Be he now by Justice blessed.

Lines 1606–1625
1606 **Chorus:** If mortal prayers are heard in hell,
1607 **Chorus:** Hear, Goddess dread, invisible!

1608 **Chorus:** Monarch of the regions drear,
1609 **Chorus:** Aidoneus, hear, O hear!
1610 **Chorus:** By a gentle, tearless doom
1611 **Chorus:** Speed this stranger to the gloom,
1612 **Chorus:** Let him enter without pain
1613 **Chorus:** The all-shrouding Stygian plain.
1614 **Chorus:** Wrongfully in life oppressed,
1615 **Chorus:** Be he now by Justice blessed.
1616 **Chorus:** Queen infernal, and thou fell
1617 **Chorus:** Watch-dog of the gates of hell,
1618 **Chorus:** Who, as legends tell, dost glare,
1619 **Chorus:** Gnarling in thy cavernous lair
1620 **Chorus:** At all comers, let him go
1621 **Chorus:** Scathless to the fields below.
1622 **Chorus:** For thy master orders thus,
1623 **Chorus:** The son of earth and Tartarus;
1624 **Chorus:** In his den the monster keep,
1625 **Chorus:** Giver of eternal sleep.

Lines 1610–1613
1610 **Chorus:** By a gentle, tearless doom
1611 **Chorus:** Speed this stranger to the gloom,
1612 **Chorus:** Let him enter without pain
1613 **Chorus:** The all-shrouding Stygian plain.

Lines 1610–1615
1610 **Chorus:** By a gentle, tearless doom
1611 **Chorus:** Speed this stranger to the gloom,
1612 **Chorus:** Let him enter without pain
1613 **Chorus:** The all-shrouding Stygian plain.
1614 **Chorus:** Wrongfully in life oppressed,
1615 **Chorus:** Be he now by Justice blessed.

Line 1612
1612 **Chorus:** Let him enter without pain

Line 1614
1614 **Chorus:** Wrongfully in life oppressed,

Lines 1614–1615
1614 **Chorus:** Wrongfully in life oppressed,
1615 **Chorus:** Be he now by Justice blessed.

Lines 1616–1621
1616 **Chorus:** Queen infernal, and thou fell
1617 **Chorus:** Watch-dog of the gates of hell,

1618 **Chorus:** Who, as legends tell, dost glare,
1619 **Chorus:** Gnarling in thy cavernous lair
1620 **Chorus:** At all comers, let him go
1621 **Chorus:** Scathless to the fields below.

Lines 1616–1625
1616 **Chorus:** Queen infernal, and thou fell
1617 **Chorus:** Watch-dog of the gates of hell,
1618 **Chorus:** Who, as legends tell, dost glare,
1619 **Chorus:** Gnarling in thy cavernous lair
1620 **Chorus:** At all comers, let him go
1621 **Chorus:** Scathless to the fields below.
1622 **Chorus:** For thy master orders thus,
1623 **Chorus:** The son of earth and Tartarus;
1624 **Chorus:** In his den the monster keep,
1625 **Chorus:** Giver of eternal sleep.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
Stygian (adjective)	of the river Styx; dark and gloomy	*By a gentle, tearless doom Speed this stranger to the gloom, Let him enter without pain The all-shrouding Stygian plain.*
Tartarus (noun)	in Greek myth, the deepest part of the underworld	*For thy master orders thus, The son of earth and Tartarus; In his den the monster keep, Giver of eternal sleep.*
Aidoneus (noun)	a name of Hades, the god of the underworld	*Monarch of the regions drear, / Aidoneus, hear, O hear!*
infernal (adjective)	belonging to the underworld	*Be he now by Justice blessed. / Queen infernal, and thou fell*
gnarling (verb)	snarling or growling	*Gnarling in thy cavernous lair / At all comers, let him go*
cavernous (adjective)	vast and deeply hollow	*Gnarling in thy cavernous lair / At all comers, let him go*
scathless (adjective)	unharmed; without injury	*At all comers, let him go / Scathless to the fields below.*

Discussion questions

1. How have the elders changed since the Parodos?
2. Where does allusion appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with refuge and hospitality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore:

1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What condition opens the elders' prayer to the powers below? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** If mortal prayers are heard in that place. The ode begins with that condition, then calls on the goddess and the monarch; the force of the line is the petition itself.
   Answer guidance: If mortal prayers are heard in that place. The ode begins with that condition, then calls on the goddess and the monarch; the force of the line is the petition itself.
2. To what gloom do the elders ask that this stranger be sped? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** To the gloom
   Answer guidance: To the gloom.
3. What do they picture the watch-dog doing at all who come? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Gnarling at all comers
   Answer guidance: Gnarling at all comers.
4. How do they first address the goddess, before they name her unseen? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** As Goddess dread
   Answer guidance: As Goddess dread.
5. How is the prayer ordered, after its opening condition? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A call on the powers, then a petition for the stranger
   Answer guidance: A call on the powers, then a petition for the stranger.
6. What do they say the master's order is, in the line that names that order? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Thy master orders thus
   Answer guidance: Thy master orders thus.
7. What do they bid both the goddess and the monarch do, in the opening cries? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Hear them
   Answer guidance: Hear them.
8. What gates does the prayer name as the watch-dog's place? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The gates of the underworld
   Answer guidance: The gates of the underworld.
9. What do they ask that this one man be, among all comers the hound glares at? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An exception among those comers
   Answer guidance: An exception among those comers.
10. What do they ask, of mortal speech, as the condition that opens the ode? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** That such speech be heard below
    Answer guidance: That such speech be heard below.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why do the elders call Oedipus "wrongfully" oppressed? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The elders now accept his plea that he acted unknowingly, so the word "Wrongfully" judges his long suffering undeserved rather than earned.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: In the Parodos the elders judged Oedipus by his name and tried to expel him. Now they call him "Wrongfully in life oppressed" (line 1614), which means they judge his suffering undeserved. They have accepted the case he argued, that he acted "all unwitting" (line 265), and they ask that he "Be he now by Justice blessed" (line 1615).
2. How have the elders changed from "Begone!" in the Parodos to the prayer they sing in this ode? State the inference and one line from this ode. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The same voices that once drove him out now ask the powers below to let him go gently and to let Justice bless a man they call wrongfully oppressed.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The ode suggests that the elders' hospitality has become complete: the men who cried "Begone!" (line 216) now ask the powers below: "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom" (lines 1610–1611). Their last service to him is this request that his going be without pain, and they add: "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (lines 1614–1615).
3. Find one example of allusion in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)". What does it reveal about the elders' prayer for his peace that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** One allusion (Aidoneus, the Goddess dread, the watch-dog of the gates, Tartarus), explained for what it reveals: the elders address each power that could block his way and ask it to let him pass.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders call on the guard dog of the underworld, the "Watch-dog of the gates of hell" (line 1617), and ask that it "let him go / Scathless to the fields below" (lines 1620–1621). The allusion shows that they are thinking through each danger their guest might meet below and pleading with each one. A plain statement that they wish him well would miss how thorough and protective their prayer is.
4. How does the tone / mood in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)" shape what we understand about the elders' prayer for his peace? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** How the tone, a hushed, reverent prayer, gentle words set against the frightening underworld, shapes our sense that the elders now feel tenderness and protectiveness toward their guest.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The tone is reverent and tender. The elders ask for "a gentle, tearless doom" (line 1610) and that he "enter without pain" (line 1612), while the powers they address are frightening, a monster "Gnarling in thy cavernous lair" (line 1619). The gentleness set against fear shows a protective care for the guest they once wanted to drive away.
5. In the passage that opens with "If mortal prayers are…", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two words from the opening lines (1606–1613) with their connotations, such as "dread," "invisible," "gentle, tearless" or "all-shrouding," showing a prayer that faces a frightening place with a gentle wish.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders call the goddess "dread" and "invisible" (line 1607), words that make the powers below frightening and unseen. Against them they set "gentle, tearless" (line 1610). The diction shows a prayer that faces a frightening world honestly and still asks for kindness inside it.

6. What causes the main turn in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The turn from asking a gentle way for the stranger to judging his life, "Wrongfully in life oppressed," and its likely effect: the audience now waits for news of how he fared.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The ode turns from its request for a gentle way to a judgment of his life: "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (lines 1614–1615). That turn changes a prayer into a verdict. Because Oedipus has left the stage, its effect is to make the audience wait, with the elders, for word of what happened to him.

7. How does "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)" build on "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A causal link: Oedipus left the stage drawing near "the final gloom / Of Hades," so the elders, left behind, pray that his way into that gloom be gentle.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The thunder scene ended with Oedipus saying "I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades" (lines 1601–1602) as he led the others out. Because he has gone where they cannot follow, the elders do the one thing they can: they ask the powers below to "Speed this stranger to the gloom" (line 1611) gently. His exit causes the prayer.

8. In "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the elders' prayer for his peace, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A motive inferred from the prayer: the elders ask nothing for themselves, which shows that their concern is now for the guest, and perhaps a wish to make amends for their first hostility.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The elders ask nothing for themselves; every request is for the stranger, that he "enter without pain" (line 1612) and that the watch-dog "let him go / Scathless" (lines 1620–1621). A fair inference is that they want to make amends: the men who first wanted him gone now use their only power, prayer, on his behalf.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (How have the elders changed since the Parodos?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A revised answer to the bell-ringer (how the elders have changed since the Parodos), with a line from each ode.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: My first answer was that the elders have grown used to him. The two odes show something deeper. In the Parodos they cried "Begone!" (line 216); now they call him "Wrongfully in life oppressed" (line 1614). They have changed their judgment of him, not just their feelings. They now believe his suffering was undeserved.

10. Where does theme appear in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)", and how does it connect the elders' prayer for his peace to the larger concern with refuge and hospitality? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Where theme appears and how it connects to refuge and hospitality: the elders' last act of hospitality is to speak for their guest before the gods below.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: Hospitality reaches past the stage. The elders cannot follow their guest, so they ask the powers below to receive him well, that he go "Scathless to the fields below" (line 1621). The ode connects the prayer for his peace to hospitality: the hosts who first refused him a seat now ask the gods below to make him welcome.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the change in the Chorus show the play's view of Oedipus? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A defended view on whether the chorus's change guides the audience, with lines from early and late, and a counterpoint (the chorus is a character group, not the author).
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: largely yes. The chorus has moved with the audience from fear ("Begone!", line 216) to sympathy, and its last judgment, that he suffered wrongly in life (lines 1614–1615), echoes what Oedipus argued and what the gods' summons seems to confirm. Counter-line: the chorus is a group of old men with their own views, and the play also gave his curse on his son its full weight (lines 1426–1427), so the elders' kindness may not be the whole of the play's view.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A stand with two lines from the ode, perhaps qualifying "peace": the elders ask for a painless way and for justice, not only rest.
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: agree, with a qualification. They do pray for his peace: "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom" (lines 1610–1611). But they pray for more than rest; they ask that he be "by Justice blessed" (line 1615), a judgment that his suffering was wrong. Their prayer is for peace and for justice.
3. No character acts in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)"; the elders pray. Which of the powers or attitudes the ode presents seems wisest, and which least wise? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named standard applied to the powers the ode addresses or to the elders' own conduct, with a line, for example judging by mercy: the elders ask the dread powers below to show the gentleness they once withheld.
   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: by the standard of mercy, the elders' own conduct is the wisest thing in the ode: they ask that the stranger be sped "By a gentle, tearless doom" (line 1610), the mercy they once withheld. The ode presents the guard dog, "Gnarling in thy cavernous lair / At all comers" (lines 1619–1620), as the opposite: a power that treats everyone alike, without mercy. A student could argue that the ode asks this power for an exception, so mercy here has to be won by prayer.
4. You are directing "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the elders' prayer for his peace. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two staging choices tied to lines, such as low, hushed delivery facing the direction Oedipus left, or a sound cue for the watch-dog, each with its effect.
   Answer guidance: Model answer: (1) Sing "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom" (lines 1610–1611) softly, facing the way Oedipus left, so the prayer follows him off stage. (2) On "Gnarling in thy cavernous lair" (line 1619), have a low drum or growl from below the stage, then silence on "let him go" (line 1620). The audience feels both the danger and the hope that it will be stilled.
5. Write your own questions about "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Three questions answerable from lines 1606–1625: one recall, one why/how and one should/what-if, different in kind.
   Answer guidance: Model set. Recall: Which creature do the elders ask to let him go? (The watch-dog at

the gates, lines 1616–1621.) Why/how: Why do the elders say "If mortal prayers are heard in hell" (line 1606)? (They are unsure whether the gods below listen.) Should/what if: Should the chorus have prayed for Oedipus after he cursed his son? (Answers weigh "Wrongfully in life oppressed," line 1614, against the curse at lines 1426–1427.)

6. Connect "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)", with its focus on the elders' prayer for his peace, to guilt and intent: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment about guilt and intent, the question's theme. The link is strong: "Wrongfully in life oppressed" judges that his suffering was undeserved because he did not intend his acts. A strong answer says what must come next.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the link is strong. The elders now judge that he was "Wrongfully in life oppressed" (line 1614), which accepts the case Oedipus has argued since the Parodos: that he acted without knowledge and is innocent in intent. The judgment is still the elders' prayer, not the gods' answer. To strengthen the link, Sophocles would need to show some sign that the powers below accept that judgment.

7. Is the allusion in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)" effective in presenting the elders' prayer for his peace, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment against a stated criterion (do the allusions deepen the prayer or crowd it?), with a line that meets it and one that might miss it.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: effective, because each allusion names a danger the elders want their guest spared. The guard dog "Who, as legends tell, dost glare" (line 1618) makes the underworld vivid in a few words. Counter-line: modern readers may stumble over Aidoneus, Tartarus and "The son of earth and Tartarus" (line 1623), so the allusions can feel crowded or heavy-handed in a 20-line ode. A strong review decides whether the vivid danger is worth the difficulty.

8. Compare how "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)" treats the elders' prayer for his peace with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named comparison (another prayer, hymn or poem for someone who is dying) and one thing the ode sees that the other misses, tied to a line.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Compare a hymn sung at a deathbed for comfort, which usually speaks only of rest and light. The ode sees what such hymns often soften: the place below is frightening, with a guard that snarls "At all comers" (line 1620). The elders do not pretend otherwise; they name the danger and ask that their guest be let through "Scathless" (line 1621). Their comfort is braver because it faces the fear.

9. Predict what "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A prediction from two clues, Oedipus leading the way and the elders' prayer for a gentle end, about what the final scene will bring, without stating an outcome, checked after reading.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Clue 1: Oedipus left saying he drew "near the final gloom / Of Hades" (lines 1601–1602). Clue 2: the elders pray that he go "By a gentle, tearless doom" (line 1610). A reasonable prediction is that the final scene will bring news of what happened to him, and the class can ask whether the prayer was answered. After reading, students check whether the outcome matches the elders' hope.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the elders' prayer for his peace? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An adaptation that keeps the core: a community that once rejected someone now gathers to pray for his peaceful end. It names two details that must stay.
    Answer guidance: Model answer: Neighbours who once signed a petition to evict an old man now gather outside the hospital where he lies, praying that his last hours be painless and saying aloud that he was treated unfairly. Two things must stay: the request for a painless end ("Let him enter without pain," line 1612), and the community's changed judgment of his life (line 1614).

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders pray for?
    A. A gentle, tearless doom, and entry without pain
    B. A victory already won against a neighbouring army
    C. Rain for the fields around the sacred grove
    D. A sudden end already planned for Creon and his men

    Key: A (A gentle, tearless doom, and entry without pain)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do the elders now describe Oedipus' life?
    A. Lucky in every season
    B. Wrongfully oppressed
    C. Royal and still in power
    D. Wicked by his own design

    Key: B (Wrongfully oppressed)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "Hear, Goddess dread, _____!"
    Key: invisible
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "Monarch of the regions _____,"
    Key: drear
5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.9] What does "Stygian" refer to?
    A. A mountain standing over the sacred grove
    B. A city already named in the earlier odes
    C. The underworld, named from the river Styx
    D. A temple the chorus has already promised to build

    Key: C (The underworld, named from the river Styx)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why do the elders ask that the stranger enter without pain?

   A. They want him to stay in the grove and refuse any summons at all this hour

   B. They hope the daughters will lead him back to a neighbouring city now

   C. They mean to finish a sacrifice before the prince can return to them

   D. They petition the powers below to speed him gently and spare him suffering

   Key: D (They petition the powers below to speed him gently and spare him suffering)

7. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.9] How does the ode first call the underworld king by name? Use the line that asks him to hear, and say what that naming does in a prayer.

   Sample answer: They name him and ask him, twice, to hear. "Aidoneus, hear, O hear!" (line 1609). The doubled "hear" treats the prayer as something that must reach a king who may or may not listen, and it places the ode in his court, not in a human council. The song does not tell us that the end has already been accomplished; it asks the named monarch to attend to a petition still being spoken.

8. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What is the tone of the prayer?

   A. Gentle and reverent

   B. Angry and accusing

   C. Comic and light-hearted

   D. Boastful and triumphant

   Key: A (Gentle and reverent)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What do the elders ask for in the lines about a gentle, tearless doom and an entering without pain? Say how those words should be read.

   Sample answer: They ask that this stranger be sped to the gloom by a gentle, tearless doom, and that he enter without pain. "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain" (lines 1610–1612). "Gentle", "tearless", and "without pain" are the terms of a religious petition. The song is asking the powers below to make the going easy; it does not describe a later report of how the end will be told.

10. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Does this prayer change how we should see the elders, who once drove the stranger out? Defend your view from the petition itself.

    Sample answer: Yes, the song marks a change, even if it does not rewrite the whole play in these few lines. The same chorus that once ordered the stranger away now asks that he be sped gently, spared pain, and blessed by Justice after a life they call wrongful oppression. That is a petition for peace, not a claim that they have always been kind. The ode leaves the stranger still on his way; it does not tell us what a later messenger will say, and it should be read as a religious song of escort and blessing, spoken as he goes.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How have the elders changed since the Parodos?

    A. From driving him away to praying for him

    B. From praise of him to open blame of the king

    C. They have not changed in any important way

    D. From fear of the grove to anger at Theseus

    Key: A (From driving him away to praying for him)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which underworld king do the elders call by name in this ode?

    A. King Creon

    B. Aidoneus

    C. King Theseus

D. Lord Apollo

Key: B (Aidoneus)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Queen _____, and thou fell"

Key: infernal

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Gnarling in thy _____ lair"

Key: cavernous

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What do the elders ask the watch-dog of the gates to do?

A. Bar the gate and keep the stranger out forever

B. Hunt the daughters back from the grove at once

C. Let him go scathless to the fields below

D. Devour every comer who has already reached the plain

Key: C (Let him go scathless to the fields below)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Who, according to the ode, gives the order that the stranger be let go?

A. The chorus itself, speaking in the name of the Athenian king this hour

B. Antigone, who has already asked the hound to stand aside at the gate

C. Creon, who has already claimed the right to take the stranger home

D. The watch-dog's master, called the son of earth and the deep underworld

Key: D (The watch-dog's master, called the son of earth and the deep underworld)

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the ode picture the watch-dog at the gates, and what do the elders still ask of it? Use the lines about legends, glaring, and the gates of hell.

Sample answer: They address a fell watch-dog of the gates of hell, and they picture it as the legends do: glaring, in its lair, at all who come. "Watch-dog of the gates of hell, / Who, as legends tell, dost glare," (lines 1617–1618). The image is fierce, but the petition that follows is not a wish to see anyone destroyed. They still ask that this one stranger be let through unharmed. The hound remains a guardian in the song; the prayer asks it, under its master's order, not to treat the stranger as prey.

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which literary element is at work when the prayer names Aidoneus, the Stygian plain, and the watch-dog of the gates?

A. Allusion

B. Comic mode

C. Satiric mode

D. Ironic mode

Key: A (Allusion)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why do the elders call Oedipus "wrongfully" oppressed? Use the couplet that sets that word beside a prayer to Justice, and stay with what this ode itself says.

Sample answer: They name his life as oppression, and they judge that oppression wrongful, then ask that Justice bless him now. "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed." (lines 1614–1615). The adverb is a present verdict: whatever the past deeds, these speakers now call his suffering undeserved and ask a blessing in its place. The couplet does not retry the old case or retell the facts of the earlier plays; it marks a change of judgment in the song, and it should be taught as that judgment, not as a new narrative of how he came to suffer.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How should we hold together the appeal to Justice and the appeal to the watch-dog in this ode?

    Sample answer: Both petitions point the same way: the stranger is to be received without further harm. Justice is asked to bless one whose life they now call wrongful oppression; the hound of the gates is asked to let him go unharmed to the fields below. One appeal is moral, the other is mythic and local to the gateway, and neither describes the stranger's going as already accomplished. Read together, they turn the underworld from a place of terror into a court that can still show mercy, at the elders' request, as the stranger goes on his way.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What do the elders ask Justice to do?

    A. Bless Oedipus now, after a life they call wrongful oppression

    B. Condemn him again for deeds already judged in a neighbouring city

    C. Send him back at once to finish a war already begun in the field

    D. Silence the watch-dog before the daughters can speak at all

    Key: A (Bless Oedipus now, after a life they call wrongful oppression)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “The son of earth and _____;”

    Key: Tartarus

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “In his den the _____ keep,”

    Key: monster

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Who, according to the Chorus, is the watch-dog's master in this ode?

    A. Theseus, who has already claimed the grove as his own court now

    B. The underworld king who orders the hound to let the stranger go

    C. The chorus leader, who now speaks as if he ruled the world of the dead

    D. Creon, who has already demanded that the stranger be returned at once

    Key: B (The underworld king who orders the hound to let the stranger go)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why do the elders ask that the stranger go unharmed to the fields below?

    A. They want the hound to drive him back into the grove at once

    B. They have already seen him refused and sent away empty-handed

    C. They ask that he be allowed to enter the underworld unharmed

    D. They mean to hide the place of rest from every later visitor

    Key: C (They ask that he be allowed to enter the underworld unharmed)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the ode first test whether a prayer can reach the dead? Use the opening condition, and say what that condition does before any name is spoken.

    Sample answer: It begins with an if: mortal prayers may or may not be heard in hell. “If mortal prayers are heard in hell,” (line 1606). The line is humble and uncertain; it does not assume that the powers below owe the city an answer. Only after that condition do the elders call on a dread, unseen goddess and a named monarch. The opening therefore frames everything that follows as a request, not as a command they can enforce, and not as a report that the end has already come.

27. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the force of asking that the stranger go scathless to the fields below? Use those lines, and say how they fit a prayer.

    Sample answer: After picturing the hound that glares at all comers, the elders ask a precise mercy: let this one man go unharmed to the fields below. “At all comers, let him go / Scathless to the fields below.” (lines 1620–1621). “Scathless” means

without hurt; the request is that the gateway not wound him. That is a petition addressed to a guardian beast and, behind it, to its master. In the song, the path is still ahead, and the chorus is asking that it be gentle.

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which literary element names the feeling of a prayer that asks for a gentle, tearless doom and a blessing by Justice?

    A. Plot

    B. Comedy

    C. Satire

    D. Tone

    Key: D (Tone)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does the change in the Chorus show the play's view of Oedipus? Defend your view from this ode, without telling a later report of his end.

    Sample answer: The change shows at least the play's present view of him in the city that has taken him in. Elders who once drove the stranger out now call his life wrongful oppression and ask Justice to bless him, and they pray that the powers below receive him without pain. That is not a full verdict on every earlier scene, and the ode does not say that Athens has always been kind. It does show that, by this point, the civic voice of Colonus speaks for mercy and for a peaceful going, not for further punishment. A fair defence can also note the limit: a short prayer is not the whole play, and it does not yet tell us how the end will be narrated.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does this ode complete the turn from fear of the stranger to care for that going? Use the petition's aims, and say what it still refuses to settle.

    Sample answer: Fear is not absent: the song still names hell, a dread goddess, and a glaring hound. But the petitions all run toward care. The elders ask for a gentle, tearless doom, for an entering without pain, for a blessing by Justice, and for a scathless going to the fields below. The underworld is invoked so that it will receive him kindly. What the ode refuses to settle is the later telling of the end itself; it is a prayer spoken as he is already being led on his way, and it should be left as a song of escort.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “The all-shrouding _____ plain.”

    Key: Stygian

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Giver of _____ sleep.”

    Key: eternal

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does calling Oedipus's life wrongful oppression prepare the prayer that Justice bless him now?

    A. It first revises the verdict on his suffering, then asks that blessing follow

    B. It accuses him again, so that Justice will refuse any blessing at all now

    C. It claims he has already been blessed, and that the prayer is unnecessary now

    D. It tells the daughters to take him home before any blessing can be asked

    Key: A (It first revises the verdict on his suffering, then asks that blessing follow)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the watch-dog image work in the prayer, if the same song also asks that the stranger go unharmed?

    A. The hound is praised for already having barred every path to the stranger this day

    B. The fierce guardian is asked, under its master's order, to make an exception of this stranger

    C. The image is comic, and it asks the audience to laugh at the underworld outright

    D. The image warns Theseus to hunt the stranger out of the grove at once today

Key: B (The fierce guardian is asked, under its master's order, to make an exception of this stranger)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of closing the ode by naming a giver of last rest?

    A. It tells us that the stranger has already been laid to rest before the song began

    B. It names that power as a civic official already seated in the Athenian council

    C. It names the underworld power as the one who grants a last rest

    D. It claims to reveal a hidden grave that no one in the city may later name

    Key: C (It names the underworld power as the one who grants a last rest)

36. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which reading of the ode best holds its mythic names and its moral petition together?

    A. A war song that asks Aidoneus to destroy a neighbouring city for Athens this day

    B. A comic interlude that mocks the stranger for having entered the sacred grove

    C. A report that already confirms how the end will later be told on the stage

    D. A religious song asking the powers below to receive, without pain, a man they now call wronged

    Key: D (A religious song asking the powers below to receive, without pain, a man they now call wronged)

37. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the ode move from a conditional opening to a direct order about the master's will? Use the line about the master's order.

    Sample answer: The song begins by wondering whether mortal prayers are heard at all; it ends by stating that the watch-dog's master already orders the mercy they ask. “For thy master orders thus,” (line 1622). The movement is from uncertainty to authority: if the dead can hear, then this king has in fact commanded that the stranger be let go, and that the monster be kept in its den. They are not reporting that the end has already come. They are grounding their petition in a will they ascribe to the underworld king himself.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the phrase “all-shrouding Stygian plain”. What does the wording add to the prayer that he enter without pain?

    Sample answer: The plain is named from the Styx, so the line alludes to the underworld river, and “all-shrouding” makes that place a covering over the one who enters. The prayer has just asked that he be sped by a gentle, tearless doom and that he enter without pain; this close of the sentence tells where that entering is imagined to be, and how total its covering is. The diction is grave, not sensational. It should be taught as part of a petition for an easy going into that covered world.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How should a class read this prayer for a gentle, tearless going? Take a stand, and use the song's own petitions.

    Sample answer: It should be read as a religious song of escort. The elders ask underworld powers, by name and by office, to hear them; they ask for a gentle, tearless doom, for an entering without pain, for a blessing by Justice after a life they call wrongful oppression, and for a scathless going to the fields below. Those are petitions, spoken in the voice of the city, about how a going already signalled might be received. Taught that way, the ode honours the seriousness of the end as a prayer of escort.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does it mean that the elders who once drove the stranger out now pray for that peace? Defend a reading from this ode, and note what the song does not yet tell us.

    Sample answer: It means that the civic voice of Colonus has moved from exclusion to care. The prayer does not apologise in so many words, but the requests themselves show the change: blessing after wrongful oppression, a gentle entering, and a safe passage past the hound of the gates. That change can be read as the play's way of showing what refuge finally costs and gives: not only a place to stand, but a community willing to ask mercy for the stranger's end. The ode still does not tell us

how that end will later be narrated, and it does not show the going itself. A careful reading stops at the prayer, and lets the petition be the last word of this song.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) develops the idea of the elders' prayer for his peace. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)" could deliver about the elders' prayer for his peace. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the elders' prayer for his peace in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of the elders' prayer for his peace. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)" could deliver about the elders' prayer for his peace. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the elders' prayer for his peace in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) suggests about the elders' prayer for his peace. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's allusion and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)" could deliver about the elders' prayer for his peace. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the elders' prayer for his peace in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses allusion in Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) to complicate the reader's understanding of the elders' prayer for his peace. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)" could deliver about the elders' prayer for his peace. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the elders' prayer for his peace in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Queen infernal, and thou fell Watch-dog of the gates of hell, Who, as legends tell, dost glare, Gnarling in thy cavernous lair At all comers, let him go Scathless to the fields below.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "Scathless" most nearly mean?

   A. laden with further punishment
   B. unharmed or without injury
   C. bound in the monster's den
   D. forgotten by every power below

2. *If mortal prayers are heard in hell, Hear, Goddess dread, invisible! Monarch of the regions drear, Aidoneus, hear, O hear! By a gentle, tearless doom Speed this stranger to the gloom, Let him enter without pain The all-shrouding Stygian plain. Wrongfully in life oppressed, Be he now by Justice blessed. Queen infernal, and thou fell Watch-dog of the gates of hell, Who, as legends tell, dost glare, Gnarling in thy cavernous lair At all comers, let him go Scathless to the fields below. For thy master orders thus, The son of earth and Tartarus; In his den the monster keep, Giver of eternal sleep.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)"?

   A. The Colonus ode
   B. A plea that the powers below add further punishment
   C. The elders' prayer for his peace
   D. The summons

SAT key: 1. B (unharmed or without injury); 2. C (The elders' prayer for his peace)

Lesson 13: Exodos (lines 1626–1831)

Focus: the mysterious passing

Objective: Students will analyze how plot develops in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide or self-harm (reported or spoken of)): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: "How do the others respond to this loss?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

Background: The play ends where Antigone begins: Antigone returns to Thebes (line 1822).

Significance: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661).

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can grief and love be present at the same time? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: How can grief and love be present at the same time?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: A messenger tells of a passing without wailing or disease, seen only by Theseus; the grave stays secret, and the daughters are left with love, grief, and the road back to Thebes.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
7 key words in context.
Today's words: marvellous — causing wonder; tribulations — great troubles or suffering; evanished — vanished; passed out of sight; ineffable — too sacred or too great to be spoken; litanies — formal prayers with repeated responses, especially at a funeral or rite; beneficent — doing good; kindly or generous in effect; behoof — benefit or advantage (archaic).
Words: marvellous: causing wonder · tribulations: great troubles or suffering · evanished: vanished; passed out of sight · ineffable: too sacred or too great to be spoken · litanies: formal prayers with repeated responses, especially at a funeral or rite · beneficent: doing good; kindly or generous in effect · behoof: benefit or advantage (archaic)

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The play ends where Antigone begins: Antigone returns to Thebes (line 1822). The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Plot: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and a mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus, without wailing, disease, or pain. Theseus will not reveal the grave; Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. Theme: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is love, and Antigone can say that love turns past pain to bliss; the chorus tells sorrow to rest, for all is ordered for the best. Characterization: Theseus keeps his promise and offers the daughters his care. The daughters mourn, and Antigone resolves to return to Thebes, where her own play will begin. Watch for the sacred grove and the hidden grave: The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the mysterious passing.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)

Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.

First, meaning. I read "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A..." slowly and put it in my own words: The messenger reports Oedipus's last words to his children: their long care is over, and one word, love, wipes out the score of their troubles; they had that love from him, and must now live without him. Next, craft. I notice how "one word" is delayed until "love," and how the next sentence both gives that love and takes away the life in which they received it. The strongest word is "love": "love" is the word he says wipes out the long ministry, his last gift in the speech the messenger is here to tell. Then, effect. What do lines 1657–1663 reveal about Oedipus's last charge? My answer: This is Oedipus's last charge: his last word to his daughters is love, and the speech holds both the gift and the loss. The father whose care is ending speaks of love as the one word that settles the score.

> *My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days* *(Exodos, lines 1657–1663)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A…" slowly and put it in my own words: The messenger reports Oedipus's last words to his children: their long care is over, and one word, love, wipes out the score of their troubles; they had that love from him, and must now live without him. Next, craft. I notice how "one word" is delayed until "love," and how the next sentence both gives that love and takes away the life in which they received it. The strongest word is "love": "love" is the word he says wipes out the long ministry, his last gift in the speech the messenger is here to tell. Then, effect. What do lines 1657–1663 reveal about Oedipus's last charge? My answer: This is Oedipus's last charge: his last word to his daughters is love, and the speech holds both the gift and the loss. The father whose care is ending speaks of love as the one word that settles the score.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Messenger", "painless" and "marvellous" stand out. "A messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving" offers two causes and refuses a violent one; "painless" and "without wailing or disease or pain" describe the manner; "an end most marvellous" judges it beyond the usual course. He passed without pain or disease (Messenger, lines 1702–1705). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected student answer: The mysterious passing fulfils the blessing promised to the city that took him in: he goes without pain, and the secret place where he ended, which only Theseus may know, is the gift his hosts must guard.

> *It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous (Exodos, lines 1702–1705)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Messenger", "painless" and "marvellous" stand out. "A messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving" offers two causes and refuses a violent one; "painless" and "without wailing or disease or pain" describe the manner; "an end most marvellous" judges it beyond the usual course. He passed without pain or disease (Messenger, lines 1702–1705).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected student answer: The mysterious passing fulfils the blessing promised to the city that took him in: he goes without pain, and the secret place where he ended, which only Theseus may know, is the gift his hosts must guard.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for plot, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the mysterious passing? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Exodos (lines 1626–1831) develops the idea of the mysterious passing. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). When the text says "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days" (Exodos, lines 1657–1663), it shows this directly. A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

Task: Annotate the scene for plot, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the mysterious passing? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Exodos (lines 1626–1831) develops the idea of the mysterious passing. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Access supports: Access supports (not a legal-compliance promise). These are teaching options for English learners and for students with IEP or 504 needs; they do not replace a student's plan, and using them does not by itself satisfy any legal requirement. Chunked reading: the last charge to the children (lines 1657–1663) first, then the messenger's report of the passing (lines 1698–1705), with a gist check after each. Sentence frames: "one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love" (lines 1660–1661) means ___. / "without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous" (lines 1704–1705) describes the passing as ___, not as a battle or a storm. Graphic organizer: a two-row chart (what Oedipus says / what the messenger reports) with a located quotation in each row. Time: extended time on the quiz and writing start. Audio: hear the love speech and the "marvellous" report separately, following the printed text.

Exemplar: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). When the text says "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days" (Exodos, lines 1657–1663), it shows this directly. A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How can grief and love be present at the same time? Ask: How can grief and love be present at the same time?

Anchor question: How can grief and love be present at the same time?

Facilitation: Ask: How can grief and love be present at the same time?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the mysterious passing? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). (“My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry”, Exodos, lines 1657–1663). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the mysterious passing? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). (“My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry”, Exodos, lines 1657–1663). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes the mysterious passing. Key takeaway: A messenger tells of a passing without wailing or disease, seen only by Theseus; the grave stays secret, and the daughters are left with love, grief, and the road back to Thebes.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and a mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus, without wailing, disease, or pain. Theseus will not reveal the grave; Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.
- **Theme:** The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is love, and Antigone can say that love turns past pain to bliss; the chorus tells sorrow to rest, for all is ordered for the best.
- **Characterization:** Theseus keeps his promise and offers the daughters his care. The daughters mourn, and Antigone resolves to return to Thebes, where her own play will begin.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the mysterious passing.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the mysterious passing.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days" (Exodos, lines 1657–1663) The messenger reports Oedipus's last charge: love wipes out the long labor his daughters bore.
- "It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous" (Exodos, lines 1702–1705) He died without pain or disease, as if heaven or the earth itself had opened for him.
- "Love can turn past pain to bliss, / What seemed bitter now is sweet" (Exodos, lines 1742–1743) Antigone finds that love can sweeten what had seemed only bitter pain after so long a care.
- "Wail no more, let sorrow rest, / All is ordered for the best" (Exodos, lines 1830–1831) The chorus closes by telling the mourners to rest, for all has been ordered for the best.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661).
Evidence: "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days" (Exodos, lines 1657–1663)
Reasoning: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1644–1646
1644 **Messenger:** Then calling to his daughters bade them fetch
1645 **Messenger:** Of running water, both to wash withal
1646 **Messenger:** And make libation; so they clomb the steep,

Lines 1657–1663
1657 **Messenger:** "My children, ye will lose your sire today,
1658 **Messenger:** For all of me has perished, and no more
1659 **Messenger:** Have ye to bear your long, long ministry;
1660 **Messenger:** A heavy load, I know, and yet one word
1661 **Messenger:** Wipes out all score of tribulations—love.
1662 **Messenger:** And love from me ye had—from no man more;
1663 **Messenger:** But now must live without me all your days."

Line 1669
1669 **Messenger:** The hair of all stood up and all were 'mazed;

Line 1679
1679 **Messenger:** That time and friendship prompt in their behoof."

Lines 1682–1688

1682 **Messenger:** This promise given, Oedipus put forth
1683 **Messenger:** Blind hands and laid them on his children, saying,
1684 **Messenger:** "O children, prove your true nobility
1685 **Messenger:** And hence depart nor seek to witness sights
1686 **Messenger:** Unlawful or to hear unlawful words.
1687 **Messenger:** Nay, go with speed; let none but Theseus stay,
1688 **Messenger:** Our ruler, to behold what next shall hap."

Lines 1682–1705

1682 **Messenger:** This promise given, Oedipus put forth
1683 **Messenger:** Blind hands and laid them on his children, saying,
1684 **Messenger:** "O children, prove your true nobility
1685 **Messenger:** And hence depart nor seek to witness sights
1686 **Messenger:** Unlawful or to hear unlawful words.
1687 **Messenger:** Nay, go with speed; let none but Theseus stay,
1688 **Messenger:** Our ruler, to behold what next shall hap."
1689 **Messenger:** So we all heard him speak, and weeping sore
1690 **Messenger:** We companied the maidens on their way.
1691 **Messenger:** After brief space we looked again, and lo
1692 **Messenger:** The man was gone, evanished from our eyes;
1693 **Messenger:** Only the king we saw with upraised hand
1694 **Messenger:** Shading his eyes as from some awful sight,
1695 **Messenger:** That no man might endure to look upon.
1696 **Messenger:** A moment later, and we saw him bend
1697 **Messenger:** In prayer to Earth and prayer to Heaven at once.
1698 **Messenger:** But by what doom the stranger met his end
1699 **Messenger:** No man save Theseus knoweth. For there fell
1700 **Messenger:** No fiery bolt that reft him in that hour,
1701 **Messenger:** Nor whirlwind from the sea, but he was taken.
1702 **Messenger:** It was a messenger from heaven, or else
1703 **Messenger:** Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base;
1704 **Messenger:** For without wailing or disease or pain
1705 **Messenger:** He passed away—an end most marvellous.

Line 1695

1695 **Messenger:** That no man might endure to look upon.

Lines 1698–1705

1698 **Messenger:** But by what doom the stranger met his end
1699 **Messenger:** No man save Theseus knoweth. For there fell
1700 **Messenger:** No fiery bolt that reft him in that hour,
1701 **Messenger:** Nor whirlwind from the sea, but he was taken.
1702 **Messenger:** It was a messenger from heaven, or else
1703 **Messenger:** Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base;

1704 **Messenger:** For without wailing or disease or pain
1705 **Messenger:** He passed away—an end most marvellous.

Lines 1702–1705
1702 **Messenger:** It was a messenger from heaven, or else
1703 **Messenger:** Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base;
1704 **Messenger:** For without wailing or disease or pain
1705 **Messenger:** He passed away—an end most marvellous.

Lines 1742–1743
1742 **Antigone:** Love can turn past pain to bliss,
1743 **Antigone:** What seemed bitter now is sweet.

Line 1778
1778 **Antigone:** Lead me thither; slay me there.

Lines 1807–1808
1807 **Antigone:** With our own eyes we fain would see
1808 **Antigone:** Our father's tomb.

Lines 1812–1819
1812 **Theseus:** Charged me straitly that no mortal
1813 **Theseus:** Should approach the sacred portal,
1814 **Theseus:** Or greet with funeral litanies
1815 **Theseus:** The hidden tomb wherein he lies;
1816 **Theseus:** Saying, "If thou keep'st my hest
1817 **Theseus:** Thou shalt hold thy realm at rest."
1818 **Theseus:** The God of Oaths this promise heard,
1819 **Theseus:** And to Zeus I pledged my word.

Lines 1830–1831
1830 **Chorus:** Wail no more, let sorrow rest,
1831 **Chorus:** All is ordered for the best.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
marvellous (adjective)	causing wonder	*It was a messenger from heaven, or else Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; For without wailing or disease or pain He passed away—an end most marvellous.*
tribulations (noun)	great troubles or suffering	*A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love.*
evanished (verb)	vanished; passed out of sight	*After brief space we looked again, and lo / The man was gone, evanished from our eyes;*

ineffable (adjective)	too sacred or too great to be spoken	*What tongue can tell / That sight ineffable?*
litanies (noun)	formal prayers with repeated responses, especially at a funeral or rite	*Should approach the sacred portal, / Or greet with funeral litanies*
beneficent (adjective)	doing good; kindly or generous in effect	*On the quick and on the dead / By dark Powers beneficent,*
behoof (noun)	benefit or advantage (archaic)	*Thou never wilt forsake them, but do all / That time and friendship prompt in their behoof."*

Discussion questions

1. How can grief and love be present at the same time?
2. Where does plot appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and intent?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does the messenger say Theseus did with his hand, after the passing was complete? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He shaded his eyes, as from some awful sight. The messenger places that gesture after the man was gone, a sign of what may not be told, and not a naming of the secret place itself.
   Answer guidance: He shaded his eyes, as from some awful sight. The messenger places that gesture after the man was gone, a sign of what may not be told, and not a naming of the secret place itself.
2. Where does the messenger say Oedipus paused, before he named the later marks? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** At one of the converging paths
   Answer guidance: At one of the converging paths.
3. What does the messenger say Oedipus bade his daughters fetch, once he had paused? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Water, as he willed, for the rite at hand
   Answer guidance: Water, as he willed, for the rite at hand.
4. What does the messenger say Oedipus did with his arms, when he spoke to the girls? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He folded his arms about them both
   Answer guidance: He folded his arms about them both.
5. How does the messenger say the man was gone, when the end had come? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:**

Evanished from their eyes

Answer guidance: Evanished from their eyes.

6. What does Antigone name, as what she has lost the guidance of? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Those dear blind feet

   Answer guidance: Those dear blind feet.

7. What does Antigone ask to stay, as she looks toward her brothers' feud? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** This mortal feud

   Answer guidance: This mortal feud.

8. What does Theseus tell the daughters to do with their tears, when grace is shed? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Dry their tears

   Answer guidance: Dry their tears.

9. What does the chorus tell them they needs must bear? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** What heaven brings

   Answer guidance: What heaven brings.

10. What does the messenger say Theseus did of his nobility, before the last moment? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He repressed the display of grief beside him

    Answer guidance: He repressed the display of grief beside him.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Theseus keep the grave secret? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** He promised Oedipus; the secret protects Athens.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Theseus is bound by an oath: Oedipus "Charged me straitly that no mortal / Should approach the sacred portal" (lines 1812–1813), and "to Zeus I pledged my word" (line 1819). The secret is also the city's protection: "If thou keep'st my hest / Thou shalt hold thy realm at rest" (lines 1816–1817). Keeping it is both loyalty to his friend and care for Athens, even though it means refusing the grieving daughters.

2. What does "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" suggest about the mysterious passing? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The cursed man becomes a protector of the city, and his farewell to his daughters turns on the word "love" (line 1661).

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The Exodos suggests that the outcast's end is a blessing, not a disgrace: "without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous" (lines 1704–1705), and his hidden grave will keep Athens "at rest" (line 1817). His farewell sums up his life with his daughters in one word: "one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love" (lines 1660–1661).

3. Find one example of plot in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)". What does it reveal about the mysterious passing that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A plot example, such as only Theseus seeing the end while the Messenger reports only what he did not see, explained for what it reveals: the mystery itself is the meaning.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The Messenger and the others look back and find that "The man was gone, evanished from our eyes" (line 1692), while Theseus shades his eyes "as from some awful sight" (line

1694). The plot keeps the moment itself offstage and unknown: "No man save Theseus knoweth" (line 1699). A plain statement that Oedipus died would miss how the play makes his end a holy mystery.

4. How does the theme in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" shape what we understand about the mysterious passing? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** How the theme of love outlasting suffering ("Love can turn past pain to bliss") shapes the ending: grief is real, but the care the daughters gave is honoured.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The theme of love outlasting suffering frames the grief. Oedipus tells his daughters that one word "Wipes out all score of tribulations—love" (line 1661), and Antigone answers in her lament: "Love can turn past pain to bliss, / What seemed bitter now is sweet" (lines 1742–1743). The theme shows that the care they gave was not wasted, even in their sorrow.

5. In the passage that opens with "This promise given, Oedipus…", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two words from lines 1682–1688 with their connotations, such as "Blind hands," "nobility" or "Unlawful," showing a last blessing and a holy limit the daughters must respect.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The phrase "Blind hands" (line 1683) makes his last touch both tender and helpless, a blessing given by a man who cannot see his children. Then he tells them to "prove your true nobility" (line 1684) by leaving, rather than by staying. The diction makes leaving an act of honour and marks the holy limit that even his children must not cross.

6. What causes the main turn in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** The turn is the god's call, which ends the farewell and sends everyone but Theseus away; its effect is to leave the daughters grieving without a grave and to put them in Theseus's care.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: The turn is the voice that calls him: "Oedipus, Oedipus, why tarry we?" (line 1671). It ends the farewell and leads him to place his daughters in Theseus's care, "Thou never wilt forsake them" (line 1678), before sending them away. The effect follows: the daughters are left without even a grave to visit, and Theseus must keep both his oath of secrecy and his promise to care for them.

7. How does "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" build on "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A causal link: the elders prayed for a gentle, tearless end, and the Messenger reports an end "without wailing or disease or pain," as if the prayer was answered.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: In Stasimon 4 the elders prayed that the stranger be sped "By a gentle, tearless doom" (line 1610). The Exodos answers: "without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away" (lines 1704–1705). The Chorus even asks, "By a god-sent, painless doom, poor soul?" (line 1632). The prayer seems answered, which makes the end feel like a blessing.

8. In "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the mysterious passing, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A motive behind words: Antigone claims to want only to see the grave, but her grief and her talk of going home show that she is looking for somewhere to belong; Theseus's refusal comes with care.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Antigone asks, "With our own eyes we fain would see / Our father's tomb" (lines 1807–1808). Her deeper motive shows in her other words: "How again to get us home / I know not" (lines 1789–1790). She is looking for something to hold on to now that her life of caring for him

is over. Theseus refuses the request, but he promises to "on all your needs attend" (line 1828), answering the deeper need.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (How can grief and love be present at the same time?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A revised answer to the bell-ringer (grief and love together), using Antigone's lament or the farewell, where love and loss are spoken in the same breath.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: I first said grief and love come one after the other. Antigone shows they can be the same feeling. She misses even the work of caring for him: "Ah me! that happy toil to miss, / The guidance of those dear blind feet" (lines 1744–1745). The toil was hard but happy because of love, and losing it hurts for the same reason.

10. Where does characterization appear in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)", and how does it connect the mysterious passing to the larger concern with guilt and intent? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Where characterization connects the passing to guilt and intent: the man who called himself polluted ends honoured and painlessly taken, and the daughters' lament names the curse they carry though they did nothing.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: The man who once called himself "Corrupt and tainted" (line 1193) goes to his end calmly, blessing his daughters and his host, and is taken "without wailing or disease or pain" (line 1704). That supports his plea that he was guilty in deed but not in intent. Antigone still weeps "the curse that lay / On him our sire" (lines 1714–1715), so the play shows its burden passing to children who intended nothing.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Open question: is the ending happy, sad, or both? Defend any position. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A defended position: both, with evidence for sorrow (the daughters' grief, the feud ahead) and for peace (a painless end, a protected city, care for the daughters), and a counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: both. The end of Oedipus is peaceful, "an end most marvellous" (line 1705), and the Chorus calls it "blessèd" (line 1764). But the daughters are left grieving and homeless, and Antigone goes back to Thebes to try to "Heal this mortal feud" (line 1823). Counter-line: a reader could call it mainly hopeful, since Theseus promises to look after them (lines 1826–1829). A strong answer distinguishes the end of Oedipus from what his daughters face.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A stand with two lines: the hidden grave makes him Athens' protector and love sums up his farewell, with a correction that "love" is not literally his last word (he later blesses them and sends them away).

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: mostly agree, with a correction. He does become a protector: "If thou keep'st my hest / Thou shalt hold thy realm at rest" (lines 1816–1817). His farewell does turn on "love" (line 1661). But it is not literally his last word to his daughters: he later tells them to "prove your true nobility" and leave (lines 1684–1685). The claim is true in spirit, not in detail.

3. Which character in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" acts most wisely in the matter of the mysterious passing, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named standard applied to two characters, for example keeping faith under grief: Theseus keeps his oath and his promise to the daughters, while Antigone's grief pushes her toward what is forbidden. With a line for each and care for her grief.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: by the standard of keeping faith, Theseus acts most wisely: he keeps the secret, "to Zeus I pledged my word" (line 1819), and keeps his promise to the daughters, "nor will I spare / Aught of toil and zealous care" (lines 1826–1827). Antigone's wish to see the grave (lines 1807–1808) goes against her father's command, though it comes from love and grief, not folly. She acts wisely in the end when she yields, "We must yield" (line 1821), and turns to healing her brothers' feud.

4. You are directing "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the mysterious passing. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Two staging choices tied to lines, such as the Messenger shielding his eyes as he describes Theseus, or Theseus kneeling to the daughters as he promises care, each with its effect.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: (1) On "Only the king we saw with upraised hand / Shading his eyes" (lines 1693–1694), have the Messenger raise his own hand and look away, so the audience feels the awe without seeing anything. (2) On "Go in peace; nor will I spare / Aught of toil and zealous care" (lines 1826–1827), have Theseus kneel and take both daughters' hands. The audience sees that the host's promise to their father continues in his care for them.

5. Write your own questions about "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** Three questions answerable from lines 1626–1831: one recall, one why/how and one should/what-if, different in kind.

   Answer guidance: Model set. Recall: What does Oedipus ask his daughters to fetch before the end? (Running water, to wash and make libation, lines 1644–1646.) Why/how: Why does Theseus shade his eyes? (He sees something "That no man might endure to look upon," line 1695.) Should/what if: Should Theseus let the daughters see the grave? (Answers weigh their grief, lines 1807–1808, against his oath, lines 1812–1819.)

6. Connect "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)", with its focus on the mysterious passing, to curse and mercy: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment about curse and mercy, the question's theme. The ending gives mercy to Oedipus and his daughters, but the curse on the brothers still stands; a strong answer says what remains unresolved.

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the link is strong and deliberately unfinished. Oedipus receives mercy, a painless end and a grave that protects his hosts (lines 1704–1705), and Theseus promises his daughters mercy (lines 1826–1829). But the curse is not lifted: Antigone goes to try to "stay / The self-wrought doom / That drives our brothers to their tomb" (lines 1823–1825). The play leaves the brothers' fate outside its ending, as if mercy could reach only so far.

7. Is the plot in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" effective in presenting the mysterious passing, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment against a stated criterion (is reporting the end better than showing it?), with a line that meets the criterion and one that might miss it.

Answer guidance: One defensible answer: effective, because reporting keeps the mystery. We hear only that "The man was gone, evanished from our eyes" (line 1692), which keeps the end holy and beyond sight. Counter-line: the long lament and back-and-forth that follow (lines 1711–1800) may feel drawn out to some readers. A strong review weighs whether that length honours the grief or slows the end.

8. Compare how "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" treats the mysterious passing with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A named comparison (another story whose hero's end is hidden or reported, or whose grave is unknown) and one thing the Exodos sees that the other misses, tied to a line.

   Answer guidance: Model answer: Compare the death of Moses at the end of Deuteronomy (34:6), where no one knows the place of his grave. Both endings hide the grave. The Exodos adds a human cost the other story does not dwell on: the daughters who cared for him are refused even a visit, "That may not be" (line 1809). The play sees that a sacred secret can protect a city and still hurt the people who loved the dead.

9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve guilt and intent? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** A judgment on guilt and intent, the question's theme: the ending supports Oedipus's claim that his guilt lay in deed, not intent, by giving him a gentle, god-sent end, but the curse still weighs on his family. Is that ending earned?

   Answer guidance: One defensible answer: the ending largely resolves guilt and intent for Oedipus himself. The man who said he acted "all unwitting" (line 265) is called by a god, "Oedipus, Oedipus, why tarry we?" (line 1671), and taken without pain (line 1704), which treats his innocence of intent as real. It is earned because the play argued the case from the Parodos onward. But it does not resolve everything: Antigone still names "the curse that lay / On him our sire" (lines 1714–1715), and the brothers' feud remains (lines 1822–1825).

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the mysterious passing? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1] **Look for:** An adaptation that keeps the core: a once-rejected elder dies peacefully in a place that took him in, his resting place is kept secret, and his host promises to care for his grieving family. It names two details that must stay.

    Answer guidance: Model answer: An old exile dies quietly in the town that took him in. Only the mayor knows where he is buried, because the old man asked for secrecy, and the mayor refuses even the daughters while promising to support them. Two things must stay: the hidden grave as a promise kept (lines 1812–1819), and the host's care for the daughters after the death (lines 1826–1829).

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who alone saw Oedipus' passing?

   A. Theseus

   B. Antigone

C. Ismene

D. The messenger

Key: A (Theseus)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What one word, Oedipus says, wipes out his daughters' burdens?

   A. Duty

   B. Love

   C. Honour

   D. Fate

   Key: B (Love)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "Wipes out all score of _____—love."

   Key: tribulations

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "The pact of Theseus and _____."

   Key: Peirithous

5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does the messenger describe the end?

   A. Violent and cruel in every part

   B. Unknown even to Theseus himself

   C. Without pain, most marvellous

   D. A death already suffered in open battle

   Key: C (Without pain, most marvellous)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Where does Antigone decide to go?

   A. On to Corinth

   B. Up to Delphi

   C. To remain in Athens forever

   D. Back to Thebes

   Key: D (Back to Thebes)

7. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does the reported last speech say the daughters must now lose, and what does it still claim they had from their father? Use the lines about ministry and about love from him, without repeating the fill-line on tribulations.

   Sample answer: He tells them that they will lose their sire today, that all of him has perished, and that their long ministry is over; he also says they had love from him, from no man more, and must now live without him. "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry;" (lines 1657–1659). "And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days." (lines 1662–1663). The speech holds both the end of their service and the love that, in his telling, wipes the score out. It is a farewell reported by the messenger.

8. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Messenger say the teller is content to be counted a fool?

   A. Because the tale of the end may seem foolishness to some

   B. Because he has already forgotten what Theseus asked him to say

   C. Because the daughters have already forbidden him to speak at all

   D. Because the chorus has already called the news a lie outright

Key: A (Because the tale of the end may seem foolishness to some)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does the chorus first take the messenger's tidings? Use their question about a god-sent, painless doom, and the messenger's reply that the question hits the marvel of the tale.

    Sample answer: They ask whether the unhappy man is gone, and then whether the doom was god-sent and painless. “What, has he gone, the unhappy man?” (line 1629). “How? By a god-sent, painless doom, poor soul?” (line 1632). The messenger says that the question hits the marvel of the tale, and that Oedipus has passed from life to death. “Thy question hits the marvel of the tale.” (line 1633). The first hearing of the news already frames the end as a wonder, and as god-sent rather than violent. The song that follows will keep that mystery.

10. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] How do love and loss sit together in Antigone's lines about pain turning to bliss, and about love that will not fail even in the tomb? Defend a reading from those lines.

    Sample answer: She says love can turn past pain to bliss, and what seemed bitter is now sweet; a little later she tells her father that even in the tomb he shall not lack her love and Ismene's. “Love can turn past pain to bliss, / What seemed bitter now is sweet.” (lines 1742–1743). “E’en in the tomb / Never shalt thou for lack of love repine, / Her love and mine.” (lines 1747–1749). The sweetness is not a claim that grief has vanished; it is love still addressing the father they have lost. Grief and love are present at once, and the lines should be read as mourning.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Theseus refuse the daughters?

    A. To show them the grave

    B. Food and a place of shelter

    C. His protection in the land

    D. A guard to see them home

    Key: A (To show them the grave)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say as the play closes?

    A. Leave the land before the sun has set

    B. Wail no more; all is ordered for the best

    C. Call the messenger back to tell the tale again

    D. Keep watch beside the hidden place all night

    Key: B (Wail no more; all is ordered for the best)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “The hair of all stood up and all were _____;”

    Key: ’mazed

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “That time and friendship prompt in their _____.”

    Key: behoof

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why must the others leave before the end, according to the reported charge?

    A. So that the daughters can already begin the long journey home alone now

    B. So that the messenger can hide the king from every later visitor here

    C. So that only Theseus stays to behold what may not lawfully be seen or heard

    D. So that the chorus can finish a rite already started at the altar there this hour

    Key: C (So that only Theseus stays to behold what may not lawfully be seen or heard)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Who calls Oedipus by name and says that his passing has been delayed too long?

    A. Theseus, already waiting at the basin to lead him down the path

    B. The messenger, already bidding the daughters to depart at once

    C. The chorus, already ending the prayer of the last ode here

    D. A voice that summoned him, speaking as the call of the god

    Key: D (A voice that summoned him, speaking as the call of the god)

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the messenger describe the summons that comes after the silence? Use the lines in which a voice calls Oedipus by name and speaks of a passing too long delayed.

    Sample answer: After mourning has ended and a silence has fallen, a voice summons him, and all are struck with dread. The call comes now loud, now low, and often. “Oedipus, Oedipus, why tarry we? / Too long, too long thy passing is delayed.” (lines 1671–1672). When he hears it, the messenger says, he has heard the summons of the god, and he asks that Theseus be brought. “But when he heard the summons of the god,” (line 1673). The voice is not a human command; it is a call he answers, still in the story, by sending for his friend.

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which convention is at work when the end is reported by a messenger, and only one living witness is said to know the doom?

    A. Offstage action reported by a messenger

    B. A comic close that jokes about the hidden doom

    C. A satire of the city's rites in this last scene

    D. Dramatic irony about who may know the doom

    Key: A (Offstage action reported by a messenger)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does Theseus keep the grave from being shown? Use the lines in which he tells the daughters of the charge, the hidden tomb, and the rest promised to his realm.

    Sample answer: He refuses their prayer to see their father's tomb because, he says, Oedipus charged him straitly that no mortal should approach the sacred portal or greet the hidden tomb with funeral litanies. “My children, he / Charged me straitly that no mortal / Should approach the sacred portal, / Or greet with funeral litanies / The hidden tomb wherein he lies;” (lines 1811–1815). He also reports the promise: if he keeps the hest, he shall hold his realm at rest, and he has pledged his word to Zeus. “If thou keep’st my hest / Thou shalt hold thy realm at rest.” (lines 1816–1817). The secrecy is a kept oath, and it is tied to the city's peace, not to a wish to hide the daughters from care; he will still attend to their needs.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Open question: is the ending happy, sad, or both? Defend any position from this scene.

    Sample answer: A fair defence can call it both. It is sad in the daughters' mourning, in the loss of the father they had served, and in Antigone's turn toward a feud still waiting at home. It is not only sad: the messenger tells of a god-sent, painless end that Theseus alone saw; Theseus keeps the charge and still promises care; and the chorus closes by bidding them wail no more, for all is ordered for the best. Happiness here is not cheerfulness, and sadness is not despair. The ending holds grief and a kind of peace together, and it should be read as the play's last word on a mysterious, god-sent passing.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Theseus swear, just before the end, when Oedipus asks him to take the daughters' hands?

    A. To be their constant friend, and not to forsake them

    B. To show them the hidden place as soon as he is gone now

    C. To send them at once against a neighbouring city today

D. To leave the grove before the messenger can speak at all

Key: A (To be their constant friend, and not to forsake them)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “That sight _____?”

Key: ineffable

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “His end was _____; therefore, children, stay”

Key: blessèd

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Near which marks does the messenger place the basin and the abrupt, earth-rooted threshold?

A. A new grave already hidden from every later visitor in the whole city

B. The Thorician rock, a hollow pear-tree, and a marble tomb along the path

C. The altar of Poseidon, where the last ode had called the king himself

D. A battlefield already named for the war of the two brothers now in the field

Key: B (The Thorician rock, a hollow pear-tree, and a marble tomb along the path)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Antigone first answer the chorus when they ask if Oedipus is then gone?

A. She has already seen the hidden place and can describe it in full now

B. The messenger has invented the whole tale only to frighten them here

C. All is but surmise; then gone, reft from sight, not by battle or sea storm

D. Theseus has already promised to show them the grave at once today for them

Key: C (All is but surmise; then gone, reft from sight, not by battle or sea storm)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the messenger describe the manner of the end, and how should those lines be taught? Use the sentences about a messenger from heaven or a painless cleaving, and about an end most marvellous.

Sample answer: He will not name a violent cause. There fell, he says, no fiery bolt, nor a whirlwind from the sea; the man was taken. Then he offers two images, and no more: a messenger from heaven, or a gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base. “It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth’s base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous.” (lines 1702–1705). The lines should be taught as a report of a mysterious, god-sent passing. Only Theseus is said to know the doom; the rest is wonder, and the mystery is meant to be kept.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Ismene give voice to her grief after the news, and how does the chorus answer her? Use her wish to share her father's fate, and the chorus's counsel to bear what heaven brings.

Sample answer: In grief, Ismene says she knows not where to roam, and she wishes that death might nip her breath and let her share her aged father's fate, because she cannot live a life thus desolate. “I know not. O that Death / Might nip my breath, / And let me share my aged father’s fate. / I cannot live a life thus desolate.” (lines 1734–1737). The chorus does not praise that wish. They call the daughters a worthy pair and tell them that what heaven brings they must bear, and not to fret against Heaven's will; fate, they say, has not dealt with them ill. “Best of daughters, worthy pair, / What heaven brings ye needs must bear, / Fret no more ’gainst Heaven’s will; / Fate hath dealt with you not ill.” (lines 1738–1741). The play answers the cry of grief with comfort and a charge to bear the life still left.

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which literary element names the feeling of the close, when the chorus bids the mourners wail no more and says that all is ordered for the best?

A. Comedy

B. Satire

C. Plot

D. Tone

Key: D (Tone)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Theseus's last promise of care complete, or fall short of, the friendship he swore? Use his closing offer of toil and care, and stay with what this scene itself shows.

    Sample answer: After the daughters yield and turn toward home, he tells them to go in peace, and he will not spare toil and zealous care, but will attend to all their needs, gladdening in the grave his friend. “Go in peace; nor will I spare / Aught of toil and zealous care, / But on all your needs attend, / Gladdening in his grave my friend.” (lines 1826–1829). That is the friendship of a keeper and a host, offered after he has already refused to show the tomb. It does not cancel their grief, and it does not undo the charge of silence. It does show that the oath of care is still being kept, in the only form this scene allows, as they leave under his protection.

30. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone hope to do by going back to Thebes, and what does that hope not yet settle? Use her lines about the brothers and their doom.

    Sample answer: Once she has yielded about the tomb, she asks to go back to Thebes, if yet they may, to heal a mortal feud and stay the self-wrought doom that drives their brothers to their tomb. “Well, if he would have it so, / We must yield. Then let us go / Back to Thebes, if yet we may / Heal this mortal feud and stay / The self-wrought doom / That drives our brothers to their tomb.” (lines 1820–1825). The hope is to stop a doom still ahead; the play does not show the brothers already slain, and it does not tell us whether she will succeed. Thebes here is a next task named in grief, not a report of a later play's end. Theseus then bids them go in peace, and promises his care.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “It thundered from the _____; the maids”

    Key: netherworld

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Of _____ tells they come this way.”

    Key: lamentation

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the charge about the hidden tomb, as Theseus reports it, serve the city?

    A. If he keeps the hest, he shall hold his realm at rest, a promise pledged to Zeus

    B. If he shows the place, the daughters will already have won the war at home now

    C. If he hides the messenger, no later visitor will ever learn the whole tale

    D. If he leaves the grove, the chorus will already have ended every remaining rite today

    Key: A (If he keeps the hest, he shall hold his realm at rest, a promise pledged to Zeus)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How should we read Antigone's cry “Lead me thither; slay me there”, together with what follows in the scene?

    A. As a legal demand that Theseus must lead her to the hidden place at once

    B. As a cry of grief, which the chorus answers with refuge

    C. As a report that she has already been killed beside the hidden place itself

    D. As a comic aside, which the chorus treats as a joke about the whole journey home

    Key: B (As a cry of grief, which the chorus answers with refuge)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the force of Antigone's saying that the sight was ineffable, and that all is but surmise?

    A. She claims she has already stood inside the hidden place and can describe it fully now

    B. She accuses the messenger of having invented every part of the tale himself

    C. She marks the end as something witnessed only in part, which words cannot finish telling

    D. She asks Theseus to repeat the unspeakable sights for the chorus at once here today

    Key: C (She marks the end as something witnessed only in part, which words cannot finish telling)

36. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which reading best holds together the painless end, the hidden tomb, and the chorus's last word?

    A. A battlefield death, already shown on stage, after which Athens refuses the daughters any care at all now

    B. A comic close that treats the daughters' grief as a passing joke about the sacred grove

    C. A claim that the messenger has already opened the hidden tomb to the whole city

    D. A god-sent end, kept in trust by Theseus, after which the civic voice bids the mourners rest

    Key: D (A god-sent end, kept in trust by Theseus, after which the civic voice bids the mourners rest)

37. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is remarkable about the way Oedipus moves toward the place of his end, as the messenger first reminds the chorus? Use the lines about his going without a friend to lead the way.

    Sample answer: The messenger says they saw him move hence, and they must know how: without a friend to lead the way, he himself was guiding them all. “How he moved hence, you saw him and must know; / Without a friend to lead the way, himself / Guiding us all.” (lines 1634–1636). The blind man leads the seeing, even at the last, to the abrupt earth-rooted threshold. The detail is not a claim that he has recovered ordinary sight. It shows that the summons still gives him a path, and that the others follow until the moment when only Theseus may stay.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Oedipus bind Theseus to the daughters just before he sends them away? Use the reported request for a pledge and a promise not to forsake them, without quoting the fill-line on behoof.

    Sample answer: He prays that Theseus be brought, and when the prince comes nearer he asks for a joined pledge: Theseus is to give his right hand, the daughters theirs, and Theseus is to promise never to forsake them, but to do all that time and friendship prompt. “Pledge ye my daughters, giving thy right hand— / And, daughters, give him yours—and promise me / Thou never wilt forsake them, but do all” (lines 1676–1678). The messenger adds that Theseus repressed his tears and swore to be their constant friend. The pledge is a charge of care for the living, given at the edge of the end, and it is not a request that anyone share his death.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does this ending show the cursed man becoming a protector of the city? Defend a reading from Theseus's kept charge and from the rest promised to the realm, without turning the hidden tomb into a puzzle to be solved on stage.

    Sample answer: Yes, in the form this play allows. Theseus reports that if he keeps the hest he shall hold his realm at rest, and he has pledged his word to Zeus; he then refuses to show the tomb and still promises the daughters his care. The protection is not a visible monument and not a public funeral. It is a secret kept by the king, offered as a defence of the land, after a painless passing that only he has seen. A careful reading can also note the limit: the daughters do not see the place, and they turn toward another city's feud. The protector's gift is the oath and the rest it is said to secure, not a grave the audience is invited to find.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How should a class read the daughters' sharpest grief-wishes together with the answers they receive? Use Ismene's word that he died tombless, Antigone's cry to be led there, and the chorus's offer of refuge.

    Sample answer: Ismene says he died tombless, with none near; Antigone answers by asking to be led to that place and slain there (lines 1777–1778). Ismene then asks how she herself can drag on a friendless, helpless life. The chorus tells the maids not to fear, and says that refuge has been found, where they shall be safe from harm. “Fear not, maids—” (line 1782). “Refuge hath been found.” (line 1784). “Where thou shalt be safe from harm.” (line 1786). Theseus later dries their tears and promises his care.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Exodos (lines 1626–1831) develops the idea of the mysterious passing. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Exodos (lines 1626–1831)” could deliver about the mysterious passing. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the mysterious passing in “Exodos (lines 1626–1831)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Exodos (lines 1626–1831) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of the mysterious passing. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Exodos (lines 1626–1831)” could deliver about the mysterious passing. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the mysterious passing in “Exodos (lines 1626–1831)”: each member takes one

passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Exodos (lines 1626–1831) suggests about the mysterious passing. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's plot and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" could deliver about the mysterious passing. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the mysterious passing in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses plot in Exodos (lines 1626–1831) to complicate the reader's understanding of the mysterious passing. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" could deliver about the mysterious passing. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the mysterious passing in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to refuge and hospitality and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *But by what doom the stranger met his end No man save Theseus knoweth. For there fell No fiery bolt that reft him in that hour, Nor whirlwind from the sea, but he was taken. It was a messenger from heaven, or else Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; For without wailing or disease or pain He passed away—an end most marvellous.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "marvellous" most nearly mean?

   A. ordinary and easy to explain
   B. caused by a battle or a sea storm
   C. astonishing, beyond the usual course of things
   D. still unfinished at the time of speech

2. *This promise given, Oedipus put forth Blind hands and laid them on his children, saying, "O children, prove your true nobility And hence depart nor seek to witness sights Unlawful or to hear unlawful words. Nay, go with speed; let none but Theseus stay, Our ruler, to behold what next shall hap." So we all heard him speak, and weeping sore We companied the maidens on their way. After brief space we looked again, and lo The man was gone, evanished from our eyes; Only the king we saw with upraised hand Shading his eyes as from some awful sight, That no man might endure to look upon. A moment later, and we saw him bend In prayer to Earth and prayer to Heaven at once. But by what doom the stranger met his end No man save Theseus knoweth. For there fell No fiery bolt that reft him in that hour, Nor whirlwind from the sea, but he was taken. It was a messenger from heaven, or else Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; For without wailing or disease or pain He passed away—an end most marvellous.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)"?

   A. The Colonus ode
   B. The summons
   C. The mysterious passing
   D. The elders' prayer for his peace

SAT key: 1. C (astonishing, beyond the usual course of things); 2. C (The mysterious passing)

Unit test

Oedipus at Colonus: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Antigone's line: “Within a feathered flock of _____”
   Key: nightingales
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Antigone still see of the city as they arrive?
   A. The towers that fence it, which she thinks are still far off
   B. The market already crowded with Theseus and his waiting council today
   C. A closed gate that has already shut them out of Athens
   D. A harbour already waiting with a ship for Thebes

   Key: A (The towers that fence it, which she thinks are still far off)
3. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Antigone tell her father to rest on the native seat of rock?
   A. She has already asked Theseus to meet them at that rocky seat today
   B. An old man, she says, has travelled far and should sit down there
   C. She wants him to hide before the stranger can see him at all
   D. She thinks the rock is already a tomb prepared for him here

   Key: B (An old man, she says, has travelled far and should sit down there)
4. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Antigone first describe the spot before anyone names a god? Use her lines about the plants and the birds.
   Sample answer: She judges the place holy from what she can see, and she names a wilderness of laurel, olive, and vine, with nightingales warbling among them. “But where we stand is surely holy ground; / A wilderness of laurel, olive, vine; / Within a feathered flock of nightingales / Are warbling.” (lines 16–19). The opening picture is of a sacred, living grove, offered as a place to rest, before any stranger has spoken a god's name.
5. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How do Oedipus's first lines present what he is willing to accept, and why does that wording matter here? Use his claim about the little he craves.
   Sample answer: He asks who will provide for this wanderer, and he says it is little that he craves, and less that he obtains, and that even that less is enough. “’Tis little that he craves, / And less obtains—that less enough for me;” (lines 4–5). The wording presents a man schooled to endure, not a claimant demanding a palace; it prepares the request for a seat and a hearing, not for power already in his hand.

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the chorus's line: “Thy _____ on earth.”

   Key: pilgrimage

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What warning does the chorus first give about the silent grassy glade?

   A. They invite him to sit down at once and drink the offerings found there

   B. They tell Antigone to lead him into the glade and hide him there

   C. They warn him not to trespass, lest he find that glade of offerings

   D. They say Theseus has already blessed the glade for his long rest

   Key: C (They warn him not to trespass, lest he find that glade of offerings)

8. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] When Oedipus asks whether he may sit down, what do the elders tell him to do?

   A. Stand up at once and walk straight into the city's marketplace

   B. Leave the ledge and return by night along the public road

   C. Kneel at the altar and pour a wine-cup for the goddesses now

   D. Move sideways toward the ledge and sit crouching on the scarped edge

   Key: D (Move sideways toward the ledge and sit crouching on the scarped edge)

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Oedipus first answer the hunt-like entrance of the elders? Use his claim that he is no outlaw, and the line about not being a favourite of fate.

   Sample answer: Before they know his name, he tells them he is no outlaw under ban, and he adds that he is no favourite of fate. “Oh sirs, I am no outlaw under ban.” (line 137). “No favourite of fate,” (line 139). The lines try to separate a legal ban from the suffering already visible: he asks not to be treated as a man already condemned, even as he admits that fate has not favoured him.

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: “Athens’ fair _____ by abetting wrong.”

    Key: scutcheon

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to Oedipus, what does the eye of Heaven behold?

    A. The just of men, and the unjust; no godless sinner has found escape

    B. Only kings, and no wanderer who has come as a guest to this grove yet

    C. Only Thebes, and not the land that has received him as a suppliant here

    D. Only later signs, already fulfilled before the king can speak at all

    Key: A (The just of men, and the unjust; no godless sinner has found escape)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Oedipus ask when Ismene has reported the new word about him?

    A. Whether Theseus has already marched against Thebes this hour

    B. Whether Phoebus has spoken thus concerning him

    C. Whether Creon has already been named king of Athens now

    D. Whether the daughters have already been sent home alone

    Key: B (Whether Phoebus has spoken thus concerning him)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Theseus say he will not spurn, and what rights does he grant? Use the two lines that state the grant.

    Sample answer: He says he will never spurn the favours of this visitor, and he grants him the full rights of citizen. “His

favours therefore never will I spurn, / But grant him the full rights of citizen;" (lines 660–661). The welcome is civic and present: it is not a later secret, and it is not a command that Oedipus leave the grove. It answers, in this episode, the need Ismene's news has just made plain.

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "And their wave hath a _____ gleam."
Key: crystal

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What, according to the ode, feeds the narcissi each morn?
A. A sudden fire already lit upon the hill
B. A tribute sent from a neighbouring king
C. The pearly dew from heaven each day
D. A wine-cup poured beside the public road
Key: C (The pearly dew from heaven each day)

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does the ode picture the fountains that feed Cephisus? Use the line about their never ceasing, without repeating a fill-word from the scene quiz.
Sample answer: The fountains are sleepless, and they never cease to feed the stream. "And never the sleepless fountains cease / That feed Cephisus' stream," (lines 713–714). The image is of a land kept fertile without pause; the ode offers that abundance as part of what makes this soil goodliest, not as a later political bargain, and not as a claim that the visitor has already been crowned.

17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] How does calling this a steed-famed land for rest, and a land of all lands the goodliest, recast the worn stranger? Use the opening address.
Sample answer: The ode addresses a stranger worn with toil, and it tells him he has come to a steed-famed land for rest, a land of all lands the goodliest. "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest" (lines 695–697). Weariness is met with praise of the place; the visitor is received as one who has arrived at a proud rest, not as a trespasser still being hunted. The song does not yet tell a later rescue or a later passing.

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "This country's _____ has no touch of age."
Key: vigour

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Creon first pray Oedipus to do, by their fathers' gods?
A. March at once and burn the groves around Athens now
B. Crown Theseus already as the new king of Thebes today
C. Hide both daughters in a ship already waiting at the shore
D. Consent, and come back to Thebes, to his father's home
Key: D (Consent, and come back to Thebes, to his father's home)

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Creon reveal he has already done, while he is still speaking on stage?
A. One of the daughters, he says, is already seized
B. Theseus, he says, has already agreed to send them home
C. The chorus, he says, has already voted to expel the king
D. Polyneices, he says, has already taken the Theban throne
Key: A (One of the daughters, he says, is already seized)

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] How does Antigone first appeal to Athens at Creon's approach? Use her lines about a land extolled and about making titles good.
Sample answer: She calls on a land extolled above all lands, and she says it is now for Athens to make these glorious titles

good. “O land extolled above all lands, ’tis now / For thee to make these glorious titles good.” (lines 740–741). The praise becomes a test: the city is asked to live up to the name the ode has just given it, at the moment a Theban force arrives. The lines belong to this episode's opening, not to a later report of the end.

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: “Him whose wide floods _____”

    Key: enring

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does this ode first picture the enemy it hopes will be caught?

    A. As a guest already seated safely beside the altar of the grove

    B. As a flying foe, with a loud battle roar imagined in the song

    C. As a king already crowned in Athens before the chase begins

    D. As a messenger already sent to publish peace with Thebes

    Key: B (As a flying foe, with a loud battle roar imagined in the song)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does the chorus hope Theseus and his men may do on swiftest steed?

    A. Abandon the grove and leave the daughters still in bonds

    B. Join Creon and send the stranger back by force this hour

    C. Meet with the robber band and see them vanquished

    D. Seal a new treaty already written in the marketplace

    Key: C (Meet with the robber band and see them vanquished)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] What does the last line of the ode announce, and how does that close the imagined chase? Use the line about an escort.

    Sample answer: The song has been imagining the chase; the last line turns from vision to what is now seen: an escort with the maids draws near. “For lo, an escort with the maids draws near.” (line 1152). The prayer for victory is answered, in the ode's own close, by the daughters' return under escort. The close should be taught as this song's turn from hope to arrival, not as a later scene already fully narrated.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: “And _____ and lips that cannot lie.”

    Key: righteousness

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus say he never hoped for more, when the daughters have come back?

    A. A new crown already waiting in the marketplace

    B. A signed treaty already sealed with Creon today

    C. A hidden path already opened through the sacred grove

    D. A child's embrace, long hoped for in his exile

    Key: D (A child's embrace, long hoped for in his exile)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Antigone first name Theseus, when she begins the tale of their recovery?

    A. As their saviour, whose tale her father should hear

    B. As their accuser, already ready to send them home

    C. As their captor, already joined with Creon's men

    D. As their judge, already eager to unsay his first welcome

Key: A (As their saviour, whose tale her father should hear)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does Oedipus say he has found, above all, among Theseus's people? Use the lines about righteousness and about lips that cannot lie.
Sample answer: He says he has found, above all peoples, most with them, and righteousness, and lips that cannot lie. “I found above all peoples most with you, / And righteousness and lips that cannot lie.” (lines 1185–1186). The praise is a guest's thanks after the rescue: he names truth-telling as the city's distinction. The lines belong to this reunion, not to a later passing already told.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: “Scant pleasures, heavier _____,”
Key: pains

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Whom does the ode finally compare to a headland on an iron-bound shore?
A. Creon, already safe inside a Theban wall this hour
B. The guest, who has known such ills, not the chorus alone
C. Theseus, already fallen in the chase the last ode imagined
D. Polyneices, already crowned in his father's house today
Key: B (The guest, who has known such ills, not the chorus alone)

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] How does the ode first judge the man who craves excess of days? Use the lines about a giddy wight and folly's ways.
Sample answer: It judges that man as a giddy wight who walks in folly's ways, because he scorns the common span of life. “Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span / Of life, I judge that man / A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways.” (lines 1270–1273). The judgment is about greedy prolonging. The song should be taught as a warning against scorning a common span, spoken over a guest who has already suffered long.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] How should a class hold the ode's dark sayings together with its last image of the guest?
Sample answer: The song speaks of a grievous load, of pains that outlast pleasures, and of a last unregarded age; then it says such ills are not the chorus's alone, for the guest has known them too, like a headland lashed by every wind. “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known,” (lines 1298–1299). The close turns a general meditation toward pity for this one man. It should be read as recognition of a long-buffeted life.

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: “This sullen, _____ silence try to move.”
Key: obstinate

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Antigone first announce the newcomer to her father?
A. She thinks she sees Creon already returned with a new escort
B. She thinks she sees Theseus already ready to join the seven spears
C. She thinks she sees the stranger coming, alone and weeping plenteous tears
D. She thinks she sees the chorus already ending the last ode of the play
Key: C (She thinks she sees the stranger coming, alone and weeping plenteous tears)

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Polyneices first ask when his father will not answer him?
A. Why Theseus has already refused to hear a word of the war
B. Why the daughters have already left the grove without him
C. Why the seven captains have already turned back toward Argos

D. Why he is silent, and whether he will dismiss him in mute disdain

Key: D (Why he is silent, and whether he will dismiss him in mute disdain)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Antigone beg her brother to do before he leaves? Use her line about turning the host back to Argos.

Sample answer: She begs him to turn the host back to Argos with all speed, and not to ruin himself and Thebes as well. "Turn back thy host to Argos with all speed," (line 1466). The plea is a last attempt to stop the war after the curse has been spoken; it is not a report that the brothers have already fallen. He will not be stayed.

38. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the chorus cry at the opening of this scene, before the peal is fully read?

A. Ills on ills, with no pause or rest

B. Victory already won against a neighbouring army

C. A welcome already spoken for Creon and his men

D. A hymn already finished at the altar of the grove

Key: A (Ills on ills, with no pause or rest)

39. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does Oedipus say has come, after the signs, and what does he deny remains? Use the line about no turning.

Sample answer: He tells the daughters that what was appointed has come, and that there is no turning from it any more. "Has come; no turning from it any more." (line 1526). The line is a settled reading of the signs, not a later report of how the end will be told. It should be taught as an acceptance of a summons already signalled in this scene.

40. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.9] Whom does Oedipus name as leading him, together with the empress of the dead, when he takes the way? Use those two lines.

Sample answer: Oedipus names Hermes, the spirit guide, and Persephassa, empress of the dead, as those who lead the way. "For this way Hermes leads, the spirit guide, / And Persephassa, empress of the dead." (lines 1597–1598). The guidance is divine and named, not a recovery of ordinary sight. The lines explain why he can go without a human leading hand.

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] As Oedipus sets out, what work do his closing blessings on friend, land, and followers do, and what do they leave unsettled?

Sample answer: He blesses his dearest friend, the land, and its followers, and he asks that they still think of him, when he is dead, for their welfare. "Blessing on thee, dearest friend, / On thee and on thy land and followers!" (lines 1602–1603). The speech is a blessing and a civic charge, spoken as he goes; it does not tell us that the end has already been accomplished, or by what later means it will be told, and it should not be read as a wish to make death a goal.

42. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "By a gentle, _____ doom"

Key: tearless

43. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Queen infernal is asked together with what other guardian at the gates?

A. A new herald already sent from Creon's camp

B. The fell watch-dog of the gates of hell

C. A hidden guide already named by Theseus here

D. A crowned priest already serving in the city

Key: B (The fell watch-dog of the gates of hell)

44. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] How does the ode begin, before any underworld name is spoken? Use the opening condition, and say what that beginning does.

Sample answer: It opens with a humble if: mortal prayers may or may not be heard in hell. “If mortal prayers are heard in hell,” (line 1606). Only after that condition do the elders call on a dread, unseen goddess and a named monarch. The start frames everything that follows as a request, not as a command, and not as a report that the end has already come.

45. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] How do the elders now judge the stranger's past life, and what blessing do they ask to follow that judgment? Use the couplet that sets those two claims side by side.
Sample answer: They name his life as oppression, judge that oppression wrongful, and then ask that Justice bless him now. “Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed.” (lines 1614–1615). The adverb is a present verdict in the song: whatever the past deeds, these speakers now call his suffering undeserved and ask a blessing in its place. The couplet does not retry an old case; it marks a change of judgment.

46. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the messenger's opening: “Friends, countrymen, my _____ are in sum”
Key: tidings

47. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Once the messenger has said that Oedipus has passed from life to death, what manner of end does the chorus first propose?
A. Whether it was a battle already fought beside the grove this hour
B. Whether it was a hidden crime already planned by Creon's men
C. Whether it was a god-sent, painless doom
D. Whether it was a sudden flight already made toward Thebes
Key: C (Whether it was a god-sent, painless doom)

48. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What, according to the messenger, has the chorus's question struck?
A. A fault already found in Theseus's keeping of the charge
B. A plan already made to show the daughters the place at once
C. A war already begun between Argos and Athens this day
D. The marvel of the tale
Key: D (The marvel of the tale)

49. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In the reported farewell, what heavy service does Oedipus say the daughters will no longer have to bear? Use the lines about ministry.
Sample answer: He tells them that all of him has perished, and that they will no more have to bear their long ministry. “For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry;” (lines 1658–1659). The speech releases them from a heavy service they have already given, and it is reported as a farewell. The love he still claims sits beside that release, later in the same speech.

50. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does Antigone still promise her father, even after she has named the nether gloom of the tomb? Use the couplet about love that will not leave him lacking.
Sample answer: She addresses him as a dear father wrapt for aye in nether gloom, and then she promises that, even in the tomb, he shall not lack for love, hers and Ismene's. “Dear father, wrapt for aye in nether gloom, / E'en in the tomb / Never shalt thou for lack of love repine, / Her love and mine.” (lines 1746–1749). The promise is mourning that still attends him; it is not a claim that grief has vanished.

51. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Antigone's line: “Sure there are _____; but no need”
Key: habitations

52. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Antigone recognise, and what does she say she does not yet know?

    A. She recognises Athens, but not the particular spot where they stand

    B. She recognises Thebes, but not the road that leads them onward

    C. She recognises Theseus, but not the stranger now walking toward them

    D. She recognises Colonus by name, but not the city it belongs to

    Key: A (She recognises Athens, but not the particular spot where they stand)

53. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Antigone correct Oedipus when he asks if someone is moving toward them?

    A. She says the man is still far off, and that they must wait in total silence

    B. She says the man is already here, and that they should ask him straight

    C. She says the man is Creon, already come to take them home at once

    D. She says the man is Theseus, already ready to grant them a house

    Key: B (She says the man is already here, and that they should ask him straight)

54. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the stranger mean by calling the spot inviolable and untrod, and who does the stranger say abides there? Use his first answer to the question of the site.

    Sample answer: Asked to what god the site is dedicate, he answers that the ground is inviolable and untrod, and that dread goddesses, a brood of Earth and Darkness, abide here. “Inviolable, untrod; goddesses, / Dread brood of Earth and Darkness, here abide.” (lines 39–40). The place is defined first as a forbidden seat of those powers, not as an ordinary roadside rest, which is why he has already told the visitor to quit the seat.

55. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How should we read Oedipus's request that someone be sent to summon the over-lord? Use his exchange about a slight service, without treating the later meeting as already accomplished.

    Sample answer: Once he hears that Theseus, son of Aegeus, is over-lord, he asks whether one might be sent to summon him. The stranger asks why; Oedipus answers that a slight service may avail the king much. “Might one be sent from you to summon him?” (line 70). “Say a slight service may avail him much.” (line 72). The request is a claim that the wanderer still has something to give, made before any king has arrived, and it should be read as an opening offer, not as a report of a later welcome.

56. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the chorus's warning: “I warn thee, trespass not / Within this _____ spot,”

    Key: hallowed

57. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the chorus tell Antigone she can do after they have begun to deal with her father?

    A. Leave him, because they have already sent for Theseus now

    B. Hide him, because Creon is already waiting on the public road

    C. Lead him, because she can guide him where they will

    D. Crown him, because they have already named him king of the grove

    Key: C (Lead him, because she can guide him where they will)

58. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What condition does the chorus set if Oedipus would beseech them?

    A. He may speak only after Theseus has already taken him into the city

B. He may speak only if Antigone first leaves the grove at once

C. He may speak only after he has already named himself to the whole land

D. He may speak where it is right; till then he must refrain from speech

Key: D (He may speak where it is right; till then he must refrain from speech)

59. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the force of Oedipus's plea that, "Safe within the paths of right", counsel may be freely exchanged? Use the three lines that close that thought.

Sample answer: He asks to be kept within the paths of right, where counsel may be freely exchanged, and not to have to fight with fate and fortune. "Safe within the paths of right; / Counsel freely may exchange / Nor with fate and fortune fight." (lines 180–182). The wording treats lawful speech as a shelter: if they will hear him in the right path, he will not have to contend with fortune as an enemy in that moment. The elders' next word is a halt at the rocky floor.

60. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Once Theseus has welcomed Oedipus, what choice does he leave to him?

A. To remain in the chorus's charge, or to come with Theseus

B. To return to Thebes at once with Creon's waiting men

C. To hide in the grove until night without a word

D. To send the daughters back before the king will hear him

Key: A (To remain in the chorus's charge, or to come with Theseus)

61. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus say he shall do here, in the line about those who cast him forth?

A. Here shall he march at once and burn a neighbouring city

B. Here shall he vanquish those who cast him forth

C. Here shall he hide the daughters from Theseus himself

D. Here shall he ask the chorus to unsay their welcome now

Key: B (Here shall he vanquish those who cast him forth)

62. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Theseus first ground his welcome in a shared past? Use his lines about being reared in exile.

Sample answer: He says he would recoil from no such request, because he too was reared, like Oedipus, in exile and in foreign lands. "I too was reared, / Like thee, in exile, and in foreign lands" (lines 583–584). The comparison is the ground of welcome: not pity alone, and not a legal trick, but a remembered exile that lets him recognise the man before him. The grant of protection follows from that recognition in this episode.

63. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse "If Zeus be Zeus and Phoebus still speak true". What condition does Oedipus set on the worth he promises?

Sample answer: He makes the promised worth depend on the gods still being true: if Zeus is Zeus and Phoebus still speaks true. "If Zeus be Zeus and Phoebus still speak true." (line 644). A few lines later he adds that this will hold except the gods themselves shall play him false. "Except the gods themselves shall play me false." (line 650). The gift he offers Athens is therefore a religious confidence, not a private boast he can enforce alone, and not a later report already accomplished.

64. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the ode say the Muses' quire will never do?

A. Abandon the city already to a neighbouring army

B. Refuse the stranger a seat already promised by Theseus

C. Disdain to visit this heaven-favoured plain

D. Silence the nightingales already gone from the grove

Key: C (Disdain to visit this heaven-favoured plain)

65. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “Self-nurtured year by year” add to the olive's picture, if the tree is also unpruned and untamed?

Sample answer: The tree grows unpruned and untamed, and it is self-nurtured year by year, so the ode presents it as living from this soil itself, not as an imported or forced plant. “Self-nurtured year by year;” (line 724). Together with the claim that it is unnamed in Asian soil and unclaimed by Pelops' isle, the wording makes the olive a native, enduring growth of the fatherland, not a decoration added for this scene alone.

66. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the ode give the olive a defender? Use the line about the Grey-eyed Goddess.

Sample answer: After saying that neither youth nor withering age destroys the tree, the chorus adds that the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends it. “And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends.” (line 728). The plant is not only hardy; it is under Athena's own care. The defence is religious and civic in the song, not a later battle already shown, and it belongs to the ode's praise of a land that can keep what it has grown.

67. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How do the closing gifts of the iron bit and the oar complete the ode's boast of the fatherland? Stay with what this song itself names.

Sample answer: The close boasts of gifts prized by the fatherland: the iron bit for the mouth of horses, and the oar-blade, as they dance along the brine. “For the mouth of horses the iron bit;” (line 735). The land is praised not only for flowers and a sacred tree, but for horsemanship and seafaring. The boast is a song of what this soil teaches and defends, offered to a worn stranger as the character of the place that has received him, not as a later campaign already fought.

68. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Oedipus first answer Creon's smooth appeal?

A. He thanks him, and he asks to leave for Thebes at once this hour
B. He asks the chorus to crown Creon already as a guest-friend here
C. He says Theseus has already promised to send the army with him
D. He calls it a front of brass, whose subtle tongue would twist every plea

Key: D (He calls it a front of brass, whose subtle tongue would twist every plea)

69. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the chorus say must happen if the robbers are not to get the daughters home?

A. Their sovereign may need to intervene
B. The daughters must already be sent back to Thebes alone
C. Oedipus must already agree to Creon's terms without a word
D. The grove itself must already be abandoned before nightfall

Key: A (Their sovereign may need to intervene)

70. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Creon claim about weakness and might, and how is that claim used in this scene?

Sample answer: He says that with a just quarrel, weakness conquers might. “With a just quarrel weakness conquers might.” (line 920). The line is a self-justifying proverb: he presents force as weakness in a just cause, even as he has already seized a daughter and is trying to take the other. The scene lets us hear the claim and see the act together, so the proverb can be judged against the violence it excuses.

71. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Theseus define the standard Creon has broken? Use the lines about a state that champions right and asks a warranty of law.

Sample answer: Theseus tells him that, having come unto a state that champions right, he should have asked, for every action, a warranty of law. “Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law,” (lines 957–958).

The standard is civic: force in Athens must answer to law, even when a foreign kinsman claims a just quarrel. The rebuke belongs to this episode and does not yet narrate a later war at Thebes.

72. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Whom do the knights adore as their patron, in the ode's listing of the land's powers?

    A. King Creon

    B. Pallas

    C. Prince Polyneices

    D. Lord Aegisthus

    Key: B (Pallas)

73. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What work does the chorus assign to Zeus in this song? Use the couplet about today and about victory.

    Sample answer: They say that today, today, Zeus worketh some great thing, and that this day shall victory bring. “Today, today Zeus worketh some great thing / This day shall victory bring.” (lines 1132–1133). The hope is present and divine: the day's work is imagined as Zeus's, and as a victory still being asked for, until the escort is seen. It is not a later campaign already fought in another land.

74. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the ode imagine Theseus's men in the chase? Use the lines about a chieftain's men and about each bridle.

    Sample answer: They picture Theseus's chieftain's men, with each bridle flashing and each gallant knight charging. “Theseus our chieftain's men.” (line 1118). “Flashes each bridle bright,” (line 1119). The image is bright and swift, a civic force in motion, offered as a hope the song can almost see. It remains a choral vision until the last line announces the escort.

75. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does this ode turn fear of the seizure into a prayer for recovery? Use the opening cry to the flying foe and the close about the escort.

    Sample answer: It opens by imagining the flying foe and the battle roar, and it prays the gods to cherish rites and to help the chase; it closes when an escort with the maids draws near. “O when the flying foe,” (line 1092). “For lo, an escort with the maids draws near.” (line 1152). The movement is from alarm to arrival. The song does not linger on the violence as a spectacle; it asks for a rescue and then sees the daughters brought back.

76. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Theseus say a wise man heeds?

    A. Only wars already declared against a neighbouring city

    B. Only rites already finished at the altar of the grove

    C. All matters, great or small

    D. Only threats already forgotten once the daughters have returned

    Key: C (All matters, great or small)

77. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why is Oedipus loth to hear the new suppliant? Use his lines about a voice that grates, and about not being forced to yield.

    Sample answer: Theseus asks why he is so loth to hear the man; Oedipus answers that the voice grates on a father's ears, that he has come to loathe it, and that he should not be forced to yield. “That voice, O king, grates on a father's ears; / I have come to loathe it. Force me not to yield.” (lines 1236–1237). The reluctance is personal and already sure of the speaker, before the son is officially received; it prepares the later hearing without yet speaking the curse.

78. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What warning does Theseus add, once he has said the suppliant has found asylum? Use the line about reverence to the god.

    Sample answer: He says the man has found asylum, and he warns Oedipus not to fail in due reverence to the god. “But he hath found asylum. O beware, / And fail not in due reverence to the god.” (lines 1238–1239). The warning makes the

hearing a religious duty as well as a favour: the suppliant is under a god's protection, so refusal is not only a family matter. The line belongs to this episode's pressure to admit the son, not to a later curse already spoken.

79. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Antigone argue that just suitors should not need to be importunate? Use her closing appeal to yield.

Sample answer: She asks her father to yield, because just suitors should not need to be importunate, and because the one who takes a favour should not lack the grace to make return. “O yield to us; just suitors should not need / To be importunate, nor he that takes / A favour lack the grace to make return.” (lines 1260–1262). The argument binds the hearing to courtesy and to return of grace, after she has already asked him to heed her though she is young. It wins a grudging consent, not a blessing on the war.

80. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What, according to the ode, do long years heap up?

A. A new crown already waiting for the guest in Athens today

B. A secret already published to every later visitor

C. A victory already won against a neighbouring army

D. A grievous load, with scant pleasures and heavier pains

Key: D (A grievous load, with scant pleasures and heavier pains)

81. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the ode say remains for the one who lingers on life's weary road? Use the lines about joy and about the road.

Sample answer: It says the long years heap up a grievous load, scant pleasures and heavier pains, till not one joy remains for him who lingers on life's weary road. “Till not one joy remains / For him who lingers on life’s weary road” (lines 1276–1277). The picture is of joy worn out by lingering. Taught in this episode's wake, it names what a long life can cost, especially for a guest the next stanza will compare to a beaten headland.

82. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the ode move from youth's passing to a list of public ills? Use the lines about troubles, and about envy and war.

Sample answer: When youth passes, troubles follow on troubles, toils on toils, and pain for ever pain; then the tale of life is made of envy, sedition, strife, carnage and war. “Troubles on troubles follow, toils on toils, / Pain, pain for ever pain;” (lines 1289–1290). “Envy, sedition, strife, / Carnage and war, make up the tale of life.” (lines 1292–1293). The movement is from private weariness to civic violence. It is a choral vision of a human common lot, not a later battle already shown.

83. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does the ode turn, at the end, from general human ills to “He too our guest hath known”? Defend a reading of that turn.

Sample answer: After the general meditation, the chorus says such ills are not theirs alone; the guest has known them too. “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known,” (lines 1298–1299). The turn makes the ode local and ethical: the dark common lot is used to recognise this one beaten life. It is pity for a known guest. The headland image that follows keeps the recognition concrete, as weather and tide.

84. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Where does Polyneices say he has raised a host, when he first explains his coming?

A. From Argos, with seven champion captains at his side

B. From Athens, with Theseus already pledged to march at dawn

C. From Colonus, with the chorus already armed for Thebes

D. From Delphi, with a new oracle already granted this hour

Key: A (From Argos, with seven champion captains at his side)

85. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus say his daughters have done for him, when he turns on the son?

    A. They have already agreed to march with the seven spears this hour

    B. They have tended him; without them he would have had no aid from the son

    C. They have already asked Theseus to drive the son out of the land

    D. They have already promised to forget him and leave him unnamed

    Key: B (They have tended him; without them he would have had no aid from the son)

86. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Oedipus first charge the son with the past, once he begins to speak? Use the lines about the sovereignty and about driving him out.

    Sample answer: He calls him a villain, and he asks whether, when the son had the sovereignty that the brother now holds, he did not drive his own father out. “O villain, when thou hadst the sovereignty / That now thy brother holdeth in thy stead, / Didst thou not drive me, thine own father, out,” (lines 1406–1408). The charge is exile and neglect, set against the present plea. The curse that follows is prepared by this recalling of the past, not by a later battle already shown.

87. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Polyneices treat the silence before any curse is spoken? Use his lines about mute disdain and about a sullen, obstinate silence.

    Sample answer: He meets the silence as a refusal already aimed at him. He asks why his father is silent, whether he will dismiss him in mute disdain, and he tries to move a sullen, obstinate silence. “Why silent? Father, speak, nor turn away,” (line 1329). “In mute disdain, nor tell me why thou art wrath?” (line 1331). The wound is named before the long speech of the curse: not a debate yet, but no word at all.

88. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Antigone's question: “What solemn _____ would’st thou impress on him?”

    Key: charge

89. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Oedipus say his life has done, and what would he still perform for Theseus? Use the lines about the scale and about the promise.

    Sample answer: He says his life hath turned the scale, and he would do all he promised Theseus and his before he dies. “My life hath turned the scale. I would do all / I promised thee and thine before I die.” (lines 1558–1559). The wording holds a promise kept at an appointed time. The charge that follows is the performing of that promise, in this scene, as the signs have come.

90. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse “But to the spot—the god within me goads—”. What kind of movement does that wording claim?

    Sample answer: He asks that they set forth to the spot without longer delay, because the god within him goads him. “But to the spot—the god within me goads— / Let us set forth nor longer hesitate.” (lines 1590–1591). “Goads” makes the movement an inner divine urging, not a human itinerary he has invented, and not a recovery of ordinary eyesight. The line should be taught as a summons accepted.

91. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How do Theseus's trust and Oedipus's promise work together once the king has come? Use Theseus's line about finding him a true prophet, and do not treat the end as already told.

    Sample answer: Theseus says he must believe him, having found him often a true prophet, and then he asks what must be done. “I must believe thee, having found thee oft / A prophet true; then speak what must be done.” (lines 1566–1567). Trust follows a record of truthfulness, and it opens the way for the charge and the promise Oedipus still means to perform. The scene presents belief and duty together; it does not yet report a later passing as accomplished.

92. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Who, as _____ tell, dost glare,"

    Key: legends

93. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What petition follows the picture of a hound that glares at all who come? Use the lines that ask for a scathless going, and say how they fit a prayer.

    Sample answer: After picturing the hound that glares at all comers, the elders ask a precise mercy: let this one man go unharmed to the fields below. "At all comers, let him go / Scathless to the fields below." (lines 1620–1621). "Scathless" means without hurt; the request is that the gateway not wound him. That is a petition addressed to a guardian.

94. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How is the watch-dog first addressed, and what fierce picture do the elders still give it? Use the title at the gates of hell, and the line about a cavernous lair, without repeating the fill-word about legends.

    Sample answer: They address a fell watch-dog of the gates of hell, and they picture it gnarling in its cavernous lair. "Queen infernal, and thou fell / Watch-dog of the gates of hell," (lines 1616–1617). "Gnarling in thy cavernous lair" (line 1619). The image is fierce, but the petition that follows is not a wish to see anyone destroyed. The hound remains a guardian in the song; the prayer asks it not to treat this stranger as prey.

95. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What kind of song is this, if it begins by wondering whether the dead can hear, and ends by naming a giver of last rest?

    Sample answer: It is a religious song of escort, spoken in the city's voice. It starts in uncertainty "If mortal prayers are heard in hell," (line 1606) and closes by addressing a "Giver of eternal sleep" (line 1625), after asking that a going already signalled be received without further harm. Those are petitions about how the underworld might receive him.

96. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Earth-rooted Threshold with its _____ stairs,"

    Key: brazen

97. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] According to the messenger, how does Theseus answer when he is asked to take the daughters' hands? Use the line that records what he swore.

    Sample answer: The messenger says Theseus repressed his tears and swore to be their constant friend. "His tears and swore to be their constant friend." (line 1681). The oath is a pledge of care for the living, given at the edge of the end, and it is not a request that anyone share the passing. Later he will keep another charge about the hidden place; this line records the friendship sworn beforehand.

98. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What happens in the moment after mourning ends and no wail rose? Use the messenger's account of silence, dread, and the words of the call.

    Sample answer: After mourning has an end and no wail rose, there is a moment of silence; then a voice summons him, and with sudden dread the hair of all stands up. The call comes now loud, now low, and oft, naming him twice and asking why they tarry, for the passing has been delayed too long. "A moment there was silence; suddenly / A voice that summoned him;" (lines 1667–1668). "Oedipus, Oedipus, why tarry we? / Too long, too long thy passing is delayed." (lines 1671–1672). The voice is not a human command; the messenger treats it as the summons of the god.

99. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] On what terms does Theseus say he pledged his word to Zeus about the hidden place? Use the lines that name the sacred portal and the God of Oaths.

    Sample answer: He tells the daughters that Oedipus charged him straitly that no mortal should approach the sacred portal or greet the hidden tomb with funeral litanies; he then says the God of Oaths heard that promise, and he pledged his word to Zeus. "Charged me straitly that no mortal / Should approach the sacred portal," (lines 1812–1813). "The God of Oaths this promise heard, / And to Zeus I pledged my word." (lines 1818–1819). The secrecy is a kept oath, tied to the city's rest, not a wish to abandon the daughters.

100. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does the last exchange among Theseus, the daughters, and the chorus leave a hearer in grief, in consolation, or in some mixture of both? Argue from the closing speeches.

Sample answer: A fair defence can call it both. Theseus tells them to go in peace, and he will spare no toil and zealous care, but will attend to all their needs, gladdening in the grave his friend. The chorus then bids them wail no more, and says that all is ordered for the best. “Go in peace; nor will I spare / Aught of toil and zealous care,” (lines 1826–1827). “Wail no more, let sorrow rest, / All is ordered for the best.” (lines 1830–1831). Consolation here is not cheerfulness. The close holds care and an ordered peace together with the loss still in view.

101. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] According to the stranger, who has his worship hard by, as the Titan who bears the torch?

A. Prometheus

B. Creon

C. Polyneices

D. Teiresias

Key: A (Prometheus)

102. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What name does the stranger give to the very spot Oedipus is treading?

A. The marketplace already chosen for a public trial this day

B. The Brass-footed Threshold, called Athens' bastion in his account

C. The hidden tomb already reserved for a later secret rite

D. The palace court already waiting inside the fenced city

Key: B (The Brass-footed Threshold, called Athens' bastion in his account)

103. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the stranger describe the neighbourhood's name and its fame? Use his lines about Colonus and about being unknown to fame.

Sample answer: He says the neighbouring lands claim as their chief and patron yonder knight Colonus, and in common bear his name. “Claim as their chief and patron yonder knight / Colonus, and in common bear his name.” (lines 60–61). Then he adds that the spot is to fame unknown, but dear to its native worshippers. “Such, stranger, is the spot, to fame unknown, / But dear to us its native worshippers.” (lines 62–63). The place is locally loved and named, not a famous capital, which is part of what Oedipus is being asked to understand.

104. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is the force of the stranger's saying that, by Oedipus's looks, marred though they be by fate, he judges him noble? Use those lines.

Sample answer: After warning that he would see the visitor out of harm, the stranger reads past the ruined appearance to a judgment of nobility, and he tells him to tarry while the nearby burghers are sought. “For by thy looks, marred though they be by fate, / I judge thee noble: tarry where thou art,” (lines 76–77). The contrast is the point: fate has marred the looks, but the stranger still finds a nobility there, and that reading is what lets him leave the man seated until the locals decide.

105. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the Prologue join a request for a resting place to a claim that strangers must inquire and do as they are bid? Defend a reading from Oedipus's opening instructions to Antigone.

Sample answer: He asks her to stay him and set him down if she sees a resting place on common ground or by some sacred grove, and then to discover where they have come, because strangers must inquire of denizens and do as they are bid. “Stay me and set me down. Let us discover / Where we have come, for strangers must inquire / Of denizens, and do as they are

bid." (lines 11–13). Need and courtesy are held together: he wants rest, but he also states a rule of inquiry and obedience for an outsider. The later clash over the holy seat tests that rule; it is not yet a later king's grant.

106. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What command does the chorus give to freeze Oedipus at a marked line of rock?

A. Leave the land before the sun has set this hour

B. Name yourself at once to the whole assembled host

C. Halt! Go no further than that rocky floor

D. Sit down beside the public road and wait in silence

Key: C (Halt! Go no further than that rocky floor)

107. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone tell her father when the questioning has brought him to the point of speech?

A. Be silent, for Theseus is already here to answer them

B. Flee, for Creon has already entered the sacred grove

C. Laugh, for the elders have already promised him a crown

D. Speak, for he stands on the slippery verge

Key: D (Speak, for he stands on the slippery verge)

108. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the naming itself tighten the scene once Oedipus has begun to answer? Use the broken start of Laius's name and the chorus's cry.

Sample answer: Pressed to say of what stock he comes, he begins a name and does not even finish it: "Know'st one of Laius'—" (line 209). The chorus breaks in with a cry, "Ha! Who!" (line 210). The half-spoken name is enough to turn inquiry into recognition; the scene tightens because the elders hear the lineage they fear before a full sentence is complete.

109. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does Antigone's plea ask the elders to pretend her father is innocent? Use her line about knowing the deeds he wrought, and say what she asks instead.

Sample answer: No. She does not deny the deeds. She says she knows the deeds he wrought, not innocent, and still she asks them to hear. "Knowing the deeds he wrought, not innocent," (line 230). The plea is for a hearing in the face of known acts, not for a rewriting of the past. She later asks where they will find one who escapes perdition if a god impels him; the argument is about pity and divine driving, not about a claim that nothing was done.

110. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In his defence, how does Oedipus name the deeds for which he has been judged?

A. Deeds of a man more sinned against than sinning

B. Deeds of a king already restored to Theban power this day

C. Deeds of a general already leading seven spears to war

D. Deeds of a judge already sitting in the Athenian council

Key: A (Deeds of a man more sinned against than sinning)

111. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Oedipus refuse to be called a villain for, in the line about self-defence?

Sample answer: He asks whether he is then a villain born because, in self-defence, stricken, he struck the striker back again. "A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (lines 262–263). The defence turns on not knowing and on being struck first; it is offered to the elders in this episode as a claim about intent, not as a later court's verdict, and not as a boast that nothing was suffered.

112. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Oedipus describe the decay of power and honour when he warns Theseus about time? Use the lines about earth's might and about constancy.

Sample answer: He says earth's might decays, and the might of men decays; honour grows cold, and dishonour flourishes; there is no constancy 'twixt friend and friend. “Earth’s might decays, the might of men decays, / Honour grows cold, dishonour flourishes, / There is no constancy ’twixt friend and friend,” (lines 632–634). The warning is that cities and friendships can change, so the gift he offers must be kept with that change in mind. It is counsel to a host, not a report of a war already fought.

113. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the self-defence speech work together with the later claim that Oedipus sinnèd not? Take a stand from the wording of those defences, without retrying a later play.

Sample answer: In this episode he offers two related claims: that he struck in self-defence when stricken, and that, when the chorus says “And sinned”, he answers that he sinned not. “And sinned—” “I sinnèd not.” (lines 551–552). The earlier self-defence speech and this later denial work together: the argument is about knowledge and force, not about erasing suffering. A fair reading can accept the claim as the play's present defence without pretending the past is simple, and without importing a later verdict this scene does not give.

114. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What, according to the ode, do youth and withering age fail to do to the olive?

A. They already sell the grove to a neighbouring king

B. They do not destroy the plant

C. They already uproot the tree for a public road

D. They already claim the plant for Pelops' isle

Key: B (They do not destroy the plant)

115. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the ode set the olive's life-span against a human measure, in the lines that deny destruction by youth or withering age?

Sample answer: The tree is said to feed the land's boys, and then the chorus adds that neither youth nor withering age destroys it. “Nor youth nor withering age destroys” (line 726). Human ages pass; the plant does not. The contrast turns the olive into an image of endurance beyond a single life, which is why it can stand for the fatherland in the next lines, not for a private farm already sold.

116. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What work does the verb “feeds” do in “’Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys”? Attend to who is nourished, and by what kind of tree.

Sample answer: The line names the tree by its grey leaves and says that it feeds the land's boys. “’Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys;” (line 725). The diction is domestic and civic at once: the sacred plant is also a source of food for the young of the city. The boast is not empty ornament; it ties the grove's holiness to the life the city raises, without turning the ode into a later political speech.

117. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How should a class hold together the ode's flowers, its olive, and its closing boast of bit and oar? Defend a reading from the song itself.

Sample answer: The first movements praise a fertile, favoured plain: dew, narcissi, sleepless fountains, a crystal gleam, and a tree that is self-nurtured and defended. The close adds the iron bit and the oar on the brine. Read together, the song says this land is beautiful, sacred, and capable: it grows, it defends, and it trains horse and ship. The worn stranger is being told what kind of city has received him. The ode does not yet narrate a later seizure or a later passing.

118. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] To whom does Oedipus cry for help when the seizure is made plain?

    A. The seven captains already waiting in the field

    B. The messenger already sent to publish a tomb

    C. The princes of the land

    D. The sons already crowned together in Thebes

    Key: C (The princes of the land)

119. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Creon say he thought he had, when he tries to justify the seizure? Use his line about warrant.

    Sample answer: He says that such wrong, as he thought, had warrant for his act. “Such wrong, methought, had warrant for my act.” (line 1000). He does not deny the force; he claims a warrant for it. The line lets Theseus's demand for a warranty of law meet Creon's own word “warrant”, so the quarrel is about who may authorize force in this land, not about a later battle already won.

120. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Oedipus describe Creon's manner of argument in the line about one who sticks at nothing? Use that wording.

    Sample answer: He says Creon is one who sticks at nothing, if it serve his plea. “Who sticks at nothing, if it serve his plea,” (line 1050). The charge is about method as much as about the seizure itself: any argument, any act, if it helps the case. The portrait belongs to this episode's judgment of Creon's rhetoric, and it should be read against the earlier “front of brass” and subtle tongue, not as a later verdict from another play.

121. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does Theseus's intervention show Athens living up to the titles Antigone invoked at the start of the episode? Defend a reading from her appeal and from Oedipus's blessing at the close.

    Sample answer: Antigone asked a land extolled above all lands to make its glorious titles good; at the close, after Theseus has rebuked the force and taken the matter in hand, Oedipus blesses him for his nobleness and loving care. “O land extolled above all lands, ’tis now / For thee to make these glorious titles good.” (lines 740–741). “Heaven bless thee, Theseus, for thy nobleness / And all thy loving care in my behalf.” (lines 1090–1091). The episode presents the city, in its king, as answering that appeal. A careful reading can also note that the daughters' safety still depends on what follows the exit, which this closing blessing does not yet narrate in full.

122. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the chorus say this day shall bring, if Zeus is at work?

    A. A new war already declared on Athens itself

    B. A hidden tomb shown to every later visitor

    C. A crown already placed on Creon's head here

    D. Victory, which this very day shall bring

    Key: D (Victory, which this very day shall bring)

123. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] To whom do the wide floods belong in the line that names the great Ocean-king?

    A. Earth's great Ocean-king, whose wide floods enring the land in the song

    B. Creon, already claiming the grove as a Theban harbour now

    C. Polyneices, already crossing the sea with sevenfold spears

    D. A messenger already waiting with news from a far city

    Key: A (Earth's great Ocean-king, whose wide floods enring the land in the song)

124. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the appeal “Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear” add to the prayer, after Zeus has already been named?

Sample answer: The song has already said that Zeus worketh some great thing this day; then it calls Apollo as hunter. “Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear,” (line 1144). The second god is asked under a hunting title, which fits a chase after a robber band. The prayer gathers more than one power to the same recovery, and it stays a song of hope until the escort is seen.

125. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How should we read a choral vision that describes a battle not yet shown on stage? Take a stand from the song's own turn at the last line.

Sample answer: It should be read as hope and imagining, not as a messenger's report already complete. The elders describe steeds, bridles, knights, and a victory they say this day shall bring; then the last line shows what the stage can actually present: an escort with the maids draws near. “For lo, an escort with the maids draws near.” (line 1152). The vision reaches toward the fight; the close returns to what arrives. Taught that way, the ode is a prayer that is answered in the daughters' return, not a second play hidden inside this one.

126. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Theseus say he would rather be famous by, when he has just returned with the daughters?

A. By a new war already declared on Thebes this hour

B. By deeds rather than by words

C. By a hidden tomb already shown to every visitor

D. By a crown already placed on Creon's head today

Key: B (By deeds rather than by words)

127. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What condition does Oedipus add, once he has yielded to the pleading? Use his request that no one have power to dispose of him.

Sample answer: He says the boon they win by pleading is grievous to him, but he lets them have their way; only, if the man must come, let none have power to dispose of him. “Only if come he must, I beg thee, friend, / Let none have power to dispose of me.” (lines 1265–1266). The consent is real and limited: a hearing is granted, control of his person is not. Theseus then tells him there is no need to appeal a second time.

128. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Antigone use the past, and her father's sightless orbs, to persuade him to hear his son? Use those lines, and stay with her argument in this scene.

Sample answer: She tells him to look to the past, forget the present, and think on all the woe his sire and mother brought him; from that, she says, he will draw the lesson that of evil passion evil is the end. “Look thou to the past, forget the present, think / On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee;” (lines 1254–1255). She then calls his ever-sightless orbs stern monitors to prick his memory. The persuasion is hard and intimate: she uses his own history and his blindness as teachers, not as insults, to make him yield a hearing.

129. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does yielding to hear the suppliant undo Oedipus's loathing, or only postpone it? Defend a reading from his grudging consent and from Theseus's promise of safety.

Sample answer: It postpones the loathing; it does not undo it. He still calls the boon grievous, and he yields only on condition that no one may dispose of him. “Grievous to me, my child, the boon ye win / By pleading. Let it be then; have your way” (lines 1263–1264). Theseus answers that his life is safe while any god saves the king's. “Thy life is safe while any god saves mine.” (line 1269). The episode ends in a protected hearing still to come, not in a reconciliation already achieved, and not in a curse already spoken.

130. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Joyless, _____ and slow,”

Key: companionless

131. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What is the force of saying that one doom of fate awaits all, for dance and marriage bell, the dirge and funeral knell?

Sample answer: The ode says that, come it slow or fast, one doom of fate doth all await, for dance and marriage bell, the dirge and funeral knell. “One doom of fate / Doth all await, / For dance and marriage bell, / The dirge and funeral knell.” (lines 1279–1282). The pairing makes the end a common human bound, set beside festive rites. The next line names a deliverer; it should be taught as a choral meditation on a shared lot.

132. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the headland simile work, once the ode has said the guest has known these ills? Use the lines about blasts and about a whelming tide.

Sample answer: The guest is likened to a headland on an iron-bound shore, lashed by wintry blasts and the surge's roar, and buffeted on every side by drear misfortune's whelming tide, and by every wind of heaven. “E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge’s roar,” (lines 1300–1301). The simile makes long suffering visible and outward: weather, not a hidden fault alone. It closes the ode on pity for a particular life.

133. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is this ode best read as despair, as pity, or as both? Defend a view from its general claims and from its final turn to the guest.

Sample answer: A fair defence can call it both, if the two are not collapsed into one another. The general stanzas are as dark as choral song can be: a grievous load, pain without escape, an unregarded last age. The close, though, turns that darkness into recognition of a guest already buffeted, like a headland, by every wind. “He too our guest hath known,” (line 1299). Pity is the ethical use of the despairing vision. The ode should not be taught as a report of a later passing already accomplished.

134. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Polyneices say an army must not have seen, when he refuses to turn the host back?

A. Theseus already marching with them toward Thebes

B. The daughters already leaving the grove this hour

C. Their leader quail

D. A new oracle already published to the waiting host

Key: C (Their leader quail)

135. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus say will happen before the city can be stormed? Use the line that begins that claim, and do not treat the brothers as already fallen.

Sample answer: He tells the son that the city he would storm can never be taken by him; first there is a doom still spoken, not shown. “That city thou canst never storm, but first” (line 1426). The line opens a prophecy of mutual ruin, which this episode utters as a father's curse, not as a report that the two have already slain each other. It should be taught as a foretelling in this scene, still ahead of the war.

136. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Oedipus invoke a curse already launched and make it fight for him now? Use the lines about the curse against the two sons.

Sample answer: He says such a curse he lately launched against them twain, and such a curse he now invokes to fight for him. “Such curse I lately launched against you twain, / Such curse I now invoke to fight for me,” (lines 1428–1429). The past speech is called back to work in the present; the family's anger is made into a future that the son will carry to the field. The scene does not yet show that future as accomplished.

137. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the episode set a sister's plea to turn back against a brother's claim to be a good general? Use one line from each side.

Sample answer: Antigone begs him to turn the host back to Argos with all speed; he answers that he shall not tell the curse, because a good general reports successes and conceals mishaps. “Turn back thy host to Argos with all speed,” (line

1466). “I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports successes and conceals mishaps.” (lines 1479–1480). The contrast is stark: she wants the march stopped; he wants the army's morale kept. The play lets both speeches stand, and then he goes.

138. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus say Theseus must do about the dread mysteries, as opposed to speaking them as common news?

A. He must already publish them to the chorus and the daughters now

B. He must already send them in writing to a neighbouring king

C. He must already forget them before he leaves the grove this hour

D. He must gather them there alone; speech may not profane them

Key: D (He must gather them there alone; speech may not profane them)

139. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What reversal does Oedipus name as strange, when he tells the daughters to follow? Use the two lines about leading and being led.

Sample answer: He tells them to follow, and he names the strange turn: he whom they have led so long should lead them now. “Follow me, daughters, this way. Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now.” (lines 1592–1593). The reversal is not a claim that ordinary sight has returned. It shows that the summons gives him a path he can walk, at the place appointed in this land, and it should not be taught as a trick.

140. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In the line “O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile,” how does Oedipus greet a sense he can still feel at the edge of the gloom?

Sample answer: He greets a light that is no light to him now, yet was once his, as he comes near the gloom of Hades. “O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile,” (line 1599). The wording holds a last sense of the world he cannot see: “no light to me” and “mine erewhile” together. It is a last address to daylight, spoken by a man answering a summons, and it stops short of any later report of how that end will be told.

141. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does the thunder-scene present Oedipus as keeping his word to Theseus, as answering a god's goad, or as doing both at once? Argue from the scale and from the goad.

Sample answer: Both are present and should be held together. He tells Theseus that his life has turned the scale, and that he would do all he promised before he dies; that is a promise kept at the appointed time. “I would do all / I promised thee and thine before I die.” (lines 1558–1559). A little later he says the god within him goads him to the spot. “But to the spot—the god within me goads—” (line 1590). He chooses the path he is to take, not the fact that the end has come.

142. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What claim does the ode make about the watch-dog's master, after picturing the hound?

A. That this master already orders the mercy they ask

B. That Creon already commands the hound against the guest

C. That Theseus already claims the grove as his own court

D. That Apollo already forbids the stranger to enter there

Key: A (That this master already orders the mercy they ask)

143. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What work does the word “wrongfully” do in the couplet that also asks Justice to bless the stranger now?

Sample answer: It revises the verdict before the blessing is asked. The elders call the life wrongful oppression, then pray that he now be blessed by Justice. “Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed.” (lines 1614–1615). The prayer does not pretend the past never happened; it changes the judgment of the suffering and asks a moral power to ratify that change. The couplet is the hinge of the ode's mercy, not a report that the end has already been accomplished.

144. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Where does the song turn from wondering whether prayers can be heard to claiming that a command has already been given? Use the line about the master's order.

Sample answer: The song begins by wondering whether mortal prayers are heard at all; it later states that the watch-dog's master already orders the mercy they ask. “For thy master orders thus,” (line 1622). The movement is from uncertainty to authority: if the dead can hear, then this king has in fact commanded that the stranger be let go, and that the monster be kept in its den. They are not reporting that the end has already come.

145. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Elders who once drove the stranger out now ask that he be received without pain. What does that turn show about the city's present voice, and what does it still not decide? Stay with this ode.

Sample answer: It shows at least the city's present view of him in the community that has taken him in. They now call his life wrongful oppression, ask Justice to bless him, and pray that the powers below receive him without pain. “Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain.” (lines 1612–1613). That is not a full verdict on every earlier scene, and the ode does not say Athens has always been kind. It does show that, by this point, the civic voice of Colonus speaks for mercy and for a peaceful going, not for further punishment.

146. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “So having reached the _____”

Key: abrupt

147. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which causes does the messenger expressly rule out, and what does he still refuse to claim to know? Use the sentences about no fiery bolt and no whirlwind.

Sample answer: He will not name a violent cause, and he will not claim to know the doom as Theseus knows it. There fell no fiery bolt that reft him in that hour, nor whirlwind from the sea, but he was taken; no man save Theseus knoweth by what doom the stranger met his end. “But by what doom the stranger met his end / No man save Theseus knoweth.” (lines 1698–1699). “No fiery bolt that reft him in that hour, / Nor whirlwind from the sea, but he was taken.” (lines 1700–1701). The lines should be taught as a report of a mysterious, god-sent passing.

148. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] After Ismene says she cannot live a life thus desolate, what counsel does the chorus give the pair? Use the lines about bearing what heaven brings.

Sample answer: Ismene has just said she cannot live a life thus desolate. The chorus does not praise any wish to share the father's fate. They call the pair a worthy pair, tell them that what heaven brings they needs must bear, and bid them fret no more against Heaven's will, for fate has not dealt with them ill. “I cannot live a life thus desolate.” (line 1737). “What heaven brings ye needs must bear, / Fret no more ’gainst Heaven’s will;” (lines 1739–1740). The play answers the cry of grief with a charge to bear the life still left.

149. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Theseus still offer the daughters after they have yielded about the tomb? Use the lines about toil, care, and gladdening his friend, and say how far that offer goes.

Sample answer: After they yield and turn toward home, he tells them to go in peace, and he will not spare toil and zealous care, but will attend to all their needs, gladdening in the grave his friend. “But on all your needs attend, / Gladdening in his grave my friend.” (lines 1828–1829). That is the friendship of a keeper and a host, offered after he has already refused to show the tomb. It does not cancel their grief, and it does not undo the charge of silence. It does show that the oath of care is still being kept.

150. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Once Antigone has accepted that the tomb may not be seen, toward what unfinished task at home does she turn? Use the lines about a mortal feud, and say what the play does not yet show.

Sample answer: Once she has yielded, she asks to go back to Thebes, if yet they may, to heal a mortal feud and stay the self-wrought doom that drives their brothers to their tomb. “Back to Thebes, if yet we may / Heal this mortal feud and stay /

The self-wrought doom / That drives our brothers to their tomb." (lines 1822–1825). The hope is to stop a doom still ahead; the play does not show the brothers already slain, and it does not tell us whether she will succeed. Thebes here is a next task named in grief, not a report of a later play's end.

151. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus say has taught him to endure, besides the long years that have grown old with him?

A. Suffering, and last not least, true nobility

B. A new army already waiting for him just outside Athens

C. A written treaty already sealed with Creon in Thebes

D. A restored kingship already promised by the nearby burghers

Key: A (Suffering, and last not least, true nobility)

152. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Antigone report at the close of the Prologue, and what does Oedipus then choose to do? Use her warning and his last instruction.

Sample answer: She hushes him, because she sees grey-beards on their way, their errand to spy out the resting-place. "Hush! for I see some grey-beards on their way, / Their errand to spy out our resting-place." (lines 109–110). He says he will be mute, and that she shall guide his steps off the public road, until he has learned their drift. "I will be mute, and thou shalt guide my steps / Into the covert from the public road," (lines 111–112). The scene ends in caution and listening, not in a public claim already accepted.

153. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse the wording of "Hear, namesake of great Pallas; Athens, first / Of cities, pity this dishonoured shade". What does Oedipus ask, and of whom?

Sample answer: In the prayer, after calling on the gentle daughters of primeval Night, he turns to Athens by name, as namesake of great Pallas and first of cities, and he asks pity for a dishonoured shade. "Hear, namesake of great Pallas; Athens, first / Of cities, pity this dishonoured shade, / The ghost of him who once was Oedipus." (lines 106–108). The petition is civic as well as religious: the city itself is asked to pity a shade, not to restore a throne, and the wording holds honour and dishonour in one address.

154. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Oedipus describe the respite Apollo once spoke of, and how should those lines be taught in this opening scene? Use the lines about a haven and a rest.

Sample answer: In the prayer, once the stranger has gone, he says Phoebus, when he told the miseries to come, also spoke of this respite after many years: some haven in a far-off land, a rest vouchsafed at last by dread divinities. "Spake of this respite after many years, / Some haven in a far-off land, a rest / Vouchsafed at last by dread divinities." (lines 88–90). The lines should be taught as a promised rest at the end of wandering. In this scene the haven is still a hope named in prayer, not a later report of the end.

155. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does the Prologue present Oedipus chiefly as a man asking to be told where he is, or as a man already sure of a fate tied to this ground? Defend a reading that holds both, using one early question and one later claim in the prayer.

Sample answer: Both are present and should be held together. At the opening he still has to ask what region and whose city they have reached, and he tells Antigone that strangers must inquire. "What region, say, whose city have we reached?" (line 2). After the stranger has named the goddesses and gone, he prays that he now recognises as theirs the sign that led his wanderings to this grove. "And now I recognise as yours the sign / That led my wanderings to this your grove;" (lines 96–97). Inquiry comes first; recognition is claimed only after the place has been named. The scene does not yet show a later king's welcome, or the end itself.

156. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus, at the moment he is about to speak, tell his daughter that they are undone? Use his cry and the question that prompted it.

Sample answer: The chorus has asked of what stock he comes, what man's son; that is the question he has been reluctant

to meet. “Say of what stock thou comest, what man’s son—” (line 204). His answer is a cry to Antigone that now they are undone. “Ah me, my daughter, now we are undone!” (line 205). He already knows that the name, once spoken, will undo the fragile safety of being only a nameless trespasser; the line is a recognition of that cost, just before he agrees to speak.

157. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the chorus's command “Halt! Go no further than that rocky floor” organise the stage at this point in the parodos? Use the following questions about staying and sitting.

Sample answer: The halt freezes him at a marked line: no further than that rocky floor. “Halt! Go no further than that rocky floor.” (line 183). He asks whether he should stay where he now is, and they tell him to advance no more; he then asks if he may sit, and they direct him sideways to the ledge. The questioning of name and lineage happens only after he has been placed, crouching, at that edge. The staging turns a hunt-like entrance into a controlled examination at a boundary.

158. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyse “Honour whatso’er the State / Honours, all she frowns on hate”. What does the chorus demand of the newcomer?

Sample answer: They require him to honour whatever the State honours, and to hate all that she frowns on. “Honour whatso’er the State / Honours, all she frowns on hate.” (lines 177–178). The demand is civic and present: the stranger must take the city's likings and dislikings as his measure, not import another rule, and not treat the grove as ground he may define for himself. It is spoken before they know his name, so the claim is general; later, once the name is known, that same civic voice will add fear to law.

159. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Is the parodos more a scene of discovery or a scene of expulsion? Defend a reading that holds the movement from one to the other, using the cry to speed them from the borders.

Sample answer: It is a discovery that turns into an expulsion. The elders begin by hunting an unseen trespasser and questioning him; once the lineage is out, they order father and daughter out of the land. “Forth from our borders speed ye both!” (line 220). The same civic voice that had been setting limits and asking for a name now uses that name as a reason to drive them away. A fair reading can also note the limit: pity is later admitted, but the command to depart has already been spoken, and they will not unsay it in this scene.

160. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Theseus say no one shall do, in his despite, when Oedipus fears threats?

A. Crown him king of Athens before nightfall comes

B. Hale him hence, against Theseus's will

C. Hide the daughters in the city without a word

D. Send him back by sea before the chorus can speak

Key: B (Hale him hence, against Theseus's will)

161. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Theseus treat the threats to take Oedipus back? Use his lines about the seas between them, and about his name warranting the guest from harm.

Sample answer: He says that even if the foemen's words are brave, boasting to bring Oedipus back, they are like to find the seas between them wide and hard to sail. “Boasting to bring thee back, they are like to find / The seas between us wide and hard to sail.” (lines 690–691). He adds that his name, though he be distant, warrants the guest from harm. “Though I be distant, warrants thee from harm.” (line 694). The protection is a king's purpose in this land, not a later battle already shown, and not a dismissal from the grove.

162. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse the phrase “more sinned against than sinning”. What distinction does Oedipus ask the elders to draw?

Sample answer: He asks them to see his deeds as those of a man more sinned against than sinning. “Deeds of a man more sinned against than sinning” (line 258). The wording does not deny that acts were done; it asks for a weighing of what was

done to him against what he did, and it belongs with his claim of self-defence and of acting without knowledge. The line should be taught as this episode's defence of intent, not as a verdict imported from a later play.

163. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How do Theseus's grant of citizen rights and Oedipus's claim that here he shall vanquish those who cast him forth belong together? Defend a reading from both lines, without treating a later battle as already shown.

Sample answer: Theseus grants the full rights of citizen and will not spurn the favours offered; Oedipus, received, says that here he shall vanquish those who cast him forth. “But grant him the full rights of citizen;” (line 661). “Here shall I vanquish those who cast me forth.” (line 670). The vanquishing is tied to being held in this land, under a god's word, not to Oedipus taking up arms on stage. The two speeches together recast the outcast as a guest whose worth will tell against Thebes, without showing that later conflict as already accomplished in this scene.

164. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of opening the ode by naming rest before naming the land's glory? Use the first two lines.

Sample answer: The first gift named is rest, offered to a stranger worn with toil, and only then is the land called goodliest. “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil,” (lines 695–696). The order matters: the song meets weariness first, and praise of Colonus follows as the ground of that rest. It is a welcome, not a hunt, and it does not yet tell what a later messenger will say of an end.

165. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse “Terror to foemen’s spear” as a description of the olive. What kind of boast is this?

Sample answer: The tree grows unpruned and untamed, and the next line calls it a terror to foemen's spear. “Terror to foemen’s spear,” (line 721). The olive is not only a peaceful emblem; the ode makes it a living defence that should frighten an enemy. The boast is civic and almost martial, yet still a plant's boast, not a report of a battle already won on stage. It prepares the later claim that Athena herself defends the tree.

166. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What map does the ode draw when it refuses Asian soil and Pelops’ Dorian isle a claim on this tree? Stay with those denials.

Sample answer: The ode insists the tree is unnamed in Asian soil and unclaimed by Pelops' Dorian isle, yet self-nurtured year by year here. The contrast locates the olive as uniquely Attic: not a borrowed eastern wonder, and not a Peloponnesian prize, but a growth of this fatherland. The patriotism is made by exclusion as well as by praise, and it should be taught as the song's way of saying whose tree this is, not as a later campaign already fought.

167. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does this ode change how we should hear the earlier fear of the grove? Defend a view from the song's own welcome, without rewriting the parodos.

Sample answer: Yes, at least in the civic voice of this song. Elders who had hunted a trespasser now praise the same land as a rest for a worn stranger, a heaven-favoured plain, and a fatherland whose tree feeds its boys and is itself defended. The fear of the holy ground is not erased, but it is joined to pride and welcome. A careful reading can also note the limit: a short ode is not the whole play, and it does not yet show whether that welcome will hold when force arrives.

168. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Antigone tell her father when she cannot break free?

A. Theseus has already sent her home by another road

B. Creon has already promised to leave her in the grove

C. They will not let her, father

D. The chorus has already voted to crown her in the city

Key: C (They will not let her, father)

169. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Oedipus use the past against Creon's present offer? Use the lines about yearning for exile as a glad release, when the favour was refused.

Sample answer: He reminds Creon that in old days, when he was distraught by self-wrought woes, he yearned for exile as a glad release, and the favour he then craved was refused. “In old days when by self-wrought woes distraught, / I yearned for exile as a glad release,” (lines 783–784). The present invitation to come home is judged by that past refusal: the offer is late, and it is suspect because it arrives when Thebes wants him, not when he asked to go. The argument is about timing and motive in this episode, not about a later grave already assigned.

170. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse “O front of brass, thy subtle tongue would twist / To thy advantage every plea of right”. What does Oedipus accuse Creon of doing to language?

Sample answer: He accuses him of a brazen face and a subtle tongue that would twist every plea of right to his own advantage. “O front of brass, thy subtle tongue would twist / To thy advantage every plea of right” (lines 779–780). The charge is rhetorical: right is not denied as a word, but is said to be twisted. That accusation frames all of Creon's later claims of warrant and just quarrel, so the class can hear those claims as the twisting the opening insult named.

171. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does this episode test whether a city that boasts of law will use law against force? Take a stand from Theseus's standard and from Creon's act, without telling a later war as already done.

Sample answer: The test is the point of the scene. Creon seizes a daughter and claims a warrant for the wrong; Theseus answers that a state which champions right asks, for every action, a warranty of law. “Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law,” (lines 957–958). Athens is asked to make its titles good, not by a speech alone, but by refusing to let force go scathless. The episode shows that test under way; it does not yet narrate later campaigns beyond this land.

172. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of ending a battle-ode with the simple sight of an escort and the maids? Use that closing line.

Sample answer: After steeds, gods, and a promised victory, the last line is almost plain: an escort with the maids draws near. “For lo, an escort with the maids draws near.” (line 1152). The effect is to answer the prayer in the form the play can show—the daughters coming back—without staging the fight itself. The close is relief and arrival, not a boast that every enemy has already been destroyed offstage.

173. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How do the appeals to Zeus and to Apollo as hunter divide the work of the prayer? Use both addresses.

Sample answer: Zeus is asked as the power who worketh some great thing today and whose day shall bring victory; Apollo is asked as hunter. “Today, today Zeus worketh some great thing” (line 1132). “Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear,” (line 1144). One address is about a day's great work; the other fits the chase. The song holds a civic hope under two names, and it should be taught as prayer, not as a report that the gods have already finished the work before the escort appears.

174. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What is the force of asking the land's own gods to cherish mystic rites in a song about a rescue? Stay with this ode's prayer.

Sample answer: Early in the song the chorus bids the powers cherish the mystic rites, even as it imagines a chase after a robber band. The rescue is therefore asked for inside a religious frame: the land's rites, not only its pride, are what the violence has offended. The prayer wants the daughters back, and it wants the holy order of the place upheld. That double asking is the ode's way of making the seizure more than a family quarrel, without yet telling a later passing or a later tomb.

175. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does this short ode complete the test begun when Antigone asked Athens to make its titles good? Defend a reading from the escort's arrival, and note what the song still does not show.

Sample answer: It completes that test in the form a choral song can complete it: the city, having been asked to make its titles good, is now seen bringing the maids back under escort. Earlier the song had hoped to behold a rescue of the captives twain. “Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain.” (lines 1110–1111). “I shall behold the twain” (line 1129).

The closing arrival fulfills that hope on stage, without staging the fight itself. A careful reading should also note the limit: the next episode will still have to deal with a suppliant son. The ode answers the seizure; it does not end the play.

176. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus infer, once Theseus's words have been enough to identify the newcomer?

A. The words have already ended the war at Thebes this hour

B. The words have already named Theseus as a traitor to the grove

C. The words have already sent the daughters back to Creon

D. The words have told him who the suppliant is

Key: D (The words have told him who the suppliant is)

177. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Antigone ask her father to weigh her youth against the prince's will and the god's service? Use the opening of her plea.

Sample answer: She asks him to heed her though she is young in years, to let the prince have his will, and to pay what in Theseus's eyes is service to the god; and she asks, for their sake also, that their brother may come. “O heed me, father, though I am young in years.” (line 1240). “For our sake also let our brother come.” (line 1243). Youth, civic duty, piety, and family are stacked in one appeal, which is why the hearing, when it is granted, is granted to more than one claimant.

178. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse “Of evil passion evil is the end”. What lesson does Antigone want her father to draw from his own past?

Sample answer: She has just told him to think on the woe his sire and mother brought him, and she says he will draw this lesson without fail: of evil passion evil is the end. “Of evil passion evil is the end.” (line 1257). The maxim is aimed at his present loathing as much as at a past history: she wants him to see that a savage mood, if not yielded, ends in evil. The line is persuasion, not a curse already spoken, and it should be taught as her attempt to avert a new harshness by recalling an old one.

179. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does this episode make a family hearing also a question of asylum and of a king's safety? Defend a reading from Theseus's two warnings, without telling the next scene's curse as already said.

Sample answer: Theseus first warns that the suppliant has found asylum and that due reverence to the god must not fail; at the close he promises that Oedipus's life is safe while any god saves his own. “But he hath found asylum. O beware, / And fail not in due reverence to the god.” (lines 1238–1239). “Thy life is safe while any god saves mine.” (line 1269). The son cannot be refused as if he were only a hated voice, and the father cannot be handed over as if he were only a prize. The episode holds both protections at once, and it leaves the hearing itself still to come.

180. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the catalogue of winds do at the close, after the headland has been named? Use the lines that place the blasts by quarter, including the last.

Sample answer: After the headland and the whelming tide, the song says he is overborne by every wind of heaven, some from the sunset, some from orient morn, some from the noonday glow, some from Rhipean gloom of everlasting snow. “Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, / Some from the noonday glow.” (lines 1305–1306). The four quarters make the buffeting complete: no side is spared. The close is an image of exposure, not a map of a later tomb.

181. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse “Last comes the worst and most abhorred stage / Of unregarded age”. What makes that stage the worst in the ode's own terms?

Sample answer: The ode has already named pain, envy, war; then it says last comes the worst and most abhorred stage of unregarded age, joyless, companionless and slow, of woes the crowning woe. “Last comes the worst and most abhorred stage / Of unregarded age,” (lines 1294–1295). What makes it worst, in the song, is not a hidden crime but being unregarded, without joy or companion, and slow. The diction is social as well as bodily. It should be taught as a lament over neglect, especially once the next lines turn toward a known guest.

182. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How should a class read “Death the deliverer freeth all at last” in this ode? Take a stand from the ode itself.

Sample answer: It should be read as a choral statement of a common bound. The line comes after the claim that one doom awaits all, for marriage bell and funeral knell; it names death as a deliverer who frees all at last. “Death the deliverer freeth all at last.” (line 1283). In a tragedy, that can be a grim consolation about a shared fate. The class should hear the darkness of the line and keep it in the song that is about to name the guest.

183. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does it mean that this meditation is sung over a particular guest, just after a hearing has been granted to a hated son? Defend a reading from the ode's last turn.

Sample answer: It means the general vision is already ethical and dramatic, not a detachable essay. A father has just been persuaded, grudgingly, to hear a son he loathes; the chorus then sings of a weary road, of public strife, and of a guest buffeted like a headland. “He too our guest hath known,” (line 1299). The song places that coming hearing inside a view of a life already overloaded. It does not speak the curse, and it does not tell a later passing; it asks us to see the man who must still receive a suppliant as one who has already been lashed by every wind.

184. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Polyneices say about the road he chooses, when he asks not to be stayed?

A. It is so, and stay him not; the road he chooses, he will take

B. It is already closed, and Theseus has forbidden him to leave

C. It is already safe, and the curse has been lifted from both sons

D. It is already hidden, and no sister may speak of it again

Key: A (It is so, and stay him not; the road he chooses, he will take)

185. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Polyneices first picture himself as he arrives, before the plea for aid? Use the line about a wallet and hunger's pinch.

Sample answer: He presents himself as a figure of want: he bears a wallet against hunger's pinch. “He bears a wallet against hunger’s pinch.” (line 1320). The detail is meant to stir pity and to rhyme with his father's beggar's state, before he names the seven captains and the war. The later curse will judge that resemblance as a tactic; in these opening lines it is still his chosen image of himself.

186. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the force of calling the silence mute disdain, before any argument has been answered? Use Polyneices's own wording.

Sample answer: He does not only ask for a word; he names the silence as mute disdain, and as a dismissal already under way. “In mute disdain, nor tell me why thou art wrath?” (line 1331). The phrase turns absence of speech into a judged insult, so that the son can feel refused before the father has begun the curse. It is a rhetorical move as well as a wound, and it sets the temperature of the scene before the long speeches start.

187. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is the curse in this episode best read as justice delayed, as vengeance, or as both? Defend a reading from the charge of exile and from the invocation of a curse already launched, without showing the brothers already slain.

Sample answer: A fair defence can call it both. Oedipus charges the son with driving him out when he had the sovereignty, and he then invokes a curse already launched to fight for him now. “Didst thou not drive me, thine own father, out,” (line 1408). “Such curse I now invoke to fight for me,” (line 1429). The justice he claims is real in his account of neglect; the form it takes is a doom sent onward into a war not yet fought. The scene should be taught as a spoken future, not as a report that the two have already fallen.

188. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What question does Antigone ask about the charge, and why does that question matter for the scene's pace before Theseus is used as more than a name?

Sample answer: She asks what solemn charge he would impress on the prince. “What solemn charge would’st thou impress on him?” (line 1540). The question pulls the promised trust into the open before the king is fully employed on stage, so that the audience hears the need for a charge, not only the need for a hurried coming. It organises the scene without inventing the summons, and it does not yet tell how a later report will describe the end.

189. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyse “Myself anon without a guiding hand / Will take thee to the spot where I must end”. What does Oedipus claim, and how should it be taught?
Sample answer: He claims that he himself, soon, without a guiding hand, will take Theseus to the spot where he must end. “Myself anon without a guiding hand / Will take thee to the spot where I must end.” (lines 1570–1571). The claim is a reversal of being led, and a placing of the charge at a particular spot in this land. It should be taught as a god-sent path he can walk, not as a recovery of ordinary sight.

190. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the scene bind a civic gift to a silence Theseus must keep? Use the lines about mysteries that speech may not profane, without turning the later tomb into a puzzle for the class to solve.
Sample answer: The dread mysteries are not to be spoken as common news. Theseus himself must gather them there alone; speech may not profane them. “But those dread mysteries speech may not profane / Thyself shalt gather coming there alone;” (lines 1576–1577). The gift to the city is tied to a kept silence, already in this scene, as a charge on the king. The class should hear that trust as part of the going, not as a later riddle about a grave the audience is invited to find.

191. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What is the effect of letting a blessing, rather than a lament, close the spoken scene as they set out? Attend also to what the written exit does and does not tell us.
Sample answer: The last words bless the friend, the land, and its followers, and they ask to be remembered for the city's welfare. That is a civic close, not a wail and not a report of an accomplished end. The written exit then names Theseus followed by Antigone and Ismene; by the sense of his command to follow, he leads them as they go. The scene stops there. It does not describe a later messenger's tale, and it does not tell us what will later be refused at a grave.

192. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “If mortal _____ are heard in hell,”
Key: prayers

193. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the title “Queen infernal” add to the prayer, coming just after the appeal to Justice?
Sample answer: It turns from a moral power to a named queen of the underworld, so the blessing just asked of Justice is also sought from the goddess who rules the place he would enter. “Queen infernal, and thou fell” (line 1616). The title is grave and official, not a smear. It keeps the song inside a religious petition, and it should not be taught as a map of a later report.

194. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “all-shrouding” add to the naming of a Stygian plain, in the petition that he enter without pain?
Sample answer: The plain is already named from the Styx, so the line alludes to the underworld river; “all-shrouding” then makes that place a covering over the one who enters. “The all-shrouding Stygian plain.” (line 1613). The wording is grave, not sensational. It should be taught as part of a petition for an easy going into that covered world.

195. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] If this ode is read as a civic prayer rather than as a plan, what does it ask the underworld to do? Use the close that names a giver of last rest.
Sample answer: It asks the powers below, by name and by office, to receive the stranger without further harm, and it ends by addressing a giver of last rest. “In his den the monster keep, / Giver of eternal sleep.” (lines 1624–1625). Read as prayer, those lines are the city's request about how a going already signalled might be received. A careful reading should hear the reverence in the prayer.

196. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Theseus's offer: “Aught of toil and _____ care,”

Key: zealous

197. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the messenger insist the chorus already saw, before the Threshold is named? Use the lines in which the blind man, not a friend, is said to be guiding them all.

Sample answer: He says they saw him move hence, and they must know how: without a friend to lead the way, he himself was guiding them all. “How he moved hence, you saw him and must know; / Without a friend to lead the way, himself / Guiding us all.” (lines 1634–1636). The blind man leads the seeing, even at the last, toward the place he will later name. The detail is not a claim that he has recovered ordinary sight. It shows that the summons still gives him a path.

198. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Ismene has said he died tombless, with none near. How does Antigone answer, and how does the chorus answer her?

Sample answer: Antigone answers by asking to be led to that place and slain there. The chorus tells the maids not to fear, and says that refuge has been found, where they shall be safe from harm. “Tombless he died, none near.” (line 1777). “Lead me thither; slay me there.” (line 1778). “Refuge hath been found.” (line 1784).

199. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Theseus reports a promise that the realm shall be at rest if he keeps a charge, and he has pledged that word to Zeus. Does the close present that kept silence as a civic gift? Argue from this scene, without turning the hidden tomb into a puzzle to solve on stage.

Sample answer: Yes, in the form this play allows. Theseus reports that if he keeps the hest he shall hold his realm at rest; he then says the God of Oaths heard the promise, and he pledged his word to Zeus. “If thou keep’st my hest / Thou shalt hold thy realm at rest.” (lines 1816–1817). “The God of Oaths this promise heard, / And to Zeus I pledged my word.” (lines 1818–1819). The protection is not a visible monument. It is a silence kept by the king, offered as a defence of the land, after a painless passing that only he has seen. The gift is the oath, not a grave the audience is invited to find.

200. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the scene answer Ismene's wish to share her father's fate, once she has said she cannot live a life thus desolate? Use the chorus's counsel about bearing what heaven brings, and Theseus's later word about drying tears.

Sample answer: The wish is real: Ismene would have death nip her breath and let her share her aged father's fate, because she cannot live a life thus desolate. The chorus tells the daughters that what heaven brings they needs must bear; later Theseus bids them dry their tears, saying that when grace is shed by dark Powers, over-grief would be resented. “O that Death / Might nip my breath, / And let me share my aged father’s fate.” (lines 1734–1736). “Dry your tears; when grace is shed / On the quick and on the dead” (lines 1801–1802).

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50	recall 19, inference 16, analysis 9, synthesis 6
HS Junior	51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59, 60, 61, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 100	recall 16, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 6
HS Senior	101, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107, 108, 109, 110, 111, 112, 113, 114, 115, 116, 117, 118, 119, 120, 121, 122, 123, 124, 125, 126, 127, 128, 129, 130, 131, 132, 133, 134, 135, 136, 137, 138, 139, 140, 141, 142, 143, 144, 145, 146, 147, 148, 149, 150	recall 13, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 9

AP	151, 152, 153, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158, 159, 160, 161, 162, 163, 164, 165, 166, 167, 168, 169, 170, 171, 172, 173, 174, 175, 176, 177, 178, 179, 180, 181, 182, 183, 184, 185, 186, 187, 188, 189, 190, 191, 192, 193, 194, 195, 196, 197, 198, 199, 200	recall 7, inference 12, analysis 15, synthesis 16

Final paper

Oedipus at Colonus: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Sophocles develops refuge and hospitality across Oedipus at Colonus. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Oedipus at Colonus and argue how its meaning changes over the play and why that change matters to guilt and intent.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Oedipus at Colonus. Argue whether the play judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Oedipus at Colonus finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of curse and mercy. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words

Evidence requirement: at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the section and line (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.

Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. The text makes this visible when it says "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue, lines 1–2). Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Refuge and hospitality

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops refuge and hospitality across Oedipus at Colonus. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus at Colonus (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of refuge and hospitality. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of refuge and hospitality in Oedipus at Colonus. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus at Colonus (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of refuge and hospitality, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Guilt and intent

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops guilt and intent across Oedipus at Colonus. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus at Colonus (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of guilt and intent. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of guilt and intent in Oedipus at Colonus. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus at Colonus (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of guilt and intent, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Curse and mercy

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops curse and mercy across Oedipus at Colonus. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus at Colonus (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of curse and mercy. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of curse and mercy in Oedipus at Colonus. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus at Colonus (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of curse and mercy, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Law against force

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops law against force across Oedipus at Colonus. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus at Colonus (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of law against force. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of law against force in Oedipus at Colonus. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus at Colonus (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of law against force, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Death and blessing

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops death and blessing across Oedipus at Colonus. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus at Colonus (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of death and blessing. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of death and blessing in Oedipus at Colonus. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus at Colonus (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of death and blessing, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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